Northwind Global Services Ltd.

HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY MANUAL

Version 2.0

Effective from 01 April 2025

Applicable to all employees of the Company

Classification: Internal / Confidential

This is a sample document with fictitious content, prepared for illustration and testing. It is not legal advice and does not reflect the policy of any real organisation.

Document Control

Version	Effective date	Status	Description of change
1.0	01 April 2023	Superseded	First consolidated release of the HR Policy Manual.
2.0	01 April 2025	Current	Annual review: revised entitlements, new chapters on AI use, flexible working and mental health; withdrawal of biometric attendance and company housing chapters.

Document owner	Head of Human Resources
Approved by	Policy Committee and Managing Director
Review cycle	Every 12 months
Contact	hr.policy@northwind.example

How to read this version

Text marked † has been reworded or revised since version 1.0. Provisions marked **[Revised in v2.0]** show a change in an entitlement or limit, with the previous value stated. Provisions marked **[New in v2.0]** did not exist in version 1.0. Chapter numbers differ between versions because of added and withdrawn chapters.

Summary of Changes from Version 1.0

Changes in key entitlements and limits

Item	Version 1.0	Version 2.0
Probation period	3 months	6 months
Maximum probation extension	up to 1 month	up to 3 months
Standard working week	45 hours per week	40 hours per week
Overtime rate	1.5 times	2.0 times
Overtime cap	50 hours per month	40 hours per month
Annual leave	18 working days	22 working days
Leave carry forward	10 days	12 days
Paid sick leave	8 days	12 days
Medical certificate required	more than 3 consecutive days	more than 2 consecutive days
Paternity leave	5 days	15 days
Expense claim deadline	30 days	45 days
Performance review cycle	annual	half-yearly
Grievance resolution time	15 working days	10 working days
Notice period (standard)	30 days	60 days
Notice period (senior)	60 days	90 days
Remote work	up to 2 days per month, with prior written approval	up to 3 days per week under the hybrid model
Referral reward	a bonus of 5,000 payable after 6 months of service	a bonus of 10,000 payable after 3 months of service
Annual learning hours	24 hours per year	40 hours per year
Wellbeing days	no dedicated wellbeing days	2 wellbeing days per year
Credential policy	a password change every 90 days	multi-factor authentication with an annual credential rotation
Investigation timeline	60 days	45 days

Structural changes

New chapters: Use of Artificial Intelligence and Generative Tools, Flexible Working Arrangements, Mental Health Support Programme.

Withdrawn chapters: Biometric Attendance System, Company Housing Scheme.

Retitled chapters: Remote Work (Exceptional Cases) is now Remote and Hybrid Work; Whistleblowing is now Whistleblowing and Protected Disclosures.

Reworded clauses (marked with a dagger): 1314. **New clauses in existing chapters:** 88. **Revised entitlements or limits:** 21.

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Chapter 1

Introduction and Governance

1.1 Purpose and Scope

1.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to introduction and governance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.1.2 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to introduction and governance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

1.1.3 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on introduction and governance. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.1.4 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.1.5 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.1.6 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to introduction and governance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.1.7 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

1.1.8 The objective of these provisions on introduction and governance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.1.9 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

1.1.10 The objective of these provisions on introduction and governance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights

available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

1.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to introduction and governance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.1.12 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

1.1.13 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The objective of these provisions on introduction and governance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

1.1.15 The objective of these provisions on introduction and governance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

1.1.16 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to introduction and governance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.1.17 The objective of these provisions on introduction and governance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.1.19 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.1.20 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

1.1.21 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The objective of these provisions on introduction and governance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

1.1.22 The objective of these provisions on introduction and governance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

1.1.23 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

1.1.24 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to introduction and governance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

1.1.25 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.1.26 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

1.1.27 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be

borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.1.29 The Company recognises that introduction and governance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

1.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.1.32 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on introduction and governance. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on introduction and governance. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.2 Definitions and Interpretation

1.2.1 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "introduction and governance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance.

1.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "introduction and governance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. †

1.2.5 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "introduction and governance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

1.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

1.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "introduction and governance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. †

1.2.8 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

1.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

1.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.2.12 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

1.2.13 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.2.14 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.2.15 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. For

the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "introduction and governance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

1.2.16 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "introduction and governance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

1.2.17 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

1.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

1.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

1.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

1.2.21 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.2.22 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

1.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member

may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance.

1.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.2.26 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance.

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1.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.2.29 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

1.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

1.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to introduction and governance.

1.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.3 Eligibility and Applicability

1.3.1 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

1.3.2 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.3.4 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.3.5 Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for introduction and governance restricted until the matter is concluded.

1.3.6 Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.3.7 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. †

1.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

1.3.9 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.3.10 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

1.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.3.13 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

1.3.14 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.3.16 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.3.17 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on introduction and governance. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

1.3.19 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for introduction and governance restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.3.21 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.3.22 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on introduction and governance.

1.3.23 Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.3.24 Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.3.25 Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.3.26 Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.3.27 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.3.28 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.3.29 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.3.30 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.3.33 Eligibility for introduction and governance shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.4 Responsibilities of Employees

1.4.1 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of introduction and governance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

1.4.2 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to introduction and governance and shall not withhold material facts.

1.4.4 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

1.4.6 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on introduction and governance and shall comply with them at all times.

1.4.7 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to introduction and governance and shall not withhold material facts. †

1.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

1.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

1.4.10 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of introduction and governance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on introduction and governance and shall comply with them at all times.

1.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to introduction and governance and shall not withhold material facts. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

1.4.17 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of introduction and governance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

1.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of introduction and governance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

1.4.21 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.4.22 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of introduction and governance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

1.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to introduction and governance and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.4.24 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to introduction and governance and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on introduction and governance and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance.

1.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.4.27 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.4.28 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to introduction and governance and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

1.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on introduction and governance and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of introduction and governance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

1.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on introduction and governance and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.4.32 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. †

1.4.34 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with introduction and governance. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. **[New in v2.0]**

1.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

1.5.1 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to introduction and governance within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

1.5.2 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on introduction and governance and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.5.3 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

1.5.4 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on introduction and governance and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.5.5 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on introduction and governance and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

1.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to introduction and governance to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.5.7 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.5.8 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.5.9 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on introduction and governance and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.5.10 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.5.11 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to introduction and governance within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.5.12 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to introduction and governance within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on introduction and governance and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

1.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on introduction and governance and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

1.5.15 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to introduction and governance within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

1.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

1.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to introduction and governance within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

1.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on introduction and governance. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.5.20 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on introduction and governance. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to introduction and governance to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

1.5.21 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to introduction and governance within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on introduction and governance and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

1.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to introduction and governance to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

1.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on introduction and governance.

1.5.25 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

1.5.26 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on introduction and governance. †

1.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on introduction and governance. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on introduction and governance and applies them consistently.

1.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to introduction and governance to the Policy Committee without undue delay. †

1.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on introduction and governance and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

1.5.30 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to introduction and governance to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

1.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.5.32 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on introduction and governance and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

1.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to introduction and governance within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

1.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with introduction and governance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.6.2 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for introduction and governance and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance.

1.6.3 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with introduction and governance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.6.4 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

1.6.5 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to introduction and governance and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. †

1.6.6 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.6.7 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 5 working days of receipt.

1.6.8 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.6.9 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 21 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

1.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with introduction and governance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for introduction and governance and shall make them available to all employees.

1.6.12 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to introduction and governance and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.6.13 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance.

1.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 5 working days of receipt. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance

made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 5 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.6.17 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 14 working days of receipt.

1.6.19 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 7 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for introduction and governance and shall make them available to all employees.

1.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

1.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 15 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

1.6.22 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for introduction and governance and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

1.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall monitor compliance with

this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

1.6.24 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with introduction and governance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.6.25 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 10 working days of receipt. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

1.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for introduction and governance and shall make them available to all employees.

1.6.28 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance.

1.6.30 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to introduction and governance and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on introduction and governance within 3 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

1.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with introduction and governance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.6.33 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to introduction and governance and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to introduction and governance. †

1.7 Procedure and Process Steps

1.7.1 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.7.2 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.7.3 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.7.4 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. †

1.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.7.7 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.7.8 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it.

1.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to introduction and governance by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.7.10 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the

employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

1.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 2 working days of receiving it.

1.7.12 The employee shall initiate the process relating to introduction and governance by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.7.13 The employee shall initiate the process relating to introduction and governance by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.7.14 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it.

1.7.15 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.7.16 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

1.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

1.7.18 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. †

1.7.19 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant,

shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.7.20 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

1.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

1.7.22 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to introduction and governance by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

1.7.24 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.7.26 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.7.28 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.7.29 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to introduction and governance by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed

period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

1.7.31 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

1.7.32 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

1.7.33 The employee shall initiate the process relating to introduction and governance by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

1.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.8.3 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.8.4 Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.8.5 Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

1.8.6 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to introduction and governance that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

1.8.8 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.8.9 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

1.8.10 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

1.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

1.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to introduction and governance that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years.

1.8.15 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

1.8.16 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

1.8.18 All documents relating to introduction and governance shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the

employee.

1.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to introduction and governance that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.8.21 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

1.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

1.8.23 Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

1.8.24 All documents relating to introduction and governance shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.8.25 Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

1.8.26 Records relating to introduction and governance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.8.27 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

1.8.28 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.8.29 All documents relating to introduction and governance shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.8.30 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to introduction and governance that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

1.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.8.32 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

1.8.33 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to introduction and governance that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

1.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.9.2 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

1.9.3 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.9.4 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance

made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.9.5 Exceptions to the provisions on introduction and governance may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

1.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

1.9.8 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

1.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

1.9.12 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.9.13 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

1.9.14 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this

Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

1.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

1.9.16 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

1.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.9.20 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on introduction and governance may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

1.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

1.9.23 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.9.25 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.9.26 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.9.27 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. †

1.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on introduction and governance may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

1.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

1.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on introduction and governance may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

1.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.9.34 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. **[New in v2.0]**

1.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

1.10.1 Where an external regulator requests information concerning introduction and governance, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.10.2 Compliance with the provisions on introduction and governance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.10.3 An internal audit of introduction and governance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.10.4 Compliance with the provisions on introduction and governance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to introduction and governance. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.10.7 Compliance data relating to introduction and governance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.10.8 An internal audit of introduction and governance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the HR Operations team shall decide

on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.10.9 An internal audit of introduction and governance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

1.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on introduction and governance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.10.12 An internal audit of introduction and governance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.10.13 An internal audit of introduction and governance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.10.14 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to introduction and governance. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

1.10.15 Compliance with the provisions on introduction and governance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to introduction and governance.

1.10.16 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

1.10.17 Compliance with the provisions on introduction and governance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

1.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to introduction and governance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

1.10.19 Compliance data relating to introduction and governance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under

this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.10.20 Compliance data relating to introduction and governance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to introduction and governance.

1.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.10.24 An internal audit of introduction and governance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning introduction and governance, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning introduction and governance, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

1.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on introduction and governance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.10.29 Where an external regulator requests information concerning introduction and governance, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to introduction and governance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.10.32 Compliance data relating to introduction and governance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

1.10.33 Compliance data relating to introduction and governance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

1.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

1.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

1.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on introduction and governance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.11.5 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.11.7 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct.

1.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

1.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

1.11.10 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.11.12 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

1.11.13 A failure to comply with the provisions on introduction and governance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on introduction and governance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive

rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

1.11.17 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

1.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

1.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on introduction and governance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct.

1.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.11.21 A failure to comply with the provisions on introduction and governance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct. †

1.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A failure to comply with the provisions on introduction and governance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. †

1.11.23 A failure to comply with the provisions on introduction and governance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

1.11.24 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

1.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.11.26 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company

may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

1.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

1.11.29 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

1.11.30 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

1.11.31 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.11.32 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.11.33 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to introduction and governance shall be treated as serious misconduct.

1.12 Review and Amendment

1.12.1 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

1.12.2 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. †

1.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

1.12.4 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

1.12.5 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

1.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to introduction and governance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

1.12.7 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

1.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.12.9 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

1.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

1.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

1.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

1.12.14 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the

policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

1.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

1.12.17 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on introduction and governance through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

1.12.18 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

1.12.19 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

1.12.20 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.12.21 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

1.12.22 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

1.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

1.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on introduction and governance through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

1.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.12.26 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

1.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to introduction and governance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

1.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

1.12.29 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on introduction and governance through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

1.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

1.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on introduction and governance through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

1.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

Chapter 2

Equal Opportunity and Diversity

2.1 Purpose and Scope

2.1.1 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.1.2 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to equal opportunity and diversity and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to equal opportunity and diversity and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.1.4 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to equal opportunity and diversity and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.1.5 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

2.1.6 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

2.1.7 The Company recognises that equal opportunity and diversity has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.1.8 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to equal opportunity and diversity and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the

Policy Committee. The Company recognises that equal opportunity and diversity has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

2.1.9 The Company recognises that equal opportunity and diversity has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

2.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.1.11 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on equal opportunity and diversity. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on equal opportunity and diversity. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.1.14 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on equal opportunity and diversity. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

2.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to equal opportunity and diversity and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

2.1.16 The Company recognises that equal opportunity and diversity has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to equal opportunity and diversity and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

2.1.18 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.1.19 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.1.20 The Company recognises that equal opportunity and diversity has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.1.21 The objective of these provisions on equal opportunity and diversity is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.1.22 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

2.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company recognises that equal opportunity and diversity has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

2.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on equal opportunity and diversity. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.1.25 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to equal opportunity and diversity and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.1.27 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on equal opportunity and diversity. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

2.1.28 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

2.1.29 The Company recognises that equal opportunity and diversity has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

2.1.31 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.1.32 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on equal opportunity and diversity. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

2.2 Definitions and Interpretation

2.2.1 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "equal opportunity and diversity" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

2.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

2.2.3 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "equal opportunity and diversity" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

2.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to equal opportunity and diversity. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

2.2.8 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.2.10 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.2.11 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.2.12 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to equal opportunity and diversity. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

2.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.2.14 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "equal opportunity and diversity" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.2.15 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

2.2.16 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "equal opportunity and diversity" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

2.2.17 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to equal opportunity and diversity. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.2.18 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

2.2.19 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.2.20 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to equal opportunity and diversity. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

2.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

2.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to equal opportunity and diversity. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

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2.2.27 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.2.28 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.2.29 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.2.30 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

2.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

2.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

2.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.3 Eligibility and Applicability

2.3.1 Eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity.

2.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

2.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity.

2.3.4 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded.

2.3.7 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

2.3.8 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

2.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

2.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

2.3.13 Eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

2.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a

request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.3.17 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. †

2.3.18 Eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

2.3.21 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

2.3.22 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.3.23 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.3.24 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.3.25 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity. Where a

provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

2.3.26 Eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded.

2.3.27 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

2.3.29 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

2.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

2.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for equal opportunity and diversity restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.4 Responsibilities of Employees

2.4.1 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

2.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

2.4.4 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.4.7 The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

2.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

2.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. No

employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.4.12 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

2.4.13 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with equal opportunity and diversity.

2.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and shall comply with them at all times.

2.4.16 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

2.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.4.18 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with equal opportunity and diversity. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.4.19 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with equal opportunity and diversity.

2.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with equal opportunity and diversity. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

2.4.21 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and shall comply with them at all times. For instance, where two employees

make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.4.22 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.4.23 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with equal opportunity and diversity. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.4.24 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

2.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts.

2.4.26 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

2.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.4.28 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with equal opportunity and diversity. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

2.4.30 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and shall comply with them at all times.

2.4.32 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity and shall not withhold material facts.

2.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with equal opportunity and diversity. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of equal opportunity and diversity as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

2.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

2.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

2.5.2 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to equal opportunity and diversity to the HR Director without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and applies them consistently.

2.5.3 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

2.5.4 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to equal opportunity and diversity to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.5.5 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to equal opportunity and diversity to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to equal opportunity and diversity within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

2.5.6 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.5.7 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to equal opportunity and diversity to the HR Director without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

2.5.8 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.5.9 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

2.5.10 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.5.11 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

2.5.12 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to equal opportunity and diversity within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity

and applies them consistently.

2.5.13 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on equal opportunity and diversity. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.5.14 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

2.5.15 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

2.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on equal opportunity and diversity. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.5.18 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.5.19 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to equal opportunity and diversity within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and applies them consistently.

2.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

2.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to equal

opportunity and diversity within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. †

2.5.22 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to equal opportunity and diversity within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on equal opportunity and diversity. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

2.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.5.25 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.5.26 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on equal opportunity and diversity. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to equal opportunity and diversity to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.5.29 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to equal opportunity and diversity to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.5.30 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on equal opportunity and diversity. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by

e-mail. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to equal opportunity and diversity to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

2.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on equal opportunity and diversity.

2.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on equal opportunity and diversity and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to equal opportunity and diversity within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

2.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

2.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

2.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. †

2.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.6.5 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for equal opportunity and diversity and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this

Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

2.6.7 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for equal opportunity and diversity and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

2.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to equal opportunity and diversity and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.6.9 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.6.10 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity.

2.6.13 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

2.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

2.6.16 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to equal opportunity and diversity and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For

instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for equal opportunity and diversity and shall make them available to all employees.

2.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for equal opportunity and diversity and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall respond to every written query on equal opportunity and diversity within 5 working days of receipt.

2.6.18 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for equal opportunity and diversity and shall make them available to all employees.

2.6.19 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

2.6.20 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for equal opportunity and diversity and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.6.21 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to equal opportunity and diversity and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to equal opportunity and diversity and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall respond to every written query on equal opportunity and diversity within 30 working days of receipt.

2.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to equal opportunity and diversity and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall respond to every written query on equal opportunity and diversity within 5 working days of receipt.

2.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

2.6.25 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides

otherwise.

2.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on equal opportunity and diversity within 5 working days of receipt. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

2.6.27 HR shall respond to every written query on equal opportunity and diversity within 15 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

2.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

2.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on equal opportunity and diversity within 15 working days of receipt.

2.6.31 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

2.6.32 HR shall respond to every written query on equal opportunity and diversity within 7 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with equal opportunity and diversity in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

2.6.33 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to equal opportunity and diversity. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

2.7 Procedure and Process Steps

2.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.7.2 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.7.3 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

2.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

2.7.5 The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it.

2.7.6 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

2.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.7.8 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.7.9 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

2.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.7.12 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where

two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.7.14 The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.7.15 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.7.16 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

2.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.7.18 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager.

2.7.19 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.7.20 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

2.7.21 The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

2.7.22 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.7.23 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.7.24 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager.

2.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 14 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.7.26 The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to equal opportunity and diversity by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. †

2.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

2.7.29 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

2.7.31 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 21 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less

favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

2.8.1 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.8.2 Records relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

2.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.8.4 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.8.5 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to equal opportunity and diversity that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.8.6 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

2.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

2.8.8 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the

employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

2.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

2.8.11 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

2.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.8.13 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.8.16 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.8.17 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.8.18 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. †

2.8.19 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.8.20 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less

favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

2.8.21 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Records relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years.

2.8.22 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.8.23 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

2.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to equal opportunity and diversity that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

2.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. †

2.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

2.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.8.28 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.8.29 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.8.30 Records relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

2.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.8.33 All documents relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

2.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

2.9.3 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

2.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the

discretion of the HR Business Partner.

2.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.9.6 Exceptions to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

2.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice.

2.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

2.9.11 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.9.13 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. No

exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

2.9.15 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

2.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.9.17 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

2.9.18 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

2.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

2.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

2.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

2.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.9.24 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. For instance, where two employees make competing requests

relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.9.26 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.9.27 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

2.9.28 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.9.29 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.9.31 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

2.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

2.10.1 Where an external regulator requests information concerning equal opportunity and diversity, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.10.2 Compliance data relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

2.10.3 Compliance data relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.10.4 Compliance data relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

2.10.5 An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.10.7 Compliance data relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

2.10.8 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to equal opportunity and diversity. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.10.9 An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.10.10 An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where

the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance data relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

2.10.11 Where an external regulator requests information concerning equal opportunity and diversity, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

2.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

2.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.10.14 Where an external regulator requests information concerning equal opportunity and diversity, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

2.10.15 An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

2.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.10.17 Compliance with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning equal opportunity and diversity, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter

expressly provides otherwise.

2.10.19 An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

2.10.20 Compliance data relating to equal opportunity and diversity shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to equal opportunity and diversity. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

2.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

2.10.23 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning equal opportunity and diversity, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning equal opportunity and diversity, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.10.26 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Compliance with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

2.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning equal opportunity and diversity, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.10.29 An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

2.10.30 An internal audit of equal opportunity and diversity shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

2.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.10.32 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

2.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

2.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

2.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

2.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

2.11.4 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be

given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

2.11.5 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

2.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

2.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to equal opportunity and diversity shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. A failure to comply with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

2.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

2.11.10 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

2.11.13 A failure to comply with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.11.14 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to equal opportunity and diversity shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall

be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

2.11.15 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

2.11.16 A failure to comply with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

2.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

2.11.18 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

2.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

2.11.20 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

2.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to equal opportunity and diversity shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

2.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to equal opportunity and diversity shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

2.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to equal opportunity and diversity shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

2.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to equal opportunity and diversity shall be treated as serious misconduct.

2.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

2.11.30 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to equal opportunity and diversity shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

2.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

2.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR

Business Partner.

2.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

2.12 Review and Amendment

2.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.12.2 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

2.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

2.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.12.5 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

2.12.6 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.12.7 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

2.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.12.9 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and

approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

2.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

2.12.11 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to equal opportunity and diversity made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

2.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

2.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

2.12.15 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

2.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.12.17 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

2.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

2.12.19 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

2.12.20 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

2.12.21 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be

borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

2.12.22 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

2.12.23 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

2.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

2.12.25 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. †

2.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. †

2.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

2.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

2.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

2.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned

unless the Company decides otherwise. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

2.12.31 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to equal opportunity and diversity, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

2.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

2.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

2.12.34 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on equal opportunity and diversity through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. **[New in v2.0]**

Chapter 3

Recruitment and Selection

3.1 Purpose and Scope

3.1.1 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.1.2 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to recruitment and selection and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection.

3.1.3 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection.

3.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

3.1.5 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to recruitment and selection and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.1.6 The objective of these provisions on recruitment and selection is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.1.7 The Company recognises that recruitment and selection has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

3.1.9 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.1.10 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to recruitment and selection and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

3.1.11 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.1.12 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection.

3.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.1.15 The objective of these provisions on recruitment and selection is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to recruitment and selection and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

3.1.16 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.1.17 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

3.1.18 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to recruitment and selection and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

3.1.20 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

3.1.21 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to recruitment and selection and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.1.22 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company recognises that recruitment and selection has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

3.1.23 The objective of these provisions on recruitment and selection is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

3.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

3.1.26 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.1.27 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.1.28 The Company recognises that recruitment and selection has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.1.29 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection.

3.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.1.31 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on recruitment and selection. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.1.32 The objective of these provisions on recruitment and selection is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

3.1.33 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.2 Definitions and Interpretation

3.2.1 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "recruitment and selection" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

3.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "recruitment and selection" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.2.5 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.2.6 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

3.2.7 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

3.2.8 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

3.2.9 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

3.2.10 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.2.11 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

3.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.2.13 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to recruitment and selection. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.2.15 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The term "Line

Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

3.2.17 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to recruitment and selection. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.2.20 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

3.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.2.22 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

3.2.23 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "recruitment and selection" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

3.2.24 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "recruitment and selection" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on

record.

3.2.26 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to recruitment and selection. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.2.27 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

3.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to recruitment and selection.

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3.2.31 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.2.32 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to recruitment and selection. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to recruitment and selection.

3.3 Eligibility and Applicability

3.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

3.3.2 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.3.3 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

3.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

3.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for recruitment and selection restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for recruitment and selection restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

3.3.8 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

3.3.9 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.3.10 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

3.3.11 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

3.3.13 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.3.15 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

3.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

3.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on recruitment and selection. This requirement

applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.3.20 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on recruitment and selection.

3.3.22 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.3.23 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

3.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

3.3.26 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for recruitment and selection restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.3.28 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on recruitment and selection. Employees should

seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

3.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on recruitment and selection. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

3.3.30 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. †

3.3.31 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on recruitment and selection. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

3.3.33 Eligibility for recruitment and selection shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

3.4 Responsibilities of Employees

3.4.1 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on recruitment and selection and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.4.2 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on recruitment and selection and shall comply with them at all times.

3.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.4.4 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the

person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

3.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

3.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.4.10 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on recruitment and selection and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.4.11 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

3.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. †

3.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

3.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.4.16 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on recruitment and selection and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

3.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

3.4.19 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

3.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.4.21 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.4.22 The employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is

intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to recruitment and selection and shall not withhold material facts.

3.4.23 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

3.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.4.25 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection.

3.4.26 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.4.27 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

3.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to recruitment and selection and shall not withhold material facts.

3.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

3.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to recruitment and selection and shall not withhold material facts.

3.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with recruitment and selection. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.4.32 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another

department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

3.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of recruitment and selection as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

3.4.34 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. **[New in v2.0]**

3.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

3.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on recruitment and selection and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.5.3 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

3.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on recruitment and selection and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.5.6 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on recruitment and selection and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to recruitment and selection within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR

repository.

3.5.7 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the HR Director without undue delay.

3.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.5.10 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on recruitment and selection. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.5.11 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

3.5.12 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on recruitment and selection and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.5.13 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on recruitment and selection. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on recruitment and selection and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.5.15 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on

recruitment and selection.

3.5.16 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.5.18 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

3.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on recruitment and selection. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to recruitment and selection within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

3.5.21 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to recruitment and selection within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.5.22 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on recruitment and selection and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.5.23 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the

reason for it.

3.5.25 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.5.26 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to recruitment and selection within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

3.5.27 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on recruitment and selection and applies them consistently.

3.5.28 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to recruitment and selection within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

3.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on recruitment and selection.

3.5.30 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

3.5.31 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on recruitment and selection. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to recruitment and selection within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

3.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to recruitment and selection to the HR Director without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.5.33 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on recruitment and selection and applies them consistently. Cost implications,

where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

3.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with recruitment and selection in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 15 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

3.6.3 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.6.4 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for recruitment and selection and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

3.6.5 HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 7 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.6.6 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to recruitment and selection. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with recruitment and selection in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

3.6.8 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.6.9 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to recruitment and selection. HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 14 working days of receipt.

3.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 15 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.6.11 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to recruitment and selection and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for recruitment and selection and shall make them available to all employees. †

3.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to recruitment and selection and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to recruitment and selection. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.6.15 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to recruitment and selection. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 14 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.6.17 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

3.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to recruitment and selection and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall

continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.6.19 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to recruitment and selection and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.6.20 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with recruitment and selection in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to recruitment and selection and on the applicable legal requirements.

3.6.22 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

3.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to recruitment and selection. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for recruitment and selection and shall make them available to all employees.

3.6.24 HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 10 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

3.6.25 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for recruitment and selection and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.6.26 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with recruitment and selection in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate,

where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

3.6.29 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with recruitment and selection in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

3.6.30 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.6.31 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to recruitment and selection. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 21 working days of receipt.

3.6.32 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to recruitment and selection and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

3.6.33 HR shall respond to every written query on recruitment and selection within 14 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.6.34 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. **[New in v2.0]**

3.7 Procedure and Process Steps

3.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.7.2 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

3.7.3 The employee shall initiate the process relating to recruitment and selection by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

3.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.7.5 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.7.6 The employee shall initiate the process relating to recruitment and selection by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

3.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to recruitment and selection by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

3.7.10 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee

submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

3.7.11 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.7.12 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The employee shall initiate the process relating to recruitment and selection by submitting a written request to the Head of Department.

3.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

3.7.14 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.7.15 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 21 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to recruitment and selection by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

3.7.18 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

3.7.19 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and

any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.7.20 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

3.7.21 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 15 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.7.22 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 14 working days of receiving it.

3.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

3.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

3.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The employee shall initiate the process relating to recruitment and selection by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager.

3.7.27 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.7.28 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

3.7.29 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.7.30 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.7.31 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.7.32 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.7.33 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

3.7.34 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. **[New in v2.0]**

3.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

3.8.1 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

3.8.2 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.8.3 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to

act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

3.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

3.8.5 Records relating to recruitment and selection shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.8.6 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

3.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

3.8.8 All documents relating to recruitment and selection shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

3.8.9 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to recruitment and selection that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

3.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.8.11 All documents relating to recruitment and selection shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a

dated annotation rather than by deletion. †

3.8.12 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.8.14 Records relating to recruitment and selection shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.8.15 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

3.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.8.17 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.8.18 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to recruitment and selection that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

3.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to recruitment and selection that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.8.22 Records relating to recruitment and selection shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.8.23 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.8.24 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Records relating to recruitment and selection shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years.

3.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

3.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.8.28 Records relating to recruitment and selection shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

3.8.29 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to recruitment and selection that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

3.8.30 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to recruitment and selection that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

3.8.31 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to recruitment and selection that is held about them, subject to applicable law. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.8.32 All documents relating to recruitment and selection shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

3.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

3.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on recruitment and selection may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

3.9.4 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.9.7 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

3.9.8 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.9.9 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

3.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on recruitment and selection may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot

reasonably be applied.

3.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.9.12 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. †

3.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

3.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.9.17 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

3.9.18 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

3.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

3.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any

statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on recruitment and selection may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

3.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

3.9.24 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.9.25 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

3.9.26 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on recruitment and selection may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

3.9.31 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

3.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

3.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.10.2 Compliance data relating to recruitment and selection shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

3.10.3 Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

3.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.10.6 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

3.10.7 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to recruitment and selection.

3.10.8 Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to recruitment and selection.

3.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to recruitment and selection. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

3.10.10 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance data relating to recruitment and selection shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

3.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.10.13 Compliance data relating to recruitment and selection shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

3.10.14 Compliance data relating to recruitment and selection shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Any deficiency identified shall

be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

3.10.16 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.10.17 Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

3.10.18 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

3.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to recruitment and selection. †

3.10.22 An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.10.23 An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

3.10.24 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to recruitment and selection. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.10.25 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the

order in which the requests were received.

3.10.26 An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

3.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

3.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.10.29 Where an external regulator requests information concerning recruitment and selection, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.10.30 An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to recruitment and selection. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

3.10.32 Compliance with the provisions on recruitment and selection shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.10.33 An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

3.10.34 An internal audit of recruitment and selection shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. **[New in v2.0]**

3.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

3.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

3.11.2 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.11.3 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.11.4 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.11.5 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to recruitment and selection shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

3.11.7 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to recruitment and selection shall be treated as serious misconduct.

3.11.8 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to recruitment and selection shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

3.11.9 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

3.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less

favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

3.11.14 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

3.11.15 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to recruitment and selection shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

3.11.19 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to recruitment and selection shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.11.20 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

3.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

3.11.25 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

3.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

3.11.27 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

3.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by

law.

3.11.30 A failure to comply with the provisions on recruitment and selection may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on recruitment and selection may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

3.11.32 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

3.12 Review and Amendment

3.12.1 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

3.12.2 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

3.12.3 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

3.12.4 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

3.12.5 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

3.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

3.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on recruitment and selection through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

3.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.12.10 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

3.12.11 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on recruitment and selection through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

3.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

3.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.12.14 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

3.12.15 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on recruitment and selection through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

3.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall be notified of

every amendment to the provisions on recruitment and selection through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

3.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

3.12.18 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

3.12.19 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

3.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. As an illustration, a request relating to recruitment and selection made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

3.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

3.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

3.12.23 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on recruitment and selection through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

3.12.25 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

3.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

3.12.28 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

3.12.29 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

3.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on recruitment and selection through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to recruitment and selection, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

3.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

3.12.32 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

3.12.33 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

Chapter 4

Employment Contracts and Onboarding

4.1 Purpose and Scope

4.1.1 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.1.2 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employment contracts and onboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

4.1.3 The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.1.4 The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

4.1.5 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.1.7 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

4.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employment contracts and onboarding. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.1.9 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

4.1.10 The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

4.1.11 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.1.12 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.1.13 The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

4.1.14 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.1.15 The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.1.16 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.1.17 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employment contracts and onboarding. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

4.1.18 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employment contracts and onboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that

have adopted this Manual.

4.1.20 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

4.1.21 The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

4.1.22 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employment contracts and onboarding. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

4.1.23 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employment contracts and onboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

4.1.24 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

4.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.1.26 The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

4.1.27 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employment contracts and onboarding. Where a provision of

this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.1.28 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employment contracts and onboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

4.1.29 The objective of these provisions on employment contracts and onboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The Company recognises that employment contracts and onboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. †

4.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employment contracts and onboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.1.32 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employment contracts and onboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.2 Definitions and Interpretation

4.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employment contracts and onboarding. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

4.2.2 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

4.2.3 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.2.4 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.2.5 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

4.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

4.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.2.10 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

4.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.2.12 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

4.2.13 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

4.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

4.2.15 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

4.2.16 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.2.17 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employment contracts and onboarding. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

4.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

4.2.21 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.2.22 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.2.23 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.2.24 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employment contracts and onboarding. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

4.2.25 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

4.2.26 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employment contracts and onboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

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4.2.28 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

4.2.30 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

4.2.31 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

4.2.32 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For the purposes

of this Chapter, the expression "employment contracts and onboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

4.3 Eligibility and Applicability

4.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.3.2 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.3.3 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

4.3.4 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

4.3.5 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

4.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

4.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.3.10 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

4.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

4.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

4.3.13 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.3.14 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

4.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

4.3.16 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

4.3.17 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

4.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

4.3.19 Eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

4.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

4.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

4.3.22 Eligibility for employment contracts and onboarding shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

4.3.23 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.3.25 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.3.26 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.3.27 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

4.3.28 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

4.3.29 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.3.30 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.3.31 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.3.32 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

4.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

4.4 Responsibilities of Employees

4.4.1 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employment contracts and onboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.4.3 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.4.4 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employment contracts and onboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employment contracts and onboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employment contracts and onboarding. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Each employee shall familiarise themselves

with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and shall comply with them at all times.

4.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employment contracts and onboarding. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employment contracts and onboarding. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

4.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employment contracts and onboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.4.11 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.4.13 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

4.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding and shall not withhold material facts.

4.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.4.16 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding and shall not withhold material facts.

4.4.17 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employment contracts and onboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.4.18 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employment contracts and onboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.4.19 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employment contracts and onboarding.

4.4.20 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

4.4.21 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.4.22 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

4.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.4.26 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding and shall not withhold material facts.

4.4.27 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employment contracts and onboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding and shall not withhold material facts.

4.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and shall comply with them at all times.

4.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employment contracts and onboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

4.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.4.33 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding and shall not withhold material facts.

4.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

4.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employment contracts and onboarding. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employment contracts and onboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.5.3 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.5.4 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employment contracts and onboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

4.5.5 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. †

4.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employment contracts and onboarding to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and

shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employment contracts and onboarding.

4.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employment contracts and onboarding to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

4.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.5.15 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employment contracts and onboarding to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employment contracts and onboarding. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

4.5.17 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

4.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employment contracts and onboarding to the HR Director without undue delay.

Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

4.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employment contracts and onboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

4.5.21 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.5.23 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employment contracts and onboarding to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and applies them consistently.

4.5.25 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employment contracts and onboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.5.26 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.5.27 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.5.28 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.5.29 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

4.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.5.31 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

4.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employment contracts and onboarding to the HR Director without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding and applies them consistently.

4.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employment contracts and onboarding within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

4.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

4.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employment contracts and onboarding and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

4.6.2 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

4.6.3 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employment contracts and onboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority

nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employment contracts and onboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding.

4.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employment contracts and onboarding and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.6.7 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employment contracts and onboarding and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding.

4.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employment contracts and onboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.6.10 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employment contracts and onboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.6.11 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employment contracts and onboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall respond to every written query on employment contracts and onboarding within 15 working days of receipt.

4.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall respond to every written query on employment contracts and onboarding within 21 working days of receipt.

4.6.14 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employment contracts and onboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

4.6.15 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employment contracts and onboarding and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

4.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employment contracts and onboarding and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

4.6.19 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

4.6.20 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding.

4.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

4.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employment contracts and onboarding and on the applicable legal requirements. HR shall respond to every written query on employment contracts and onboarding within 10 working days of receipt.

4.6.23 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employment contracts and onboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

4.6.24 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employment contracts and onboarding and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding.

4.6.25 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

4.6.26 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employment contracts and onboarding. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

4.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.6.28 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employment contracts and onboarding and shall make them available to all employees. †

4.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employment contracts and onboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

4.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employment contracts and onboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall respond to every written query on employment contracts and onboarding within 7 working days of receipt. †

4.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

4.7 Procedure and Process Steps

4.7.1 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.7.2 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

4.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

4.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision,

and the outcome shall be final.

4.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

4.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

4.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

4.7.8 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employment contracts and onboarding by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner.

4.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

4.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.7.11 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employment contracts and onboarding by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.7.12 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

4.7.14 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employment contracts and onboarding by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

4.7.17 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employment contracts and onboarding by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

4.7.18 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it.

4.7.19 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.7.20 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it.

4.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

4.7.22 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

4.7.23 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The employee shall initiate the process relating to employment contracts and onboarding by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner.

4.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

4.7.25 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. †

4.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 3 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

4.7.28 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

4.7.29 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.7.30 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employment contracts and onboarding by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.7.33 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.7.34 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. **[New in v2.0]**

4.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

4.8.1 All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.8.2 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.8.3 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

4.8.4 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.8.5 Records relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

4.8.6 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.8.7 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

4.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

4.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.8.10 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. †

4.8.11 All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

4.8.12 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

4.8.13 All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

4.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.8.15 All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Records relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years.

4.8.16 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

4.8.17 Records relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

4.8.18 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance,

where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.8.19 Records relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.8.20 All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.8.21 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

4.8.22 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

4.8.23 All documents relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

4.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

4.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

4.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the

employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.8.28 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.8.29 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

4.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.8.31 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

4.8.32 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.8.33 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employment contracts and onboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

4.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

4.9.1 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

4.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

4.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

4.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.9.5 Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.9.6 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

4.9.8 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

4.9.9 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.9.10 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.9.12 Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.9.13 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

4.9.15 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice.

4.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

4.9.18 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

4.9.20 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.9.21 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

4.9.22 Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be

dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.9.24 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

4.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

4.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.9.28 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

4.9.30 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

4.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

4.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate,

where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

4.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

4.10.1 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.10.2 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding.

4.10.3 An internal audit of employment contracts and onboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.10.4 Compliance with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

4.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

4.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.10.8 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the

order in which the requests were received.

4.10.9 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

4.10.10 An internal audit of employment contracts and onboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

4.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Compliance with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

4.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.10.14 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.10.15 Compliance with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employment contracts and onboarding, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

4.10.16 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.10.17 An internal audit of employment contracts and onboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.10.18 Compliance with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding.

4.10.19 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

4.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employment contracts and onboarding, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

4.10.24 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

4.10.25 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.10.26 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.10.27 An internal audit of employment contracts and onboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

4.10.28 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.10.29 Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

4.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

4.10.31 An internal audit of employment contracts and onboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.10.32 An internal audit of employment contracts and onboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Compliance data relating to employment contracts and onboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

4.10.33 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employment contracts and onboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

4.11.1 A failure to comply with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employment contracts and onboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct.

4.11.3 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees

make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

4.11.4 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.11.5 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.11.6 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.11.7 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

4.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A failure to comply with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

4.11.9 A failure to comply with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

4.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.11.11 A failure to comply with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

4.11.12 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

4.11.13 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than

punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.11.14 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.11.15 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employment contracts and onboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

4.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

4.11.18 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employment contracts and onboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

4.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

4.11.20 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

4.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employment contracts and onboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

4.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

4.11.24 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.11.25 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

4.11.26 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employment contracts and onboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct.

4.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

4.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.11.30 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employment contracts and onboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

4.11.31 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employment contracts and onboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

4.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

4.11.33 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.11.34 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. **[New in v2.0]**

4.12 Review and Amendment

4.12.1 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

4.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect.

4.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

4.12.5 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. †

4.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

4.12.7 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

4.12.8 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

4.12.9 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.12.10 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

4.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.12.12 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.12.14 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

4.12.15 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

4.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

4.12.19 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once

every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

4.12.20 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

4.12.21 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

4.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

4.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

4.12.25 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

4.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employment contracts and onboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

4.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

4.12.28 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

4.12.29 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employment contracts and onboarding through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

4.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

4.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employment contracts and onboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

4.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

4.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

Chapter 5

Probation and Confirmation

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Probation period	3 months	**6 months**
Maximum extension	up to 1 month	**up to 3 months**

5.1 Purpose and Scope

5.1.1 The Company recognises that probation and confirmation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.1.2 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

5.1.4 The objective of these provisions on probation and confirmation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation.

5.1.5 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

5.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to probation and confirmation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

5.1.8 The objective of these provisions on probation and confirmation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This Chapter sets out the

Company's approach to probation and confirmation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

5.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation.

5.1.11 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

5.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

5.1.13 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to probation and confirmation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.1.14 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The Company recognises that probation and confirmation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. †

5.1.16 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

5.1.17 The objective of these provisions on probation and confirmation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

5.1.18 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company recognises that probation and confirmation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

5.1.19 The Company recognises that probation and confirmation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

5.1.20 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to probation and confirmation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.1.22 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.1.23 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.1.24 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to probation and confirmation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

5.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.1.26 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.1.27 The objective of these provisions on probation and confirmation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.1.28 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company recognises that probation and confirmation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

5.1.29 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.1.30 The Company recognises that probation and confirmation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to probation and confirmation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.1.32 The objective of these provisions on probation and confirmation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. †

5.1.33 The objective of these provisions on probation and confirmation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on probation and confirmation.

5.2 Definitions and Interpretation

5.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.2.2 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

5.2.3 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.2.4 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be

borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "probation and confirmation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

5.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.2.9 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.2.10 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

5.2.11 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "probation and confirmation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

5.2.12 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

5.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.2.14 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to probation and confirmation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to probation and confirmation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.2.17 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "probation and confirmation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

5.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "probation and confirmation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to probation and confirmation.

5.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.2.22 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.2.23 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

5.2.24 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to probation and confirmation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.2.25 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.2.26 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "probation and confirmation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

5.2.27 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

5.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.2.29 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.2.30 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

5.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter

expressly provides otherwise.

5.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

5.2.33 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.2.34 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. **[New in v2.0]**

5.3 Eligibility and Applicability

5.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.3.2 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

5.3.3 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

5.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded.

5.3.5 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on probation and confirmation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Eligibility for probation and confirmation shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

5.3.6 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.3.7 Eligibility for probation and confirmation shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

5.3.9 Eligibility for probation and confirmation shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.3.10 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.3.11 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

5.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.3.14 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.3.15 Eligibility for probation and confirmation shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.3.16 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

5.3.17 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on probation and confirmation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department

fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.3.18 Eligibility for probation and confirmation shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded.

5.3.19 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

5.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.3.25 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded.

5.3.26 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on probation and confirmation.

5.3.27 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.3.28 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for probation and confirmation restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

5.3.30 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

5.3.31 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on probation and confirmation.

5.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on probation and confirmation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.3.33 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

5.4 Responsibilities of Employees

5.4.1 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with probation and confirmation.

5.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of probation and confirmation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on probation and

confirmation and shall comply with them at all times.

5.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of probation and confirmation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.4.4 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to probation and confirmation and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

5.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of probation and confirmation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on probation and confirmation and shall comply with them at all times.

5.4.6 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on probation and confirmation and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.4.8 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with probation and confirmation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

5.4.10 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on probation and confirmation and shall comply with them at all times.

5.4.11 The employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with probation and confirmation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

5.4.13 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on probation and confirmation and shall comply with them at all times.

5.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on probation and confirmation and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.4.15 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to probation and confirmation and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with probation and confirmation.

5.4.16 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on probation and confirmation and shall comply with them at all times.

5.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.4.19 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of probation and confirmation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

5.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with probation and confirmation.

5.4.23 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of probation and confirmation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.4.24 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with probation and confirmation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee

shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

5.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.4.26 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

5.4.27 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

5.4.28 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.4.29 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to probation and confirmation and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.4.30 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of probation and confirmation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

5.4.31 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

5.4.32 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of probation and confirmation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

5.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation. †

5.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on probation and confirmation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

5.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to probation and confirmation to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.5.7 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to probation and confirmation within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on probation and confirmation and applies them consistently.

5.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

5.5.9 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to probation and confirmation to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

5.5.10 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to probation and confirmation within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.5.12 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation.

5.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.5.14 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to probation and confirmation within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on probation and confirmation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to probation and confirmation to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.5.18 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on probation and confirmation and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.5.19 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

Line Managers shall act on each request relating to probation and confirmation within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

5.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.5.21 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to probation and confirmation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. †

5.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

5.5.26 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on probation and confirmation and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

5.5.27 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on probation and confirmation and applies them consistently.

5.5.28 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

5.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on probation and confirmation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

5.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to probation and confirmation within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

5.5.32 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on probation and confirmation.

5.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to probation and confirmation within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

5.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to probation and confirmation and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall respond to every written query on probation and confirmation within 7 working days of receipt.

5.6.2 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with probation and confirmation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.6.3 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with probation and confirmation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to probation and confirmation.

5.6.4 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for probation and confirmation and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

5.6.5 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to probation and confirmation and on the applicable legal requirements.

5.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with probation and confirmation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

5.6.7 HR shall respond to every written query on probation and confirmation within 21 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.6.8 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.6.9 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to probation and confirmation and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

5.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on probation and confirmation within 10 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for probation and confirmation and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

5.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to probation and confirmation.

5.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

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5.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for probation and confirmation and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.6.18 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.6.20 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to probation and confirmation and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

5.6.21 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to probation and confirmation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.6.22 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with probation and confirmation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.6.23 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for probation and confirmation and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable

to the employee shall prevail.

5.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to probation and confirmation and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on probation and confirmation within 10 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for probation and confirmation and shall make them available to all employees.

5.6.27 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to probation and confirmation and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

5.6.28 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for probation and confirmation and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to probation and confirmation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for probation and confirmation and shall make them available to all employees.

5.6.30 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.6.31 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.6.32 HR shall respond to every written query on probation and confirmation within 5 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.6.33 HR shall respond to every written query on probation and confirmation within 14 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal

e-mail address on record.

5.6.34 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. **[New in v2.0]**

5.7 Procedure and Process Steps

5.7.1 **Probation period.** The probation period for every new employee shall be 6 months, counted from the date of joining. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 3 months]**

5.7.2 **Maximum extension.** The probation period may be extended by up to 3 months, for reasons recorded in writing and communicated to the employee. **[Revised in v2.0; previously up to 1 month]**

5.7.3 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.7.5 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.7.8 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

5.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this

Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.7.10 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

5.7.12 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 2 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

5.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.7.14 The employee shall initiate the process relating to probation and confirmation by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.7.15 The employee shall initiate the process relating to probation and confirmation by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

5.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.7.17 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.7.18 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

5.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to probation and confirmation by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team.

5.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.7.21 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

5.7.22 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The employee shall initiate the process relating to probation and confirmation by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. †

5.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to probation and confirmation by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

5.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 21 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The employee shall initiate the process relating to probation and confirmation by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. †

5.7.26 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The employee shall initiate the process relating to probation and confirmation by submitting a written request to the Line Manager.

5.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 2 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

5.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories

unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

5.7.29 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it.

5.7.30 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 2 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.7.31 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

5.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.7.33 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.7.34 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it.

5.7.35 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.7.36 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. **[New in v2.0]**

5.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

5.8.1 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

5.8.2 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.8.3 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

5.8.4 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

5.8.5 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.8.6 All documents relating to probation and confirmation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.8.7 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.8.8 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.8.10 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to probation and confirmation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.8.11 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.8.12 All documents relating to probation and confirmation shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. †

5.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.8.14 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. All documents relating to probation and confirmation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. †

5.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision

shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

5.8.16 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to probation and confirmation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.8.17 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

5.8.18 All documents relating to probation and confirmation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

5.8.19 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

5.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

5.8.21 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.8.23 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

5.8.24 All documents relating to probation and confirmation shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the

employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

5.8.26 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to probation and confirmation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

5.8.28 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.8.29 All documents relating to probation and confirmation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.8.30 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.8.31 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

5.8.32 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

5.8.33 Records relating to probation and confirmation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

5.9.1 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

5.9.2 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To

illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

5.9.5 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.9.7 Exceptions to the provisions on probation and confirmation may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.9.9 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.9.11 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

5.9.12 Exceptions to the provisions on probation and confirmation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

5.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

5.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

5.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

5.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions to the provisions on probation and confirmation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

5.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.9.18 Exceptions to the provisions on probation and confirmation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.9.19 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

5.9.20 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

5.9.21 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the

employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.9.22 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

5.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

5.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

5.9.25 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

5.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on probation and confirmation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.9.28 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.9.29 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.9.30 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on probation and confirmation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision

reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

5.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

5.10.1 Where an external regulator requests information concerning probation and confirmation, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

5.10.2 An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

5.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to probation and confirmation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.10.4 An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on probation and confirmation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.10.6 Where an external regulator requests information concerning probation and confirmation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to probation and confirmation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision

shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Compliance data relating to probation and confirmation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

5.10.9 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where an external regulator requests information concerning probation and confirmation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

5.10.10 Compliance data relating to probation and confirmation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.10.11 An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.10.12 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

5.10.14 Where an external regulator requests information concerning probation and confirmation, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.10.15 Where an external regulator requests information concerning probation and confirmation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.10.16 Compliance data relating to probation and confirmation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Compliance with the provisions on probation and confirmation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

5.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to probation and confirmation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible

employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.10.18 Compliance data relating to probation and confirmation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning probation and confirmation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

5.10.20 An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

5.10.21 Compliance with the provisions on probation and confirmation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.10.22 An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to probation and confirmation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.10.24 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

5.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.10.26 Compliance with the provisions on probation and confirmation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.10.27 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

5.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning probation and confirmation, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Compliance with the provisions on probation and confirmation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

5.10.29 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to probation and confirmation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. †

5.10.31 An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

5.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

5.10.33 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to probation and confirmation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. An internal audit of probation and confirmation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

5.10.34 Compliance data relating to probation and confirmation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. **[New in v2.0]**

5.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

5.11.1 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to probation and confirmation shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. †

5.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to probation and confirmation shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.11.4 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.11.5 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to probation and confirmation shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

5.11.7 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.11.8 A failure to comply with the provisions on probation and confirmation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

5.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

5.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.11.11 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

5.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to probation and confirmation shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

5.11.13 A failure to comply with the provisions on probation and confirmation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.11.14 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

5.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on probation and confirmation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.11.17 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

5.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to probation and confirmation shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.11.21 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

5.11.22 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to probation and confirmation shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

5.11.24 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A failure to comply with the provisions on probation and confirmation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

5.11.25 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather

than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.11.28 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

5.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on probation and confirmation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

5.11.32 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to probation and confirmation shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

5.11.33 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.12 Review and Amendment

5.12.1 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.12.2 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.12.3 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

5.12.4 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

5.12.5 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

5.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

5.12.7 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on probation and confirmation through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

5.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.12.10 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

5.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.12.12 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the

individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

5.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

5.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

5.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

5.12.17 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

5.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to probation and confirmation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

5.12.19 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

5.12.20 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

5.12.21 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which

the requests were received. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on probation and confirmation through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

5.12.23 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

5.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on probation and confirmation through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

5.12.25 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

5.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

5.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

5.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to probation and confirmation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

5.12.29 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

5.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

5.12.31 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on probation and confirmation through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

5.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on probation and confirmation through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This

provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

5.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

Chapter 6

Working Hours and Attendance

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Standard working week	45 hours per week	**40 hours per week**

6.1 Purpose and Scope

6.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on working hours and attendance. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.1.3 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on working hours and attendance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company recognises that working hours and attendance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

6.1.4 The objective of these provisions on working hours and attendance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on working hours and attendance.

6.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.1.7 The Company recognises that working hours and attendance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

6.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne

by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.1.9 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

6.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on working hours and attendance.

6.1.12 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

6.1.13 The objective of these provisions on working hours and attendance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

6.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

6.1.16 The Company recognises that working hours and attendance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period,

the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

6.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

6.1.19 The objective of these provisions on working hours and attendance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

6.1.20 The Company recognises that working hours and attendance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

6.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

6.1.23 The objective of these provisions on working hours and attendance is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. By way of illustration, where

the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

6.1.27 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to working hours and attendance and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.1.28 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.1.29 The Company recognises that working hours and attendance has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

6.1.31 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

6.1.32 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

6.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on working hours and attendance. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

6.2 Definitions and Interpretation

6.2.1 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

6.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "working hours and attendance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual

circumstances of each case.

6.2.3 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to working hours and attendance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

6.2.4 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "working hours and attendance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to working hours and attendance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.2.6 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

6.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

6.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to working hours and attendance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

6.2.11 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

6.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

6.2.13 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

6.2.14 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to working hours and attendance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.2.16 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.2.17 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

6.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

6.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.2.21 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to working hours and attendance. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

6.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to

all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

6.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to working hours and attendance. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

6.2.24 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.2.25 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

6.2.26 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "working hours and attendance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.2.27 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.2.28 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "working hours and attendance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

6.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.2.30 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "working hours and attendance" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.2.31 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for

business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

6.2.32 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

6.3 Eligibility and Applicability

6.3.1 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

6.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.3.3 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.3.4 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

6.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.3.9 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.3.10 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on working hours and attendance. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

6.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on working hours and attendance. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.3.14 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.3.15 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.3.16 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. †

6.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on working hours and attendance. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

6.3.21 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.3.22 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on working hours and attendance.

6.3.23 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

6.3.24 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.3.26 Eligibility for working hours and attendance shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded.

6.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the

following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

6.3.28 Eligibility for working hours and attendance shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

6.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on working hours and attendance. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.3.30 Eligibility for working hours and attendance shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded.

6.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.3.32 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for working hours and attendance restricted until the matter is concluded.

6.3.33 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on working hours and attendance. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.4 Responsibilities of Employees

6.4.1 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

6.4.2 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with working hours and attendance.

6.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on working hours and attendance and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant,

shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.4.4 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on working hours and attendance and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.4.6 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.4.7 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to working hours and attendance and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.4.8 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on working hours and attendance and shall comply with them at all times.

6.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

6.4.10 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to working hours and attendance and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.4.12 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

6.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

6.4.15 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.4.16 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

6.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.4.18 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.4.19 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on working hours and attendance and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.4.20 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

6.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

6.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to working hours and attendance and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a

Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on working hours and attendance and shall comply with them at all times.

6.4.24 The employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to working hours and attendance and shall not withhold material facts.

6.4.25 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with working hours and attendance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.4.27 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

6.4.28 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on working hours and attendance and shall comply with them at all times. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

6.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on working hours and attendance and shall comply with them at all times.

6.4.30 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of working hours and attendance as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with working hours and attendance. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the

discretion of the Reporting Manager.

6.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to working hours and attendance and shall not withhold material facts. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.4.33 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with working hours and attendance.

6.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

6.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

6.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

6.5.3 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.5.5 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

6.5.6 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.5.7 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.5.8 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on working hours and attendance and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance.

6.5.9 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.5.11 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to working hours and attendance within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

6.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.5.14 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to working hours and attendance to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance.

6.5.15 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on working hours and attendance and applies them consistently.

6.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

6.5.17 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to working hours and attendance within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.5.18 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

6.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by

HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to working hours and attendance to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

6.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to working hours and attendance to the HR Director without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.5.22 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.5.23 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to working hours and attendance to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to working hours and attendance to the HR Director without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance.

6.5.25 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on working hours and attendance and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

6.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

6.5.27 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to working hours and attendance to the HR Director without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on working hours and attendance and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

6.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is

absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.5.30 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on working hours and attendance. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

6.5.31 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on working hours and attendance and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

6.5.33 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

6.6.1 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on working hours and attendance within 5 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.6.3 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for working hours and attendance and shall make them available to all employees.

6.6.4 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

6.6.5 HR shall respond to every written query on working hours and attendance within 5 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

6.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for working hours and attendance and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

6.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with working hours and attendance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.6.8 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.6.9 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to working hours and attendance and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

6.6.10 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with working hours and attendance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

6.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for working hours and attendance and shall make them available to all employees. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to working hours and attendance. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for working hours and attendance and shall make them available to all employees.

6.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

6.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on working hours and attendance within 7 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.6.18 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with working hours and attendance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

6.6.19 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to working hours and attendance and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.6.20 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.6.22 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to working hours and attendance. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

6.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to working hours and attendance and on the applicable legal requirements.

6.6.24 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with working hours and attendance in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

6.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to working hours and attendance and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall respond to every written query on working hours and attendance within 3 working days

of receipt.

6.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on working hours and attendance within 21 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.6.27 HR shall respond to every written query on working hours and attendance within 5 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

6.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to working hours and attendance. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.6.30 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.6.31 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for working hours and attendance and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to working hours and attendance and on the applicable legal requirements.

6.6.32 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to working hours and attendance and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

6.6.33 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to working hours and attendance. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

6.7 Procedure and Process Steps

6.7.1 **Standard working week.** The standard working week shall be 40 hours per week, exclusive of meal intervals. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 45 hours per week]**

6.7.2 The employee shall initiate the process relating to working hours and attendance by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

6.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to working hours and attendance by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

6.7.6 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

6.7.8 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to working hours and attendance by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it.

6.7.10 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 14 working days of receiving it.

6.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

6.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.7.14 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.7.15 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 2 working days of receiving it.

6.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

6.7.17 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.7.19 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

6.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 14 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.7.21 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

6.7.22 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.7.24 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 15 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

6.7.26 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 14 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.7.27 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to working hours and attendance by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.7.29 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

6.7.30 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.7.31 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

6.7.33 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

6.7.34 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

6.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

6.8.1 Records relating to working hours and attendance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.8.2 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.8.3 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.8.4 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to working hours and attendance that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

6.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.8.6 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

6.8.7 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to working hours and attendance that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

6.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

6.8.10 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.8.11 Records relating to working hours and attendance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

6.8.12 Records relating to working hours and attendance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

6.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

6.8.14 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.8.15 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.8.16 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

6.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to working hours and attendance that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

6.8.19 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

6.8.20 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.8.21 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

6.8.22 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

6.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

6.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to working hours and attendance that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.8.25 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

6.8.26 Records relating to working hours and attendance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

6.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.8.28 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

6.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

6.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

6.8.31 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.8.32 Records relating to working hours and attendance shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.8.33 All documents relating to working hours and attendance shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

6.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

6.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.9.2 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

6.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

6.9.4 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

6.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. †

6.9.6 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

6.9.12 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.9.13 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.9.17 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

6.9.18 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.9.19 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

6.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

6.9.24 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

6.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

6.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.9.28 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

6.9.29 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

6.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make

competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

6.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on working hours and attendance may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

6.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

6.10.1 Where an external regulator requests information concerning working hours and attendance, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.10.3 An internal audit of working hours and attendance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

6.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where an external regulator requests information concerning working hours and attendance, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

6.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

6.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

6.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to working hours and attendance. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.10.8 An internal audit of working hours and attendance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

6.10.9 An internal audit of working hours and attendance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.10.10 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

6.10.11 An internal audit of working hours and attendance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.10.12 An internal audit of working hours and attendance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

6.10.14 An internal audit of working hours and attendance shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This

provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

6.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to working hours and attendance. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.10.16 Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

6.10.18 Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.10.19 Compliance data relating to working hours and attendance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.10.20 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to working hours and attendance. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.10.23 Compliance data relating to working hours and attendance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

6.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning working hours and attendance, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and

information they reasonably require. †

6.10.25 Compliance data relating to working hours and attendance shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

6.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.10.27 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance with the provisions on working hours and attendance shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

6.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning working hours and attendance, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.10.29 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to working hours and attendance.

6.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to working hours and attendance. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

6.10.32 Where an external regulator requests information concerning working hours and attendance, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.10.33 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to working hours and attendance. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

6.11.1 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

6.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to working hours and attendance shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

6.11.3 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

6.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

6.11.5 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to working hours and attendance shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

6.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to working hours and attendance shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

6.11.8 A failure to comply with the provisions on working hours and attendance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

6.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

6.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

6.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to working hours and attendance shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

6.11.13 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.11.14 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

6.11.15 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to working hours and attendance shall be treated as serious misconduct. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

6.11.18 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

6.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on working hours and attendance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

6.11.20 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

6.11.22 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

6.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to working hours and attendance shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

6.11.24 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.11.25 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

6.11.26 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to working hours and attendance shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on working hours and attendance may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

6.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

6.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades,

locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

6.11.31 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

6.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.11.33 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

6.12 Review and Amendment

6.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

6.12.2 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

6.12.3 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

6.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.12.5 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

6.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

6.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

6.12.9 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

6.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

6.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

6.12.14 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.12.15 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

6.12.16 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to working hours and attendance, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

6.12.17 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.12.18 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

6.12.19 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

6.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

6.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

6.12.22 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to working hours and attendance made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

6.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

6.12.25 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies

to their situation.

6.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

6.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

6.12.28 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

6.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

6.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

6.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect.

6.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on working hours and attendance through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

6.12.33 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

Chapter 7

Overtime and Shift Work

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Overtime rate	1.5 times	**2.0 times**
Overtime cap	50 hours per month	**40 hours per month**

7.1 Purpose and Scope

7.1.1 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

7.1.2 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.1.5 The Company recognises that overtime and shift work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

7.1.6 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

7.1.7 The Company recognises that overtime and shift work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

7.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of

the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.1.9 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

7.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.1.11 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on overtime and shift work.

7.1.12 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to overtime and shift work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

7.1.13 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on overtime and shift work.

7.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to overtime and shift work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

7.1.15 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.1.16 The Company recognises that overtime and shift work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.1.17 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise. The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

7.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company recognises that overtime and shift work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

7.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.1.20 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

7.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.1.22 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

7.1.23 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.1.24 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

7.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to overtime and shift work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.1.27 The Company recognises that overtime and shift work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the

prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. †

7.1.28 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.1.29 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on overtime and shift work.

7.1.30 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.1.31 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on overtime and shift work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.1.32 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on overtime and shift work.

7.1.33 The objective of these provisions on overtime and shift work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

7.2 Definitions and Interpretation

7.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to overtime and shift work. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "overtime and shift work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

7.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.2.3 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect

any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

7.2.4 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to overtime and shift work. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

7.2.6 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "overtime and shift work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

7.2.7 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "overtime and shift work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

7.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

7.2.10 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "overtime and shift work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

7.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

7.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the

discretion of the Head of Department.

7.2.13 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.2.14 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

7.2.15 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

7.2.17 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "overtime and shift work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. †

7.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

7.2.19 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to overtime and shift work. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

7.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

7.2.21 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.2.22 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to overtime and shift work. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.2.24 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.2.25 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.2.26 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

7.2.27 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.2.29 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "overtime and shift work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

7.2.30 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

7.2.31 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied

consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.2.32 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "overtime and shift work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. †

7.2.33 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.3 Eligibility and Applicability

7.3.1 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.3.2 Eligibility for overtime and shift work shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.3.3 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

7.3.5 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

7.3.6 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications,

where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

7.3.8 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.3.9 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work.

7.3.10 Eligibility for overtime and shift work shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work.

7.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.3.14 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work.

7.3.15 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.3.16 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.3.17 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. †

7.3.21 Eligibility for overtime and shift work shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

7.3.22 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

7.3.23 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded.

7.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.3.25 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of

business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.3.26 Eligibility for overtime and shift work shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

7.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on overtime and shift work.

7.3.28 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

7.3.29 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.3.31 Eligibility for overtime and shift work shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.3.32 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for overtime and shift work restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.3.33 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.4 Responsibilities of Employees

7.4.1 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not

withhold material facts.

7.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with overtime and shift work.

7.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

7.4.6 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with overtime and shift work. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.4.8 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. †

7.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times.

7.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of overtime and shift work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.4.11 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

7.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with overtime and shift work. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

7.4.13 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.4.15 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

7.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.4.19 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.4.20 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

7.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.4.22 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of overtime and shift work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

7.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not withhold material facts.

7.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with overtime and shift work. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of overtime and shift work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

7.4.27 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.4.28 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the

matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.4.29 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on overtime and shift work and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of overtime and shift work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

7.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to overtime and shift work and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with overtime and shift work. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

7.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

7.5.1 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently.

7.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

7.5.3 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to overtime and shift work within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

7.5.4 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

7.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

7.5.6 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on overtime and shift work.

7.5.7 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to overtime and shift work within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently.

7.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to overtime and shift work within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. †

7.5.9 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

7.5.10 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.5.11 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

7.5.12 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on overtime and shift work.

7.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to overtime and shift work to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to overtime and shift work within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

7.5.14 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

7.5.15 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to overtime and shift work to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.5.16 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to overtime and shift work to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently.

7.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.5.18 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on overtime and shift work. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.5.19 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to overtime and shift work within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.5.22 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on overtime and shift work. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.5.23 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

7.5.24 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.5.25 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently.

7.5.26 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently. †

7.5.27 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on overtime and shift work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.5.28 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.5.30 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

7.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to overtime and shift work within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.5.32 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to overtime and shift work within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on overtime and shift work and applies them consistently.

7.5.34 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on overtime and shift work. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. **[New in v2.0]**

7.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

7.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to overtime and shift work and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

7.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 7 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.6.3 HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 10 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.6.5 HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 10 working days of receipt.

7.6.6 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to overtime and shift work. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

7.6.7 HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 15 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.6.8 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with overtime and shift work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

7.6.9 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.6.10 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to overtime and shift work. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

7.6.11 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.6.12 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to overtime and shift work and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.6.13 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to overtime and shift work. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

7.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to overtime and shift work. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with overtime and shift work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

7.6.15 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to overtime and shift work and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 5 working days of receipt.

7.6.17 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 30 working days of receipt.

7.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to overtime and shift work and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

7.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

7.6.20 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to overtime and shift work. HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 30 working days of receipt. †

7.6.21 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to overtime and shift work and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.6.22 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to overtime and shift work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.6.24 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for overtime and shift work and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.6.25 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for overtime and shift work and shall make them available to all employees. †

7.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.6.27 HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 14 working days of receipt.

7.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to overtime and shift work and on the applicable legal requirements. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

7.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to overtime and shift work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with overtime and shift work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.6.31 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. †

7.6.32 HR shall respond to every written query on overtime and shift work within 5 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with overtime and shift work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

7.7 Procedure and Process Steps

7.7.1 **Overtime rate.** Authorised overtime shall be compensated at 2.0 times the normal hourly rate. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 1.5 times]**

7.7.2 **Overtime cap.** No employee shall be required to work more than 40 hours per month of overtime. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 50 hours per month]**

7.7.3 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.7.5 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

7.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

7.7.8 The employee shall initiate the process relating to overtime and shift work by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

7.7.9 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.7.10 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.7.12 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

7.7.13 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it.

7.7.14 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.7.15 The employee shall initiate the process relating to overtime and shift work by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.7.16 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. †

7.7.18 The employee shall initiate the process relating to overtime and shift work by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

7.7.19 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure

prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

7.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

7.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

7.7.22 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.7.23 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

7.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to overtime and shift work by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.7.25 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.7.26 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

7.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

7.7.28 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.7.29 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

7.7.30 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The employee shall initiate the process relating to overtime and shift work by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner.

7.7.31 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.7.34 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

7.7.35 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

7.8.1 All documents relating to overtime and shift work shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

7.8.3 Records relating to overtime and shift work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is

due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

7.8.4 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

7.8.5 Records relating to overtime and shift work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

7.8.7 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.8.9 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

7.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.8.11 All documents relating to overtime and shift work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

7.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.8.13 Records relating to overtime and shift work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.8.14 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

7.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records relating to overtime and shift work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years.

7.8.16 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

7.8.17 All documents relating to overtime and shift work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

7.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.8.20 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

7.8.21 Records relating to overtime and shift work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

7.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by

HR.

7.8.24 All documents relating to overtime and shift work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

7.8.25 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

7.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

7.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

7.8.29 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

7.8.31 Records relating to overtime and shift work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.8.32 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

7.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request

relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to overtime and shift work that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

7.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

7.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Exceptions to the provisions on overtime and shift work may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

7.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.9.3 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

7.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.5 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. †

7.9.6 Exceptions to the provisions on overtime and shift work may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

7.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

7.9.10 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt

resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

7.9.12 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

7.9.13 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.14 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

7.9.15 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on overtime and shift work may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.9.17 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.19 Exceptions to the provisions on overtime and shift work may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the

personal e-mail address on record. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

7.9.20 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.9.21 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

7.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice.

7.9.23 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

7.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on overtime and shift work may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

7.9.27 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.28 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.9.29 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee

who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on overtime and shift work may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

7.9.31 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Exceptions to the provisions on overtime and shift work may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

7.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.9.33 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

7.10.1 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

7.10.2 Where an external regulator requests information concerning overtime and shift work, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.10.3 An internal audit of overtime and shift work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to overtime and shift work.

7.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning overtime and shift work, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

7.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to overtime and shift work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

7.10.7 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.10.8 Compliance with the provisions on overtime and shift work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

7.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to overtime and shift work. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.10.10 Where an external regulator requests information concerning overtime and shift work, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.10.11 Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.10.12 Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

7.10.14 Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.10.15 Compliance with the provisions on overtime and shift work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if

they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.10.16 Compliance with the provisions on overtime and shift work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

7.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to overtime and shift work. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning overtime and shift work, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.10.19 Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Compliance with the provisions on overtime and shift work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

7.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning overtime and shift work, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where an external regulator requests information concerning overtime and shift work, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

7.10.22 Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to overtime and shift work. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

7.10.24 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

7.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An internal audit of overtime and shift work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

7.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

7.10.27 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.10.28 Compliance data relating to overtime and shift work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to overtime and shift work.

7.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on overtime and shift work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

7.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to overtime and shift work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.10.32 An internal audit of overtime and shift work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where an external regulator requests information concerning overtime and shift work, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

7.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having

been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

7.11.1 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

7.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

7.11.4 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to overtime and shift work shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

7.11.7 A failure to comply with the provisions on overtime and shift work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

7.11.8 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.11.9 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

7.11.10 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

7.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

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7.11.15 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

7.11.17 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

7.11.19 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

7.11.20 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to overtime and shift work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

7.11.21 A failure to comply with the provisions on overtime and shift work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.11.22 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under

this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.11.24 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

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7.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

7.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on overtime and shift work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

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7.11.30 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

7.11.31 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to overtime and shift work shall be treated as serious misconduct. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

7.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades,

locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

7.11.33 A failure to comply with the provisions on overtime and shift work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.11.34 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. **[New in v2.0]**

7.12 Review and Amendment

7.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

7.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to overtime and shift work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

7.12.3 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

7.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

7.12.6 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

7.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.12.8 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

7.12.9 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

7.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

7.12.11 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

7.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.12.13 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

7.12.14 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

7.12.15 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

7.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

7.12.17 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

7.12.18 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An

example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

7.12.19 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.12.20 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

7.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

7.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

7.12.24 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

7.12.25 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect.

7.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

7.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

7.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

7.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

7.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

7.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

7.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on overtime and shift work through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

7.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

Chapter 8

Annual Leave

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Annual entitlement	18 working days	**22 working days**
Carry forward	10 days	**12 days**

8.1 Purpose and Scope

8.1.1 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

8.1.2 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to annual leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.1.4 The objective of these provisions on annual leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

8.1.5 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

8.1.6 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.1.7 The Company recognises that annual leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

8.1.8 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to annual leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

8.1.9 The Company recognises that annual leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

8.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.1.11 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on annual leave. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.1.12 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to annual leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

8.1.13 The objective of these provisions on annual leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

8.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

8.1.15 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on annual leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.1.16 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on annual leave.

8.1.17 The Company recognises that annual leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

8.1.18 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

8.1.19 The objective of these provisions on annual leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

8.1.21 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to annual leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

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8.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

8.1.24 The objective of these provisions on annual leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on annual leave.

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Manager.

8.1.28 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.1.29 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

8.1.30 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

8.1.31 The Company recognises that annual leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.1.32 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.2 Definitions and Interpretation

8.2.1 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "annual leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.2.3 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the

interpretation of any provision relating to annual leave.

8.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

8.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "annual leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

8.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.2.11 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

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8.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

8.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to annual leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.2.16 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to annual leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

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8.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.2.20 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

8.2.21 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

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8.2.24 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

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8.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

8.2.29 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

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8.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to annual leave. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

8.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority

nominated by HR. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

8.2.33 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "annual leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.2.34 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. **[New in v2.0]**

8.3 Eligibility and Applicability

8.3.1 Eligibility for annual leave shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

8.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.3.3 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.3.4 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.3.5 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

8.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for annual leave restricted until the matter is concluded.

8.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for annual leave restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

8.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.3.10 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on annual leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

8.3.13 Eligibility for annual leave shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.3.14 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for annual leave restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.3.15 Eligibility for annual leave shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.3.16 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on annual leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

8.3.17 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

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8.3.19 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.3.20 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. †

8.3.21 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.3.22 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for annual leave restricted until the matter is concluded. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for annual leave shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

8.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on annual leave. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

8.3.24 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

8.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

8.3.26 Eligibility for annual leave shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on annual leave.

8.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for annual leave restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

8.3.28 Eligibility for annual leave shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.3.29 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for annual leave restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.3.31 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on annual leave.

8.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on annual leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.3.33 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on annual leave.

8.4 Responsibilities of Employees

8.4.1 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.4.2 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to annual leave and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

8.4.3 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with annual leave. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.4.4 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of annual leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

8.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of annual leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to

ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

8.4.7 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

8.4.8 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on annual leave and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

8.4.10 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.4.11 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with annual leave. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.4.12 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of annual leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.4.13 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of annual leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

8.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to annual leave and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek

guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

8.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.4.18 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with annual leave. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with annual leave. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

8.4.21 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with annual leave. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.4.22 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on annual leave and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of annual leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

8.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

8.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on annual leave and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.4.26 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.4.27 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

8.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with annual leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

8.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to annual leave and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.4.31 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on annual leave and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.4.32 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

8.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with annual leave.

8.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

8.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

8.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on annual leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.5.3 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.5.5 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to annual leave to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

8.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to annual leave within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.5.8 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on annual leave and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave.

8.5.10 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on annual leave and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned

employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on annual leave and applies them consistently.

8.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to annual leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

8.5.13 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to annual leave within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.5.14 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on annual leave and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

8.5.15 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

8.5.16 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to annual leave to the HR Director without undue delay. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

8.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

8.5.18 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to annual leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.5.19 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on annual leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to annual leave within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on annual leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

8.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

8.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

8.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

8.5.25 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to annual leave within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.5.26 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to annual leave to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

8.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to annual leave to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

8.5.29 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on annual leave and applies them consistently. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

8.5.30 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any

deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to annual leave to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

8.5.31 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave.

8.5.32 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

8.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on annual leave. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

8.6.1 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

8.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to annual leave and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

8.6.3 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.6.4 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

8.6.5 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.6.6 HR shall respond to every written query on annual leave within 3 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.6.7 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

8.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.6.10 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees.

8.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

8.6.13 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.6.14 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with annual leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

8.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to annual leave and on the applicable legal requirements.

8.6.16 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall ensure that

its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to annual leave and on the applicable legal requirements.

8.6.20 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with annual leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on annual leave within 10 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

8.6.22 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave.

8.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

8.6.24 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

8.6.25 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to annual leave and on the applicable legal requirements.

8.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

8.6.27 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.6.28 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with annual leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.6.29 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for annual leave and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive

rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

8.6.30 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall respond to every written query on annual leave within 5 working days of receipt.

8.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with annual leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to annual leave.

8.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.7 Procedure and Process Steps

8.7.1 **Annual entitlement.** Each confirmed employee shall be entitled to 22 working days of paid annual leave in every leave year. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 18 working days]**

8.7.2 **Carry forward.** Unused annual leave of up to 12 days may be carried forward to the next leave year. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 10 days]**

8.7.3 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

8.7.5 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it.

8.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer

within 7 working days of receiving it.

8.7.7 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.7.9 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

8.7.10 The employee shall initiate the process relating to annual leave by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. †

8.7.11 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

8.7.12 The employee shall initiate the process relating to annual leave by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

8.7.13 The employee shall initiate the process relating to annual leave by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

8.7.14 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

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8.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it.

8.7.19 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

8.7.20 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

8.7.22 The employee shall initiate the process relating to annual leave by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.7.23 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.7.24 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.7.25 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

8.7.26 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. †

8.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to annual leave by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to annual leave by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.7.29 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

8.7.30 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

8.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.7.33 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

8.7.34 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.7.35 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

8.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

8.8.1 Records relating to annual leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

8.8.2 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.8.3 Records relating to annual leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

8.8.4 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. All documents relating to annual leave shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

8.8.5 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.8.6 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to annual leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

8.8.8 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

8.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

8.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

8.8.11 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

8.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to annual leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

8.8.13 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

8.8.14 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.8.15 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

8.8.16 Records relating to annual leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

8.8.18 All documents relating to annual leave shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and

a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.8.19 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.8.20 Records relating to annual leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to annual leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

8.8.21 Records relating to annual leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

8.8.22 All documents relating to annual leave shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. †

8.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

8.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to annual leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.8.25 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

8.8.26 All documents relating to annual leave shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to annual leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

8.8.27 All documents relating to annual leave shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.8.28 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to annual leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

8.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.8.31 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.8.32 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to annual leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

8.8.33 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

8.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

8.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on annual leave may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice.

8.9.2 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.9.3 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

8.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior

leadership team for information.

8.9.5 Exceptions to the provisions on annual leave may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

8.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

8.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on annual leave may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

8.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

8.9.14 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

8.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on annual leave may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

8.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

8.9.17 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.9.21 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act

within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. †

8.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

8.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.9.24 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

8.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

8.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on annual leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

8.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

8.9.30 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.9.31 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.9.32 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and

employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

8.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

8.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on annual leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

8.10.3 Where an external regulator requests information concerning annual leave, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

8.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

8.10.5 An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave.

8.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.10.7 Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

8.10.8 An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Compliance with the provisions on annual leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

8.10.9 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

8.10.10 Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall

prevail. Where an external regulator requests information concerning annual leave, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

8.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

8.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where an external regulator requests information concerning annual leave, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

8.10.13 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.10.14 Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

8.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

8.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.10.18 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

8.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning annual leave, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

8.10.20 An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. By way of illustration,

where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

8.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave.

8.10.22 Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where an external regulator requests information concerning annual leave, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

8.10.23 An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

8.10.24 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave.

8.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning annual leave, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

8.10.27 Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning annual leave, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.10.29 An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

8.10.30 Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on annual leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

8.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to annual leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

8.10.33 An internal audit of annual leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Compliance data relating to annual leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

8.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

8.11.1 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

8.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.11.3 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.11.4 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

8.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to annual leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Head of Department

shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

8.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.11.7 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

8.11.8 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to annual leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

8.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

8.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. †

8.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to annual leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

8.11.14 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having

been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.11.15 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

8.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to annual leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

8.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

8.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

8.11.20 A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

8.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

8.11.23 A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the

Line Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

8.11.24 A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.11.25 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

8.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

8.11.27 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. †

8.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

8.11.29 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

8.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

8.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on annual leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new

Line Manager.

8.11.32 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

8.11.33 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.11.34 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. **[New in v2.0]**

8.12 Review and Amendment

8.12.1 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

8.12.2 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.12.3 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

8.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

8.12.5 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

8.12.6 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

8.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good

faith. †

8.12.9 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.12.11 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

8.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

8.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

8.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

8.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

8.12.17 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

8.12.18 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of

this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

8.12.19 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

8.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

8.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

8.12.22 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

8.12.23 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

8.12.24 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

8.12.25 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

8.12.26 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

8.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.12.28 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

8.12.29 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to annual leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

8.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on annual leave through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

8.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

8.12.32 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to annual leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

8.12.33 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

Chapter 9

Sick Leave and Medical Absence

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Paid sick leave	8 days	**12 days**
Medical certificate	more than 3 consecutive days	**more than 2 consecutive days**

9.1 Purpose and Scope

9.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on sick leave and medical absence. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

9.1.2 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.1.3 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

9.1.4 The objective of these provisions on sick leave and medical absence is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

9.1.5 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on sick leave and medical absence. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.1.7 The Company recognises that sick leave and medical absence has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's

decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

9.1.8 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

9.1.9 The objective of these provisions on sick leave and medical absence is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.1.11 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.1.12 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.1.13 The objective of these provisions on sick leave and medical absence is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The Company recognises that sick leave and medical absence has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

9.1.14 The Company recognises that sick leave and medical absence has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.1.15 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on sick leave and medical absence. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.1.16 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be

victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

9.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.1.20 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.1.21 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.1.22 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.1.23 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.1.24 The objective of these provisions on sick leave and medical absence is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. †

9.1.26 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.1.27 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

9.1.28 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The objective of these provisions on sick leave and medical absence is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

9.1.29 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

9.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to sick leave and medical absence and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

9.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

9.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.2 Definitions and Interpretation

9.2.1 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. †

9.2.3 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence.

9.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

9.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

9.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

9.2.7 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

9.2.10 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

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9.2.12 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.2.13 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

9.2.15 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

9.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

9.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

9.2.19 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.2.20 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.2.21 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

9.2.22 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

9.2.23 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.2.25 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.2.27 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.2.28 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "sick leave and medical absence" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

9.2.29 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each

case.

9.2.30 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

9.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to sick leave and medical absence.

9.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.3 Eligibility and Applicability

9.3.1 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for sick leave and medical absence restricted until the matter is concluded.

9.3.3 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.3.4 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Eligibility for sick leave and medical absence shall be

determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

9.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for sick leave and medical absence restricted until the matter is concluded.

9.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on sick leave and medical absence. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

9.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

9.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on sick leave and medical absence. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.3.11 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.3.13 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.3.15 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.3.16 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on sick leave and medical absence. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the

employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.3.17 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on sick leave and medical absence. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.3.18 Eligibility for sick leave and medical absence shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.3.19 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.3.20 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

9.3.21 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.3.22 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on sick leave and medical absence. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

9.3.23 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for sick leave and medical absence restricted until the matter is concluded.

9.3.25 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every employee

who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on sick leave and medical absence.

9.3.26 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

9.3.27 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.3.28 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

9.3.29 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.3.30 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

9.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.3.32 Eligibility for sick leave and medical absence shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.3.33 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

9.4 Responsibilities of Employees

9.4.1 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.4.2 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.4.3 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and shall comply with them at all times.

9.4.4 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

9.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to sick leave and medical absence and shall not withhold material facts.

9.4.8 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

9.4.9 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.4.10 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and

medical absence, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with sick leave and medical absence. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.4.13 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and shall comply with them at all times.

9.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

9.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

9.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to sick leave and medical absence and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.4.19 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to sick leave and medical absence and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision

reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

9.4.22 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

9.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to sick leave and medical absence and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.4.24 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with sick leave and medical absence. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

9.4.25 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.4.26 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to sick leave and medical absence and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

9.4.27 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to sick leave and medical absence and shall not withhold material facts. †

9.4.28 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to sick leave and medical absence and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.4.29 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

9.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with sick leave and medical absence. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.4.32 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of sick leave and medical absence as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

9.4.33 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and shall comply with them at all times. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

9.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

9.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.5.2 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.5.3 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on sick leave and medical absence. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on sick leave and medical absence and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.5.6 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority

nominated by HR.

9.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on sick leave and medical absence and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on sick leave and medical absence.

9.5.8 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.5.9 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on sick leave and medical absence and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

9.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to sick leave and medical absence to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

9.5.11 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.5.12 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to sick leave and medical absence within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

9.5.14 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to sick leave and medical absence to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.5.15 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that

spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

9.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to sick leave and medical absence within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on sick leave and medical absence. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on sick leave and medical absence and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.5.21 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to sick leave and medical absence within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to sick leave and medical absence to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.5.23 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.5.24 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to sick leave and medical absence within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.5.25 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on sick leave and medical absence. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on sick leave and medical absence and applies them consistently.

9.5.28 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on sick leave and medical absence and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.5.29 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to sick leave and medical absence to the HR Director without undue delay. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.5.30 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on sick leave and medical absence and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to sick leave and medical absence to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

9.5.31 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on sick leave and medical absence. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on sick leave and medical absence.

9.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to sick leave and medical absence within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

9.6.1 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for sick leave and medical absence and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.6.2 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.6.3 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

9.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for sick leave and medical absence and shall make them available to all employees.

9.6.6 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to sick leave and medical absence and on the applicable legal requirements.

9.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

9.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to sick leave and medical absence and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

9.6.9 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

9.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

9.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.6.12 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to sick leave and medical absence and on the applicable legal requirements.

9.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.6.15 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.6.16 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for sick leave and medical absence and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for sick leave and medical absence and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence.

9.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to sick leave and medical absence. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

9.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an

illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.6.20 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for sick leave and medical absence and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

9.6.21 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to sick leave and medical absence and on the applicable legal requirements.

9.6.22 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to sick leave and medical absence and on the applicable legal requirements.

9.6.24 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

9.6.25 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

9.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.6.27 HR shall respond to every written query on sick leave and medical absence within 21 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

9.6.28 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for sick leave and medical absence and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business

need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on sick leave and medical absence within 5 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.6.30 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

9.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on sick leave and medical absence within 5 working days of receipt. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.6.33 HR shall respond to every written query on sick leave and medical absence within 15 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with sick leave and medical absence in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

9.7 Procedure and Process Steps

9.7.1 **Paid sick leave.** Each employee shall be entitled to 12 days of paid sick leave in every leave year. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 8 days]**

9.7.2 **Medical certificate.** A medical certificate shall be produced for any absence lasting more than 2 consecutive days. **[Revised in v2.0; previously more than 3 consecutive days]**

9.7.3 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

9.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.7.5 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.7.10 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.7.12 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.7.13 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.7.14 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager.

9.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.7.16 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible

employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

9.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.7.18 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.7.20 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

9.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

9.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.7.25 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department.

9.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

9.7.27 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it.

9.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

9.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

9.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.7.32 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

9.7.33 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.7.34 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this

Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.7.35 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 2 working days of receiving it.

9.7.36 The employee shall initiate the process relating to sick leave and medical absence by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. **[New in v2.0]**

9.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

9.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

9.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. †

9.8.3 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.8.4 All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

9.8.5 Records relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

9.8.6 All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

9.8.7 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

9.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to sick leave and medical absence that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.8.9 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to sick leave and medical absence that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

9.8.10 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

9.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.8.12 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

9.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.8.15 All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless

this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to sick leave and medical absence that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

9.8.16 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.8.17 All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to sick leave and medical absence that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

9.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

9.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.8.21 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.8.22 All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

9.8.23 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to sick leave and medical absence that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.8.24 Records relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.8.27 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.8.28 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

9.8.29 Records relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

9.8.30 All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

9.8.31 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

9.8.32 Records relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. All documents relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

9.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

9.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

9.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.9.3 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.9.5 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

9.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

9.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

9.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and

any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Exceptions to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. †

9.9.13 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.9.14 Exceptions to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice.

9.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.9.16 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.9.17 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.9.19 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.9.20 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

9.9.23 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Exceptions to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

9.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

9.9.25 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.9.29 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

9.9.30 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

9.9.33 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Exceptions to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

9.9.34 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. **[New in v2.0]**

9.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

9.10.1 An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

9.10.2 Compliance data relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.10.3 Where an external regulator requests information concerning sick leave and medical absence, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.10.4 Compliance data relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.10.5 An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.10.6 An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.10.7 Where an external regulator requests information concerning sick leave and medical absence, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

9.10.8 Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or

treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.10.9 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Compliance data relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

9.10.10 Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

9.10.11 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where an external regulator requests information concerning sick leave and medical absence, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

9.10.12 An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

9.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

9.10.14 Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.10.15 Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

9.10.16 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to sick leave and medical absence. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

9.10.17 Compliance data relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.10.18 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. †

9.10.19 Compliance data relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

9.10.20 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.10.21 Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

9.10.22 An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to sick leave and medical absence.

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9.10.24 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning sick leave and medical absence, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

9.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning sick leave and medical absence, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to sick leave and medical absence. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably

for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

9.10.30 Compliance data relating to sick leave and medical absence shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.10.31 An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.10.32 An internal audit of sick leave and medical absence shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

9.10.33 Compliance with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where an external regulator requests information concerning sick leave and medical absence, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

9.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

9.11.1 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to sick leave and medical absence, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

9.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

9.11.3 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

9.11.4 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

9.11.5 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A failure to comply with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

9.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to sick leave and medical absence shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

9.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

9.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

9.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.11.13 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant,

shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.11.14 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.11.15 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to sick leave and medical absence shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.11.16 A failure to comply with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

9.11.17 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

9.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to sick leave and medical absence shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

9.11.21 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

9.11.22 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

9.11.23 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

9.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to sick leave and medical absence shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

9.11.25 A failure to comply with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.11.26 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

9.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

9.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

9.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.11.30 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

9.11.31 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A failure to comply with the provisions on sick leave and medical absence may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

9.11.32 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.11.33 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.12 Review and Amendment

9.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

9.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.12.3 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

9.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

9.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

9.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

9.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

9.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.12.10 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

9.12.11 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

9.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

9.12.13 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

9.12.15 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

9.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

9.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.12.18 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.12.20 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

9.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

9.12.22 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

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9.12.28 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

9.12.30 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

9.12.31 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on sick leave and medical absence through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

9.12.32 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

9.12.33 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to sick leave and medical absence made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

Chapter 10

Parental Leave

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Maternity leave	26 weeks	26 weeks
Paternity leave	5 days	**15 days**

10.1 Purpose and Scope

10.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to parental leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.1.2 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.1.3 The Company recognises that parental leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.1.4 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on parental leave. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The objective of these provisions on parental leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

10.1.5 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.1.6 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to parental leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.1.7 The objective of these provisions on parental leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.1.8 The Company recognises that parental leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

10.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on parental leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.1.10 The objective of these provisions on parental leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.1.11 The Company recognises that parental leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on parental leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

10.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.1.15 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.1.16 The Company recognises that parental leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on parental leave.

10.1.17 The objective of these provisions on parental leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

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10.1.19 The objective of these provisions on parental leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

10.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.1.21 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

10.1.22 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

10.1.23 The objective of these provisions on parental leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.1.24 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to parental leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

10.1.26 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

10.1.27 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

10.1.28 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.1.29 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to parental leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.1.30 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.1.31 The objective of these provisions on parental leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.1.32 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on parental leave. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.1.33 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all

grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.2 Definitions and Interpretation

10.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to parental leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "parental leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.2.3 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to parental leave. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.2.4 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

10.2.5 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "parental leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

10.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. †

10.2.7 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.2.10 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.2.11 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "parental leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

10.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

10.2.13 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to parental leave. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "parental leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

10.2.16 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.2.17 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

10.2.18 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

10.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.2.20 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to parental leave.

10.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.2.22 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

10.2.23 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

10.2.24 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.2.25 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "parental leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

10.2.26 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

10.2.27 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.2.28 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.2.29 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to parental leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

10.2.33 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

10.3 Eligibility and Applicability

10.3.1 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.3.2 Eligibility for parental leave shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

10.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.3.4 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

10.3.6 Eligibility for parental leave shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.3.7 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

10.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on parental leave. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

10.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

10.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.3.13 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for parental leave restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

10.3.14 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

10.3.15 Eligibility for parental leave shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

10.3.17 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

10.3.19 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.3.21 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on parental leave.

10.3.22 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

10.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.3.24 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.3.26 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on parental leave.

10.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

10.3.28 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on parental leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for parental leave restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.3.31 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on parental leave. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

10.3.32 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

10.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.3.34 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. **[New in v2.0]**

10.4 Responsibilities of Employees

10.4.1 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on parental leave and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of parental leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of parental leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

10.4.5 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.4.6 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.4.7 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of parental leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.4.8 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with parental leave.

10.4.9 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of parental leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

10.4.10 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

10.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. †

10.4.12 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.4.13 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.4.14 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with parental leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the

HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

10.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.4.16 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on parental leave and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

10.4.18 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

10.4.19 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with parental leave. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on parental leave and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

10.4.21 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

10.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with parental leave. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on parental leave and shall comply with them at all times.

10.4.23 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

10.4.24 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with parental leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.4.25 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with parental leave.

10.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with parental leave. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

10.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to parental leave and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

10.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.4.29 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

10.4.30 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of parental leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

10.4.31 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the

Reporting Manager.

10.4.32 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of parental leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on parental leave and shall comply with them at all times.

10.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

10.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

10.5.3 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

10.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.5.5 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to parental leave to the HR Director without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

10.5.6 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on parental leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave.

10.5.7 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to parental leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is

absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.5.8 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on parental leave and applies them consistently. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on parental leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

10.5.9 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to parental leave to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave.

10.5.12 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

10.5.13 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on parental leave and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.5.14 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to parental leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.5.15 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on parental leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

10.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.5.18 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on parental leave and applies them consistently. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.5.19 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to parental leave within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

10.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.5.21 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on parental leave and applies them consistently.

10.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.5.25 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on parental leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.5.26 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

10.5.27 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on parental leave and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to parental leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall

be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on parental leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to parental leave within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

10.5.30 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on parental leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. †

10.5.32 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on parental leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.5.33 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on parental leave and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

10.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on parental leave within 30 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to parental leave and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.6.4 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.6.5 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for parental leave and shall make them available to all employees. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with parental leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

10.6.6 HR shall respond to every written query on parental leave within 30 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to parental leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to parental leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.6.9 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to parental leave and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.6.10 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for parental leave and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

10.6.11 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.6.12 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to parental leave and on the applicable legal requirements. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall respond to every written query on parental leave within 21 working days of receipt.

10.6.13 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with parental leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.6.14 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to parental leave and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Head of

Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.6.15 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for parental leave and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on parental leave within 7 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

10.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for parental leave and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. †

10.6.19 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for parental leave and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to parental leave and on the applicable legal requirements.

10.6.20 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with parental leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.6.21 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with parental leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.6.22 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with parental leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

10.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to parental leave and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

10.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to parental leave.

10.6.25 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for parental leave and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to parental leave and on the applicable legal requirements.

10.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

10.6.28 HR shall respond to every written query on parental leave within 2 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to parental leave.

10.6.29 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.6.30 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with parental leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.6.33 HR shall respond to every written query on parental leave within 10 working days of receipt. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

10.6.34 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to parental leave. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall respond to every written query on parental leave within 10 working days of receipt. **[New in v2.0]**

10.7 Procedure and Process Steps

10.7.1 **Maternity leave.** Eligible employees shall be entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave.

10.7.2 **Paternity leave.** Eligible employees shall be entitled to 15 days of paid paternity leave. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 5 days]**

10.7.3 The employee shall initiate the process relating to parental leave by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

10.7.4 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 3 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.7.5 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

10.7.7 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

10.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it.

10.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it.

10.7.10 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 3 working days of receiving it.

10.7.11 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter

shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 7 working days of receiving it.

10.7.12 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.7.14 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 3 working days of receiving it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

10.7.15 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

10.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

10.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.7.18 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to parental leave by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.7.20 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance

from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

10.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

10.7.22 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

10.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to parental leave by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

10.7.25 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it.

10.7.26 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

10.7.27 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to parental leave by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request

has been declined or modified.

10.7.29 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

10.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to parental leave by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

10.7.31 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

10.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.7.33 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 30 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.7.34 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The employee shall initiate the process relating to parental leave by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department.

10.7.35 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it.

10.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

10.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.8.2 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which

the requests were received.

10.8.3 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.8.4 All documents relating to parental leave shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.8.6 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.8.7 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

10.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

10.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.8.10 All documents relating to parental leave shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.8.12 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

10.8.13 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

10.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Line Manager shall

decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. All documents relating to parental leave shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

10.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

10.8.16 All documents relating to parental leave shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.8.17 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.8.18 All documents relating to parental leave shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

10.8.20 All documents relating to parental leave shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records relating to parental leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

10.8.21 All documents relating to parental leave shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

10.8.22 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to parental leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to parental leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

10.8.23 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.8.24 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

10.8.25 Records relating to parental leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

10.8.27 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.8.28 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.8.29 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

10.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

10.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice.

10.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.9.4 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

10.9.5 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.9.6 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

10.9.8 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

10.9.12 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on

the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

10.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

10.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.9.17 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

10.9.18 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

10.9.19 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

10.9.20 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

10.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a

term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

10.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

10.9.23 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.9.25 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

10.9.26 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

10.9.27 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

10.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.9.29 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.9.30 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

10.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.9.32 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions to the provisions on parental leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

10.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

10.10.1 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.10.2 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.10.3 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where an external regulator requests information concerning parental leave, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

10.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to parental leave. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than

punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

10.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

10.10.7 Compliance with the provisions on parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.10.8 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.10.9 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.10.10 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.10.11 Compliance data relating to parental leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.10.12 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.10.13 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.10.14 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

10.10.15 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

10.10.16 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.10.17 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Compliance data relating to parental leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

10.10.18 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning parental leave, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Compliance with the provisions on parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

10.10.20 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

10.10.21 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where an external regulator requests information concerning parental leave, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

10.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning parental leave, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Compliance data relating to parental leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

10.10.24 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to parental leave. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the HR Business

Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to parental leave. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.10.27 Compliance with the provisions on parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

10.10.28 Compliance data relating to parental leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

10.10.29 Compliance data relating to parental leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

10.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.10.31 An internal audit of parental leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance with the provisions on parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. †

10.10.32 Compliance with the provisions on parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.10.33 Where an external regulator requests information concerning parental leave, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

10.10.34 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Compliance with the provisions on

parental leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. **[New in v2.0]**

10.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

10.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

10.11.2 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

10.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct.

10.11.6 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.11.7 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.11.8 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct.

10.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise.

10.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

10.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

10.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

10.11.14 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

10.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

10.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct.

10.11.18 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

10.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

10.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

10.11.21 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

10.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

10.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

10.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

10.11.26 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.11.28 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to

all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

10.11.29 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct.

10.11.30 A failure to comply with the provisions on parental leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

10.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

10.11.33 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to parental leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

10.11.34 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. **[New in v2.0]**

10.12 Review and Amendment

10.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

10.12.2 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

10.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

10.12.4 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

10.12.6 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

10.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

10.12.8 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

10.12.9 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.12.10 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to parental leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on parental leave through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

10.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

10.12.13 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

10.12.14 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on parental leave through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a

decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

10.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.12.17 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

10.12.18 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

10.12.19 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to parental leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

10.12.20 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

10.12.21 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

10.12.23 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on parental leave through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

10.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

10.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and

employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

10.12.26 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on parental leave through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect.

10.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

10.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

10.12.29 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on parental leave through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect.

10.12.30 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

10.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

10.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on parental leave through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

10.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

Chapter 11

Public Holidays and Special Leave

11.1 Purpose and Scope

11.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.1.2 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

11.1.3 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.1.4 The Company recognises that public holidays and special leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on public holidays and special leave.

11.1.5 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on public holidays and special leave.

11.1.7 The Company recognises that public holidays and special leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.1.8 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

11.1.10 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company recognises that public holidays and special leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

11.1.12 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.1.13 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.1.15 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

11.1.16 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.1.18 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.1.19 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.1.22 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on public holidays and special leave.

11.1.23 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on public holidays and special leave.

11.1.25 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.1.26 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.1.27 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.1.28 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to public holidays and special leave and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

11.1.29 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on public holidays and special leave. The Company's decision

under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

11.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.1.31 The objective of these provisions on public holidays and special leave is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

11.1.32 The Company recognises that public holidays and special leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on public holidays and special leave.

11.1.33 The Company recognises that public holidays and special leave has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.2 Definitions and Interpretation

11.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

11.2.2 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

11.2.3 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to public holidays and special leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "public holidays and special leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

11.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.2.5 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "public holidays and special leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.2.6 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

11.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

11.2.8 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "public holidays and special leave" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.2.9 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to public holidays and special leave.

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circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.2.14 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

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11.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

11.2.21 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

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prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.2.24 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to public holidays and special leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

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11.2.30 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to public holidays and special leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.2.33 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.3 Eligibility and Applicability

11.3.1 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

11.3.2 Eligibility for public holidays and special leave shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.3.3 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on public holidays and special leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

11.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.3.5 Eligibility for public holidays and special leave shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

11.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.3.7 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall

continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

11.3.9 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on public holidays and special leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.3.10 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.3.11 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.3.13 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.3.14 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

11.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on public holidays and special leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

11.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.3.17 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on public holidays and special leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent

seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.3.18 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

11.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.3.20 Eligibility for public holidays and special leave shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.3.21 Eligibility for public holidays and special leave shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

11.3.22 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for public holidays and special leave restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

11.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

11.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for public holidays and special leave restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

11.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.3.26 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy

Committee.

11.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for public holidays and special leave restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.3.28 Eligibility for public holidays and special leave shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

11.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on public holidays and special leave. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

11.3.30 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on public holidays and special leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

11.3.31 Eligibility for public holidays and special leave shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.3.32 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

11.3.33 Eligibility for public holidays and special leave shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for public holidays and special leave restricted until the matter is concluded.

11.4 Responsibilities of Employees

11.4.1 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with public holidays and special leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

11.4.2 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to public holidays and special leave and shall not withhold material facts.

11.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

11.4.4 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with public holidays and special leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.4.7 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

11.4.8 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.4.9 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.4.10 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to public holidays and special leave and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.4.11 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with public holidays and special leave. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.4.12 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.4.14 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with public holidays and special leave. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

11.4.15 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.4.16 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to public holidays and special leave and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on public holidays and special leave and shall comply with them at all times.

11.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.4.20 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

11.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to public holidays and special leave and shall not withhold material facts.

11.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with public holidays and special leave. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on public holidays and special leave and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.4.26 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.4.27 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of public holidays and special leave as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may

escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to public holidays and special leave and shall not withhold material facts.

11.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to public holidays and special leave and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.4.31 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to public holidays and special leave and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

11.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on public holidays and special leave and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with public holidays and special leave. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on public holidays and special leave and shall comply with them at all times. †

11.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

11.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on public holidays and special leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

11.5.2 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.5.3 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

11.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave.

11.5.5 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to public holidays and special leave within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

11.5.6 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on public holidays and special leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.5.7 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

11.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to public holidays and special leave to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

11.5.11 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.5.12 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.5.13 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to public holidays and special leave within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this

Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

11.5.15 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on public holidays and special leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave.

11.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

11.5.18 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.5.19 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on public holidays and special leave and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

11.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to public holidays and special leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

11.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to public holidays and special leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the

Company decides otherwise.

11.5.23 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

11.5.24 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to public holidays and special leave within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

11.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently.

11.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to public holidays and special leave to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.5.27 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave.

11.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on public holidays and special leave. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.5.34 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on public holidays and special leave and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. **[New in v2.0]**

11.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

11.6.1 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to public holidays and special leave. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

11.6.3 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to public holidays and special leave. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

11.6.4 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for public holidays and special leave and shall make them available to all employees.

11.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for public holidays and special leave and shall make them available to all employees.

11.6.6 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.6.7 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to public holidays and special leave and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

11.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for public holidays and special leave and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.6.9 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on public holidays and special leave within 10 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.6.13 HR shall respond to every written query on public holidays and special leave within 21 working days of receipt. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to public holidays and special leave and on the applicable legal requirements.

11.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

11.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

11.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for public holidays and special leave and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are

sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to public holidays and special leave.

11.6.18 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.6.19 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on public holidays and special leave within 15 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

11.6.22 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to public holidays and special leave and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to public holidays and special leave.

11.6.24 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

11.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to public holidays and special leave and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by

e-mail.

11.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

11.6.27 HR shall respond to every written query on public holidays and special leave within 30 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

11.6.28 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.6.29 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to public holidays and special leave and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to public holidays and special leave.

11.6.30 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to public holidays and special leave and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.6.32 HR shall respond to every written query on public holidays and special leave within 5 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

11.6.33 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with public holidays and special leave in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

11.7 Procedure and Process Steps

11.7.1 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it.

11.7.3 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.7.5 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.7.8 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.7.9 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.7.10 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

11.7.12 The employee shall initiate the process relating to public holidays and special leave by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

11.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

11.7.14 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

11.7.15 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.7.16 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

11.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.7.18 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to public holidays and special leave by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

11.7.20 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

11.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

11.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

11.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to public holidays and special leave by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager.

11.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

11.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. †

11.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

11.7.29 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.7.30 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to public holidays and special leave by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner.

11.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.7.33 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

11.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

11.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to public holidays and special leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

11.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

11.8.3 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to public holidays and special leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.8.5 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.8.6 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

11.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

11.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to public holidays and special leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.8.11 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. †

11.8.12 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.8.13 All documents relating to public holidays and special leave shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.8.14 All documents relating to public holidays and special leave shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

11.8.15 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.8.16 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.8.17 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to public holidays and special leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

11.8.20 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate

the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

11.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

11.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.8.23 All documents relating to public holidays and special leave shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.8.24 Records relating to public holidays and special leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

11.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Records relating to public holidays and special leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years.

11.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.8.27 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

11.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to public holidays and special leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

11.8.29 Records relating to public holidays and special leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.8.30 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to public holidays and special leave that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by

HR.

11.8.31 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.8.32 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.8.33 Records relating to public holidays and special leave shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

11.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

11.9.1 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

11.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.9.3 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.9.4 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

11.9.6 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

11.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

11.9.8 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

11.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

11.9.11 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. †

11.9.13 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

11.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.9.17 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

11.9.19 Exceptions to the provisions on public holidays and special leave may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

11.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on public holidays and special leave may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

11.9.21 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

11.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.9.23 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.9.25 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

11.9.26 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.9.27 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on public holidays and special leave may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.9.29 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

11.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

11.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

11.9.34 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. **[New in v2.0]**

11.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

11.10.1 Compliance data relating to public holidays and special leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where an external regulator requests information concerning public holidays and special leave, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

11.10.2 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.10.3 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department

concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where an external regulator requests information concerning public holidays and special leave, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

11.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to public holidays and special leave. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

11.10.6 Compliance with the provisions on public holidays and special leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.10.7 Compliance data relating to public holidays and special leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.10.8 Compliance data relating to public holidays and special leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.10.9 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

11.10.11 An internal audit of public holidays and special leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

11.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to public holidays and special leave. An internal audit of public holidays and special leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

11.10.13 An internal audit of public holidays and special leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.10.14 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Compliance with the provisions on public holidays and special leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

11.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to public holidays and special leave.

11.10.16 Compliance data relating to public holidays and special leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.10.17 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to public holidays and special leave.

11.10.18 Compliance data relating to public holidays and special leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

11.10.19 An internal audit of public holidays and special leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on public holidays and special leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning public holidays and special leave, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Compliance with the provisions on public holidays and special leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

11.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on public holidays and special leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning public holidays and special leave, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

11.10.24 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.10.25 An internal audit of public holidays and special leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.10.27 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning public holidays and special leave, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.10.29 Compliance data relating to public holidays and special leave shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An internal audit of public holidays and special leave shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

11.10.30 Where an external regulator requests information concerning public holidays and special leave, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

11.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on public holidays and special leave shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.10.33 Where an external regulator requests information concerning public holidays and special leave, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

11.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.11.3 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

11.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on public holidays and special leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.11.6 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. †

11.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

11.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on public holidays and special leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.11.11 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to public holidays and special leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

11.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on public holidays and special leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

11.11.13 A failure to comply with the provisions on public holidays and special leave may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.11.16 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.11.17 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

11.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.11.19 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

11.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

11.11.23 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to public holidays and special leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

11.11.25 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

11.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

11.11.27 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to public holidays and special leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

11.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

11.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

11.11.30 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant,

shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

11.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

11.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

11.11.33 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to public holidays and special leave shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.12 Review and Amendment

11.12.1 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to public holidays and special leave, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

11.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on public holidays and special leave through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

11.12.3 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

11.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. †

11.12.5 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.12.6 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

11.12.7 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on public holidays and special leave through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

11.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

11.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

11.12.11 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on public holidays and special leave through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

11.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.12.13 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

11.12.14 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

11.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

11.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

11.12.17 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

11.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

11.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

11.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on public holidays and special leave through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

11.12.21 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

11.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

11.12.23 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

11.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.12.25 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

11.12.26 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to public holidays and special leave made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

11.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

11.12.28 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on public holidays and special leave through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

11.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

11.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

11.12.31 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

11.12.32 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

11.12.33 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on public holidays and special leave through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This

requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

Chapter 12

Compensation and Pay Administration

12.1 Purpose and Scope

12.1.1 The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.1.2 The Company recognises that compensation and pay administration has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

12.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.1.4 The Company recognises that compensation and pay administration has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.1.5 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

12.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

12.1.7 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

12.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

12.1.10 The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.1.11 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.1.12 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

12.1.15 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

12.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.1.20 The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.1.21 The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.1.23 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to compensation and pay administration and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The objective of these provisions on compensation and pay administration is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

12.1.24 The Company recognises that compensation and pay administration has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. †

12.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on compensation and pay administration. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

12.1.26 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.1.27 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. As an illustration, a request relating to

compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

12.1.29 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.1.31 The Company recognises that compensation and pay administration has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.1.32 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

12.1.33 The Company recognises that compensation and pay administration has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

12.2 Definitions and Interpretation

12.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to compensation and pay administration. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

12.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.2.4 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to compensation and pay administration. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to compensation and pay administration. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

12.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

12.2.8 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.2.9 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.2.10 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.2.11 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line

Manager.

12.2.15 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

12.2.16 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

12.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

12.2.18 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

12.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "compensation and pay administration" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to compensation and pay administration. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.2.23 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

12.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

12.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "compensation and pay administration" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

12.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

12.2.29 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to compensation and pay administration. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.2.30 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

12.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

12.2.33 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to compensation and pay administration. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

12.3 Eligibility and Applicability

12.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.3.3 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.3.5 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on compensation and pay administration. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Eligibility for compensation and pay administration shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

12.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on compensation and pay administration.

12.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on compensation and pay administration.

12.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded.

12.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on compensation and pay administration.

12.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

12.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.3.14 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.3.15 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.3.16 Eligibility for compensation and pay administration shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.3.17 Eligibility for compensation and pay administration shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice,

suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded.

12.3.18 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

12.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

12.3.20 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on compensation and pay administration. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

12.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.3.23 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.3.24 Eligibility for compensation and pay administration shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

12.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded.

12.3.26 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to

benefit from the provisions on compensation and pay administration.

12.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.3.28 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.3.29 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

12.3.30 Eligibility for compensation and pay administration shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

12.3.31 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility for compensation and pay administration shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

12.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on compensation and pay administration. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for compensation and pay administration restricted until the matter is concluded.

12.3.33 Eligibility for compensation and pay administration shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.4 Responsibilities of Employees

12.4.1 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

12.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of compensation and pay administration as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on compensation and pay administration and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.4.4 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of compensation and pay administration as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.4.6 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.4.7 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of compensation and pay administration as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

12.4.8 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to compensation and pay administration and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.4.9 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of compensation and pay administration as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the

matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.4.10 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on compensation and pay administration and shall comply with them at all times.

12.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.4.13 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with compensation and pay administration. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of compensation and pay administration as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to compensation and pay administration and shall not withhold material facts.

12.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with compensation and pay administration. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.4.16 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on compensation and pay administration and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of compensation and pay administration as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

12.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

12.4.18 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

12.4.19 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to compensation and pay administration and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on compensation and pay administration and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

12.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to compensation and pay administration and shall not withhold material facts. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

12.4.22 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.4.23 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with compensation and pay administration. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.4.24 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with compensation and pay administration. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.4.26 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on compensation and pay administration and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.4.27 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

12.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.4.29 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall

treat all information obtained in the course of compensation and pay administration as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

12.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

12.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with compensation and pay administration. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to compensation and pay administration and shall not withhold material facts. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with compensation and pay administration.

12.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with compensation and pay administration. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

12.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to compensation and pay administration to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.5.2 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

12.5.3 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

12.5.4 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.5.5 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

12.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to compensation and pay administration to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

12.5.7 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on compensation and pay administration. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.5.8 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

12.5.9 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to compensation and pay administration within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on compensation and pay administration and applies them consistently.

12.5.10 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on compensation and pay administration and applies them consistently.

12.5.11 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to compensation and pay administration to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

12.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to compensation and pay administration to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

12.5.13 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

12.5.14 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

12.5.15 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on compensation and pay administration. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. †

12.5.17 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to compensation and pay administration within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

12.5.18 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.5.19 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to compensation and pay administration within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to compensation and pay administration to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

12.5.22 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to compensation and pay administration within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is

transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

12.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.5.24 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on compensation and pay administration. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.5.26 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on compensation and pay administration. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.5.27 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on compensation and pay administration. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

12.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

12.5.30 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to compensation and pay administration within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

12.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to compensation and pay administration within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental

register. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

12.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.5.33 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on compensation and pay administration and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

12.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

12.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.6.4 HR shall respond to every written query on compensation and pay administration within 2 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.6.5 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.6.6 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.6.7 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications,

where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

12.6.8 HR shall respond to every written query on compensation and pay administration within 7 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

12.6.9 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to compensation and pay administration.

12.6.10 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for compensation and pay administration and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for compensation and pay administration and shall make them available to all employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

12.6.12 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to compensation and pay administration. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.6.13 HR shall respond to every written query on compensation and pay administration within 10 working days of receipt.

12.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to compensation and pay administration. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

12.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

12.6.16 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.6.17 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

12.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for compensation and pay administration and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.6.19 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.6.20 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

12.6.21 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

12.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to compensation and pay administration.

12.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to compensation and pay administration. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for compensation and pay administration and shall make them available to all employees.

12.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.6.27 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to compensation and pay administration and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person

responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

12.6.28 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for compensation and pay administration and shall make them available to all employees.

12.6.29 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.6.30 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for compensation and pay administration and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

12.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on compensation and pay administration within 7 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with compensation and pay administration in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

12.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

12.7 Procedure and Process Steps

12.7.1 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.7.2 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

12.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.7.5 The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.7.9 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it.

12.7.10 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

12.7.12 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the

discretion of the HR Operations team. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

12.7.14 The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.7.15 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager.

12.7.17 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.7.18 The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.7.19 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.7.20 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.7.21 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

12.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.7.25 The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.7.26 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

12.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

12.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.7.30 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 15 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

12.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 2 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.7.32 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

12.7.33 The employee shall initiate the process relating to compensation and pay administration by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

12.8.1 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

12.8.2 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. All documents relating to compensation and pay administration shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

12.8.3 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

12.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.8.6 All documents relating to compensation and pay administration shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a

provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

12.8.8 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.8.9 All documents relating to compensation and pay administration shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

12.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

12.8.11 All documents relating to compensation and pay administration shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.8.12 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.8.13 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.8.14 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.8.15 All documents relating to compensation and pay administration shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.8.17 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. All documents relating to compensation and pay administration shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

12.8.19 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.8.20 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.8.21 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.8.22 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

12.8.23 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

12.8.24 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.8.25 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.8.26 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.8.27 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

12.8.28 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.8.29 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.8.30 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.8.31 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.8.32 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

12.8.33 Records relating to compensation and pay administration shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to compensation and pay administration that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

12.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

12.9.1 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.9.3 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

12.9.4 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.9.5 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

12.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

12.9.8 Exceptions to the provisions on compensation and pay administration may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.9.11 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.9.12 Exceptions to the provisions on compensation and pay administration may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. †

12.9.14 Exceptions to the provisions on compensation and pay administration may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

12.9.15 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.9.16 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

12.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

12.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.9.20 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

12.9.21 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

12.9.23 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.9.24 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.9.25 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on compensation and pay administration may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.9.28 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

12.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

12.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

12.9.31 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.9.32 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

12.10.1 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to compensation and pay administration. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.10.2 Compliance data relating to compensation and pay administration shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

12.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.10.5 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

12.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance with the provisions on compensation and pay administration shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

12.10.7 An internal audit of compensation and pay administration shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

12.10.8 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

12.10.9 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.10.10 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Compliance with the provisions on compensation and pay administration shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

12.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

12.10.12 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.10.13 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.10.14 Compliance with the provisions on compensation and pay administration shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.10.15 Compliance data relating to compensation and pay administration shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.10.16 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to compensation and pay administration. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Compliance with the provisions on compensation and pay administration shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

12.10.17 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations

and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.10.18 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.10.19 Compliance data relating to compensation and pay administration shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.10.20 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to compensation and pay administration. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

12.10.22 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to compensation and pay administration. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.10.24 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.10.25 Compliance with the provisions on compensation and pay administration shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.10.26 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to compensation and pay administration.

12.10.27 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to compensation and pay administration. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed

through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

12.10.29 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.10.30 Compliance data relating to compensation and pay administration shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

12.10.31 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

12.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

12.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to compensation and pay administration.

12.10.34 Where an external regulator requests information concerning compensation and pay administration, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. **[New in v2.0]**

12.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

12.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.11.2 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

12.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. †

12.11.4 A failure to comply with the provisions on compensation and pay administration may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

12.11.5 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter

and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.11.7 A failure to comply with the provisions on compensation and pay administration may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.11.8 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.11.9 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct.

12.11.10 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

12.11.12 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

12.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.11.16 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly

provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

12.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

12.11.18 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

12.11.19 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

12.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

12.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

12.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.11.23 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

12.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.11.25 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.11.26 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by

HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

12.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

12.11.30 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.11.31 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to compensation and pay administration, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A failure to comply with the provisions on compensation and pay administration may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. †

12.11.32 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to compensation and pay administration shall be treated as serious misconduct.

12.11.33 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

12.11.34 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. **[New in v2.0]**

12.12 Review and Amendment

12.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

12.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

12.12.3 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.12.4 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

12.12.5 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.12.6 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

12.12.9 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

12.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to compensation and pay administration made on a Friday shall be treated as received on

the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

12.12.11 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

12.12.12 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

12.12.13 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect.

12.12.14 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

12.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

12.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.12.17 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

12.12.18 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

12.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

12.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.12.22 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

12.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

12.12.25 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

12.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

12.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

12.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

12.12.29 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect.

12.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

12.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

12.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on compensation and pay administration through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

12.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

12.12.34 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. **[New in v2.0]**

Chapter 13

Benefits and Allowances

13.1 Purpose and Scope

13.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company recognises that benefits and allowances has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

13.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

13.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

13.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.1.5 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on benefits and allowances. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

13.1.7 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

13.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

13.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

13.1.11 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The Company recognises that benefits and allowances has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

13.1.12 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.1.13 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.1.14 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.1.15 The Company recognises that benefits and allowances has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on benefits and allowances.

13.1.16 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

13.1.17 The Company recognises that benefits and allowances has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to benefits and allowances and the standards that apply to every

employee in every location.

13.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.1.19 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on benefits and allowances. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. †

13.1.20 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on benefits and allowances. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.1.21 The Company recognises that benefits and allowances has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

13.1.22 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.1.23 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.1.24 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.1.25 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to benefits and allowances and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company recognises that benefits and allowances has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

13.1.26 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

13.1.27 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.1.29 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

13.1.31 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on benefits and allowances. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company recognises that benefits and allowances has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

13.1.32 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on benefits and allowances. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.1.34 The objective of these provisions on benefits and allowances is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. **[New in v2.0]**

13.2 Definitions and Interpretation

13.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "benefits and allowances" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

13.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

13.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "benefits and allowances" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

13.2.5 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.2.9 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.2.10 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "benefits and allowances" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.2.11 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last

day of the period is included.

13.2.13 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "benefits and allowances" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

13.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

13.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.2.17 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to benefits and allowances.

13.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "benefits and allowances" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.2.21 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

13.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to benefits and allowances. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

13.2.23 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

13.2.24 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.2.25 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

13.2.26 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.2.27 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

13.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.2.29 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

13.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

13.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

13.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

13.2.33 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to benefits and allowances. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

13.2.34 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "benefits and allowances" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. **[New in v2.0]**

13.3 Eligibility and Applicability

13.3.1 Eligibility for benefits and allowances shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. †

13.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and

employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.3.6 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on benefits and allowances. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.3.7 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded.

13.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. †

13.3.9 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on benefits and allowances. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

13.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on benefits and allowances. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

13.3.14 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on benefits and allowances. †

13.3.15 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on benefits and allowances.

13.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.3.17 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.3.18 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

13.3.19 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

13.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.3.22 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.3.23 Eligibility for benefits and allowances shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

13.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.3.25 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.3.26 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied

consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.3.28 Eligibility for benefits and allowances shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.3.29 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

13.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.3.32 Eligibility for benefits and allowances shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

13.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for benefits and allowances restricted until the matter is concluded. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for benefits and allowances shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

13.4 Responsibilities of Employees

13.4.1 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of benefits and allowances as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on benefits and allowances and shall comply with them at all times.

13.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of benefits and allowances as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

13.4.3 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

13.4.4 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on benefits and allowances and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.4.6 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

13.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with benefits and allowances. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

13.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.4.9 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of benefits and allowances as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

13.4.10 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of benefits and allowances as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

13.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts.

13.4.12 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts.

13.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.4.14 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts.

13.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.4.19 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The

time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

13.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of benefits and allowances as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.4.22 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on benefits and allowances and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

13.4.24 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on benefits and allowances and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.4.25 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with benefits and allowances.

13.4.26 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

13.4.29 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

13.4.31 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

13.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to benefits and allowances and shall not withhold material facts. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

13.4.33 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.4.34 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. **[New in v2.0]**

13.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

13.5.1 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to benefits and allowances within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.5.2 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to benefits and allowances to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.5.4 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.5.5 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

13.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

13.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

13.5.11 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.5.12 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on benefits and allowances. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

13.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

13.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to benefits and allowances to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.5.18 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

13.5.19 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to benefits and allowances to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.5.22 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

13.5.23 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to benefits and allowances to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

13.5.25 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to benefits and allowances to the Policy Committee without undue delay. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently.

13.5.27 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to benefits and allowances to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on benefits and allowances and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

13.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to benefits and allowances to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.5.30 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.5.31 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.5.32 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to benefits and allowances within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.5.33 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on benefits and allowances and applies them consistently. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

13.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

13.6.1 HR shall respond to every written query on benefits and allowances within 7 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.6.2 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to benefits and allowances. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

13.6.3 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to benefits and allowances. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.6.5 HR shall respond to every written query on benefits and allowances within 30 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for benefits and allowances and shall make them available to all employees.

13.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for benefits and allowances and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to benefits and allowances and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.6.9 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

13.6.10 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to benefits and allowances and on the applicable legal requirements.

13.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for benefits and allowances and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by

e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.6.12 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.6.13 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

13.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on benefits and allowances within 7 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

13.6.15 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to benefits and allowances. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall respond to every written query on benefits and allowances within 2 working days of receipt.

13.6.16 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to benefits and allowances. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for benefits and allowances and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.6.18 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.6.19 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to benefits and allowances and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

13.6.20 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

13.6.21 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.6.22 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for benefits and allowances and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to benefits and allowances and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

13.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

13.6.25 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.6.27 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to benefits and allowances.

13.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to benefits and allowances and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.6.29 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to benefits and allowances and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

13.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

13.6.31 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with benefits and allowances in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.6.32 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to benefits and allowances. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.7 Procedure and Process Steps

13.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

13.7.3 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The employee shall initiate the process relating to benefits and allowances by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner.

13.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to benefits and allowances by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

13.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

13.7.6 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.7.8 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

13.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it.

13.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 30 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

13.7.12 The employee shall initiate the process relating to benefits and allowances by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.7.14 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

13.7.15 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

13.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.7.17 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under

this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.7.19 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.7.20 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

13.7.21 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.7.22 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

13.7.24 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.7.25 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human

Resources within 3 working days of receiving it.

13.7.26 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

13.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The employee shall initiate the process relating to benefits and allowances by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner.

13.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to benefits and allowances by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.7.30 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.7.31 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 2 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. †

13.7.33 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

13.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

13.8.1 All documents relating to benefits and allowances shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

13.8.2 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to benefits and allowances that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

13.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.8.6 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.8.8 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

13.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.8.11 All documents relating to benefits and allowances shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

13.8.13 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.8.14 All documents relating to benefits and allowances shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.8.15 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

13.8.16 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. All documents relating to benefits and allowances shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

13.8.17 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

13.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

13.8.19 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter

shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.8.20 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

13.8.21 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

13.8.23 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

13.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to benefits and allowances that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

13.8.25 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to benefits and allowances that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.8.26 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.8.27 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.8.28 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. All documents relating to benefits and allowances shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

13.8.29 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

13.8.31 Records relating to benefits and allowances shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

13.8.32 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

13.8.33 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to benefits and allowances that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

13.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

13.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.9.3 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

13.9.4 Exceptions to the provisions on benefits and allowances may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

13.9.5 Exceptions to the provisions on benefits and allowances may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

13.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

13.9.8 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.9.9 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.9.10 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

13.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.9.12 Exceptions to the provisions on benefits and allowances may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. †

13.9.13 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.9.14 Exceptions to the provisions on benefits and allowances may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of

illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

13.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

13.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.9.18 Exceptions to the provisions on benefits and allowances may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

13.9.19 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.9.20 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.9.21 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on benefits and allowances may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if

they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.9.25 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.9.26 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

13.9.27 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

13.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

13.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.9.31 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

13.9.32 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

13.10.1 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

13.10.2 An internal audit of benefits and allowances shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning benefits and allowances, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

13.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to benefits and allowances. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An internal audit of benefits and allowances shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

13.10.9 Compliance data relating to benefits and allowances shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.10.10 An internal audit of benefits and allowances shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter

expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

13.10.11 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.10.12 Where an external regulator requests information concerning benefits and allowances, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.10.13 An internal audit of benefits and allowances shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.10.14 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

13.10.15 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.10.16 Compliance data relating to benefits and allowances shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to benefits and allowances. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An internal audit of benefits and allowances shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

13.10.18 Compliance with the provisions on benefits and allowances shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

13.10.19 Compliance with the provisions on benefits and allowances shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

13.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning benefits and allowances, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the

request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

13.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Compliance data relating to benefits and allowances shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

13.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on benefits and allowances shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Compliance data relating to benefits and allowances shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

13.10.23 Compliance data relating to benefits and allowances shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.10.24 Compliance with the provisions on benefits and allowances shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

13.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.10.26 Compliance with the provisions on benefits and allowances shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.10.27 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to benefits and allowances. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.10.29 Compliance with the provisions on benefits and allowances shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on benefits and allowances shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.10.31 Compliance data relating to benefits and allowances shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.10.32 An internal audit of benefits and allowances shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.10.33 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

13.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

13.11.4 A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

13.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

13.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.11.7 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

13.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.11.9 A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

13.11.10 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to benefits and allowances shall be treated as serious misconduct.

13.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to benefits and allowances shall be treated as serious misconduct.

13.11.12 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

13.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to benefits and allowances shall be treated as serious misconduct.

13.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.11.16 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.11.17 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.11.18 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

13.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.11.22 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to benefits and allowances shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

13.11.25 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are

intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

13.11.27 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.11.28 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.11.30 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

13.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

13.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on benefits and allowances may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.11.33 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to benefits and allowances shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.12 Review and Amendment

13.12.1 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.12.2 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months,

or earlier if there is a change in law.

13.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

13.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

13.12.5 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

13.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

13.12.7 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on benefits and allowances through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

13.12.8 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.12.9 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

13.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

13.12.11 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.12.12 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

13.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right

of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.12.14 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on benefits and allowances through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect.

13.12.15 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

13.12.16 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.12.17 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

13.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.12.19 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to benefits and allowances, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

13.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

13.12.21 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

13.12.22 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on benefits and allowances through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect.

13.12.23 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

13.12.24 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

13.12.25 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

13.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

13.12.27 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

13.12.28 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to benefits and allowances made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

13.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

13.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

13.12.31 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

13.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

13.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

Chapter 14

Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Claim deadline	30 days	**45 days**

14.1 Purpose and Scope

14.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on travel and expense reimbursement. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company recognises that travel and expense reimbursement has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

14.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on travel and expense reimbursement. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.1.3 The objective of these provisions on travel and expense reimbursement is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.1.4 The objective of these provisions on travel and expense reimbursement is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.1.5 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to travel and expense reimbursement and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on travel and expense reimbursement. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to travel and expense reimbursement and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.1.8 The Company recognises that travel and expense reimbursement has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should

seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on travel and expense reimbursement.

14.1.9 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.1.11 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.1.12 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

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14.1.16 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to travel and expense reimbursement and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

14.1.17 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.1.19 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be

an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.1.20 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.1.21 The objective of these provisions on travel and expense reimbursement is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.1.22 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

14.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on travel and expense reimbursement.

14.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on travel and expense reimbursement. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to travel and expense reimbursement and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. †

14.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to travel and expense reimbursement and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.1.27 The objective of these provisions on travel and expense reimbursement is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.1.28 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to travel and expense reimbursement and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on travel and expense reimbursement.

14.1.29 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

14.1.31 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.1.32 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to travel and expense reimbursement and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.1.33 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

14.2 Definitions and Interpretation

14.2.1 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.2.2 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.2.3 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

14.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

14.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.2.7 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. †

14.2.8 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.2.11 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

14.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.2.13 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.2.14 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.2.15 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

14.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

14.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to travel and expense reimbursement.

14.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

14.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to travel and expense reimbursement. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

14.2.23 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are

unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

14.2.24 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. †

14.2.27 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

14.2.29 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to travel and expense reimbursement.

14.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

14.2.31 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "travel and expense reimbursement" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.2.33 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

14.2.34 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to travel and expense reimbursement. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. **[New in v2.0]**

14.3 Eligibility and Applicability

14.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

14.3.2 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

14.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

14.3.5 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.3.8 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement.

14.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

14.3.10 Eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

14.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

14.3.12 Eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

14.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the

Chief People Officer.

14.3.16 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.3.17 Eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.3.18 Eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

14.3.19 Eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

14.3.20 Eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

14.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement restricted until the matter is concluded. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. †

14.3.25 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades,

locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

14.3.26 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

14.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

14.3.28 Eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

14.3.30 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement restricted until the matter is concluded.

14.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

14.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for travel and expense reimbursement restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.4 Responsibilities of Employees

14.4.1 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with travel and expense reimbursement.

14.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and shall comply with them at all times.

14.4.4 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

14.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with travel and expense reimbursement. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.4.8 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with travel and expense reimbursement.

14.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters

relating to travel and expense reimbursement and shall not withhold material facts.

14.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.4.12 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

14.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. †

14.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.4.15 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.4.16 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with travel and expense reimbursement. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.4.19 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and shall comply with them at all times. †

14.4.21 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and shall comply with them at all times. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.4.22 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. †

14.4.24 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

14.4.25 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

14.4.26 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time

limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.4.27 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.4.28 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with travel and expense reimbursement. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

14.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

14.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with travel and expense reimbursement. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement and shall not withhold material facts.

14.4.32 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of travel and expense reimbursement as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

14.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

14.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

14.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on travel and expense reimbursement and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to travel and expense reimbursement to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

14.5.4 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to travel and expense reimbursement to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

14.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on travel and expense reimbursement and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.5.7 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.5.9 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on travel and expense reimbursement and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This

requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and applies them consistently.

14.5.10 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement.

14.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

14.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.5.13 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

14.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on travel and expense reimbursement and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.5.15 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

14.5.16 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.5.17 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

14.5.18 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

14.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

14.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on travel and expense reimbursement and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

14.5.21 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

14.5.22 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement.

14.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

14.5.24 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.5.26 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement.

14.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on travel and expense reimbursement. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

14.5.30 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on travel and expense reimbursement and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

14.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to travel and expense reimbursement within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on travel and expense reimbursement and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.5.33 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

14.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

14.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with travel and expense reimbursement in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.6.2 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with travel and expense reimbursement in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to travel and expense reimbursement and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.6.4 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for travel and expense reimbursement and shall make them available to all employees. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to travel and expense reimbursement and on the applicable legal requirements.

14.6.5 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to travel and expense reimbursement and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

14.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

14.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to travel and expense reimbursement and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.6.9 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

14.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

14.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with travel and expense reimbursement in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

14.6.13 HR shall respond to every written query on travel and expense reimbursement within 10 working days of receipt. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

14.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement.

14.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.6.17 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall respond to every written query on travel and expense reimbursement within 10 working days of receipt.

14.6.19 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to travel and expense reimbursement and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.6.20 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for travel and expense reimbursement and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To

illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

14.6.21 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to travel and expense reimbursement and on the applicable legal requirements. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.6.22 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement.

14.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

14.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to travel and expense reimbursement. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

14.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

14.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

14.6.28 HR shall respond to every written query on travel and expense reimbursement within 7 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.6.30 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to travel and expense reimbursement and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on travel and expense reimbursement within 30 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To

illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

14.6.32 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.7 Procedure and Process Steps

14.7.1 **Claim deadline.** All expense claims shall be submitted within 45 days of the date on which the expense was incurred. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 30 days]**

14.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

14.7.3 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

14.7.4 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

14.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.7.10 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

14.7.12 The employee shall initiate the process relating to travel and expense reimbursement by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 2 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.7.14 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.7.15 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 3 working days of receiving it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.7.16 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

14.7.17 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 3 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the

prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

14.7.18 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

14.7.19 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.7.20 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The employee shall initiate the process relating to travel and expense reimbursement by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner.

14.7.22 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

14.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to travel and expense reimbursement by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.7.25 The employee shall initiate the process relating to travel and expense reimbursement by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

14.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to travel and expense reimbursement by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.7.28 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

14.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

14.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

14.7.31 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

14.7.32 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.7.34 The employee shall initiate the process relating to travel and expense reimbursement by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

14.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to travel and expense reimbursement that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

14.8.3 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

14.8.4 Records relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.8.5 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to travel and expense reimbursement that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

14.8.6 All documents relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

14.8.7 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

14.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to travel and expense reimbursement that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.8.9 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the

Reporting Manager.

14.8.10 Records relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

14.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

14.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

14.8.14 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.8.15 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.8.16 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to travel and expense reimbursement that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.8.17 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

14.8.18 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to travel and expense reimbursement that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

14.8.21 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to travel and expense reimbursement that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

14.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

14.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.8.25 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

14.8.26 All documents relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

14.8.27 All documents relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.8.28 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.8.29 All documents relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

14.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may

escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Records relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

14.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

14.8.32 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to travel and expense reimbursement that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Records relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

14.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

14.9.1 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

14.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.9.3 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

14.9.4 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the

Reporting Manager.

14.9.5 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

14.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.9.7 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

14.9.8 Exceptions to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Exceptions to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

14.9.10 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.9.11 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

14.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

14.9.14 Exceptions to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be

recorded together with the reason for it.

14.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.9.17 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.9.18 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.9.19 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

14.9.20 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

14.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

14.9.23 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.9.26 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

14.9.27 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

14.9.30 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

14.9.32 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.9.34 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. **[New in v2.0]**

14.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

14.10.1 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to travel and expense reimbursement.

14.10.2 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning travel and expense reimbursement, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

14.10.5 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

14.10.7 Where an external regulator requests information concerning travel and expense reimbursement, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

14.10.8 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

14.10.9 An internal audit of travel and expense reimbursement shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Compliance with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

14.10.10 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.10.11 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

14.10.12 Where an external regulator requests information concerning travel and expense reimbursement, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

14.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.10.14 Where an external regulator requests information concerning travel and expense reimbursement, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

14.10.15 Where an external regulator requests information concerning travel and expense reimbursement, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.10.16 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

14.10.17 Compliance with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

14.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning travel and expense reimbursement, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. An internal audit of travel and expense reimbursement shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

14.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An internal audit of travel and expense reimbursement shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

14.10.20 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

14.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning travel and expense reimbursement, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

14.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.10.23 Compliance with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.10.24 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

14.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to travel and expense reimbursement.

14.10.26 Compliance with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

14.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to travel and expense reimbursement. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to travel and expense reimbursement.

14.10.29 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An internal audit of travel and expense reimbursement shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

14.10.30 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to travel and expense reimbursement. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Compliance with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

14.10.31 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

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14.10.33 Compliance data relating to travel and expense reimbursement shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

14.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

14.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.11.2 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

14.11.5 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

14.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

14.11.7 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.11.8 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

14.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

14.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.11.13 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to travel and expense reimbursement shall be treated as serious misconduct.

14.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

14.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.11.16 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

14.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.11.18 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

14.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

14.11.21 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

14.11.22 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

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14.11.24 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

14.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to travel and expense reimbursement shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.11.26 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

14.11.29 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

14.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.11.32 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

14.11.33 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to travel and expense reimbursement shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.12 Review and Amendment

14.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. †

14.12.2 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

14.12.4 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

14.12.5 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.12.6 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.12.7 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

14.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

14.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

14.12.11 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

14.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

14.12.14 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

14.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

14.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.12.17 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

14.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

14.12.19 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

14.12.20 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

14.12.21 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

14.12.22 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on travel and expense reimbursement through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

14.12.24 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

14.12.25 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

14.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

14.12.27 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

14.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

14.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

14.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

14.12.31 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to travel and expense reimbursement, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

14.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

14.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to travel and expense reimbursement made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

Chapter 15

Performance Management

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Review cycle	annual	**half-yearly**

15.1 Purpose and Scope

15.1.1 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

15.1.2 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

15.1.3 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

15.1.4 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

15.1.5 The Company recognises that performance management has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

15.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

15.1.7 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

15.1.8 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

15.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

15.1.10 The Company recognises that performance management has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

15.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

15.1.12 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

15.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.1.15 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

15.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.1.17 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company recognises that performance management has a

direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

15.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

15.1.19 The objective of these provisions on performance management is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

15.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

15.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

15.1.22 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

15.1.23 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

15.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.1.25 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.1.26 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

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15.1.28 The objective of these provisions on performance management is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. †

15.1.29 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

15.1.30 The Company recognises that performance management has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management.

15.1.31 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management.

15.1.32 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on performance management. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

15.1.33 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to performance management and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.2 Definitions and Interpretation

15.2.1 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.2.3 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to performance management. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.2.4 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or

treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.2.5 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

15.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. †

15.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. †

15.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to performance management. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.2.9 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.2.10 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.2.11 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

15.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.2.13 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "performance management" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

15.2.14 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "performance management" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

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15.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

15.2.20 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

15.2.21 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to performance management. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "performance management" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

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15.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "performance management" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

15.2.25 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.2.26 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.2.27 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "performance management" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

15.2.28 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

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15.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.2.32 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is

absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

15.3 Eligibility and Applicability

15.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

15.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on performance management.

15.3.3 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Eligibility for performance management shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

15.3.4 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

15.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

15.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.3.7 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the

request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Eligibility for performance management shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

15.3.9 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.3.10 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

15.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

15.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.3.13 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

15.3.14 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded.

15.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on performance management.

15.3.16 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.3.17 Eligibility for performance management shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the

employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.3.18 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

15.3.19 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Eligibility for performance management shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

15.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

15.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

15.3.23 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.3.25 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.3.26 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance

management restricted until the matter is concluded.

15.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

15.3.29 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

15.3.30 Eligibility for performance management shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

15.3.31 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

15.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for performance management restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Eligibility for performance management shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

15.4 Responsibilities of Employees

15.4.1 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on performance management and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on performance management and shall comply with them at all times. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

15.4.4 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of performance management as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

15.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on performance management and shall comply with them at all times.

15.4.6 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with performance management. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.4.7 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

15.4.8 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with performance management.

15.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.4.10 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with performance management. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of performance management as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

15.4.12 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on performance management and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management,

the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.4.13 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to performance management and shall not withhold material facts. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of performance management as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.4.15 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.4.16 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of performance management as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

15.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to performance management and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.4.18 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with performance management. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of performance management as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.4.20 The employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

15.4.21 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on performance management and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.4.22 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on performance management and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of performance management as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. †

15.4.26 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.4.27 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.4.28 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of performance management as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

15.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on performance management and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. †

15.4.30 The employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with performance management. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to performance management and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated

as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

15.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

15.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the HR Director without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

15.5.2 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on performance management. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.5.3 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on performance management and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

15.5.4 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on performance management. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to performance management within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on performance management and applies them consistently.

15.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on performance management and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

15.5.8 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and

the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to performance management within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

15.5.9 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

15.5.10 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on performance management and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

15.5.11 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on performance management and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

15.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on performance management and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

15.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.5.14 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on performance management and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on performance management. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on performance management. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to performance management within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.5.19 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to performance management within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

15.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

15.5.21 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.5.22 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to performance management within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

15.5.23 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on performance management and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

15.5.24 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on performance management and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on performance management.

15.5.25 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on performance management and applies them consistently.

15.5.26 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on performance management and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.5.27 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of

this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.5.28 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on performance management and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

15.5.29 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.5.30 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on performance management.

15.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

15.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to performance management to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. †

15.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on performance management. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

15.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

15.6.1 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

15.6.2 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to performance management. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

15.6.3 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter

expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.6.4 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with performance management in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to performance management.

15.6.7 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

15.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.6.9 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with performance management in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.6.10 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees.

15.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

15.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. †

15.6.17 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.6.18 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with performance management in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

15.6.19 HR shall respond to every written query on performance management within 5 working days of receipt. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.6.20 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

15.6.21 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of

calculating time limits.

15.6.22 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.6.24 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to performance management.

15.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees.

15.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees.

15.6.28 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on performance management within 14 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with performance management in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.6.31 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.6.32 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to performance management and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for performance management and shall make them available to all employees.

15.6.33 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to performance management. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.7 Procedure and Process Steps

15.7.1 **Review cycle.** Formal performance reviews shall be conducted on a half-yearly basis. **[Revised in v2.0; previously annual]**

15.7.2 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.7.3 The employee shall initiate the process relating to performance management by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

15.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

15.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

15.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

15.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

15.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

15.7.9 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 2 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration,

where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

15.7.10 The employee shall initiate the process relating to performance management by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

15.7.11 The employee shall initiate the process relating to performance management by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.7.12 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 30 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. †

15.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

15.7.15 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to performance management by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

15.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

15.7.18 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.7.19 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

15.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it.

15.7.22 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

15.7.23 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.7.25 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

15.7.26 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

15.7.27 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The

time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.7.28 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 15 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.7.29 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.7.30 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

15.7.31 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.7.32 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

15.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.7.34 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The appeal shall be decided by a person

who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

15.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

15.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

15.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.8.3 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to performance management that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.8.5 All documents relating to performance management shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records relating to performance management shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

15.8.6 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

15.8.8 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.8.9 Records relating to performance management shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.8.10 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

15.8.11 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Records relating to performance management shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. †

15.8.13 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. All documents relating to performance management shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

15.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to performance management that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.8.16 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

15.8.18 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

15.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.8.21 Records relating to performance management shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.8.22 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to performance management that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

15.8.23 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to performance management that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

15.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to performance management that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.8.27 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

15.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to performance management that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.8.30 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Records relating to performance management shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

15.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

15.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Records relating to performance management shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

15.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

15.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

15.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on performance management may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.9.2 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

15.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

15.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised

or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice.

15.9.8 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.9.9 Exceptions to the provisions on performance management may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.9.10 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on performance management may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

15.9.12 Exceptions to the provisions on performance management may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.9.13 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

15.9.14 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

15.9.15 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

15.9.16 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

15.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.9.19 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.9.20 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

15.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on performance management may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

15.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

15.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. No exception shall be granted that would contravene

applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

15.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

15.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.9.28 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

15.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

15.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

15.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

15.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on performance management shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

15.10.2 Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to performance management.

15.10.3 An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning performance management, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.10.5 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to performance management. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.10.7 An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

15.10.8 Where an external regulator requests information concerning performance management, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

15.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to performance management. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than

punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

15.10.10 Compliance with the provisions on performance management shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

15.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on performance management shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

15.10.12 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

15.10.13 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to performance management. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.10.14 An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.10.15 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

15.10.16 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where an external regulator requests information concerning performance management, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

15.10.17 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

15.10.18 Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

15.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning performance management, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Notices

under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

15.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning performance management, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance with the provisions on performance management shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

15.10.21 An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

15.10.22 An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. †

15.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.10.24 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to performance management. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

15.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning performance management, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

15.10.26 Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. †

15.10.27 Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

15.10.28 An internal audit of performance management shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. For instance, where

two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.10.29 Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.10.30 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to performance management. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

15.10.31 Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.10.32 Where an external regulator requests information concerning performance management, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance data relating to performance management shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

15.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

15.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

15.11.1 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.11.2 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.11.3 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

15.11.4 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.11.5 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

15.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.11.7 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

15.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct.

15.11.10 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

15.11.13 A failure to comply with the provisions on performance management may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

15.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the

request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

15.11.15 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. †

15.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

15.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.11.19 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

15.11.20 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

15.11.21 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct.

15.11.22 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

15.11.23 A failure to comply with the provisions on performance management may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct.

15.11.24 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.11.25 A failure to comply with the provisions on performance management may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

15.11.26 A failure to comply with the provisions on performance management may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

15.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on performance management may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

15.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

15.11.30 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.11.31 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.11.32 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct. For instance, where two employees make

competing requests relating to performance management, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

15.11.33 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to performance management shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

15.12 Review and Amendment

15.12.1 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

15.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on performance management through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

15.12.3 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

15.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

15.12.5 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

15.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

15.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be

dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

15.12.9 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

15.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.12.11 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on performance management through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

15.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.12.13 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on performance management through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

15.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

15.12.15 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.12.16 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

15.12.18 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

15.12.19 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on performance management through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

15.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

15.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

15.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.12.24 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to performance management made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

15.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

15.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

15.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.12.28 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

15.12.29 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on performance management through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

15.12.30 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

15.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

15.12.32 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to performance management, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

15.12.33 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

Chapter 16

Learning and Development

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Learning commitment	24 hours per year	**40 hours per year**

16.1 Purpose and Scope

16.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on learning and development. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.1.2 The Company recognises that learning and development has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The objective of these provisions on learning and development is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

16.1.4 The Company recognises that learning and development has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on learning and development.

16.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on learning and development. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The objective of these provisions on learning and development is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

16.1.6 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to learning and development and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

16.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to learning and development and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each

case. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. †

16.1.8 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

16.1.9 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.1.10 The Company recognises that learning and development has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.1.11 The objective of these provisions on learning and development is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company recognises that learning and development has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. †

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16.1.13 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

16.1.16 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to learning and development and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.1.17 The objective of these provisions on learning and development is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

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16.1.19 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.1.20 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.1.21 The Company recognises that learning and development has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to learning and development and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

16.1.23 The objective of these provisions on learning and development is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to learning and development and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

16.1.24 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

16.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The Company recognises that learning and development has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

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shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on learning and development.

16.1.27 The objective of these provisions on learning and development is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

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16.1.30 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on learning and development. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.1.32 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on learning and development. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.1.33 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on learning and development.

16.2 Definitions and Interpretation

16.2.1 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

16.2.2 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.2.5 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.2.6 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

16.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.2.9 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to learning and development. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

16.2.10 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

16.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Where a period is expressed in

days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

16.2.13 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

16.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.2.16 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.2.17 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

16.2.18 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.2.20 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to learning and development.

16.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.2.22 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and

development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.2.23 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

16.2.25 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to learning and development. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.2.26 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to learning and development. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. †

16.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.2.28 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

16.2.29 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.2.30 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

16.2.31 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

16.2.32 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.2.33 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "learning and development" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.3 Eligibility and Applicability

16.3.1 Eligibility for learning and development shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

16.3.2 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.3.3 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for learning and development restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.3.5 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for learning and development restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

16.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.3.7 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.3.9 Eligibility for learning and development shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost

implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.3.10 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.3.11 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

16.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.3.13 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Eligibility for learning and development shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

16.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.3.16 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for learning and development restricted until the matter is concluded.

16.3.17 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.3.18 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

16.3.19 Eligibility for learning and development shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

16.3.21 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.3.22 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

16.3.23 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.3.24 Eligibility for learning and development shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

16.3.25 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.3.26 Eligibility for learning and development shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

16.3.28 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on learning and development. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for learning and development restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

16.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for learning and development restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

16.3.31 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on learning and development. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

16.3.32 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for learning and development restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.4 Responsibilities of Employees

16.4.1 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.4.3 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with learning and development. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

16.4.4 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts.

16.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

16.4.7 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of learning and development as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

16.4.8 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

16.4.9 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

16.4.10 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of learning and development as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.4.13 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without

delay.

16.4.14 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.4.15 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of learning and development as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.4.17 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.4.18 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts.

16.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with learning and development.

16.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

16.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.4.23 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.4.24 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

16.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with learning and development. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with learning and development. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. †

16.4.31 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on learning and development and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to learning and development and shall not withhold material facts.

16.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of learning and development as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

16.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

16.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to learning and development to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

16.5.3 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to learning and development to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.5.4 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on learning and development and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a

Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to learning and development within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

16.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to learning and development within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

16.5.8 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.5.9 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to learning and development to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

16.5.11 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to learning and development within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. †

16.5.12 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on learning and development and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

16.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on learning and development and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.5.15 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

16.5.16 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on learning and development and applies them consistently. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

16.5.17 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on learning and development and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.5.18 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on learning and development and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

16.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to learning and development to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on learning and development and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

16.5.21 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to learning and development to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

16.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.5.26 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to learning and development within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

16.5.28 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on learning and development and applies them consistently.

16.5.29 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

16.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on learning and development and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.5.32 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on learning and development and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision

shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on learning and development. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

16.6.1 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to learning and development and on the applicable legal requirements.

16.6.2 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development.

16.6.3 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to learning and development and on the applicable legal requirements.

16.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.6.6 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis

of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

16.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to learning and development and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

16.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for learning and development and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.6.10 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

16.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for learning and development and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.6.13 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

16.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.6.15 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to learning and development and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.6.16 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for learning and development and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter

expressly provides otherwise.

16.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to learning and development. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to learning and development and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.6.19 HR shall respond to every written query on learning and development within 21 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.6.20 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

16.6.21 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

16.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on learning and development within 7 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.6.23 HR shall respond to every written query on learning and development within 21 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

16.6.24 HR shall respond to every written query on learning and development within 10 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to learning and development and on the applicable legal requirements.

16.6.25 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.6.26 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall maintain the forms,

templates and portal workflows required for learning and development and shall make them available to all employees.

16.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall respond to every written query on learning and development within 7 working days of receipt.

16.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.6.29 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to learning and development and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

16.6.31 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for learning and development and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.6.33 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with learning and development in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.7 Procedure and Process Steps

16.7.1 **Learning commitment.** Each employee shall be provided with a minimum of 40 hours per year of structured learning. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 24 hours per year]**

16.7.2 The employee shall initiate the process relating to learning and development by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

16.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The employee shall initiate the process relating to learning and development by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department.

16.7.5 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

16.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

16.7.7 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

16.7.8 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.7.9 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

16.7.10 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 30 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

16.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

16.7.12 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.7.14 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 2 working days of receiving it.

16.7.15 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

16.7.16 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 15 working days of receiving it.

16.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

16.7.19 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.7.20 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.7.21 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.7.22 The employee shall initiate the process relating to learning and development by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

16.7.24 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.7.25 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

16.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to learning and development by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department.

16.7.27 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.7.28 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an

eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

16.7.29 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.7.31 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

16.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.7.34 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

16.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

16.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to learning and development that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.8.2 All documents relating to learning and development shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

16.8.3 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

16.8.4 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.8.5 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.8.6 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

16.8.7 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

16.8.8 All documents relating to learning and development shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

16.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

16.8.10 All documents relating to learning and development shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

16.8.11 All documents relating to learning and development shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

16.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.8.13 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.8.14 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to learning and development that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.8.16 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.8.17 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

16.8.18 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.8.19 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.8.20 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

16.8.21 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

16.8.22 All documents relating to learning and development shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

16.8.23 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.8.24 All documents relating to learning and development shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

16.8.25 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.8.26 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

16.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to learning and development that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. All documents relating to learning and development shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

16.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to learning and development that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.8.30 Records relating to learning and development shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.8.31 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.8.32 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to learning and development that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

16.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to learning and development that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

16.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

16.9.1 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

16.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

16.9.3 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

16.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.9.6 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

16.9.9 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

16.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

16.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on learning and development may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

16.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on learning and development may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.9.16 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

16.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall

prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.9.19 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

16.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on learning and development may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

16.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on learning and development may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.9.25 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

16.9.26 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

16.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

16.9.28 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision

reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

16.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

16.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

16.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.9.32 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.9.33 Exceptions to the provisions on learning and development may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

16.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

16.10.1 An internal audit of learning and development shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.10.2 Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

16.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to learning and development. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

16.10.4 Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.10.5 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.10.6 Compliance with the provisions on learning and development shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.10.7 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.10.8 Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.10.9 Compliance with the provisions on learning and development shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

16.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to learning and development. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

16.10.11 Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on learning and development shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. †

16.10.13 Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to learning and development.

16.10.14 Compliance with the provisions on learning and development shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the

department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

16.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. †

16.10.17 Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

16.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

16.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.10.20 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to learning and development. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

16.10.22 An internal audit of learning and development shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.10.23 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. †

16.10.26 Compliance with the provisions on learning and development shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to learning and development. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

16.10.28 Compliance data relating to learning and development shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

16.10.29 An internal audit of learning and development shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on learning and development shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

16.10.31 Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

16.10.32 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

16.10.33 Compliance with the provisions on learning and development shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.10.34 Where an external regulator requests information concerning learning and development, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. **[New in v2.0]**

16.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

16.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.11.2 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

16.11.3 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

16.11.5 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

16.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

16.11.7 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

16.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

16.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall

then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.11.11 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

16.11.12 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.11.13 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.11.14 A failure to comply with the provisions on learning and development may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.11.15 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to learning and development shall be treated as serious misconduct.

16.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

16.11.17 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

16.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.11.20 A failure to comply with the provisions on learning and development may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations

team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

16.11.21 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

16.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.11.23 A failure to comply with the provisions on learning and development may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

16.11.25 A failure to comply with the provisions on learning and development may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

16.11.27 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on learning and development may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

16.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and

the order in which the requests were received.

16.11.31 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

16.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on learning and development may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.12 Review and Amendment

16.12.1 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

16.12.2 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

16.12.3 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

16.12.4 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.12.5 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

16.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall

apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

16.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

16.12.9 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

16.12.10 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

16.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

16.12.13 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on learning and development through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.12.14 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

16.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on learning and development through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect.

16.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

16.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

16.12.19 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

16.12.21 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on learning and development through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. †

16.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to learning and development made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

16.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

16.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on learning and development through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

16.12.25 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

16.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

16.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on learning and development through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the

Company decides otherwise.

16.12.28 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

16.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

16.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on learning and development through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to learning and development, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

16.12.31 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on learning and development through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

16.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

16.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

Chapter 17

Career Progression and Promotions

17.1 Purpose and Scope

17.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.1.2 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.1.3 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions.

17.1.4 The objective of these provisions on career progression and promotions is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

17.1.5 The Company recognises that career progression and promotions has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The objective of these provisions on career progression and promotions is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

17.1.6 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

17.1.7 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The objective of these provisions on career progression and promotions is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

17.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.1.9 The objective of these provisions on career progression and promotions is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company

will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

17.1.10 The objective of these provisions on career progression and promotions is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

17.1.11 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.1.12 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

17.1.13 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

17.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.1.15 The objective of these provisions on career progression and promotions is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

17.1.18 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

17.1.19 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.1.20 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions.

17.1.21 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.1.22 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The objective of these provisions on career progression and promotions is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

17.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions.

17.1.24 The Company recognises that career progression and promotions has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on career progression and promotions. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

17.1.26 The Company recognises that career progression and promotions has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.1.27 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications,

where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.1.28 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.1.29 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.1.33 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to career progression and promotions and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.2 Definitions and Interpretation

17.2.1 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. †

17.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to career progression and promotions. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

17.2.3 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

17.2.4 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "career progression and promotions" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.2.5 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

17.2.6 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

17.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

17.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

17.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.2.11 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

17.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may

escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

17.2.14 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "career progression and promotions" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.2.15 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.2.16 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.2.17 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to career progression and promotions. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

17.2.18 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

17.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.2.21 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to career progression and promotions.

17.2.22 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

17.2.23 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "career progression and promotions" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.2.25 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to career progression and promotions. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.2.26 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.2.27 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

17.2.30 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to career progression and promotions.

17.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to career progression and promotions. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

17.2.32 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A reference to "written"

or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

17.2.33 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.2.34 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. **[New in v2.0]**

17.3 Eligibility and Applicability

17.3.1 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.3.3 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.3.4 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

17.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.3.7 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

17.3.8 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

17.3.9 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on career progression and promotions. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.3.10 Eligibility for career progression and promotions shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Eligibility for career progression and promotions shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

17.3.12 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.3.13 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded.

17.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility for career progression and promotions shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. †

17.3.16 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on career progression and promotions. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

17.3.17 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

17.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

17.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

17.3.21 Eligibility for career progression and promotions shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded.

17.3.22 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.3.23 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

17.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.3.26 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

17.3.28 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on career progression and promotions. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on career progression and promotions. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Eligibility for career progression and promotions shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

17.3.30 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on career progression and promotions. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.3.31 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

17.3.32 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for career progression and promotions restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

17.4 Responsibilities of Employees

17.4.1 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on career progression and promotions and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

17.4.2 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with career progression and promotions. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the

request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

17.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on career progression and promotions and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

17.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

17.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to career progression and promotions and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.4.7 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to career progression and promotions and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of career progression and promotions as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

17.4.8 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of career progression and promotions as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

17.4.9 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

17.4.10 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

17.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.4.12 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

17.4.13 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with career progression and promotions. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of career progression and promotions as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with career progression and promotions.

17.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.4.16 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with career progression and promotions. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of career progression and promotions as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.4.18 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on career progression and promotions and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to career progression and promotions and shall not withhold material facts.

17.4.19 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with career progression and promotions. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.4.21 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

17.4.22 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

17.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.4.25 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

17.4.26 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

17.4.27 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with career progression and promotions.

17.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of career progression and promotions as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this

Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to career progression and promotions and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.4.31 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.4.32 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of career progression and promotions as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

17.4.33 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to career progression and promotions and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with career progression and promotions.

17.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

17.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

17.5.2 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on career progression and promotions and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.5.3 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

17.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on career progression and promotions. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example

would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on career progression and promotions. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

17.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to career progression and promotions within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.5.7 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on career progression and promotions.

17.5.8 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on career progression and promotions. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

17.5.9 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on career progression and promotions and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.5.12 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.5.13 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to career progression and promotions within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

17.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on career progression and promotions and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.5.15 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

17.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

17.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on career progression and promotions. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.5.20 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to career progression and promotions to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on career progression and promotions.

17.5.21 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on career progression and promotions and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

17.5.22 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.5.23 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to career progression and promotions to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent

seniority nominated by HR.

17.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to career progression and promotions to the Policy Committee without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.5.25 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to career progression and promotions within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

17.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to career progression and promotions to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.5.27 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.5.28 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

17.5.29 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on career progression and promotions. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.5.30 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to career progression and promotions within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

17.5.31 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to career progression and promotions to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.5.32 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on career progression and promotions and applies them consistently. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression

and promotions, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to career progression and promotions within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

17.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with career progression and promotions in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

17.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 3 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with career progression and promotions in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

17.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 5 working days of receipt.

17.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.6.5 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 5 working days of receipt.

17.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with career progression and promotions in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after

the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

17.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for career progression and promotions and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.6.9 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to career progression and promotions and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

17.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with career progression and promotions in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for career progression and promotions and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to career progression and promotions.

17.6.13 HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 21 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.6.14 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to career progression and promotions and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

17.6.15 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to career progression and promotions and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.6.16 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to career progression and promotions. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for

career progression and promotions and shall make them available to all employees.

17.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 5 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

17.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to career progression and promotions. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 5 working days of receipt.

17.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.6.20 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for career progression and promotions and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.6.21 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to career progression and promotions. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.6.22 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to career progression and promotions. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.6.25 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for career progression and promotions and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.6.26 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for career progression and promotions and shall make them available to all employees. Where a

provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

17.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.6.28 HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 10 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.6.29 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on career progression and promotions within 10 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.6.31 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to career progression and promotions. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.6.32 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for career progression and promotions and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to career progression and promotions and on the applicable legal requirements.

17.7 Procedure and Process Steps

17.7.1 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

17.7.2 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 30 working days of receiving it. On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

17.7.3 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The employee shall initiate the process relating to career progression and promotions by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner.

17.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

17.7.5 The employee shall initiate the process relating to career progression and promotions by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The employee shall initiate the process relating to career progression and promotions by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager.

17.7.7 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.7.8 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to career progression and promotions by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.7.10 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

17.7.11 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.7.12 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.7.14 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

17.7.15 The employee shall initiate the process relating to career progression and promotions by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

17.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to career progression and promotions by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.7.20 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.7.21 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 2 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

17.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.7.24 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 14 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.7.26 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

17.7.28 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

17.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

17.7.30 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

17.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to career progression and promotions by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

17.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

17.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.8.2 Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

17.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

17.8.4 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

17.8.6 All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.8.7 All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.8.8 Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which

the requests were received.

17.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

17.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

17.8.11 All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

17.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.8.16 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.8.17 Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

17.8.19 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

17.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.8.21 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.8.22 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.8.24 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

17.8.25 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this

Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

17.8.26 All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

17.8.27 Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.8.28 Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.8.29 Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.8.30 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.8.31 All documents relating to career progression and promotions shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Records relating to career progression and promotions shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

17.8.32 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

17.8.34 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to career progression and promotions that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. **[New in v2.0]**

17.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

17.9.1 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.9.2 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.9.3 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Exceptions to the provisions on career progression and promotions may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

17.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

17.9.5 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

17.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Exceptions to the provisions on career progression and promotions may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

17.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

17.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on career progression and promotions may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on career progression and promotions may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.9.12 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

17.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.9.17 Exceptions to the provisions on career progression and promotions may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or

personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

17.9.18 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on career progression and promotions may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

17.9.21 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

17.9.22 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.9.23 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.9.25 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time

limits. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

17.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

17.9.27 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on career progression and promotions may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.9.30 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.9.31 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.9.32 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.9.33 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

17.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on career progression and promotions shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where an external regulator requests information concerning career progression and promotions, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

17.10.2 An internal audit of career progression and promotions shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

17.10.3 Where an external regulator requests information concerning career progression and promotions, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning career progression and promotions, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.10.5 Where an external regulator requests information concerning career progression and promotions, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Compliance data relating to career progression and promotions shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. †

17.10.6 Compliance data relating to career progression and promotions shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.10.7 Compliance with the provisions on career progression and promotions shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

17.10.8 Where an external regulator requests information concerning career progression and promotions, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.10.9 An internal audit of career progression and promotions shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.10.10 An internal audit of career progression and promotions shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.10.12 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.10.13 An internal audit of career progression and promotions shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

17.10.14 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to career progression and promotions. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to career progression and promotions. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

17.10.16 Compliance with the provisions on career progression and promotions shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

17.10.17 Compliance data relating to career progression and promotions shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

17.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to career progression and promotions. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.10.19 Compliance with the provisions on career progression and promotions shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.10.20 An internal audit of career progression and promotions shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.10.21 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.10.22 Compliance data relating to career progression and promotions shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority

nominated by HR. †

17.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to career progression and promotions. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. An internal audit of career progression and promotions shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

17.10.24 An internal audit of career progression and promotions shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

17.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning career progression and promotions, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.10.27 Compliance data relating to career progression and promotions shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.10.28 Compliance data relating to career progression and promotions shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. †

17.10.29 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

17.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to career progression and promotions.

17.10.31 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.10.32 Compliance with the provisions on career progression and promotions shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

17.10.33 Where an external regulator requests information concerning career progression and promotions, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they

are sent by e-mail.

17.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

17.11.1 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

17.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to career progression and promotions shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

17.11.3 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A failure to comply with the provisions on career progression and promotions may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

17.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to career progression and promotions shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on career progression and promotions may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

17.11.7 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

17.11.8 A failure to comply with the provisions on career progression and promotions may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the

approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

17.11.10 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to career progression and promotions shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

17.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

17.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

17.11.13 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to career progression and promotions shall be treated as serious misconduct.

17.11.15 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

17.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on career progression and promotions may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

17.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.11.22 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

17.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

17.11.25 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

17.11.28 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to career progression and promotions shall be treated as serious misconduct. †

17.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

17.11.31 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.11.32 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

17.12 Review and Amendment

17.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

17.12.2 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

17.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

17.12.4 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

17.12.5 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

17.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

17.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

17.12.8 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to career progression and promotions made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

17.12.9 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on career progression and promotions through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

17.12.10 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

17.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

17.12.12 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

17.12.13 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter

shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

17.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

17.12.15 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.12.16 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on career progression and promotions through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

17.12.18 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

17.12.19 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

17.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

17.12.21 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

17.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

17.12.23 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on career progression and promotions through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

17.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

17.12.25 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to career progression and promotions, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

17.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

17.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

17.12.28 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

17.12.29 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on career progression and promotions through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

17.12.30 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

17.12.31 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

17.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

17.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

Chapter 18

Code of Conduct

18.1 Purpose and Scope

18.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

18.1.2 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

18.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.1.4 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on code of conduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.1.5 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

18.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on code of conduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.1.7 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.1.8 The Company recognises that code of conduct has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

18.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on code of conduct. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.1.10 The Company recognises that code of conduct has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

18.1.11 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. †

18.1.12 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

18.1.13 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

18.1.14 The objective of these provisions on code of conduct is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.1.15 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

18.1.16 The objective of these provisions on code of conduct is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

18.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.1.18 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

18.1.19 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on code of conduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

18.1.20 The objective of these provisions on code of conduct is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

18.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The objective of these provisions on code of conduct is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

18.1.22 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

18.1.23 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.1.24 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

18.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on code of conduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.1.26 The objective of these provisions on code of conduct is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.1.27 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to code of conduct and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

18.1.28 The objective of these provisions on code of conduct is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.1.29 The objective of these provisions on code of conduct is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

18.1.30 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager

fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

18.1.31 The Company recognises that code of conduct has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

18.1.32 The Company recognises that code of conduct has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

18.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.2 Definitions and Interpretation

18.2.1 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

18.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

18.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

18.2.5 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

18.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

18.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

18.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to code of conduct.

18.2.10 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.2.11 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

18.2.13 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

18.2.14 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to code of conduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

18.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within

the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

18.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.2.17 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to code of conduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

18.2.19 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.2.20 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

18.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.2.22 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.2.23 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

18.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an

eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

18.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

18.2.26 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

18.2.27 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.2.29 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

18.2.30 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

18.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.2.32 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "code of conduct" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

18.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

18.3 Eligibility and Applicability

18.3.1 Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

18.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.3.3 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.3.5 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

18.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.3.7 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for code of conduct restricted until the matter is concluded.

18.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on code of conduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

18.3.10 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received

on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.3.11 Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

18.3.13 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.3.15 Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

18.3.16 Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on code of conduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under

this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on code of conduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.3.20 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on code of conduct. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

18.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for code of conduct restricted until the matter is concluded.

18.3.22 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for code of conduct restricted until the matter is concluded. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.3.23 Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

18.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

18.3.25 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for code of conduct restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.3.26 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.3.27 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on code of conduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as

received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

18.3.28 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

18.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for code of conduct restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

18.3.30 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on code of conduct.

18.3.31 Eligibility for code of conduct shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.3.32 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

18.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for code of conduct restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.4 Responsibilities of Employees

18.4.1 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with code of conduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

18.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of code of conduct as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.4.3 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to code of conduct and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.4.4 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to code of conduct and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday

shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of code of conduct as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.4.7 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of code of conduct as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.4.8 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.4.9 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on code of conduct and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with code of conduct.

18.4.10 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to code of conduct and shall not withhold material facts. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of code of conduct as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

18.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.4.13 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on code of conduct and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

18.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

18.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

18.4.16 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices

under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

18.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.4.18 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to code of conduct and shall not withhold material facts. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

18.4.19 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on code of conduct and shall comply with them at all times. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

18.4.20 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to code of conduct and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of code of conduct as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

18.4.22 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of code of conduct as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

18.4.23 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of code of conduct as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

18.4.24 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

18.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.4.26 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with code of conduct. †

18.4.27 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

18.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

18.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on code of conduct and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.4.30 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

18.4.31 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

18.4.32 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with code of conduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

18.5.1 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on code of conduct and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to code of conduct within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

18.5.3 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to code of conduct to the HR Director without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company

that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

18.5.4 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on code of conduct and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

18.5.6 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on code of conduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.5.8 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on code of conduct and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to code of conduct within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

18.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to code of conduct to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

18.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to code of conduct to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on code of conduct and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

18.5.11 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on code of conduct and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

18.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.5.13 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on code of conduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.5.14 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to code of conduct to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on code of conduct and applies them consistently.

18.5.15 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on code of conduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

18.5.16 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.5.17 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on code of conduct and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on code of conduct and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

18.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on code of conduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

18.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

18.5.21 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and

shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.5.22 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to code of conduct within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

18.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

18.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on code of conduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.5.25 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to code of conduct within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on code of conduct and applies them consistently.

18.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to code of conduct to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on code of conduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.5.28 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on code of conduct and applies them consistently.

18.5.29 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to code of conduct within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

18.5.30 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on code of conduct and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied

consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to code of conduct within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

18.5.32 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to code of conduct within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to code of conduct to the HR Director without undue delay.

18.5.33 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on code of conduct and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

18.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with code of conduct in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

18.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.6.4 HR shall respond to every written query on code of conduct within 2 working days of receipt. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for code of conduct and shall make them available to all employees.

18.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to code of conduct.

18.6.6 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to code of conduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.6.7 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the

following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. †

18.6.8 HR shall respond to every written query on code of conduct within 5 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to code of conduct and on the applicable legal requirements.

18.6.9 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with code of conduct in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.6.10 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with code of conduct in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to code of conduct.

18.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for code of conduct and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

18.6.12 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to code of conduct and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for code of conduct and shall make them available to all employees.

18.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on code of conduct within 10 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.6.15 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to code of conduct and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

18.6.16 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with code of conduct in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.6.17 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with code of conduct in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.6.18 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.6.19 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with code of conduct in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

18.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to code of conduct.

18.6.21 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to code of conduct.

18.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to code of conduct and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.6.23 HR shall respond to every written query on code of conduct within 15 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

18.6.24 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for code of conduct and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to code of conduct.

18.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on code of conduct within 30 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to code of conduct and on the applicable legal requirements.

18.6.27 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for code of conduct and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.6.28 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to code of conduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.6.29 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to code of conduct and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.6.30 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for code of conduct and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with code of conduct in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

18.6.31 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

18.6.32 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

18.7 Procedure and Process Steps

18.7.1 The employee shall initiate the process relating to code of conduct by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.7.2 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not

affect any statutory right of the employee. The employee shall initiate the process relating to code of conduct by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team.

18.7.3 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.7.4 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

18.7.5 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.7.6 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

18.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.7.8 The employee shall initiate the process relating to code of conduct by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department.

18.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to code of conduct by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

18.7.10 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.7.12 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall

request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

18.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.7.14 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.7.15 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.7.16 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

18.7.17 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

18.7.18 The employee shall initiate the process relating to code of conduct by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.7.19 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

18.7.20 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

18.7.21 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For

example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.7.23 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.7.25 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

18.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.7.27 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.7.28 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

18.7.29 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

18.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

18.7.31 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.7.32 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

18.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

18.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

18.8.2 Records relating to code of conduct shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. All documents relating to code of conduct shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

18.8.3 All documents relating to code of conduct shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.8.4 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.8.5 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Records relating to code of conduct shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years.

18.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

18.8.7 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

18.8.8 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

18.8.10 Records relating to code of conduct shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.8.13 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

18.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.8.15 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.8.16 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.8.17 All documents relating to code of conduct shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

18.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy

Committee.

18.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

18.8.20 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.8.23 Records relating to code of conduct shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to code of conduct that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

18.8.26 Records relating to code of conduct shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.8.27 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.8.28 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

18.8.30 Records relating to code of conduct shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

18.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.8.32 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

18.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.8.34 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. **[New in v2.0]**

18.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

18.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.9.2 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories

unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.9.4 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

18.9.5 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

18.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

18.9.7 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

18.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.9.9 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.9.10 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

18.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.9.12 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

18.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.9.14 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

18.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.9.17 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

18.9.18 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

18.9.19 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

18.9.20 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

18.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.9.24 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

18.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

18.9.27 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

18.9.28 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

18.9.30 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

18.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.9.33 Exceptions to the provisions on code of conduct may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

18.9.34 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. **[New in v2.0]**

18.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

18.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on code of conduct shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

18.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.10.3 Compliance with the provisions on code of conduct shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

18.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.10.5 Where an external regulator requests information concerning code of conduct, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

18.10.6 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where an external regulator requests information concerning code of conduct, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

18.10.7 An internal audit of code of conduct shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

18.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than

punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where an external regulator requests information concerning code of conduct, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

18.10.9 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on code of conduct shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

18.10.14 Compliance data relating to code of conduct shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

18.10.15 Where an external regulator requests information concerning code of conduct, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.10.16 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

18.10.17 Compliance data relating to code of conduct shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.10.18 An internal audit of code of conduct shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

18.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance data relating to code of conduct shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

18.10.20 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

18.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

18.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.10.23 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct.

18.10.24 Compliance data relating to code of conduct shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

18.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.10.26 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.10.27 Compliance data relating to code of conduct shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

18.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on code of conduct shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.10.29 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example

would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.10.30 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.10.31 Where an external regulator requests information concerning code of conduct, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

18.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to code of conduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.10.33 Compliance with the provisions on code of conduct shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An internal audit of code of conduct shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

18.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

18.11.1 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

18.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.11.3 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

18.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision

is made.

18.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

18.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct.

18.11.8 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.11.9 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

18.11.10 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

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18.11.13 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

18.11.14 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.11.15 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive

rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

18.11.16 A failure to comply with the provisions on code of conduct may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.11.17 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

18.11.18 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on code of conduct may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

18.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

18.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

18.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct.

18.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.11.24 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

18.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the

requests were received.

18.11.26 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.11.29 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

18.11.30 A failure to comply with the provisions on code of conduct may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on code of conduct may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.11.32 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

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18.11.34 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to code of conduct shall be treated as serious misconduct. **[New in v2.0]**

18.12 Review and Amendment

18.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

18.12.4 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

18.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect.

18.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

18.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

18.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

18.12.12 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.12.13 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

18.12.14 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

18.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.12.17 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

18.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect.

18.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect.

18.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

18.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

18.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

18.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

18.12.24 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to code of conduct made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

18.12.25 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

18.12.26 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

18.12.27 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

18.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

18.12.29 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

18.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on code of conduct through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

18.12.32 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

18.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to code of conduct, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

Chapter 19

Conflict of Interest

19.1 Purpose and Scope

19.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conflict of interest. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

19.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.1.4 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conflict of interest and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

19.1.5 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.1.6 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

19.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conflict of interest and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.1.9 The Company recognises that conflict of interest has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

19.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a

term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

19.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conflict of interest. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

19.1.13 The objective of these provisions on conflict of interest is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.1.14 The Company recognises that conflict of interest has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.1.15 The objective of these provisions on conflict of interest is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.1.16 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conflict of interest and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

19.1.17 The objective of these provisions on conflict of interest is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

19.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.1.19 The objective of these provisions on conflict of interest is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.1.21 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

19.1.22 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conflict of interest. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.1.23 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conflict of interest and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.1.26 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

19.1.27 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conflict of interest. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

19.1.28 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.1.29 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.1.31 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conflict of interest and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

19.1.32 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conflict of interest and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conflict of interest. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.2 Definitions and Interpretation

19.2.1 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

19.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conflict of interest" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

19.2.4 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.2.5 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conflict of interest" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

19.2.7 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

19.2.8 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

19.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.2.10 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.2.11 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

19.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.2.13 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conflict of interest. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be

treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

19.2.17 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conflict of interest. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

19.2.20 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conflict of interest. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

19.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conflict of interest. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.2.23 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. †

19.2.24 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

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19.2.29 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conflict of interest. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.2.30 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conflict of interest" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

19.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

19.2.33 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

19.3 Eligibility and Applicability

19.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conflict of interest restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.3.2 Eligibility for conflict of interest shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.3.3 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.3.4 Eligibility for conflict of interest shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conflict of interest restricted until the matter is concluded.

19.3.7 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conflict of interest restricted until the matter is concluded.

19.3.8 Eligibility for conflict of interest shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.3.9 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conflict of interest. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.3.10 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise.

19.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conflict of interest. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.3.13 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.3.15 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

19.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.3.17 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conflict of interest. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.3.20 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conflict of interest restricted until the matter is concluded. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Reporting

Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.3.21 Eligibility for conflict of interest shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

19.3.22 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

19.3.23 Eligibility for conflict of interest shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

19.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.3.25 Eligibility for conflict of interest shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.3.26 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conflict of interest. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.3.27 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conflict of interest restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

19.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conflict of interest. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by

e-mail. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

19.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conflict of interest restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

19.3.31 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conflict of interest. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

19.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conflict of interest.

19.3.34 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. **[New in v2.0]**

19.4 Responsibilities of Employees

19.4.1 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

19.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conflict of interest as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.4.3 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or

inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conflict of interest.

19.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conflict of interest and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conflict of interest and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.4.7 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

19.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conflict of interest.

19.4.10 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The staff member shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

19.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conflict of interest as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.4.12 The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their

situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

19.4.14 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conflict of interest. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

19.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conflict of interest and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conflict of interest.

19.4.18 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conflict of interest as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

19.4.19 The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conflict of interest and shall comply with them at all times.

19.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conflict of interest and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conflict of interest and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

19.4.23 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

19.4.24 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conflict of interest and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conflict of interest and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.4.26 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conflict of interest as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

19.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conflict of interest and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

19.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conflict of interest as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

19.4.29 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conflict of interest.

19.4.30 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conflict of interest. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conflict of interest. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

19.4.32 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conflict of interest and shall not withhold material facts.

19.4.33 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

19.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

19.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

19.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conflict of interest and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

19.5.3 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conflict of interest within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

19.5.4 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.5.5 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter

expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.5.7 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.5.8 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conflict of interest and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.5.9 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

19.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

19.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conflict of interest and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

19.5.13 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conflict of interest and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line

Manager.

19.5.15 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conflict of interest and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conflict of interest.

19.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conflict of interest and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

19.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conflict of interest within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.5.19 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. †

19.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conflict of interest within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

19.5.21 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conflict of interest and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.5.22 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conflict of interest. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

19.5.23 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conflict of interest.

19.5.24 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.5.25 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

19.5.26 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

19.5.27 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Policy Committee without undue delay. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conflict of interest to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conflict of interest and applies them consistently.

19.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.5.30 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conflict of interest and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conflict of interest.

19.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conflict of interest and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conflict of interest within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

19.6.1 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conflict of interest. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conflict of interest and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

19.6.3 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conflict of interest in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

19.6.4 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall respond to every written query on conflict of interest within 3 working days of receipt.

19.6.5 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. †

19.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.6.7 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conflict of interest. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.6.9 HR shall respond to every written query on conflict of interest within 15 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall treat all personal information received in

connection with conflict of interest in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

19.6.10 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conflict of interest. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for conflict of interest and shall make them available to all employees.

19.6.11 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conflict of interest and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.6.12 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conflict of interest in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

19.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.6.15 HR shall respond to every written query on conflict of interest within 5 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.6.16 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for conflict of interest and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on conflict of interest within 7 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conflict of interest.

19.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conflict of interest.

19.6.19 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conflict of interest and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.6.20 HR shall respond to every written query on conflict of interest within 3 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff

member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conflict of interest.

19.6.21 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on conflict of interest within 15 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.6.23 HR shall respond to every written query on conflict of interest within 5 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.6.24 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conflict of interest in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

19.6.26 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for conflict of interest and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conflict of interest in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

19.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conflict of interest and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.6.29 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conflict of interest in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.6.31 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conflict of interest and on the applicable legal requirements. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.6.32 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conflict of interest and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

19.7 Procedure and Process Steps

19.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.7.2 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. †

19.7.3 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conflict of interest by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.7.5 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

19.7.6 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 14 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the

matter directly to the HR Director.

19.7.8 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.7.9 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.7.10 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.7.11 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.7.12 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it.

19.7.13 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

19.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

19.7.15 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conflict of interest by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

19.7.16 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.7.18 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conflict of interest by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the

matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

19.7.21 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

19.7.22 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

19.7.23 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.7.24 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.7.25 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.7.26 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

19.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

19.7.28 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

19.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conflict of interest by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

19.7.30 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

19.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 15 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

19.7.33 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it.

19.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

19.8.1 Records relating to conflict of interest shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

19.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

19.8.3 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.8.4 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

19.8.6 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

19.8.7 Records relating to conflict of interest shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

19.8.8 Records relating to conflict of interest shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

19.8.9 Records relating to conflict of interest shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law. †

19.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.8.11 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.8.12 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

19.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

19.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.8.17 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

19.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.8.19 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.8.20 All documents relating to conflict of interest shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Records relating to conflict of interest shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years.

19.8.22 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.8.23 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.8.24 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

19.8.25 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. All documents relating to conflict of interest shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

19.8.26 Records relating to conflict of interest shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.8.29 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conflict of interest that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

19.8.30 All documents relating to conflict of interest shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Records relating to conflict of interest shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

19.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.8.32 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

19.9.1 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

19.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. †

19.9.3 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

19.9.5 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

19.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

19.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

19.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

19.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

19.9.14 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.9.15 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

19.9.16 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.9.17 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

19.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.9.19 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

19.9.20 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

19.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The

Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

19.9.22 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.9.23 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. †

19.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.9.25 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.9.26 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

19.9.28 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

19.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on conflict of interest may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

19.10.1 An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.10.4 Compliance with the provisions on conflict of interest shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

19.10.5 Compliance data relating to conflict of interest shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest.

19.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and

shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

19.10.7 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conflict of interest, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

19.10.9 Compliance with the provisions on conflict of interest shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

19.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on conflict of interest shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

19.10.12 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conflict of interest, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.10.13 An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.10.14 An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.10.15 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

19.10.17 An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conflict of interest, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.10.19 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. †

19.10.20 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.10.22 An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.10.23 Compliance data relating to conflict of interest shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.10.24 Compliance with the provisions on conflict of interest shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

19.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

19.10.26 Compliance data relating to conflict of interest shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance with the provisions on conflict of interest shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. †

19.10.27 An internal audit of conflict of interest shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company will apply this

provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

19.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on conflict of interest shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

19.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest.

19.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.10.31 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conflict of interest.

19.10.32 Compliance with the provisions on conflict of interest shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

19.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

19.11.1 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.11.2 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

19.11.3 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.11.4 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A failure to comply with the provisions on conflict of interest may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

19.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conflict of interest shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any

deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

19.11.6 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conflict of interest shall be treated as serious misconduct.

19.11.7 A failure to comply with the provisions on conflict of interest may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

19.11.8 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A failure to comply with the provisions on conflict of interest may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

19.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.11.12 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

19.11.15 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A failure to comply with the provisions on conflict of interest may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

19.11.16 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

19.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

19.11.18 A failure to comply with the provisions on conflict of interest may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.11.20 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

19.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conflict of interest shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

19.11.23 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

19.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.11.25 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.11.26 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

19.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

19.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

19.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. †

19.11.30 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

19.11.31 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

19.11.32 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

19.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

19.12 Review and Amendment

19.12.1 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.12.2 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

19.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

19.12.5 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

19.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

19.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.12.8 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

19.12.9 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conflict of interest through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

19.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conflict of interest through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. †

19.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

19.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

19.12.14 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

19.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

19.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

19.12.17 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

19.12.18 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

19.12.19 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

19.12.20 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.12.21 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision

applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

19.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conflict of interest, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

19.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

19.12.24 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

19.12.25 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

19.12.26 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

19.12.27 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

19.12.28 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

19.12.29 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

19.12.30 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conflict of interest made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees

shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conflict of interest through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

19.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

19.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

19.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

Chapter 20

Anti-Harassment and Anti-Bullying

20.1 Purpose and Scope

20.1.1 The objective of these provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.1.2 The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.1.3 The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

20.1.4 The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

20.1.5 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

20.1.6 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and the

standards that apply to every employee in every location.

20.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.1.12 The objective of these provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

20.1.13 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.1.15 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.1.16 The objective of these provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

20.1.17 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.1.19 The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.1.20 The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

20.1.21 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

20.1.22 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.1.23 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

20.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

20.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

20.1.26 The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.1.27 The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.1.28 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any

deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.1.29 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on anti-harassment and anti-bullying.

20.1.30 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.1.31 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The objective of these provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

20.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company recognises that anti-harassment and anti-bullying has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

20.1.33 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.2 Definitions and Interpretation

20.2.1 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.2.2 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

20.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the

interpretation of any provision relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. †

20.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

20.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.2.8 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "anti-harassment and anti-bullying" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.2.10 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying.

20.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.2.13 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "anti-harassment and anti-bullying" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may

be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "anti-harassment and anti-bullying" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

20.2.15 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "anti-harassment and anti-bullying" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

20.2.16 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.2.17 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "anti-harassment and anti-bullying" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

20.2.18 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.2.20 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

20.2.21 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

20.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying.

20.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "anti-harassment and anti-bullying" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the

matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.2.25 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.2.26 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "anti-harassment and anti-bullying" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.2.27 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.2.28 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.2.30 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.2.31 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

20.2.32 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

20.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

20.3 Eligibility and Applicability

20.3.1 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

20.3.2 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying.

20.3.3 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

20.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.3.5 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

20.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. †

20.3.8 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

20.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall

not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.3.10 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.3.11 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying.

20.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

20.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.3.14 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.3.15 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.3.16 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

20.3.17 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.3.18 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

20.3.20 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.3.21 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.3.22 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

20.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

20.3.24 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

20.3.25 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ,

the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

20.3.26 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.3.27 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.3.28 Eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.3.30 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for anti-harassment and anti-bullying restricted until the matter is concluded.

20.3.32 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. †

20.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.4 Responsibilities of Employees

20.4.1 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of anti-harassment and anti-bullying as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

20.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.4.4 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.4.5 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

20.4.6 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

20.4.8 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.4.9 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of anti-harassment and anti-bullying as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.4.10 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts.

20.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of anti-harassment and anti-bullying as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with anti-harassment and anti-bullying.

20.4.12 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of anti-harassment and anti-bullying as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of anti-harassment and anti-bullying as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

20.4.15 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.4.16 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts.

20.4.18 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

20.4.19 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

20.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with anti-harassment and anti-bullying. †

20.4.22 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts.

20.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.4.24 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

20.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

20.4.26 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.4.27 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of anti-harassment and anti-bullying as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make

competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. †

20.4.30 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.4.31 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.4.33 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

20.5.1 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently.

20.5.2 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.5.3 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

20.5.4 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.5.5 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers are accountable for

escalating any unresolved matter relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

20.5.6 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

20.5.7 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

20.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently.

20.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

20.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently.

20.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.5.13 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual

circumstances of each case.

20.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

20.5.15 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying to the HR Director without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

20.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

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20.5.21 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

20.5.22 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they

are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

20.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.5.24 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.5.25 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

20.5.27 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

20.5.29 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

20.5.30 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and applies them consistently. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

20.5.31 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying to the HR Director without undue delay. The

Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

20.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

20.5.33 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

20.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.6.2 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with anti-harassment and anti-bullying in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.6.4 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

20.6.5 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.6.7 HR shall respond to every written query on anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 30 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of

each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.6.9 HR shall respond to every written query on anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 14 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

20.6.10 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying.

20.6.11 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.6.13 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements. †

20.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.6.15 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of

business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements.

20.6.18 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.6.19 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.6.20 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.6.21 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.6.22 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.6.23 HR shall respond to every written query on anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 10 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

20.6.25 HR shall respond to every written query on anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 3 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.6.26 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.6.27 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.6.29 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for anti-harassment and anti-bullying and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

20.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on anti-harassment and anti-bullying within 7 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

20.6.31 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with anti-harassment and anti-bullying in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

20.6.32 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.6.33 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying and on the applicable legal requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.7 Procedure and Process Steps

20.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

20.7.2 The employee shall initiate the process relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.7.5 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

20.7.8 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.7.9 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

20.7.10 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.7.12 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

20.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.7.15 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

20.7.18 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The employee shall initiate the process relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team.

20.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.7.21 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 14 working days of receiving it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The employee shall initiate the process relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team.

20.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. Employees should seek

guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

20.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

20.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

20.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

20.7.27 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.7.29 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.7.30 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.7.31 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.7.32 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

20.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

20.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

20.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

20.8.2 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.8.3 All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

20.8.4 Records relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.8.5 All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

20.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

20.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

20.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. †

20.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.8.11 Records relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.8.12 All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

20.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

20.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.8.16 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

20.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

20.8.18 All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.8.19 Records relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.8.20 All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.8.21 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Records relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

20.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.8.24 Records relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.8.25 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

20.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.8.28 All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying

made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

20.8.30 Records relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

20.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

20.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.8.33 All documents relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

20.9.1 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

20.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

20.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.9.6 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

20.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.9.8 Exceptions to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.9.9 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

20.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

20.9.11 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.9.12 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.9.13 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time

limits.

20.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.9.15 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

20.9.16 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.9.18 Exceptions to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

20.9.20 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

20.9.21 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.9.22 Exceptions to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.9.23 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

20.9.26 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

20.9.27 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

20.9.28 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.9.30 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

20.9.31 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.9.33 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

20.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

20.10.1 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.10.2 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

20.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Compliance data relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

20.10.6 Compliance with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

20.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

20.10.8 Where an external regulator requests information concerning anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.10.9 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.10.10 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.10.11 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall

be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.10.12 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.10.13 Compliance data relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.10.14 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.10.15 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. †

20.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.10.17 Compliance data relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Compliance with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

20.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

20.10.20 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

20.10.21 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.10.23 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.10.24 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Compliance data relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

20.10.25 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

20.10.27 An internal audit of anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.10.28 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.10.29 Compliance data relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where an external regulator requests information concerning anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

20.10.31 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Compliance data relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

20.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to anti-harassment and anti-bullying. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in

which the requests were received.

20.10.33 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

20.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

20.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.11.3 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be treated as serious misconduct.

20.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be treated as serious misconduct.

20.11.6 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.11.7 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. †

20.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

20.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.11.11 A failure to comply with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. †

20.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.11.13 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

20.11.14 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

20.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

20.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.11.17 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

20.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

20.11.20 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.11.21 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.11.23 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

20.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.11.27 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

20.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday

shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.11.29 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.11.30 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to anti-harassment and anti-bullying shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

20.11.31 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

20.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.12 Review and Amendment

20.12.1 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.12.2 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

20.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

20.12.4 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

20.12.5 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails

to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

20.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

20.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

20.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect.

20.12.9 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

20.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

20.12.11 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.12.13 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

20.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.12.15 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

20.12.16 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

20.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

20.12.18 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

20.12.19 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

20.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

20.12.22 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

20.12.23 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.12.24 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

20.12.25 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless

this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

20.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on anti-harassment and anti-bullying through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

20.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

20.12.29 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

20.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

20.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. As an illustration, a request relating to anti-harassment and anti-bullying made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

20.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

20.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

Chapter 21

Grievance Handling

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Resolution time	15 working days	**10 working days**

21.1 Purpose and Scope

21.1.1 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on grievance handling. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to grievance handling and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

21.1.4 The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.1.5 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to grievance handling and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

21.1.6 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.1.7 The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on grievance handling. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.1.9 The Company recognises that grievance handling has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies

equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

21.1.10 The Company recognises that grievance handling has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

21.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.1.12 The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on grievance handling. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.1.14 The Company recognises that grievance handling has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.1.15 The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company recognises that grievance handling has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

21.1.17 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

21.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

21.1.20 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on grievance handling. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

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21.1.25 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to grievance handling and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

21.1.26 The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

21.1.27 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on grievance handling.

21.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period,

an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

21.1.29 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on grievance handling. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to grievance handling and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

21.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.1.31 The Company recognises that grievance handling has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

21.1.32 The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.1.33 The objective of these provisions on grievance handling is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

21.2 Definitions and Interpretation

21.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to grievance handling. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "grievance handling" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

21.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to grievance handling. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.2.4 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "grievance handling" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. †

21.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.2.6 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

21.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "grievance handling" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

21.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.2.9 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.2.10 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to grievance handling. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

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21.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision

reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

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21.2.17 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

21.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to grievance handling. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

21.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

21.2.20 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

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21.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is

absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

21.2.25 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.2.26 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

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21.2.28 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

21.2.29 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "grievance handling" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

21.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to grievance handling. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

21.2.33 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.3 Eligibility and Applicability

21.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

21.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded.

21.3.3 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

21.3.5 Eligibility for grievance handling shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.3.8 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.3.10 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

21.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

21.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on grievance handling.

21.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

21.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on grievance handling. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

21.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

21.3.17 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

21.3.18 Eligibility for grievance handling shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

21.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

21.3.20 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on grievance handling. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision

under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

21.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.3.23 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

21.3.26 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

21.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for grievance handling restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

21.3.30 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.3.32 Eligibility for grievance handling shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

21.3.33 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

21.3.34 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. **[New in v2.0]**

21.4 Responsibilities of Employees

21.4.1 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to grievance handling and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on grievance handling and shall comply with them at all times.

21.4.2 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to grievance handling and shall not withhold material facts.

21.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.4.4 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on grievance handling and shall comply with them at all times.

21.4.5 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to grievance handling and shall not withhold material facts.

21.4.7 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.4.8 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

21.4.10 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to grievance handling and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling.

21.4.12 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

21.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on grievance handling and shall comply with them at all times.

21.4.14 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to grievance handling and shall not withhold material facts. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

21.4.15 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a

Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

21.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

21.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling.

21.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.4.20 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

21.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.4.23 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.4.24 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.4.25 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with grievance handling. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The staff member shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

21.4.26 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.4.27 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.4.28 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on grievance handling and shall comply with them at all times. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

21.4.30 The employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

21.4.31 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of grievance handling as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

21.4.32 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

21.4.33 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to grievance handling and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

21.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

21.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on grievance handling. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.5.2 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on grievance handling and applies them consistently.

21.5.3 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on grievance handling. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

21.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on grievance handling. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.5.6 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on grievance handling. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.5.7 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on grievance handling and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

21.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to grievance handling within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

21.5.9 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to grievance handling to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.5.10 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

21.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.5.12 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on grievance handling and applies them consistently. Cost implications,

where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to grievance handling to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

21.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on grievance handling and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on grievance handling and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.5.16 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to grievance handling within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on grievance handling.

21.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on grievance handling and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

21.5.18 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on grievance handling and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to grievance handling to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

21.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to grievance handling within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

21.5.21 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply

this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.5.22 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on grievance handling. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.5.24 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to grievance handling within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

21.5.25 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

21.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to grievance handling to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

21.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on grievance handling. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to grievance handling to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

21.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to grievance handling to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

21.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.5.30 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

21.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on grievance handling and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

21.5.33 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to grievance handling to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

21.6.1 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for grievance handling and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.6.2 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

21.6.4 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to grievance handling. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

21.6.5 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for grievance handling and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

21.6.6 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with grievance handling in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to grievance handling.

21.6.7 HR shall respond to every written query on grievance handling within 7 working days of receipt.

21.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for grievance handling and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on grievance handling within 30 working days of receipt.

21.6.9 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

21.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

21.6.11 HR shall respond to every written query on grievance handling within 10 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.6.12 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to grievance handling. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on grievance handling within 3 working days of receipt.

21.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.6.14 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with grievance handling in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on grievance handling within 2 working days of receipt.

21.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

21.6.17 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

21.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

21.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to grievance handling. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

21.6.21 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.6.22 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with grievance handling in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

21.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on grievance handling within 3 working days of receipt.

21.6.24 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with grievance handling in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

21.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with grievance handling in

accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

21.6.26 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to grievance handling. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

21.6.28 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.6.29 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with grievance handling in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.6.30 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.6.31 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.6.32 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for grievance handling and shall make them available to all employees. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.6.33 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to grievance handling and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.7 Procedure and Process Steps

21.7.1 **Resolution time.** The Company shall endeavour to resolve every formal grievance within 10 working days of receipt. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 15 working days]**

21.7.2 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 21 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

21.7.3 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

21.7.4 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.7.5 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

21.7.6 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 30 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.7.7 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

21.7.8 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.7.9 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 2 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.7.10 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

21.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.7.12 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team.

21.7.14 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

21.7.15 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

21.7.16 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

21.7.17 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

21.7.18 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

21.7.19 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

21.7.20 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

21.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure

prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.7.22 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

21.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

21.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

21.7.26 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

21.7.29 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This

provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

21.7.34 The employee shall initiate the process relating to grievance handling by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

21.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

21.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to grievance handling that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

21.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.8.3 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

21.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

21.8.6 All documents relating to grievance handling shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

21.8.7 All documents relating to grievance handling shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

21.8.8 All documents relating to grievance handling shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.8.9 Records relating to grievance handling shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

21.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to grievance handling that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

21.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to grievance handling that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

21.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

21.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

21.8.15 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.8.16 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to grievance handling that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance,

where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.8.18 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

21.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

21.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

21.8.22 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. All documents relating to grievance handling shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

21.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.8.24 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.8.26 Records relating to grievance handling shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. This provision shall be applied consistently,

and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.8.27 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to grievance handling that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

21.8.29 All documents relating to grievance handling shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Records relating to grievance handling shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

21.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.8.31 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to grievance handling that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.8.32 All documents relating to grievance handling shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

21.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

21.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right

of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

21.9.5 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

21.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.9.7 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

21.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

21.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.9.10 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

21.9.11 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

21.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

21.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.9.14 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

21.9.15 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.9.17 Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

21.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

21.9.21 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

21.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

21.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.9.25 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

21.9.27 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

21.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

21.9.30 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.9.31 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Exceptions to the provisions on grievance handling may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

21.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

21.10.1 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

21.10.2 An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.10.3 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.10.4 An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.10.5 Compliance data relating to grievance handling shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

21.10.6 Where an external regulator requests information concerning grievance handling, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

21.10.7 Where an external regulator requests information concerning grievance handling, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.10.8 An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For

example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.10.9 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to grievance handling. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.10.11 An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to grievance handling. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.10.13 Where an external regulator requests information concerning grievance handling, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.10.14 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to grievance handling. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

21.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

21.10.16 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

21.10.18 An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority

nominated by HR.

21.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

21.10.20 Compliance data relating to grievance handling shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

21.10.21 Compliance with the provisions on grievance handling shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. †

21.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.10.23 An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

21.10.24 Compliance data relating to grievance handling shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.10.25 Compliance with the provisions on grievance handling shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

21.10.26 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to grievance handling. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

21.10.27 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

21.10.28 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the

department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.10.29 Compliance data relating to grievance handling shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

21.10.30 Where an external regulator requests information concerning grievance handling, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An internal audit of grievance handling shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

21.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to grievance handling. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

21.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

21.10.33 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

21.10.34 Compliance data relating to grievance handling shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. **[New in v2.0]**

21.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

21.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

21.11.2 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on grievance handling may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.11.4 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to grievance handling shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An

example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.11.5 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

21.11.6 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.11.7 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

21.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.11.10 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.11.12 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

21.11.13 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

21.11.14 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be

treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

21.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.11.17 A failure to comply with the provisions on grievance handling may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.11.19 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

21.11.20 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

21.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.11.22 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

21.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

21.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to grievance handling shall be treated as serious misconduct.

21.11.25 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the

order in which the requests were received.

21.11.26 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

21.11.27 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to grievance handling shall be treated as serious misconduct.

21.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.11.29 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to grievance handling shall be treated as serious misconduct.

21.11.30 A failure to comply with the provisions on grievance handling may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

21.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

21.11.32 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

21.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

21.12 Review and Amendment

21.12.1 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.12.2 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

21.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

21.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

21.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. †

21.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to grievance handling, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

21.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.12.8 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.12.9 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

21.12.10 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.12.11 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

21.12.12 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

21.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

21.12.14 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

21.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

21.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.12.18 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

21.12.19 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

21.12.20 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.12.22 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.12.23 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

21.12.24 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

21.12.25 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.12.26 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on grievance handling through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

21.12.27 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

21.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to grievance handling made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

21.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

21.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

21.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

21.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

21.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the

prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

Chapter 22

Disciplinary Procedures

22.1 Purpose and Scope

22.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to disciplinary procedures and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

22.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.1.3 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.1.4 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

22.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on disciplinary procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.1.6 The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

22.1.7 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on disciplinary procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.1.8 The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

22.1.9 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

22.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to disciplinary procedures and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

22.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on disciplinary procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.1.13 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

22.1.14 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

22.1.16 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.1.17 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.1.18 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on disciplinary procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.1.19 The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

22.1.20 The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.1.21 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on disciplinary procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

22.1.22 The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.1.23 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

22.1.24 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

22.1.26 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.1.27 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. †

22.1.28 The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision

under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.1.29 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.1.30 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

22.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.1.32 The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.1.33 The objective of these provisions on disciplinary procedures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The Company recognises that disciplinary procedures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. †

22.2 Definitions and Interpretation

22.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "disciplinary procedures" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

22.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.2.4 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the

decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

22.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.2.6 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

22.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

22.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. †

22.2.9 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to disciplinary procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

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22.2.12 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to disciplinary procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

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22.2.15 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.2.16 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

22.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

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22.2.20 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

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22.2.22 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "disciplinary procedures" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

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22.2.24 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to disciplinary procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

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22.2.27 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

22.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

22.2.32 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

22.2.33 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to disciplinary procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently,

and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.3 Eligibility and Applicability

22.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

22.3.3 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on disciplinary procedures. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded.

22.3.4 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

22.3.5 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

22.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.3.7 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

22.3.8 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded.

22.3.9 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

22.3.10 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.3.11 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.3.12 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on disciplinary procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.3.13 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded.

22.3.14 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on disciplinary procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

22.3.17 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees who are on notice,

suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded.

22.3.18 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.3.19 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

22.3.23 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.3.24 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on disciplinary procedures.

22.3.26 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

22.3.27 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. †

22.3.28 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

22.3.29 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.3.30 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.3.31 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for disciplinary procedures restricted until the matter is concluded.

22.3.32 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

22.3.33 Eligibility for disciplinary procedures shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

22.4 Responsibilities of Employees

22.4.1 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

22.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of disciplinary procedures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

22.4.4 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.4.5 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to disciplinary procedures and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

22.4.7 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.4.8 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.4.9 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of disciplinary procedures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance

from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

22.4.10 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on disciplinary procedures and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. †

22.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of disciplinary procedures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

22.4.12 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.4.13 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

22.4.14 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of disciplinary procedures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

22.4.15 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of disciplinary procedures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.4.16 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to disciplinary procedures and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An

employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

22.4.18 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to disciplinary procedures and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.4.19 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to disciplinary procedures and shall not withhold material facts.

22.4.20 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to disciplinary procedures and shall not withhold material facts.

22.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to disciplinary procedures and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.4.22 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

22.4.23 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

22.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

22.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with disciplinary procedures.

22.4.26 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.4.27 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on disciplinary procedures and shall comply with them at all times. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following

Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.4.28 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

22.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of disciplinary procedures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.4.30 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of disciplinary procedures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on disciplinary procedures and shall comply with them at all times.

22.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

22.4.32 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with disciplinary procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

22.4.33 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on disciplinary procedures and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

22.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to disciplinary procedures to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

22.5.2 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to disciplinary procedures to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where a

provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.5.3 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.5.4 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on disciplinary procedures and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on disciplinary procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

22.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on disciplinary procedures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

22.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

22.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.5.10 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on disciplinary procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

22.5.12 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

22.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to disciplinary procedures to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

22.5.14 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

22.5.15 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on disciplinary procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on disciplinary procedures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

22.5.18 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to disciplinary procedures to the HR Director without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in

the HR information system.

22.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.5.21 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

22.5.22 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on disciplinary procedures and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

22.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on disciplinary procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.5.24 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.5.25 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to disciplinary procedures to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.5.26 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on disciplinary procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.5.28 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers are

accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to disciplinary procedures to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

22.5.30 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to disciplinary procedures to the HR Director without undue delay.

22.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on disciplinary procedures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

22.5.32 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on disciplinary procedures and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on disciplinary procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.5.34 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to disciplinary procedures within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. **[New in v2.0]**

22.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

22.6.1 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to disciplinary procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

22.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

22.6.4 HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 21 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.6.5 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with disciplinary procedures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

22.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with disciplinary procedures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to disciplinary procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.6.9 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 7 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

22.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for disciplinary procedures and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.6.12 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with disciplinary procedures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 10 working days of receipt.

22.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for disciplinary procedures and shall make them available to all employees.

22.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 7 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to

disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements.

22.6.15 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with disciplinary procedures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

22.6.17 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with disciplinary procedures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.6.18 HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 21 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.6.19 HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 7 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.6.20 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.6.21 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to disciplinary procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.6.23 HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 2 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

22.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line

Manager.

22.6.25 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with disciplinary procedures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

22.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for disciplinary procedures and shall make them available to all employees.

22.6.27 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to disciplinary procedures.

22.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to disciplinary procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

22.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on disciplinary procedures within 7 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements.

22.6.32 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.6.33 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to disciplinary procedures and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.7 Procedure and Process Steps

22.7.1 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

22.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

22.7.4 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.7.6 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 2 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.7.8 The employee shall initiate the process relating to disciplinary procedures by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

22.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to disciplinary procedures by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.7.10 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

22.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.7.12 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

22.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

22.7.14 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.7.15 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

22.7.16 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

22.7.17 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

22.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

22.7.19 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

22.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

22.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is

provided.

22.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to disciplinary procedures by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

22.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

22.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 15 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.7.26 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.7.27 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. †

22.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

22.7.30 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to disciplinary procedures by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

22.7.32 The employee shall initiate the process relating to disciplinary procedures by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.7.33 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 21 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

22.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.8.2 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

22.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

22.8.4 Records relating to disciplinary procedures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

22.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

22.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. All documents relating to disciplinary procedures shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

22.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

22.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. All

documents relating to disciplinary procedures shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

22.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

22.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.8.12 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.8.13 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

22.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.8.16 All documents relating to disciplinary procedures shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.8.17 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to disciplinary procedures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years.

22.8.18 Records relating to disciplinary procedures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

22.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

22.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

22.8.22 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records relating to disciplinary procedures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

22.8.23 All documents relating to disciplinary procedures shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.8.24 All documents relating to disciplinary procedures shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.8.26 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.8.28 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

22.8.29 All documents relating to disciplinary procedures shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the

HR Operations team.

22.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

22.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.8.32 All documents relating to disciplinary procedures shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.8.33 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to disciplinary procedures that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

22.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

22.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

22.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

22.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on disciplinary procedures may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.9.4 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.9.5 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.9.6 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Exceptions to the provisions on disciplinary procedures may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. †

22.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

22.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

22.9.9 Exceptions to the provisions on disciplinary procedures may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.9.10 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.9.12 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.9.13 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice.

22.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

22.9.15 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on disciplinary procedures may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

22.9.17 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

22.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.9.20 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.9.21 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.9.22 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.9.23 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

22.9.24 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

22.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on disciplinary procedures may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.9.26 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

22.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

22.9.28 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of

illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

22.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

22.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

22.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

22.10.1 An internal audit of disciplinary procedures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where an external regulator requests information concerning disciplinary procedures, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

22.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to disciplinary procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.10.3 An internal audit of disciplinary procedures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.10.4 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.10.6 An internal audit of disciplinary procedures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Compliance data relating to disciplinary procedures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

22.10.7 Compliance data relating to disciplinary procedures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to disciplinary procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.10.10 An internal audit of disciplinary procedures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.10.11 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to disciplinary procedures.

22.10.12 An internal audit of disciplinary procedures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.10.13 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to disciplinary procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.10.14 Compliance with the provisions on disciplinary procedures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

22.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to disciplinary procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the

employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

22.10.16 Compliance data relating to disciplinary procedures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.10.17 Where an external regulator requests information concerning disciplinary procedures, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

22.10.18 Compliance with the provisions on disciplinary procedures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.10.19 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to disciplinary procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.10.20 An internal audit of disciplinary procedures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

22.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning disciplinary procedures, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by

HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.10.24 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

22.10.25 Compliance data relating to disciplinary procedures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.10.26 Compliance data relating to disciplinary procedures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

22.10.27 Compliance data relating to disciplinary procedures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

22.10.28 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.10.29 An internal audit of disciplinary procedures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

22.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on disciplinary procedures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where an external regulator requests information concerning disciplinary procedures, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

22.10.31 Where an external regulator requests information concerning disciplinary procedures, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. †

22.10.32 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

22.10.33 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to disciplinary procedures.

22.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

22.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A failure to comply with the provisions on disciplinary procedures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

22.11.2 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on disciplinary procedures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.11.4 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to disciplinary procedures shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A failure to comply with the provisions on disciplinary procedures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

22.11.5 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on disciplinary procedures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

22.11.7 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.11.8 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

22.11.9 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

22.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.11.11 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to disciplinary procedures shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall

prevail.

22.11.12 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.11.13 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

22.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.11.16 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to disciplinary procedures shall be treated as serious misconduct.

22.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.11.18 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to disciplinary procedures shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. †

22.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

22.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to disciplinary procedures shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.11.21 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to disciplinary procedures shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

22.11.22 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.11.23 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.11.24 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

22.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.11.26 A failure to comply with the provisions on disciplinary procedures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.11.27 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

22.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

22.11.30 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to disciplinary procedures shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

22.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on disciplinary procedures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.11.33 A failure to comply with the provisions on disciplinary procedures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

22.11.34 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. **[New in v2.0]**

22.12 Review and Amendment

22.12.1 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

22.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. †

22.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.12.4 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

22.12.6 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.12.7 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

22.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

22.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. †

22.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

22.12.11 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

22.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.12.14 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

22.12.15 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

22.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.12.17 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

22.12.19 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

22.12.21 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

22.12.22 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect.

22.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

22.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

22.12.25 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

22.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

22.12.28 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on disciplinary procedures through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. Cost

implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

22.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

22.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to disciplinary procedures, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

22.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to disciplinary procedures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

22.12.32 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

22.12.33 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

Chapter 23

Whistleblowing and Protected Disclosures

[Retitled / revised]

23.1 Purpose and Scope

23.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The objective of these provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

23.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.1.4 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

23.1.5 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

23.1.7 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.1.9 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

23.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.1.11 The objective of these provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

23.1.12 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The objective of these provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

23.1.13 The objective of these provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. †

23.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

23.1.15 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.1.16 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

23.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

23.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

23.1.19 The Company recognises that whistleblowing and protected disclosures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

23.1.20 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The objective of these provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

23.1.21 The Company recognises that whistleblowing and protected disclosures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

23.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.1.23 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.1.26 The Company recognises that whistleblowing and protected disclosures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.1.27 The objective of these provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests

relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.1.29 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

23.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company recognises that whistleblowing and protected disclosures has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

23.1.31 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

23.1.32 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.1.33 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.1.34 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. **[New in v2.0]**

23.2 Definitions and Interpretation

23.2.1 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.2.2 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.2.3 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

23.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

23.2.6 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.2.7 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

23.2.9 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. †

23.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures

made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.2.12 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "whistleblowing and protected disclosures" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

23.2.13 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "whistleblowing and protected disclosures" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

23.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.2.15 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.2.16 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "whistleblowing and protected disclosures" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.2.18 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

23.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.2.21 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

23.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.2.25 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.2.26 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.2.27 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.2.28 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.2.29 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

23.2.30 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

23.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter

shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.2.32 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "whistleblowing and protected disclosures" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.2.33 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.3 Eligibility and Applicability

23.3.1 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.3.2 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

23.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

23.3.4 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures restricted until the matter is concluded.

23.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.3.7 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

23.3.8 Eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

23.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.3.11 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

23.3.12 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.3.13 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

23.3.15 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

23.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. †

23.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee

is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

23.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

23.3.19 Eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

23.3.20 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

23.3.21 Eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

23.3.22 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.3.23 Eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

23.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

23.3.25 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

23.3.26 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures restricted until the matter is concluded.

23.3.27 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant,

shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

23.3.28 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.3.29 Eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

23.3.32 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

23.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for whistleblowing and protected disclosures restricted until the matter is concluded. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

23.4 Responsibilities of Employees

23.4.1 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. †

23.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

23.4.3 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

23.4.4 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.4.5 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with whistleblowing and protected disclosures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

23.4.6 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.4.8 The employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

23.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall not withhold material facts.

23.4.10 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall not withhold material facts. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

23.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

23.4.12 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

23.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall not withhold material facts.

23.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of whistleblowing and protected disclosures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.4.15 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of whistleblowing and protected disclosures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

23.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

23.4.17 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.4.18 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall comply with them at all times.

23.4.20 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall not withhold material facts.

23.4.21 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

23.4.22 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

23.4.23 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

23.4.26 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.4.27 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with whistleblowing and protected disclosures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.4.29 The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall comply with them at all times.

23.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of whistleblowing and protected disclosures as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

23.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. †

23.4.33 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

23.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

23.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

23.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

23.5.4 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.5.5 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

23.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

23.5.7 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

23.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

23.5.10 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.5.11 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

23.5.12 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.5.13 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall

refresh that training at least once every two years.

23.5.14 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.5.16 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.5.17 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

23.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

23.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.5.22 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and

shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

23.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

23.5.25 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.5.26 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.5.27 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.5.28 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.5.30 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

23.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.5.33 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

23.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

23.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees.

23.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.6.4 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

23.6.5 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

23.6.6 HR shall respond to every written query on whistleblowing and protected disclosures within 21 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.6.7 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

23.6.8 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are

intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.6.9 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on whistleblowing and protected disclosures within 5 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees.

23.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

23.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees.

23.6.15 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

23.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees.

23.6.18 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.6.19 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements.

23.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

23.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

23.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

23.6.23 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees.

23.6.24 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.6.25 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with whistleblowing and protected disclosures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.6.26 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

23.6.27 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.6.28 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with whistleblowing and protected disclosures in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. HR shall monitor

compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

23.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on whistleblowing and protected disclosures within 10 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.6.30 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements.

23.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

23.6.32 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for whistleblowing and protected disclosures and shall make them available to all employees.

23.6.33 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

23.7 Procedure and Process Steps

23.7.1 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

23.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

23.7.3 The employee shall initiate the process relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.7.4 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

23.7.5 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

23.7.7 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 30 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.7.10 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 15 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.7.12 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

23.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.7.14 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

23.7.15 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.7.16 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. †

23.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

23.7.18 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

23.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

23.7.20 The employee shall initiate the process relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

23.7.21 The employee shall initiate the process relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.7.22 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it.

23.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

23.7.26 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

23.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

23.7.28 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

23.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.7.30 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.7.31 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

23.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

23.8.1 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.8.3 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. †

23.8.5 All documents relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.8.6 Records relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. †

23.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

23.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.8.9 Records relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

23.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.8.11 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.8.14 All documents relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

23.8.15 Records relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

23.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way

of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

23.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.8.18 All documents relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Records relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

23.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

23.8.20 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

23.8.21 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

23.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

23.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.8.25 Records relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

23.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.8.27 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.8.28 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

23.8.29 All documents relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.8.30 All documents relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.8.31 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. All documents relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

23.8.32 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

23.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

23.9.1 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

23.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

23.9.4 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

23.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Exceptions to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

23.9.6 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

23.9.8 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

23.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.9.10 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be

dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

23.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

23.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.9.16 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.9.17 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.9.18 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

23.9.19 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

23.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.9.21 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

23.9.23 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.9.24 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.9.26 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

23.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.9.28 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An

exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

23.9.29 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

23.9.31 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.9.33 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

23.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

23.10.1 An internal audit of whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. †

23.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.10.4 Compliance data relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

23.10.5 An internal audit of whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

23.10.7 An internal audit of whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.10.8 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Compliance with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

23.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.10.10 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.10.13 Compliance data relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.10.14 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where an external regulator requests information concerning whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. †

23.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.10.17 Where an external regulator requests information concerning whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.10.19 Compliance with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

23.10.21 Compliance with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures.

23.10.22 An internal audit of whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

23.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

23.10.24 Compliance data relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

23.10.25 Compliance data relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

23.10.26 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to whistleblowing and protected disclosures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.10.27 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

23.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Compliance data relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

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23.10.31 Where an external regulator requests information concerning whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.10.32 Compliance data relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

23.10.33 Where an external regulator requests information concerning whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.10.34 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. **[New in v2.0]**

23.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

23.11.1 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.11.3 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

23.11.4 A failure to comply with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.11.5 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

23.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

23.11.8 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The

Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

23.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

23.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

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23.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

23.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

23.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

23.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

23.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

23.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be treated as serious misconduct.

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23.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

23.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

23.11.25 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.11.26 A failure to comply with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

23.11.28 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

23.11.29 A failure to comply with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

23.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to whistleblowing and protected disclosures shall be treated as serious misconduct.

23.11.31 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

23.11.33 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

23.11.34 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. **[New in v2.0]**

23.12 Review and Amendment

23.12.1 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.12.3 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

23.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

23.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

23.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned

unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

23.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

23.12.9 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. †

23.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.12.11 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

23.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. As an illustration, a request relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

23.12.13 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect.

23.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

23.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to whistleblowing and protected disclosures, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

23.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and

employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

23.12.17 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

23.12.19 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

23.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. †

23.12.21 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

23.12.22 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

23.12.23 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

23.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on whistleblowing and protected disclosures through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

23.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

23.12.26 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

23.12.27 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

23.12.28 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.12.29 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

23.12.32 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

23.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

Chapter 24

Health and Safety

24.1 Purpose and Scope

24.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.1.2 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.1.3 The Company recognises that health and safety has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

24.1.4 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.1.5 The objective of these provisions on health and safety is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.1.6 The objective of these provisions on health and safety is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

24.1.7 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

24.1.8 The objective of these provisions on health and safety is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.1.9 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.1.10 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to health and safety and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.1.11 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.1.13 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.1.15 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.1.16 The Company recognises that health and safety has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety.

24.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.1.18 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to health and safety and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.1.19 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.1.20 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to health and safety and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee

shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

24.1.21 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

24.1.23 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to health and safety and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on health and safety. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company recognises that health and safety has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

24.1.26 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to health and safety and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

24.1.27 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the

requests were received.

24.1.29 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.1.30 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to health and safety and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

24.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

24.1.33 The Company recognises that health and safety has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.2 Definitions and Interpretation

24.2.1 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "health and safety" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.2.2 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety.

24.2.3 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

24.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.2.6 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "health and safety" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.2.7 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety.

24.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.2.9 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.2.11 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.2.12 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "health and safety" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

24.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.2.14 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.2.15 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

24.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.2.17 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

24.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

24.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "health and safety" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.2.21 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as

having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

24.2.24 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

24.2.25 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.2.26 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "health and safety" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.2.27 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.2.28 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

24.2.29 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

24.2.31 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.2.32 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.3 Eligibility and Applicability

24.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

24.3.2 Eligibility for health and safety shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.3.3 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

24.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on health and safety.

24.3.5 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

24.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.3.7 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.3.9 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.3.10 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on health and safety.

24.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.3.12 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

24.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.3.14 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on health and safety. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.3.15 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded.

24.3.16 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

24.3.17 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.3.19 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.3.21 Eligibility for health and safety shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.3.22 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

24.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

24.3.24 Eligibility for health and safety shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

24.3.25 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.3.26 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

24.3.27 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

24.3.28 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on health and safety. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.3.29 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.3.30 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.3.31 Eligibility for health and safety shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

24.3.32 Eligibility for health and safety shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

24.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for health and safety restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.4 Responsibilities of Employees

24.4.1 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on health and safety and shall comply with them at all times.

24.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of health and safety as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.4.3 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts.

24.4.4 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

24.4.5 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on health and safety and shall comply with them at all times.

24.4.7 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts.

24.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

24.4.10 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on health and safety and shall comply with them at all times.

24.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.4.12 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on health and safety and shall comply with them at all times. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

24.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of health and safety as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be

delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

24.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.4.15 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.4.16 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts.

24.4.18 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.4.19 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on health and safety and shall comply with them at all times.

24.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of health and

safety as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

24.4.23 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of health and safety as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.4.24 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with health and safety. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.4.26 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on health and safety and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

24.4.27 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.4.28 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.4.29 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with health and safety.

24.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

24.4.31 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with health and safety.

24.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to health and safety and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

24.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of health and safety as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with health and safety.

24.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

24.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.5.2 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on health and safety and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

24.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on health and safety and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.5.4 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to health and safety to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

24.5.5 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

24.5.6 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on health and safety. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

24.5.7 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on health and safety and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and

a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to health and safety to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. †

24.5.9 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on health and safety and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.5.10 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently.

24.5.12 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on health and safety.

24.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to health and safety to the Policy Committee without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

24.5.14 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

24.5.15 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

24.5.16 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on health and safety. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently.

24.5.18 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

24.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.5.20 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.5.21 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to health and safety to the HR Director without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on health and safety and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to health and safety to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.5.25 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

24.5.26 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.5.27 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.5.28 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

24.5.29 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to health and safety to the HR Director without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.5.30 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on health and safety and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

24.5.31 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on health and safety and applies them consistently. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on health and safety. †

24.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on health and safety and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

24.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to health and safety within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

24.6.1 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

24.6.2 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to health and safety. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to health and safety and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.6.4 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to health and safety and on the applicable legal requirements. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.6.5 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for health and safety and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for health and safety and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall respond to every written query on health and safety within 2 working days of receipt.

24.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with health and safety in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to health and safety. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.6.9 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with health and safety in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

24.6.10 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for health and safety and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied

consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.6.11 HR shall respond to every written query on health and safety within 15 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

24.6.12 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to health and safety and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to health and safety and on the applicable legal requirements.

24.6.15 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for health and safety and shall make them available to all employees.

24.6.16 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with health and safety in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on health and safety within 5 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to health and safety. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

24.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.6.20 HR shall respond to every written query on health and safety within 2 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

24.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to health and safety and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.6.23 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for health and safety and shall make them available to all employees.

24.6.24 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to health and safety and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.6.25 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for health and safety and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.6.26 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with health and safety in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.6.27 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to health and safety. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to health and safety and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on health and safety within 14 working days of receipt. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.6.30 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.6.31 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to health and safety. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with health and safety in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall respond to every written query on health and safety within 5 working days of receipt.

24.6.33 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for health and safety and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.6.34 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. **[New in v2.0]**

24.7 Procedure and Process Steps

24.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

24.7.2 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.7.3 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

24.7.4 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

24.7.5 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.7.6 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it.

24.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.7.8 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.7.9 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

24.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

24.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

24.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

24.7.14 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

24.7.15 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.7.17 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 14 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The employee shall initiate the process relating to health and safety by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager.

24.7.18 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to health and safety by submitting a written request to the Head of Department.

24.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

24.7.22 The employee shall initiate the process relating to health and safety by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

24.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

24.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to health and safety by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome

shall be final.

24.7.25 The employee shall initiate the process relating to health and safety by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

24.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

24.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to health and safety by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to health and safety by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

24.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be

delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

24.8.1 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.8.3 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to health and safety that is held about them, subject to applicable law. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

24.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

24.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

24.8.6 All documents relating to health and safety shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to health and safety that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

24.8.8 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.8.9 All documents relating to health and safety shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.8.10 All documents relating to health and safety shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.8.11 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.8.12 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. †

24.8.13 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

24.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.8.15 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.8.16 All documents relating to health and safety shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

24.8.17 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to health and safety that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

24.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to health and safety that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

24.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.8.20 Records relating to health and safety shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

24.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

24.8.22 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

24.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

24.8.24 Records relating to health and safety shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.8.25 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to health and safety that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

24.8.26 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.8.27 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.8.28 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.8.29 Records relating to health and safety shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting

Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

24.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

24.8.31 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to health and safety that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. All documents relating to health and safety shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

24.8.32 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to health and safety that is held about them, subject to applicable law. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

24.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

24.9.1 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

24.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

24.9.4 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

24.9.5 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.9.6 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

24.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

24.9.12 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

24.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on health and safety may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

24.9.16 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.9.17 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.9.19 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.9.20 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

24.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

24.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.9.25 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.9.26 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

24.9.27 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice.

24.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

24.9.30 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.9.31 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

24.10.1 Compliance data relating to health and safety shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.10.3 An internal audit of health and safety shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning health and safety, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

24.10.5 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.10.6 Compliance data relating to health and safety shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.10.7 Compliance data relating to health and safety shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.10.8 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

24.10.10 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.10.11 Where an external regulator requests information concerning health and safety, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An internal audit of health and safety shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

24.10.12 Compliance data relating to health and safety shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.10.13 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.10.14 Compliance with the provisions on health and safety shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.10.15 Where an external regulator requests information concerning health and safety, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.10.16 Compliance data relating to health and safety shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where an external regulator requests information concerning health and safety, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. †

24.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.10.19 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

24.10.20 Compliance data relating to health and safety shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.10.21 An internal audit of health and safety shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

24.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.10.23 An internal audit of health and safety shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.10.24 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.10.26 Compliance with the provisions on health and safety shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.10.29 Compliance with the provisions on health and safety shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.10.30 Where an external regulator requests information concerning health and safety, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

24.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on health and safety shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to health and safety. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

24.10.33 An internal audit of health and safety shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

24.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

24.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.11.2 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

24.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on health and safety may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

24.11.4 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

24.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to health and safety shall be treated as serious misconduct.

24.11.6 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

24.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.11.8 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

24.11.9 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to health and safety shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.11.10 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.11.11 A failure to comply with the provisions on health and safety may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies

equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to health and safety shall be treated as serious misconduct.

24.11.12 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

24.11.13 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A failure to comply with the provisions on health and safety may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

24.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

24.11.15 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to health and safety shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

24.11.16 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

24.11.17 A failure to comply with the provisions on health and safety may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

24.11.18 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.11.20 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to

ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

24.11.21 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to health and safety shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

24.11.23 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

24.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

24.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

24.11.27 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

24.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

24.11.30 A failure to comply with the provisions on health and safety may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

24.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as

having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

24.11.32 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.11.33 A failure to comply with the provisions on health and safety may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

24.11.34 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A failure to comply with the provisions on health and safety may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. **[New in v2.0]**

24.12 Review and Amendment

24.12.1 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

24.12.2 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

24.12.3 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

24.12.4 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

24.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

24.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.12.7 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.12.8 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

24.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

24.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

24.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

24.12.14 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

24.12.15 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect.

24.12.16 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

24.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

24.12.18 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

24.12.19 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

24.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

24.12.21 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect.

24.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

24.12.23 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. †

24.12.24 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

24.12.25 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

24.12.26 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to health and safety, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this

Manual.

24.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

24.12.28 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

24.12.29 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to health and safety made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. †

24.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

24.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

24.12.33 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on health and safety through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect.

Chapter 25

Information Security and Acceptable Use

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Credential policy	a password change every 90 days	**multi-factor authentication with an annual credential rotation**

25.1 Purpose and Scope

25.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

25.1.2 The Company recognises that information security and acceptable use has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

25.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to information security and acceptable use and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.1.4 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on information security and acceptable use. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.1.5 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

25.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

25.1.7 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on information security and acceptable use. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to information security and acceptable use and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

25.1.9 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.1.10 The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.1.11 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on information security and acceptable use. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

25.1.12 The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.1.13 The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to information security and acceptable use and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.1.15 The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. These

provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

25.1.16 The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

25.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

25.1.19 The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

25.1.20 The Company recognises that information security and acceptable use has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

25.1.21 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.1.22 The Company recognises that information security and acceptable use has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.1.23 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.1.24 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.1.25 The Company recognises that information security and acceptable use has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost

implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

25.1.26 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

25.1.27 The objective of these provisions on information security and acceptable use is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.1.28 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on information security and acceptable use.

25.1.29 The Company recognises that information security and acceptable use has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to information security and acceptable use and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

25.1.30 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to information security and acceptable use and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

25.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to information security and acceptable use and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

25.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.1.33 The Company recognises that information security and acceptable use has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.1.34 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at

the discretion of the HR Operations team. **[New in v2.0]**

25.2 Definitions and Interpretation

25.2.1 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to information security and acceptable use.

25.2.3 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.2.4 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to information security and acceptable use. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

25.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

25.2.6 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.2.7 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

25.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "information security and acceptable use" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

25.2.10 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the

department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.2.11 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

25.2.12 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.2.13 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to information security and acceptable use. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to information security and acceptable use.

25.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to information security and acceptable use. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. †

25.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

25.2.17 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.2.18 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "information security and acceptable use" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last

day of the period is included.

25.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

25.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "information security and acceptable use" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.2.22 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.2.23 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

25.2.24 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

25.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "information security and acceptable use" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "information security and acceptable use" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right

under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to information security and acceptable use.

25.2.29 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to information security and acceptable use.

25.2.30 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

25.2.31 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

25.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

25.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

25.3 Eligibility and Applicability

25.3.1 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded.

25.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Eligibility for information security and acceptable use shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

25.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this

provision applies to their situation. †

25.3.4 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded.

25.3.5 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

25.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use.

25.3.8 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.3.9 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

25.3.10 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

25.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Eligibility for information security and acceptable use shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

25.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use.

25.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.3.14 Eligibility for information security and acceptable use shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

25.3.16 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

25.3.18 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.3.19 Eligibility for information security and acceptable use shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. †

25.3.20 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.3.22 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use.

25.3.23 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use.

25.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

25.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.3.26 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use.

25.3.27 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.3.28 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on information security and acceptable use. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Eligibility for information security and acceptable use shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. †

25.3.29 Eligibility for information security and acceptable use shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on

record.

25.3.30 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

25.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

25.3.32 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for information security and acceptable use restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.4 Responsibilities of Employees

25.4.1 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to information security and acceptable use and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. †

25.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.4.3 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to information security and acceptable use and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

25.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.4.5 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the

provisions on information security and acceptable use and shall comply with them at all times.

25.4.6 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.4.7 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to information security and acceptable use and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.4.8 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to information security and acceptable use and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.4.11 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

25.4.12 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

25.4.13 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to information security and acceptable use and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

25.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with information security and acceptable use. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on information security and acceptable use and shall comply with them at all times. †

25.4.16 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on information security and acceptable use and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

25.4.18 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

25.4.19 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with information security and acceptable use. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

25.4.20 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

25.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to information security and acceptable use and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

25.4.22 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.4.23 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

25.4.25 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with information security and acceptable use. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

25.4.27 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

25.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

25.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

25.4.30 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with information security and acceptable use.

25.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.4.32 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of information security and acceptable use as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

25.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

25.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to information security and acceptable use to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on information security and acceptable use.

25.5.2 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to information security and acceptable use within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

25.5.3 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on information security and acceptable use and applies them consistently. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

25.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.5.5 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to information security and acceptable use within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on information security and acceptable use and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

25.5.6 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.5.7 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to information security and acceptable use within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any

unresolved matter relating to information security and acceptable use to the HR Director without undue delay.

25.5.8 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.5.9 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to information security and acceptable use to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

25.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

25.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.5.12 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on information security and acceptable use. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

25.5.13 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on information security and acceptable use. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on information security and acceptable use. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

25.5.15 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

25.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

25.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on information security and acceptable use. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

25.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

25.5.19 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on information security and acceptable use and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

25.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on information security and acceptable use and applies them consistently.

25.5.21 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

25.5.22 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on information security and acceptable use and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on information security and acceptable use and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on information security and acceptable use. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.5.25 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.5.26 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on information security and acceptable use and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.5.27 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.5.28 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on information security and acceptable use and applies them consistently.

25.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on information security and acceptable use and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on information security and acceptable use and applies them consistently.

25.5.30 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on information security and acceptable use. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.5.31 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to information security and acceptable use to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

25.5.32 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on information security and acceptable use and applies them consistently.

25.5.33 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

25.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with information security and acceptable use in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.6.2 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for information security and acceptable use and shall make them available to all employees.

25.6.3 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 15 working days of receipt.

25.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with information security and acceptable use in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

25.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with information security and acceptable use in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

25.6.6 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 3 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with information security and acceptable use in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for information security and acceptable use and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

25.6.9 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to information security and acceptable use. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

25.6.10 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to information security and acceptable use and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to information security and acceptable use. The time limits

in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 10 working days of receipt.

25.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for information security and acceptable use and shall make them available to all employees. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.6.13 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 15 working days of receipt.

25.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 2 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

25.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to information security and acceptable use. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

25.6.18 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 2 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

25.6.19 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for information security and acceptable use and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 2 working days of receipt.

25.6.20 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for information security and acceptable use and shall make them available to all employees.

25.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 14 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with information security and acceptable use in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

25.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 2 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

25.6.23 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with information security and acceptable use in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.6.24 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.6.25 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 15 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

25.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

25.6.27 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to information security and acceptable use. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

25.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on information security and acceptable use within 10 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

25.6.30 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

25.6.31 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to information security and acceptable use and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing

requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.6.32 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.6.33 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to information security and acceptable use and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

25.6.34 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to information security and acceptable use. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. **[New in v2.0]**

25.7 Procedure and Process Steps

25.7.1 **Credential policy.** User accounts shall be secured through multi-factor authentication with an annual credential rotation. **[Revised in v2.0; previously a password change every 90 days]**

25.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.7.3 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.7.4 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.7.6 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 3 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall

not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

25.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

25.7.8 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.7.9 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

25.7.11 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.7.12 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 3 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.7.13 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

25.7.14 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

25.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

25.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.7.18 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

25.7.19 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

25.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.7.22 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

25.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

25.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

25.7.26 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

25.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

25.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.7.29 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

25.7.30 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager.

25.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 21 working days of receiving it.

25.7.32 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.7.33 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.7.34 The employee shall initiate the process relating to information security and acceptable use by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

25.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

25.8.1 Records relating to information security and acceptable use shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. †

25.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

25.8.6 Records relating to information security and acceptable use shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.8.8 All documents relating to information security and acceptable use shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.8.9 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.8.10 Records relating to information security and acceptable use shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

25.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.8.12 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

25.8.13 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.8.15 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. All documents relating to information security and acceptable use shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

25.8.16 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records relating to information security and acceptable use shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

25.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

25.8.18 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive

rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

25.8.19 All documents relating to information security and acceptable use shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.8.20 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.8.21 All documents relating to information security and acceptable use shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

25.8.22 All documents relating to information security and acceptable use shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.8.23 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

25.8.24 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

25.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to information security and acceptable use that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

25.8.26 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.8.27 All documents relating to information security and acceptable use shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

25.8.28 Records relating to information security and acceptable use shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Where the person

responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

25.8.29 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.8.31 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

25.8.32 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Records relating to information security and acceptable use shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

25.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

25.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. †

25.9.2 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

25.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

25.9.5 Exceptions to the provisions on information security and acceptable use may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

25.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

25.9.7 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice.

25.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

25.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

25.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

25.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on information security and acceptable use may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

25.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

25.9.13 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the

concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

25.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

25.9.15 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.9.17 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.9.18 Exceptions to the provisions on information security and acceptable use may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

25.9.19 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.9.20 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

25.9.21 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

25.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

25.9.24 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. †

25.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.9.28 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.9.30 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.9.31 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

25.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where

the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

25.9.33 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

25.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

25.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on information security and acceptable use shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance data relating to information security and acceptable use shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

25.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.10.3 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

25.10.4 Compliance with the provisions on information security and acceptable use shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Compliance data relating to information security and acceptable use shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

25.10.5 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to information security and acceptable use. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.10.7 Compliance with the provisions on information security and acceptable use shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

25.10.8 An internal audit of information security and acceptable use shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to information security and acceptable use. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to information security and acceptable use. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance with the provisions on information security and acceptable use shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

25.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.10.12 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

25.10.13 Compliance data relating to information security and acceptable use shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.10.14 Compliance data relating to information security and acceptable use shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An internal audit of information security and acceptable use shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

25.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to information security and acceptable use. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.10.16 Compliance data relating to information security and acceptable use shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

25.10.17 Compliance with the provisions on information security and acceptable use shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this

provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning information security and acceptable use, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

25.10.19 Compliance data relating to information security and acceptable use shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on information security and acceptable use shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to information security and acceptable use. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.10.22 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to information security and acceptable use. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.10.23 An internal audit of information security and acceptable use shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.10.24 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.10.25 An internal audit of information security and acceptable use shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

25.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Compliance with the provisions on information security and acceptable use shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

25.10.27 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be

dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning information security and acceptable use, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.10.29 An internal audit of information security and acceptable use shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

25.10.30 An internal audit of information security and acceptable use shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

25.10.31 Compliance data relating to information security and acceptable use shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

25.10.32 An internal audit of information security and acceptable use shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

25.10.33 Where an external regulator requests information concerning information security and acceptable use, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

25.11.1 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to information security and acceptable use shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

25.11.2 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

25.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to information security and acceptable use shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.11.4 A failure to comply with the provisions on information security and acceptable use may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

25.11.5 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

25.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on information security and acceptable use may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to information security and acceptable use shall be treated as serious misconduct.

25.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

25.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

25.11.9 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to information security and acceptable use shall be treated as serious misconduct.

25.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A failure to comply with the provisions on information security and acceptable use may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

25.11.11 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.11.12 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to

information security and acceptable use, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

25.11.13 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.11.15 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

25.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to information security and acceptable use shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A failure to comply with the provisions on information security and acceptable use may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

25.11.18 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. †

25.11.19 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

25.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.11.21 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

25.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.11.23 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.11.24 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to information security and acceptable use shall be treated as serious misconduct.

25.11.25 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.11.26 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

25.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.11.28 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.11.30 A failure to comply with the provisions on information security and acceptable use may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

25.11.31 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

25.11.32 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.12 Review and Amendment

25.12.1 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

25.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on information security and acceptable use through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

25.12.3 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.12.4 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on information security and acceptable use through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

25.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right

of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to information security and acceptable use, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

25.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

25.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

25.12.8 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

25.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

25.12.11 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

25.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on information security and acceptable use through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

25.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

25.12.14 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

25.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

25.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

25.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.12.18 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on information security and acceptable use through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

25.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

25.12.21 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

25.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

25.12.23 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on information security and acceptable use through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

25.12.25 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

25.12.26 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

25.12.27 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

25.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. As an illustration, a request relating to information security and acceptable use made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

25.12.29 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

25.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

25.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

25.12.32 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

25.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

Chapter 26

Data Protection and Employee Privacy

26.1 Purpose and Scope

26.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on data protection and employee privacy. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

26.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to data protection and employee privacy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

26.1.4 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to data protection and employee privacy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

26.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on data protection and employee privacy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company recognises that data protection and employee privacy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

26.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to data protection and employee privacy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on data protection and employee privacy. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

26.1.9 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to data protection and employee privacy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

26.1.11 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on data protection and employee privacy. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

26.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to data protection and employee privacy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. †

26.1.15 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.1.16 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on data protection and employee privacy. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.1.17 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to data protection and employee privacy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.1.20 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.1.21 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.1.22 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

26.1.23 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.1.24 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

26.1.25 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

26.1.26 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.1.27 The Company recognises that data protection and employee privacy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.1.28 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the

day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.1.29 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

26.1.30 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

26.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.1.32 The objective of these provisions on data protection and employee privacy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.1.33 The Company recognises that data protection and employee privacy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

26.1.34 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to data protection and employee privacy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. **[New in v2.0]**

26.2 Definitions and Interpretation

26.2.1 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "data protection and employee privacy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

26.2.2 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.2.3 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period,

the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

26.2.5 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.2.6 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

26.2.7 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "data protection and employee privacy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

26.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.2.11 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

26.2.12 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to data protection and employee privacy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.2.13 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

26.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

26.2.15 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

26.2.16 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

26.2.17 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

26.2.18 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "data protection and employee privacy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

26.2.19 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "data protection and employee privacy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

26.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.2.21 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to data protection and employee privacy. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to data protection and employee privacy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable

to the employee shall prevail. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "data protection and employee privacy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

26.2.24 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

26.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.2.26 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

26.2.27 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.2.29 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to data protection and employee privacy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.2.30 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

26.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

26.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day

work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

26.3 Eligibility and Applicability

26.3.1 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.3.2 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

26.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on data protection and employee privacy.

26.3.4 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for data protection and employee privacy restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

26.3.5 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

26.3.6 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

26.3.7 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

26.3.8 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.3.9 Eligibility for data protection and employee privacy shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of

service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for data protection and employee privacy restricted until the matter is concluded.

26.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on data protection and employee privacy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.3.11 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.3.12 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on data protection and employee privacy. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Eligibility for data protection and employee privacy shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

26.3.13 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

26.3.14 Eligibility for data protection and employee privacy shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.3.15 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.3.16 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on data protection and employee privacy. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

26.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.3.18 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for data protection and employee privacy restricted until the matter is concluded. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for data protection and employee privacy restricted until the matter is concluded.

26.3.22 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

26.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.3.25 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Eligibility for data protection and employee privacy shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

26.3.26 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on data protection and employee privacy.

26.3.27 Eligibility for data protection and employee privacy shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.3.28 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.3.29 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

26.3.30 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on data protection and employee privacy. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

26.3.31 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on data protection and employee privacy.

26.3.33 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.4 Responsibilities of Employees

26.4.1 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to data protection and employee privacy and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.4.2 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

26.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.4.4 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to data protection and employee privacy and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of data protection and employee privacy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with data protection and employee privacy.

26.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with data protection and employee privacy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

26.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to data protection and employee privacy and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of data protection and employee privacy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

26.4.11 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

26.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with data protection and employee privacy. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.4.13 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to data protection and employee privacy and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy and shall comply with them at all times.

26.4.14 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with data protection and employee privacy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.4.17 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with data protection and employee privacy. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The staff member shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

26.4.18 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

26.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

26.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

26.4.21 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with data protection and employee privacy.

26.4.22 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.4.24 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.4.25 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of data protection and employee privacy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

26.4.26 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to data protection and employee privacy and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.4.29 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.4.30 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of data protection and employee privacy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

26.4.32 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

26.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.5.2 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on data protection and employee privacy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.5.4 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on data protection and employee privacy and applies them consistently.

26.5.5 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.5.6 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on data protection and employee privacy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

26.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.5.9 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. This provision is

intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

26.5.10 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on data protection and employee privacy and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.5.11 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on data protection and employee privacy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

26.5.12 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.5.13 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.5.14 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on data protection and employee privacy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

26.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

26.5.18 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

26.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.5.20 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

26.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to data protection and employee privacy to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on data protection and employee privacy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

26.5.22 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on data protection and employee privacy and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on data protection and employee privacy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

26.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to data protection and employee privacy to the HR Director without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.5.25 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.5.26 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on data protection and employee privacy and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.5.27 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

26.5.28 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.5.30 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to data protection and employee privacy within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.5.31 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to data protection and employee privacy to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to data protection and employee privacy to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on data protection and employee privacy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. †

26.5.33 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

26.6.1 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for data protection and employee privacy and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.6.2 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to data protection and employee privacy. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to data protection and employee privacy and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority

nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

26.6.4 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to data protection and employee privacy and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to data protection and employee privacy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

26.6.6 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to data protection and employee privacy and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with data protection and employee privacy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

26.6.7 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.6.8 HR shall respond to every written query on data protection and employee privacy within 15 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for data protection and employee privacy and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.6.10 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to data protection and employee privacy and on the applicable legal requirements.

26.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to data protection and employee privacy. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.6.13 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for data protection and employee privacy and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the

approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

26.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to data protection and employee privacy. †

26.6.15 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to data protection and employee privacy and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

26.6.16 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for data protection and employee privacy and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.6.17 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.6.18 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

26.6.20 HR shall respond to every written query on data protection and employee privacy within 10 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.6.21 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with data protection and employee privacy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

26.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to data protection and employee privacy and on the applicable legal requirements. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of

Department.

26.6.23 HR shall respond to every written query on data protection and employee privacy within 3 working days of receipt. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.6.24 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

26.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

26.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on data protection and employee privacy within 7 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

26.6.27 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for data protection and employee privacy and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for data protection and employee privacy and shall make them available to all employees.

26.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with data protection and employee privacy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

26.6.31 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to data protection and employee privacy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.6.32 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to data protection and employee privacy and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with data protection and employee privacy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. †

26.6.33 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to data protection and employee privacy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.7 Procedure and Process Steps

26.7.1 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

26.7.3 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

26.7.4 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 14 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.7.5 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

26.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. †

26.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where

relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

26.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

26.7.10 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

26.7.14 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

26.7.15 The employee shall initiate the process relating to data protection and employee privacy by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

26.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

26.7.17 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by

HR. †

26.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

26.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. †

26.7.20 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.7.21 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

26.7.23 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.7.25 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.7.27 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. †

26.7.28 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

26.7.29 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.7.30 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

26.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to data protection and employee privacy by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

26.8.1 All documents relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

26.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

26.8.3 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.8.4 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.8.5 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

26.8.6 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

26.8.7 All documents relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.8.8 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

26.8.9 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

26.8.10 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Records relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

26.8.12 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each

case.

26.8.13 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.8.14 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

26.8.15 Records relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.8.16 All documents relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.8.17 All documents relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

26.8.18 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.8.19 All documents relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

26.8.20 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

26.8.21 Records relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

26.8.22 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.8.23 All documents relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. †

26.8.24 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

26.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.8.26 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

26.8.28 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

26.8.29 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

26.8.30 Records relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

26.8.31 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to data protection and employee privacy that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

26.8.32 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

26.8.33 Records relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. All documents relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

26.8.34 Records relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. **[New in v2.0]**

26.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

26.9.1 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

26.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.9.4 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

26.9.5 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the

requests were received.

26.9.6 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

26.9.7 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

26.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

26.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.9.12 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

26.9.13 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

26.9.15 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

26.9.17 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

26.9.18 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.9.19 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

26.9.20 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

26.9.21 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.9.22 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

26.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

26.9.26 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice.

26.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

26.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

26.10.1 Compliance data relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

26.10.3 An internal audit of data protection and employee privacy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

26.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.10.5 An internal audit of data protection and employee privacy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.10.7 Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

26.10.8 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Compliance data relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

26.10.9 Where an external regulator requests information concerning data protection and employee privacy, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

26.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.10.12 An internal audit of data protection and employee privacy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.10.13 An internal audit of data protection and employee privacy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.10.14 Compliance data relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.10.15 Where an external regulator requests information concerning data protection and employee privacy, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.10.16 An internal audit of data protection and employee privacy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.10.17 Where an external regulator requests information concerning data protection and employee privacy, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

26.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning data protection and employee privacy, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.10.19 An internal audit of data protection and employee privacy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

26.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance data relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

26.10.21 Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

26.10.24 Compliance data relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

26.10.25 Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.10.26 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to data protection and employee privacy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance data relating to data protection and employee privacy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

26.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

26.10.29 Where an external regulator requests information concerning data protection and employee privacy, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

26.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

26.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.10.33 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to data protection and employee privacy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

26.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

26.11.2 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

26.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a breach has caused

financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

26.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

26.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

26.11.6 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

26.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to data protection and employee privacy shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

26.11.8 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.11.10 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to data protection and employee privacy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

26.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

26.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to data protection and employee privacy shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies

equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.11.14 A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

26.11.15 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.11.17 A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

26.11.18 A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.11.20 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to data protection and employee privacy shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.11.21 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to data protection and employee privacy shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

26.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

26.11.23 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

26.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

26.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

26.11.26 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

26.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

26.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on data protection and employee privacy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

26.11.29 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

26.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

26.11.31 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall

not affect any statutory right of the employee.

26.11.33 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.12 Review and Amendment

26.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

26.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

26.12.3 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

26.12.4 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

26.12.7 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

26.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that

spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

26.12.9 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

26.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

26.12.11 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

26.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

26.12.13 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to data protection and employee privacy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

26.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

26.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

26.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

26.12.17 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

26.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

26.12.19 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

26.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

26.12.21 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect.

26.12.22 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

26.12.23 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.12.24 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

26.12.25 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

26.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. †

26.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.12.28 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. †

26.12.29 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

26.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

26.12.31 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

26.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

26.12.33 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on data protection and employee privacy through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

Chapter 27

Social Media and Communications

27.1 Purpose and Scope

27.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

27.1.2 The Company recognises that social media and communications has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

27.1.4 The objective of these provisions on social media and communications is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

27.1.5 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

27.1.6 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.1.7 The Company recognises that social media and communications has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.1.8 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated

as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on social media and communications. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.1.11 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.1.12 The Company recognises that social media and communications has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

27.1.13 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

27.1.14 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

27.1.15 The Company recognises that social media and communications has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

27.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.1.17 The objective of these provisions on social media and communications is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

27.1.18 The objective of these provisions on social media and communications is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is

intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on social media and communications.

27.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.1.20 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on social media and communications. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.1.21 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

27.1.22 The objective of these provisions on social media and communications is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.1.23 The objective of these provisions on social media and communications is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on social media and communications. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

27.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

27.1.26 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on social media and communications. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.1.27 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

27.1.28 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on social media and communications.

27.1.29 The objective of these provisions on social media and communications is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company recognises that social media and communications has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

27.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

27.1.32 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to social media and communications and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

27.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on social media and communications. †

27.2 Definitions and Interpretation

27.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

27.2.2 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

27.2.3 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.2.4 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

27.2.5 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

27.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to social media and communications.

27.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

27.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to social media and communications.

27.2.9 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.2.10 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to social media and communications. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.2.13 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

27.2.14 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "social media and communications" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

27.2.15 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

27.2.16 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

27.2.17 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to social media and communications. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.2.18 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.2.20 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

27.2.21 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

27.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to social media and communications. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

27.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to social media and communications. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "social media and communications" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.2.25 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to social media and communications. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.2.26 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

27.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "social media and communications" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

27.2.28 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "social media and communications" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.2.29 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.2.30 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "social media and communications" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

27.2.31 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.2.33 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.3 Eligibility and Applicability

27.3.1 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on social media and communications. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.3.2 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

27.3.3 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.3.4 Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail

address on record. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for social media and communications restricted until the matter is concluded.

27.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

27.3.6 Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

27.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on social media and communications. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

27.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

27.3.10 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for social media and communications restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

27.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.3.13 Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

27.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.3.15 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.3.16 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for social media and communications restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.3.17 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

27.3.18 Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

27.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

27.3.21 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.3.22 Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on social media and communications.

27.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

27.3.24 Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.3.25 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for social media and communications restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.3.26 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.3.27 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

27.3.28 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.3.29 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.3.30 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on social media and communications. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated

as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Eligibility for social media and communications shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

27.3.31 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for social media and communications restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.3.32 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

27.3.33 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for social media and communications restricted until the matter is concluded.

27.4 Responsibilities of Employees

27.4.1 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

27.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on social media and communications and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications.

27.4.3 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

27.4.4 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

27.4.5 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.4.6 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on social media and communications and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

27.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

27.4.8 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

27.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications.

27.4.10 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

27.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

27.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

27.4.13 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to social media and communications and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.4.15 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

27.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to social media and communications and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.4.19 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.4.20 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to social media and communications and shall not withhold material facts. †

27.4.22 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on social media and communications and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on social media and communications and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible

is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on social media and communications and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

27.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

27.4.27 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

27.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.4.30 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with social media and communications. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.4.31 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to social media and communications and shall not withhold material facts.

27.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to social media and communications and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on social media and communications and shall comply with them at all times.

27.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of social media and communications as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision

shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

27.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

27.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on social media and communications and applies them consistently.

27.5.3 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.5.4 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. †

27.5.5 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to social media and communications to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.5.6 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

27.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on social media and communications and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 5 working days and shall record the

outcome in the departmental register. †

27.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.5.9 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to social media and communications to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

27.5.10 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on social media and communications. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.5.11 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on social media and communications and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.5.12 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on social media and communications and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on social media and communications and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on social media and communications and applies them consistently.

27.5.14 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.5.15 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on social media and communications and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

27.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to social media and communications to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to social media and communications to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

27.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on social media and communications and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.5.22 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on social media and communications and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

27.5.23 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on social media and communications and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

27.5.24 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on social media and communications and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.5.25 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.5.26 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to social media and communications to the HR Director without undue delay.

27.5.27 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on social media and communications and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to social media and communications to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on social media and communications and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

27.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

27.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to social media and communications within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to social media and communications to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

27.5.33 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

27.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

27.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. †

27.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to social

media and communications and on the applicable legal requirements.

27.6.3 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for social media and communications and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to social media and communications and on the applicable legal requirements.

27.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with social media and communications in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.6.5 HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 7 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to social media and communications and on the applicable legal requirements.

27.6.7 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

27.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for social media and communications and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.6.9 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.6.10 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with social media and communications in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with social media and communications in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the

day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.6.12 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to social media and communications. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 14 working days of receipt.

27.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 21 working days of receipt.

27.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to social media and communications.

27.6.16 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with social media and communications in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

27.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to social media and communications. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 30 working days of receipt.

27.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to social media and communications and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

27.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to social media and communications. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more

favourable to the employee shall prevail.

27.6.20 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with social media and communications in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

27.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 5 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

27.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 15 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with social media and communications in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

27.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to social media and communications. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to social media and communications. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

27.6.25 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for social media and communications and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

27.6.26 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to social media and communications. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

27.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.6.29 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 5 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to social media and communications and on the

applicable legal requirements.

27.6.31 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with social media and communications in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.6.32 HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 2 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.6.33 HR shall respond to every written query on social media and communications within 5 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

27.7 Procedure and Process Steps

27.7.1 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

27.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

27.7.3 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

27.7.4 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

27.7.5 The employee shall initiate the process relating to social media and communications by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

27.7.6 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

27.7.7 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

27.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

27.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.7.10 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The employee shall initiate the process relating to social media and communications by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team.

27.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. †

27.7.12 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

27.7.14 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

27.7.15 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter

are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

27.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.7.18 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to social media and communications by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. †

27.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

27.7.22 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

27.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to social media and communications by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.7.24 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.7.25 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

27.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to social media and communications by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner.

27.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to social media and communications by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

27.7.30 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 3 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.7.32 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

27.7.33 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

27.8.1 All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

27.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

27.8.3 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.8.4 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

27.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

27.8.6 All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.8.7 All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

27.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

27.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

27.8.10 Records relating to social media and communications shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

27.8.11 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.8.12 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Records relating to social media and communications shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years.

27.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

27.8.14 All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.8.16 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

27.8.17 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

27.8.18 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.8.19 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.8.20 All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.8.21 Records relating to social media and communications shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

27.8.22 All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

27.8.23 Records relating to social media and communications shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

27.8.24 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

27.8.25 Records relating to social media and communications shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.8.26 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.8.27 All documents relating to social media and communications shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.8.28 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

27.8.29 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to social media and communications that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

27.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

27.8.31 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to social media and communications that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

27.8.32 Records relating to social media and communications shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

27.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on social media and communications may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

27.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.9.3 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. By way of illustration, where the employee

submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

27.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

27.9.5 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Exceptions to the provisions on social media and communications may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. †

27.9.6 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

27.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.9.10 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on social media and communications may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

27.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to

another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.9.13 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.9.14 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

27.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.9.16 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on social media and communications may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

27.9.17 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

27.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.9.20 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

27.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line

Manager.

27.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on social media and communications may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

27.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.9.25 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

27.9.26 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

27.9.27 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.9.28 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

27.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.9.31 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

27.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

27.10.1 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

27.10.2 An internal audit of social media and communications shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Compliance with the provisions on social media and communications shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

27.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to social media and communications.

27.10.4 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

27.10.5 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

27.10.6 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.10.7 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.10.8 An internal audit of social media and communications shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

27.10.9 Compliance with the provisions on social media and communications shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.10.10 Where an external regulator requests information concerning social media and communications, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to social media and communications.

27.10.11 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.10.12 An internal audit of social media and communications shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.10.13 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

27.10.14 An internal audit of social media and communications shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.10.15 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.10.16 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

27.10.17 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. An internal audit of social media and communications shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

27.10.18 An internal audit of social media and communications shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Compliance with the provisions on social media and communications shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

27.10.19 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.10.20 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning social media and communications, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

27.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on social media and communications shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to social media and communications. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Compliance with the provisions on social media and communications shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. †

27.10.24 Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

27.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to social media and communications. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning social media and communications, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.10.27 Compliance with the provisions on social media and communications shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning social media and communications, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.10.29 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to social media and communications. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance data relating to social media and communications shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

27.10.30 Where an external regulator requests information concerning social media and communications, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

27.10.31 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where an external regulator requests information concerning social media and communications, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

27.10.32 Where an external regulator requests information concerning social media and communications, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

27.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

27.11.1 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

27.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

27.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This

provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.11.4 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

27.11.5 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct.

27.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

27.11.9 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.11.10 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

27.11.11 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A failure to comply with

the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

27.11.14 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. †

27.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

27.11.16 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

27.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

27.11.19 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

27.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct.

27.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

27.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

27.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.11.26 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. †

27.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct.

27.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct.

27.11.29 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to social media and communications shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

27.11.30 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.11.31 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

27.11.32 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is

absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

27.11.33 A failure to comply with the provisions on social media and communications may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

27.12 Review and Amendment

27.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

27.12.2 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

27.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.12.4 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.12.5 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

27.12.6 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

27.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on social media and communications through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term

that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

27.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

27.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

27.12.11 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

27.12.12 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

27.12.14 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on social media and communications through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

27.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

27.12.16 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

27.12.17 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on social media and communications through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect.

27.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to social media and communications, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

27.12.19 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on social media and communications through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

27.12.20 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

27.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

27.12.23 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

27.12.25 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

27.12.26 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the

concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

27.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to social media and communications made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

27.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

27.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

27.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

27.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

27.12.32 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

27.12.33 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

Chapter 28

Company Assets and Equipment

28.1 Purpose and Scope

28.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to company assets and equipment and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

28.1.2 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.1.3 The Company recognises that company assets and equipment has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

28.1.4 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on company assets and equipment. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on company assets and equipment. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company recognises that company assets and equipment has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

28.1.6 The Company recognises that company assets and equipment has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.1.7 The Company recognises that company assets and equipment has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.1.8 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.1.9 The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.1.10 The Company recognises that company assets and equipment has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

28.1.11 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on company assets and equipment. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.1.12 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to company assets and equipment and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The Company recognises that company assets and equipment has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

28.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on company assets and equipment. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

28.1.14 The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

28.1.15 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

28.1.16 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to company assets and equipment and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.1.17 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

28.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.1.19 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

28.1.20 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.1.21 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.1.22 The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

28.1.23 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to company assets and equipment and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

28.1.25 The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

28.1.26 The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to company assets and equipment and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

28.1.27 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to company assets and equipment and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

28.1.28 The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail

in the event of any conflict. †

28.1.29 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on company assets and equipment. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

28.1.30 The Company recognises that company assets and equipment has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.1.31 The objective of these provisions on company assets and equipment is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

28.1.32 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.1.33 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to company assets and equipment and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

28.2 Definitions and Interpretation

28.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.2.2 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

28.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

28.2.9 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to company assets and equipment. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be

declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

28.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.2.14 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

28.2.15 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.2.16 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to company assets and equipment. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.2.17 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "company assets and equipment" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to company assets and equipment. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

28.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.2.21 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.2.23 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "company assets and equipment" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

28.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "company assets and equipment" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

28.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

28.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.2.27 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

28.2.30 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.2.31 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "company assets and equipment" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

28.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the

request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

28.3 Eligibility and Applicability

28.3.1 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on company assets and equipment. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.3.2 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on company assets and equipment. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

28.3.3 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for company assets and equipment restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.3.4 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.3.5 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on company assets and equipment. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

28.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on company assets and equipment. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

28.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

28.3.10 Eligibility for company assets and equipment shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.3.11 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.3.12 Eligibility for company assets and equipment shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.3.13 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.3.14 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.3.15 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.3.17 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently,

and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on company assets and equipment.

28.3.18 Eligibility for company assets and equipment shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.3.19 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

28.3.20 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on company assets and equipment. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.3.21 Eligibility for company assets and equipment shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

28.3.23 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for company assets and equipment restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

28.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

28.3.26 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on company assets and equipment.

28.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

28.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for company assets and equipment restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for company assets and equipment restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.3.30 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.3.31 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

28.3.32 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for company assets and equipment restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

28.3.33 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

28.4 Responsibilities of Employees

28.4.1 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on company assets and equipment and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The staff member shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

28.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

28.4.4 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.4.6 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

28.4.7 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.4.10 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on company assets and equipment and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

28.4.13 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to company assets and equipment and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that

spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

28.4.14 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to company assets and equipment and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on company assets and equipment and shall comply with them at all times.

28.4.15 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.4.16 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

28.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

28.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

28.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment.

28.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to company assets and equipment and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

28.4.25 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.4.26 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to company assets and equipment and shall not withhold material facts.

28.4.27 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.4.28 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment.

28.4.29 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.4.30 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with company assets and equipment. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

28.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on company assets and equipment and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new

Line Manager. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of company assets and equipment as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

28.4.33 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to company assets and equipment and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

28.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

28.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on company assets and equipment and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

28.5.2 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to company assets and equipment to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.5.3 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.5.5 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on company assets and equipment and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to company assets and equipment to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

28.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.5.9 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on company assets and equipment and applies them consistently. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

28.5.10 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on company assets and equipment and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

28.5.11 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to company assets and equipment to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment.

28.5.12 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

28.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to company assets and equipment to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

28.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.5.15 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.5.16 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

28.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on company assets and equipment and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

28.5.18 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on company assets and equipment and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.5.19 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on company assets and equipment and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment.

28.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.5.21 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on company assets and equipment and applies them consistently. †

28.5.22 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

28.5.23 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on company assets and equipment and applies them consistently. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment.

28.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. Cost

implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.5.25 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on company assets and equipment and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

28.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to company assets and equipment to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on company assets and equipment and applies them consistently.

28.5.27 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to company assets and equipment to the HR Director without undue delay.

28.5.28 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

28.5.29 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.5.30 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on company assets and equipment. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

28.5.31 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on company assets and equipment and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

28.5.32 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

28.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to company assets and equipment within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

28.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

28.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to company assets and equipment and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.6.2 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for company assets and equipment and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.6.3 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for company assets and equipment and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

28.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.6.5 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to company assets and equipment and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with company assets and equipment in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

28.6.6 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to company assets and equipment. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.6.7 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for company assets and equipment and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to company assets and equipment and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.6.9 HR shall respond to every written query on company assets and equipment within 30 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with company assets and equipment in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

28.6.10 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees

and managers on matters relating to company assets and equipment.

28.6.11 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for company assets and equipment and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

28.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

28.6.14 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to company assets and equipment. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

28.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.6.16 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for company assets and equipment and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.6.17 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to company assets and equipment and on the applicable legal requirements.

28.6.19 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for company assets and equipment and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.6.20 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on company assets and equipment within 5 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.6.22 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with company assets and equipment in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

28.6.23 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with company assets and equipment in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.6.24 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to company assets and equipment and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

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28.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to company assets and equipment. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on company assets and equipment within 10 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

28.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on company assets and equipment within 5 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

28.6.32 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to company assets and equipment. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all

concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with company assets and equipment in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

28.6.33 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for company assets and equipment and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.7 Procedure and Process Steps

28.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

28.7.2 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.7.3 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 14 working days of receiving it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

28.7.4 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are

sent by e-mail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 14 working days of receiving it.

28.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

28.7.10 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to company assets and equipment by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager.

28.7.11 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.7.12 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

28.7.14 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.7.15 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 3 working days of receiving it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

28.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to company assets and equipment by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team.

28.7.17 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.7.18 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be

declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

28.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.7.20 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

28.7.21 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.7.22 The employee shall initiate the process relating to company assets and equipment by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

28.7.23 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

28.7.25 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

28.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

28.7.27 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the

HR Business Partner.

28.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to company assets and equipment by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.7.30 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.7.31 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.7.34 The employee shall initiate the process relating to company assets and equipment by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. **[New in v2.0]**

28.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

28.8.1 Records relating to company assets and equipment shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

28.8.3 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

28.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

28.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.8.6 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

28.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. All documents relating to company assets and equipment shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

28.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

28.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

28.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

28.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades,

locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

28.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

28.8.15 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.8.16 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Records relating to company assets and equipment shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. †

28.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.8.18 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. All documents relating to company assets and equipment shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

28.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

28.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.8.21 All documents relating to company assets and equipment shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.8.22 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. All documents relating to company assets and equipment shall be stored in the

HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

28.8.23 Records relating to company assets and equipment shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.8.24 All documents relating to company assets and equipment shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

28.8.25 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

28.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

28.8.27 All documents relating to company assets and equipment shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.8.29 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

28.8.30 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to company assets and equipment that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

28.8.31 Records relating to company assets and equipment shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

28.8.32 Records relating to company assets and equipment shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

28.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on company assets and equipment may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

28.9.3 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.9.7 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

28.9.8 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.9.10 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.9.11 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.9.12 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.9.14 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.9.15 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

28.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

28.9.17 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.9.20 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.9.21 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.9.22 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on company assets and equipment may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

28.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on company assets and equipment may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.9.27 Exceptions to the provisions on company assets and equipment may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

28.9.28 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

28.9.29 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company

may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

28.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on company assets and equipment may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.9.31 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.9.32 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.9.33 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

28.10.1 An internal audit of company assets and equipment shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.10.2 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.10.3 An internal audit of company assets and equipment shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where an external regulator requests information concerning company assets and equipment, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. †

28.10.4 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

28.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on company assets and equipment shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to company assets and equipment. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.10.7 Compliance data relating to company assets and equipment shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

28.10.8 Compliance data relating to company assets and equipment shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.10.9 Compliance with the provisions on company assets and equipment shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

28.10.11 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to company assets and equipment. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.10.12 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.10.13 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Compliance with the provisions on company assets and equipment shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

28.10.14 Compliance data relating to company assets and equipment shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.10.15 Compliance data relating to company assets and equipment shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to company assets and equipment.

28.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. †

28.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

28.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning company assets and equipment, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

28.10.19 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning company assets and equipment, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.10.21 An internal audit of company assets and equipment shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

28.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.10.23 Compliance with the provisions on company assets and equipment shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

28.10.24 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Where an external regulator requests information concerning company assets and equipment, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

28.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning company assets and equipment, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

28.10.26 An internal audit of company assets and equipment shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning company assets and equipment, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on company assets and equipment shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

28.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.10.30 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to company assets and equipment. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.10.31 Compliance data relating to company assets and equipment shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An internal audit of company assets and equipment shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

28.10.32 Compliance data relating to company assets and equipment shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

28.10.33 Compliance data relating to company assets and equipment shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

28.10.34 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. **[New in v2.0]**

28.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

28.11.1 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

28.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

28.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

28.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on company assets and equipment may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct.

28.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on company assets and equipment may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.11.7 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.11.8 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

28.11.9 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.11.10 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

28.11.11 A failure to comply with the provisions on company assets and equipment may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

28.11.12 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.11.13 A failure to comply with the provisions on company assets and equipment may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

28.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on company assets and equipment may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

28.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct.

28.11.18 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.11.19 A failure to comply with the provisions on company assets and equipment may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.11.20 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter

shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

28.11.21 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.11.23 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A failure to comply with the provisions on company assets and equipment may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

28.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

28.11.26 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

28.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.11.28 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to company assets and equipment shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

28.11.30 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.11.31 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

28.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

28.11.33 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.12 Review and Amendment

28.12.1 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

28.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect.

28.12.4 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to company assets and equipment made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

28.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

28.12.6 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 15

days before it takes effect.

28.12.7 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. †

28.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.12.10 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

28.12.11 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.12.14 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

28.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration,

where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

28.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.12.17 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.12.18 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.12.19 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

28.12.20 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

28.12.21 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

28.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. †

28.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

28.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

28.12.25 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

28.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on company assets and equipment through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

28.12.28 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

28.12.29 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

28.12.30 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

28.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

28.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

28.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to company assets and equipment, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

Chapter 29

Transfers and Relocation

29.1 Purpose and Scope

29.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.1.2 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.1.3 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

29.1.5 The Company recognises that transfers and relocation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. †

29.1.6 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

29.1.7 The Company recognises that transfers and relocation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

29.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on transfers and relocation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

29.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on transfers and relocation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The objective of these provisions on transfers and relocation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions

are made. †

29.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

29.1.11 The objective of these provisions on transfers and relocation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

29.1.12 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.1.13 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company recognises that transfers and relocation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

29.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.1.15 The objective of these provisions on transfers and relocation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.1.16 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on transfers and relocation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

29.1.17 The Company recognises that transfers and relocation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

29.1.18 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. †

29.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An

example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

29.1.21 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.1.22 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

29.1.23 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.1.24 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

29.1.27 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The objective of these provisions on transfers and relocation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. †

29.1.28 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the

new Line Manager.

29.1.29 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on transfers and relocation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.1.31 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

29.1.32 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to transfers and relocation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.2 Definitions and Interpretation

29.2.1 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.2.2 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.2.4 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.2.6 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this

Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

29.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

29.2.9 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.2.10 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

29.2.11 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.2.12 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.2.13 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.2.14 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

29.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to transfers and relocation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.2.16 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.2.17 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.2.18 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

29.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.2.21 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

29.2.22 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.2.23 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may

be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to transfers and relocation.

29.2.25 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.2.26 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to transfers and relocation.

29.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.2.29 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.2.30 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "transfers and relocation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

29.2.31 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.2.34 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. **[New in v2.0]**

29.3 Eligibility and Applicability

29.3.1 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

29.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for transfers and relocation restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.3.3 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. †

29.3.4 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

29.3.5 Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

29.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

29.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.3.9 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.3.10 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for transfers and relocation restricted until the matter is concluded.

29.3.11 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

29.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

29.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.3.14 Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.3.16 Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.3.17 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

29.3.18 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.3.19 Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.3.21 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.3.22 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

29.3.23 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.3.24 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.3.25 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.3.26 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

29.3.27 Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.3.28 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on transfers and relocation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

29.3.30 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.3.31 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.3.32 Eligibility for transfers and relocation shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

29.3.33 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.4 Responsibilities of Employees

29.4.1 The employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on transfers and relocation and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.4.4 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

29.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of transfers and relocation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on transfers and relocation and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

29.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

29.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with transfers and relocation.

29.4.10 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on transfers and relocation and shall comply with them at all times. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

29.4.11 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on transfers and relocation and shall comply with them at all times. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

29.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

29.4.13 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

29.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of transfers and relocation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

29.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts.

29.4.16 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of transfers and relocation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with transfers and relocation.

29.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

29.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

29.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

29.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of transfers and relocation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written

request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

29.4.23 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with transfers and relocation.

29.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of transfers and relocation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

29.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

29.4.26 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on transfers and relocation and shall comply with them at all times.

29.4.28 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of transfers and relocation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.4.30 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts.

29.4.31 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to transfers and relocation and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they

are sent by e-mail.

29.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on transfers and relocation and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

29.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

29.5.1 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on transfers and relocation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on transfers and relocation.

29.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.5.4 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.5.5 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to transfers and relocation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

29.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

29.5.7 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations

and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.5.8 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on transfers and relocation and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.5.9 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on transfers and relocation and applies them consistently.

29.5.10 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on transfers and relocation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

29.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on transfers and relocation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

29.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to transfers and relocation to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on transfers and relocation and applies them consistently.

29.5.14 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to transfers and relocation within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.5.15 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

29.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.5.18 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.5.21 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on transfers and relocation and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.5.22 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.5.23 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

29.5.24 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

29.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on transfers and relocation.

29.5.26 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to transfers and relocation within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed

strictly by all concerned.

29.5.27 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to transfers and relocation within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.5.28 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to transfers and relocation within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

29.5.30 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on transfers and relocation and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.5.31 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on transfers and relocation and applies them consistently. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to transfers and relocation to the HR Director without undue delay.

29.5.32 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on transfers and relocation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on transfers and relocation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

29.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to transfers and relocation and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

29.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 10 working days of receipt.

29.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.6.5 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

29.6.6 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to transfers and relocation.

29.6.7 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 21 working days of receipt. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.6.8 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 21 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for transfers and relocation and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

29.6.10 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to transfers and relocation and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.6.11 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

29.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

29.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 7 working days of receipt. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

29.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 3 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. †

29.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to transfers and relocation.

29.6.18 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

29.6.19 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.6.20 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 15 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.6.22 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to transfers and relocation. Where a provision of this

Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.6.23 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.6.25 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to transfers and relocation. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to transfers and relocation and on the applicable legal requirements.

29.6.26 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to transfers and relocation. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for transfers and relocation and shall make them available to all employees.

29.6.27 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.6.28 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 14 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for transfers and relocation and shall make them available to all employees.

29.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 2 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with transfers and relocation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

29.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 5 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on transfers and relocation within 10 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

29.6.32 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

29.7 Procedure and Process Steps

29.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.7.3 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

29.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.7.6 The employee shall initiate the process relating to transfers and relocation by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager.

29.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

29.7.8 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

29.7.9 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.7.10 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

29.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

29.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.7.15 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

29.7.16 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

29.7.18 The employee shall initiate the process relating to transfers and relocation by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 3 working days of receiving it.

29.7.19 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.7.20 The employee shall initiate the process relating to transfers and relocation by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

29.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.7.23 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

29.7.26 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.7.27 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure

prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to transfers and relocation by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

29.7.31 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 3 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

29.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

29.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

29.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to transfers and relocation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

29.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

29.8.3 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.8.6 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. All documents relating to transfers and relocation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

29.8.7 Records relating to transfers and relocation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.8.8 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

29.8.11 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

29.8.12 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.8.13 All documents relating to transfers and relocation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.8.14 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to transfers and relocation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. †

29.8.15 All documents relating to transfers and relocation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

29.8.17 Records relating to transfers and relocation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.8.18 Records relating to transfers and relocation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

29.8.20 All documents relating to transfers and relocation shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

29.8.21 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

29.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.8.23 Records relating to transfers and relocation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

29.8.25 All documents relating to transfers and relocation shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to transfers and relocation that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

29.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.8.27 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.8.28 Records relating to transfers and relocation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

29.8.29 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to transfers and relocation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

29.8.30 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.8.31 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

29.8.33 Records relating to transfers and relocation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.8.34 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. **[New in v2.0]**

29.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

29.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.9.2 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

29.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

29.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.9.5 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

29.9.7 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.9.9 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.9.11 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

29.9.12 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

29.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.9.15 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

29.9.16 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

29.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision

shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

29.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

29.9.21 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.9.23 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

29.9.24 Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

29.9.27 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

29.9.28 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

29.9.29 Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.9.30 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.9.31 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on transfers and relocation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

29.9.32 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

29.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

29.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

29.10.1 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.10.2 Where an external regulator requests information concerning transfers and relocation, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to transfers and relocation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.10.5 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.10.6 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.10.7 Where an external regulator requests information concerning transfers and relocation, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

29.10.8 An internal audit of transfers and relocation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.10.9 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.10.10 An internal audit of transfers and relocation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.10.11 An internal audit of transfers and relocation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

29.10.12 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.10.13 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.10.14 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Compliance with the provisions on

transfers and relocation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

29.10.15 An internal audit of transfers and relocation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

29.10.16 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to transfers and relocation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.10.17 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Compliance with the provisions on transfers and relocation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

29.10.18 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to transfers and relocation. †

29.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Compliance with the provisions on transfers and relocation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

29.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning transfers and relocation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.10.21 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Compliance with the provisions on transfers and relocation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

29.10.22 An internal audit of transfers and relocation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

29.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.10.24 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to transfers and relocation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

29.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.10.27 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.10.28 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.10.29 Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

29.10.30 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to transfers and relocation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance data relating to transfers and relocation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

29.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on transfers and relocation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

29.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.10.33 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

29.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

29.11.2 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to transfers and relocation shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

29.11.5 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.11.6 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

29.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

29.11.9 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on transfers and relocation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.11.11 A failure to comply with the provisions on transfers and relocation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to

transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

29.11.12 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to transfers and relocation shall be treated as serious misconduct. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.11.14 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.11.15 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

29.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to transfers and relocation shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

29.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

29.11.19 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.11.21 A failure to comply with the provisions on transfers and relocation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

29.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.11.23 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.11.25 A failure to comply with the provisions on transfers and relocation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

29.11.26 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to transfers and relocation shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.11.27 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to transfers and relocation shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

29.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.11.30 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to transfers and relocation shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

29.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

29.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to

transfers and relocation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

29.11.33 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

29.12 Review and Amendment

29.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

29.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

29.12.4 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

29.12.5 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

29.12.6 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on transfers and relocation through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

29.12.7 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on transfers and relocation through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on transfers and relocation through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their

situation. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

29.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

29.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

29.12.11 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.12.12 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

29.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

29.12.14 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

29.12.16 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

29.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

29.12.18 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right

under this Chapter in good faith.

29.12.19 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

29.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on transfers and relocation through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.12.21 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

29.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.12.23 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

29.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.12.25 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

29.12.26 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

29.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to transfers and relocation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

29.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for

exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

29.12.29 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

29.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

29.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

29.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

29.12.33 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to transfers and relocation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

Chapter 30

Secondments and Deputation

30.1 Purpose and Scope

30.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.1.2 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.1.3 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

30.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

30.1.5 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.1.6 The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

30.1.7 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

30.1.9 The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

30.1.10 The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.1.11 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

30.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation.

30.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to secondments and deputation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.1.15 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation.

30.1.16 The objective of these provisions on secondments and deputation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

30.1.17 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.1.18 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to secondments and deputation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

30.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to secondments and deputation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. These provisions

apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

30.1.20 The objective of these provisions on secondments and deputation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation.

30.1.21 The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

30.1.22 The objective of these provisions on secondments and deputation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The objective of these provisions on secondments and deputation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

30.1.24 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

30.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to secondments and deputation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

30.1.27 The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.1.28 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The objective of these provisions on secondments and deputation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

30.1.29 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to secondments and deputation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

30.1.30 The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation.

30.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.1.32 The Company recognises that secondments and deputation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

30.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on secondments and deputation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

30.1.34 The objective of these provisions on secondments and deputation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. **[New in v2.0]**

30.2 Definitions and Interpretation

30.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.2.2 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation.

30.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation.

30.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

30.2.5 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.2.6 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation.

30.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

30.2.9 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

30.2.10 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.2.12 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "secondments and deputation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.2.13 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This

requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

30.2.14 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.2.15 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "secondments and deputation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

30.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.2.17 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

30.2.18 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

30.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are

unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.2.22 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "secondments and deputation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

30.2.23 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

30.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "secondments and deputation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. †

30.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.2.26 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to secondments and deputation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

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30.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the

department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.2.32 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

30.3 Eligibility and Applicability

30.3.1 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for secondments and deputation shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

30.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for secondments and deputation restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

30.3.3 Eligibility for secondments and deputation shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

30.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

30.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

30.3.6 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on secondments and deputation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.3.7 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

30.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.3.9 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for secondments and deputation restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.3.10 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

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30.3.16 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. †

30.3.17 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on secondments and deputation. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

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30.3.20 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for secondments and deputation restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

30.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.3.22 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.3.23 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.3.24 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on secondments and deputation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

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personal e-mail address on record.

30.3.26 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

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30.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on secondments and deputation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.3.30 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for secondments and deputation restricted until the matter is concluded.

30.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on secondments and deputation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

30.3.33 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

30.4 Responsibilities of Employees

30.4.1 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

30.4.2 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. †

30.4.3 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with secondments and deputation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to secondments and deputation and shall not withhold material facts.

30.4.4 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

30.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

30.4.7 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

30.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with secondments and deputation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to secondments and deputation and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.4.10 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with secondments and deputation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

30.4.12 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

30.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.4.14 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

30.4.15 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on secondments and deputation and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.4.16 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

30.4.17 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with secondments and deputation.

30.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on secondments and deputation and shall comply with them at all times.

30.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with secondments and deputation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

30.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

30.4.22 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on secondments and deputation and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on secondments and deputation and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

30.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on secondments and deputation and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

30.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with secondments and deputation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

30.4.27 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

30.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

30.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

30.4.30 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

30.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of secondments and deputation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

30.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on secondments and deputation and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to secondments and deputation and shall not withhold material facts.

30.4.33 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.4.34 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with secondments and deputation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. **[New in v2.0]**

30.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

30.5.1 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to secondments and deputation within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on secondments and deputation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on secondments and deputation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is

intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.5.5 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to secondments and deputation within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

30.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.5.8 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on secondments and deputation and applies them consistently.

30.5.10 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on secondments and deputation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation.

30.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

30.5.12 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on secondments and deputation and applies them consistently.

30.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.5.15 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.5.16 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

30.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.5.18 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on secondments and deputation and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation.

30.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

30.5.20 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation.

30.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on secondments and deputation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.5.22 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.5.23 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.5.25 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation.

30.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.5.27 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation.

30.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the HR Director without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to secondments and deputation within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

30.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

30.5.30 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Line Managers shall

attend the training offered by HR on secondments and deputation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

30.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.5.32 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on secondments and deputation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.5.33 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to secondments and deputation to the HR Director without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

30.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

30.6.1 HR shall respond to every written query on secondments and deputation within 30 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.6.2 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.6.4 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for secondments and deputation and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with secondments and deputation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to secondments and deputation and on the applicable legal requirements.

30.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with secondments and deputation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

30.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.6.9 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with secondments and deputation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.6.10 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

30.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.6.12 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to secondments and deputation and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation.

30.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with secondments and deputation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

30.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on secondments and deputation within 10 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.6.17 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

30.6.18 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.6.19 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with secondments and deputation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

30.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.6.21 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.6.22 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for secondments and deputation and shall make them available to all employees. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to secondments and deputation and on the applicable legal requirements.

30.6.23 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with secondments and deputation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

30.6.24 HR shall respond to every written query on secondments and deputation within 15 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation.

30.6.25 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with secondments and deputation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. HR shall respond to every written query on secondments and deputation within 5 working days of receipt. †

30.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

30.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.6.30 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.6.31 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for secondments and deputation and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

30.6.32 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.6.33 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for secondments and deputation and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to secondments and deputation. †

30.7 Procedure and Process Steps

30.7.1 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

30.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.7.3 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.7.5 The employee shall initiate the process relating to secondments and deputation by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

30.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 30 working days of receiving it.

30.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.7.9 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.7.10 The employee shall initiate the process relating to secondments and deputation by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

30.7.12 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.7.13 The employee shall initiate the process relating to secondments and deputation by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

30.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

30.7.15 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 7 working days of receiving it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

30.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.7.18 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

30.7.19 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

30.7.20 The employee shall initiate the process relating to secondments and deputation by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. No employee shall be

victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.7.21 The employee shall initiate the process relating to secondments and deputation by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

30.7.22 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

30.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

30.7.24 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

30.7.25 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

30.7.26 The employee shall initiate the process relating to secondments and deputation by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to secondments and deputation by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

30.7.28 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 2 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

30.7.29 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of

each case.

30.7.30 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.7.31 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

30.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.7.33 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

30.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

30.8.1 All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to secondments and deputation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. †

30.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

30.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.8.5 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision

reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to secondments and deputation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

30.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.8.8 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

30.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

30.8.10 All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

30.8.12 Records relating to secondments and deputation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

30.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.8.16 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each

case.

30.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.8.18 Records relating to secondments and deputation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.8.20 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.8.21 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.8.22 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to secondments and deputation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

30.8.24 Records relating to secondments and deputation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

30.8.25 All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.8.26 All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.8.27 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

30.8.28 All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

30.8.29 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.8.30 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to secondments and deputation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.8.32 All documents relating to secondments and deputation shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.8.33 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

30.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

30.9.1 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

30.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.9.3 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of

illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

30.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

30.9.5 Exceptions to the provisions on secondments and deputation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. †

30.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

30.9.8 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

30.9.10 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.9.12 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

30.9.13 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.9.14 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

30.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.9.16 Exceptions to the provisions on secondments and deputation may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.9.17 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

30.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

30.9.20 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.9.21 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

30.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the

following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.9.24 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

30.9.25 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

30.9.26 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

30.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

30.9.28 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

30.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on secondments and deputation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

30.9.31 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Reporting

Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

30.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

30.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

30.10.1 Where an external regulator requests information concerning secondments and deputation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

30.10.2 Compliance data relating to secondments and deputation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to secondments and deputation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

30.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

30.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.10.6 An internal audit of secondments and deputation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.10.7 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.10.8 Compliance data relating to secondments and deputation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter

shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where an external regulator requests information concerning secondments and deputation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

30.10.9 Where an external regulator requests information concerning secondments and deputation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

30.10.10 Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

30.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to secondments and deputation.

30.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.10.14 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

30.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.10.16 Compliance data relating to secondments and deputation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.10.17 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to secondments and deputation. Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

30.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning secondments and deputation, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning secondments and deputation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

30.10.23 Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.10.24 Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

30.10.25 An internal audit of secondments and deputation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning secondments and deputation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to secondments and deputation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

30.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning secondments and deputation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.10.29 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to secondments and deputation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Compliance with the provisions on secondments and deputation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

30.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.10.31 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

30.10.32 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Compliance data relating to secondments and deputation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

30.10.33 An internal audit of secondments and deputation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

30.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

30.11.1 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

30.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to secondments and deputation shall be treated as serious misconduct.

30.11.3 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.11.4 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their

situation.

30.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.11.6 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.11.7 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

30.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.11.9 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

30.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.11.11 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to secondments and deputation shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to secondments and deputation shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

30.11.13 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

30.11.14 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

30.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

30.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

30.11.17 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

30.11.18 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.11.20 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. †

30.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

30.11.23 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than

punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. †

30.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to secondments and deputation shall be treated as serious misconduct.

30.11.26 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

30.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

30.11.29 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to secondments and deputation shall be treated as serious misconduct. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.11.30 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.11.31 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to secondments and deputation shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

30.11.32 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary

action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

30.11.33 A failure to comply with the provisions on secondments and deputation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

30.12 Review and Amendment

30.12.1 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.12.2 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

30.12.3 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.12.4 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

30.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

30.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

30.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.12.8 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.12.9 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

30.12.10 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

30.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on secondments and deputation through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. †

30.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

30.12.14 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

30.12.15 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

30.12.16 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

30.12.17 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on secondments and deputation through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that

spirit.

30.12.18 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.12.19 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on secondments and deputation through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

30.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on secondments and deputation through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to secondments and deputation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

30.12.21 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

30.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to secondments and deputation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

30.12.24 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

30.12.25 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

30.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of

illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

30.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

30.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

30.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

30.12.30 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

30.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

30.12.32 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

30.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

Chapter 31

Resignation and Notice

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Notice period	30 days	**60 days**
Senior notice period	60 days	**90 days**

31.1 Purpose and Scope

31.1.1 The Company recognises that resignation and notice has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.1.3 The Company recognises that resignation and notice has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.1.4 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

31.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

31.1.7 The objective of these provisions on resignation and notice is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

31.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.1.9 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

31.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.1.11 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

31.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.1.15 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.1.16 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to resignation and notice and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

31.1.18 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to resignation and notice and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

31.1.19 The objective of these provisions on resignation and notice is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

31.1.20 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent,

the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The objective of these provisions on resignation and notice is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. †

31.1.22 The objective of these provisions on resignation and notice is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.1.23 The Company recognises that resignation and notice has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The objective of these provisions on resignation and notice is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

31.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to resignation and notice and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

31.1.27 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on resignation and notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

31.1.28 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to resignation and notice and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.1.29 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to resignation and notice and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

31.1.30 The Company recognises that resignation and notice has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.1.31 The objective of these provisions on resignation and notice is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

31.1.32 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to resignation and notice and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.1.33 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.2 Definitions and Interpretation

31.2.1 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

31.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to resignation and notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

31.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.2.6 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

31.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to resignation and notice.

31.2.9 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

31.2.10 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to resignation and notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.2.11 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

31.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.2.13 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

31.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "resignation and notice" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

31.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.2.16 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.2.17 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "resignation and notice" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

31.2.18 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

31.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

31.2.21 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "resignation and notice" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.2.22 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

31.2.23 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

31.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

31.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "resignation and notice" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

31.2.26 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

31.2.27 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.2.28 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to resignation and notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

31.2.29 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "resignation and notice" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

31.2.31 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

31.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

31.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.3 Eligibility and Applicability

31.3.1 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.3.2 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

31.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.3.4 Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.3.5 Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

31.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for resignation and notice restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

31.3.8 Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

31.3.10 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

31.3.11 Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

31.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.3.13 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

31.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

31.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

31.3.17 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

31.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.3.19 Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is

more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

31.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

31.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

31.3.22 Eligibility for resignation and notice shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

31.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice.

31.3.24 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.3.25 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for resignation and notice restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.3.26 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.3.27 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for resignation and notice restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

31.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for resignation and notice restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

31.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for resignation and notice restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.3.31 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

31.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on resignation and notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

31.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

31.4 Responsibilities of Employees

31.4.1 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.4.3 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

31.4.4 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

31.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

31.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to resignation and notice and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

31.4.7 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

31.4.8 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on resignation and notice and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with resignation and notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.4.11 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on resignation and notice and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.4.12 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

31.4.14 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Each employee shall familiarise

themselves with the provisions on resignation and notice and shall comply with them at all times.

31.4.16 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with resignation and notice. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. †

31.4.17 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

31.4.18 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. †

31.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.4.20 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to resignation and notice and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

31.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

31.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with resignation and notice. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

31.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to resignation and notice and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on resignation and notice and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall

prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.4.26 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

31.4.27 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on resignation and notice and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

31.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of resignation and notice as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

31.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on resignation and notice and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.4.30 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with resignation and notice.

31.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on resignation and notice and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. The staff member shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

31.4.33 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

31.5.1 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on resignation and notice and applies them consistently.

31.5.2 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on resignation and notice and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on resignation and notice and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. †

31.5.3 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on resignation and notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.5.4 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on resignation and notice and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on resignation and notice and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

31.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.5.7 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on resignation and notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.5.8 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on resignation and notice and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

31.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

31.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply

this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

31.5.11 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to resignation and notice within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

31.5.13 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on resignation and notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

31.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on resignation and notice and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.5.15 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Policy Committee without undue delay. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on resignation and notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.5.18 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

31.5.19 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

31.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on resignation and notice and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.5.21 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

31.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on resignation and notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to resignation and notice within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. †

31.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

31.5.25 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on resignation and notice and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

31.5.27 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on resignation and notice and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on resignation and notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail

address on record.

31.5.29 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on resignation and notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.5.30 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

31.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to resignation and notice within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

31.5.32 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to resignation and notice to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

31.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to resignation and notice within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

31.6.1 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to resignation and notice and on the applicable legal requirements.

31.6.3 HR shall respond to every written query on resignation and notice within 15 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose

of calculating time limits.

31.6.4 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to resignation and notice and on the applicable legal requirements.

31.6.5 HR shall respond to every written query on resignation and notice within 30 working days of receipt. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice.

31.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for resignation and notice and shall make them available to all employees. HR shall respond to every written query on resignation and notice within 30 working days of receipt.

31.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to resignation and notice and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

31.6.9 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on resignation and notice within 15 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

31.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with resignation and notice in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

31.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.6.13 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

31.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the

concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

31.6.15 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with resignation and notice in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

31.6.16 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to resignation and notice and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

31.6.18 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with resignation and notice in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

31.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

31.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.6.21 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for resignation and notice and shall make them available to all employees. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

31.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on resignation and notice within 3 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.6.23 HR shall respond to every written query on resignation and notice within 2 working days of receipt. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for resignation and notice and shall make them available to all employees.

31.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.6.25 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice. No employee shall be victimised

or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with resignation and notice in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

31.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.6.28 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for resignation and notice and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to resignation and notice.

31.6.29 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with resignation and notice in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

31.6.30 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for resignation and notice and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

31.6.31 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to resignation and notice and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with resignation and notice in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

31.7 Procedure and Process Steps

31.7.1 **Notice period.** Employees below the Senior Manager grade shall serve a notice period of 60 days. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 30 days]**

31.7.2 **Senior notice period.** Employees at Senior Manager grade and above shall serve a notice period of 90 days. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 60 days]**

31.7.3 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.7.4 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 7 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department.

31.7.5 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

31.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.7.7 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.7.8 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.7.9 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager.

31.7.10 The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By

way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

31.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

31.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.7.14 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 14 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

31.7.15 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 3 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

31.7.16 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.7.19 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne

by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

31.7.21 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

31.7.22 The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

31.7.25 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

31.7.26 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.7.27 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

31.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For

instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

31.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

31.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

31.7.31 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

31.7.33 The employee shall initiate the process relating to resignation and notice by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

31.7.34 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

31.7.35 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

31.8.1 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to resignation and notice that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

31.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to resignation and notice that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

31.8.3 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

31.8.4 Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

31.8.5 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.8.6 Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.8.7 Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

31.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.8.9 All documents relating to resignation and notice shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

31.8.10 All documents relating to resignation and notice shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

31.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to resignation and notice that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

31.8.12 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.8.13 All documents relating to resignation and notice shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to resignation and notice that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.8.15 Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

31.8.18 Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. †

31.8.19 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

31.8.20 Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.8.21 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to resignation and notice that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated

as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

31.8.22 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.8.23 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

31.8.24 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

31.8.25 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

31.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to resignation and notice that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

31.8.28 Records relating to resignation and notice shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. All documents relating to resignation and notice shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

31.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be

treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. All documents relating to resignation and notice shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

31.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

31.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.9.2 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

31.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

31.9.4 Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

31.9.5 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

31.9.6 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

31.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.9.8 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

31.9.9 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

31.9.10 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

31.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

31.9.12 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

31.9.13 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

31.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted

in that spirit.

31.9.15 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.9.16 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

31.9.17 Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

31.9.20 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

31.9.21 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

31.9.23 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.9.24 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

31.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

31.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

31.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

31.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

31.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.9.30 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.9.31 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. †

31.9.32 Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.9.33 Exceptions to the provisions on resignation and notice may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

31.10.1 Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to resignation and notice. Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

31.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning resignation and notice, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.10.5 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to resignation and notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.10.6 Compliance with the provisions on resignation and notice shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

31.10.7 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where an external regulator requests information concerning resignation and notice, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

31.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

31.10.9 Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.10.10 Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

31.10.11 Where an external regulator requests information concerning resignation and notice, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.10.12 Where an external regulator requests information concerning resignation and notice, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

31.10.13 Where an external regulator requests information concerning resignation and notice, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

31.10.14 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.10.15 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

31.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

31.10.17 Compliance with the provisions on resignation and notice shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.10.18 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

31.10.19 Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.10.20 An internal audit of resignation and notice shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.10.21 Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.10.22 Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

31.10.23 An internal audit of resignation and notice shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance with the provisions on resignation and notice shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

31.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning resignation and notice, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.10.25 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning resignation and notice, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.10.27 Compliance with the provisions on resignation and notice shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.10.28 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

31.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Compliance with the provisions on resignation and notice shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

31.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

31.10.31 An internal audit of resignation and notice shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. An internal audit of resignation and notice shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

31.10.33 Compliance data relating to resignation and notice shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

31.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

31.11.2 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on resignation and notice may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

31.11.4 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

31.11.5 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

31.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

31.11.8 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.11.9 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to resignation and notice shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

31.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

31.11.12 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

31.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to resignation and notice shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.11.14 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.11.15 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to resignation and notice shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

31.11.16 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to resignation and notice shall be treated as serious misconduct. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to resignation and notice shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A failure to comply with the provisions on resignation and notice may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

31.11.18 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.11.19 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

31.11.20 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if

they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

31.11.21 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.11.22 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

31.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

31.11.24 A failure to comply with the provisions on resignation and notice may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.11.25 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.11.26 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

31.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.11.28 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

31.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

31.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.11.31 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

31.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on resignation and notice may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.11.33 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to resignation and notice shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.12 Review and Amendment

31.12.1 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.12.2 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

31.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.12.4 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

31.12.5 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

31.12.9 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

31.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect.

31.12.12 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.12.13 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.12.14 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

31.12.15 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

31.12.16 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect.

31.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

31.12.18 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

31.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

31.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

31.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

31.12.22 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.12.23 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

31.12.24 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

31.12.25 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

31.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect.

31.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

31.12.28 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

31.12.29 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

31.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to resignation and notice made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

31.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to resignation and notice, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

31.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

31.12.33 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on resignation and notice through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

Chapter 32

Termination and Redundancy

32.1 Purpose and Scope

32.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to termination and redundancy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

32.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.1.4 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy.

32.1.5 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.1.6 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

32.1.7 The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

32.1.9 The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This

Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy.

32.1.10 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to termination and redundancy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.1.12 The objective of these provisions on termination and redundancy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.1.14 The objective of these provisions on termination and redundancy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

32.1.15 The objective of these provisions on termination and redundancy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to termination and redundancy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

32.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy.

32.1.17 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy.

32.1.18 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The objective of

these provisions on termination and redundancy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

32.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to termination and redundancy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.1.20 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to termination and redundancy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.1.22 The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy.

32.1.23 The objective of these provisions on termination and redundancy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.1.24 The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

32.1.25 The objective of these provisions on termination and redundancy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to termination and redundancy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

32.1.27 The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear

on termination and redundancy.

32.1.28 The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

32.1.29 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to termination and redundancy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

32.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.1.31 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.1.32 The Company recognises that termination and redundancy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

32.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on termination and redundancy. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.2 Definitions and Interpretation

32.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to termination and redundancy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

32.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the

staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

32.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to termination and redundancy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

32.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to termination and redundancy.

32.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

32.2.8 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

32.2.12 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to termination and redundancy. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.2.13 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the

employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.2.14 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.2.15 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

32.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.2.17 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

32.2.18 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

32.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.2.23 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. For

instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

32.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. †

32.2.26 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

32.2.27 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to termination and redundancy. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

32.2.28 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.2.29 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "termination and redundancy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

32.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

32.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. †

32.2.32 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to termination and redundancy. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.2.33 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to termination and redundancy.

32.3 Eligibility and Applicability

32.3.1 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for termination and redundancy restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on termination and redundancy.

32.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

32.3.5 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. †

32.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

32.3.7 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

32.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.3.9 Eligibility for termination and redundancy shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.3.10 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Eligibility for termination and redundancy shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

32.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for termination and redundancy restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

32.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

32.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

32.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on termination and redundancy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Eligibility for termination and redundancy shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

32.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under

this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.3.17 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

32.3.18 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for termination and redundancy restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

32.3.20 Eligibility for termination and redundancy shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

32.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for termination and redundancy restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.3.22 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

32.3.23 Eligibility for termination and redundancy shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.3.25 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

32.3.26 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

32.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.3.28 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

32.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on termination and redundancy. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for termination and redundancy restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.3.31 Eligibility for termination and redundancy shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for termination and redundancy restricted until the matter is concluded. †

32.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on termination and redundancy. †

32.4 Responsibilities of Employees

32.4.1 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of termination and redundancy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to termination and redundancy and shall not withhold material facts.

32.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.4.3 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

32.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.4.5 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to termination and redundancy and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on termination and redundancy and shall comply with them at all times.

32.4.6 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.4.7 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

32.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.4.10 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to termination and redundancy and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

32.4.12 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.4.13 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on termination and redundancy and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on termination and redundancy and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are

intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to termination and redundancy and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of termination and redundancy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. †

32.4.17 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on termination and redundancy and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.4.18 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with termination and redundancy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.4.19 The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

32.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to termination and redundancy and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with termination and redundancy.

32.4.22 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of termination and redundancy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.4.23 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of termination and redundancy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be

declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

32.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

32.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.4.26 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to termination and redundancy and shall not withhold material facts. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

32.4.27 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of termination and redundancy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with termination and redundancy.

32.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of termination and redundancy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.4.29 The employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.4.30 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.4.31 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to termination and redundancy and shall not withhold material facts. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on termination and redundancy and shall comply with them at all times. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

32.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with termination and redundancy. Employees should seek guidance from

HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

32.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

32.5.1 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.5.2 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on termination and redundancy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

32.5.3 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

32.5.4 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.5.5 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

32.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.5.7 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.5.8 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to termination and redundancy to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

32.5.9 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless

this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to termination and redundancy to the HR Director without undue delay.

32.5.10 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on termination and redundancy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to termination and redundancy to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

32.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on termination and redundancy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.5.12 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

32.5.13 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

32.5.14 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to termination and redundancy to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

32.5.15 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on termination and redundancy. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

32.5.16 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to termination and redundancy to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to termination and redundancy to the HR Director without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

32.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the

Company decides otherwise. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

32.5.19 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

32.5.20 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on termination and redundancy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.5.21 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.5.22 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on termination and redundancy. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on termination and redundancy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

32.5.24 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on termination and redundancy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

32.5.25 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.5.26 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on termination and redundancy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to termination and redundancy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

32.5.27 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

†

32.5.28 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on termination and redundancy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

32.5.29 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on termination and redundancy. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.5.30 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on termination and redundancy and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.5.31 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to termination and redundancy to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.5.33 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on termination and redundancy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

32.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to termination and redundancy and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.6.3 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another

department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 7 working days of receipt.

32.6.4 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to termination and redundancy. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.6.6 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

32.6.7 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to termination and redundancy and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.6.8 HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 30 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

32.6.10 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.6.11 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to termination and redundancy and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

32.6.12 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with termination and redundancy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 5 working days of receipt.

32.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees.

32.6.15 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with termination and redundancy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 10 working days of receipt.

32.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 21 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

32.6.17 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to termination and redundancy and on the applicable legal requirements. †

32.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

32.6.19 HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 21 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.6.20 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to termination and redundancy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 5 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with termination and redundancy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

32.6.22 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with termination and redundancy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies

equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to termination and redundancy. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to termination and redundancy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.6.25 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to termination and redundancy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with termination and redundancy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

32.6.26 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to termination and redundancy and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with termination and redundancy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

32.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.6.28 HR shall respond to every written query on termination and redundancy within 5 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

32.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

32.6.30 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.6.31 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to termination and redundancy. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees.

32.6.32 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to termination and redundancy. †

32.6.33 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for termination and redundancy and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.7 Procedure and Process Steps

32.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.7.2 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.7.3 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

32.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

32.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

32.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.7.9 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.7.10 The employee shall initiate the process relating to termination and redundancy by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. †

32.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

32.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The employee shall initiate the process relating to termination and redundancy by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner.

32.7.15 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to termination and redundancy by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.7.18 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 30 working days of receiving it.

32.7.21 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.7.22 The employee shall initiate the process relating to termination and redundancy by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

32.7.25 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

32.7.26 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less

favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to termination and redundancy by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

32.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to termination and redundancy by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.7.30 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to termination and redundancy by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.7.32 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

32.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

32.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff

member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

32.8.3 All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.8.4 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.8.5 Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to termination and redundancy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

32.8.7 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.8.8 All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

32.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.8.10 Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to termination and redundancy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

32.8.12 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

32.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

32.8.15 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

32.8.17 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to termination and redundancy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.8.19 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.8.21 All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.8.22 Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years.

32.8.23 Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

32.8.24 All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years.

32.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.8.26 Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.8.27 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to termination and redundancy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.8.29 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

32.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

32.8.31 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are

intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Records relating to termination and redundancy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

32.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.8.34 All documents relating to termination and redundancy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. **[New in v2.0]**

32.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

32.9.1 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.9.4 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

32.9.5 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions to the provisions on termination and redundancy may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

32.9.6 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.9.7 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Exceptions to the provisions on termination and redundancy may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

32.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.9.10 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

32.9.11 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.9.12 Exceptions to the provisions on termination and redundancy may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on termination and redundancy may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make

competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.9.18 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice.

32.9.19 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

32.9.22 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.9.23 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on termination and redundancy may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.9.26 Exceptions to the provisions on termination and redundancy may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.9.27 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.9.28 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.9.29 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.9.31 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

32.9.32 Exceptions to the provisions on termination and redundancy may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

32.10.1 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to termination and redundancy. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

32.10.2 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

32.10.3 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to termination and redundancy. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.10.5 Where an external regulator requests information concerning termination and redundancy, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

32.10.6 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

32.10.7 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.10.8 Where an external regulator requests information concerning termination and redundancy, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

32.10.9 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

32.10.10 An internal audit of termination and redundancy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance data relating to termination and redundancy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

32.10.11 Compliance data relating to termination and redundancy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to termination and redundancy. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An internal audit of termination and redundancy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

32.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where

two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance data relating to termination and redundancy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

32.10.14 An internal audit of termination and redundancy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where an external regulator requests information concerning termination and redundancy, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

32.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

32.10.17 Where an external regulator requests information concerning termination and redundancy, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.10.18 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.10.19 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

32.10.20 Compliance data relating to termination and redundancy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.10.21 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall

be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.10.23 An internal audit of termination and redundancy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.10.24 An internal audit of termination and redundancy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.10.25 Compliance data relating to termination and redundancy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

32.10.26 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.10.27 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Compliance data relating to termination and redundancy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

32.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning termination and redundancy, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

32.10.29 Compliance data relating to termination and redundancy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

32.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to termination and redundancy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

32.10.32 Compliance with the provisions on termination and redundancy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall

be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

32.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

32.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.11.2 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to termination and redundancy shall be treated as serious misconduct.

32.11.3 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

32.11.4 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to termination and redundancy shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

32.11.6 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. A failure to comply with the provisions on termination and redundancy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

32.11.7 A failure to comply with the provisions on termination and redundancy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

32.11.8 A failure to comply with the provisions on termination and redundancy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

32.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on termination and redundancy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

32.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

32.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to termination and redundancy shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.11.14 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

32.11.15 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to termination and redundancy shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

32.11.17 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.11.19 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

32.11.20 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

32.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

32.11.22 A failure to comply with the provisions on termination and redundancy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

32.11.23 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.11.24 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

32.11.25 A failure to comply with the provisions on termination and redundancy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

32.11.27 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.11.28 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to termination and redundancy shall be treated as serious misconduct. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

32.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

32.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

32.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to termination and redundancy shall be treated as serious misconduct.

32.11.32 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

32.11.33 A failure to comply with the provisions on termination and redundancy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.11.34 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. **[New in v2.0]**

32.12 Review and Amendment

32.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.12.2 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

32.12.3 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. †

32.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

32.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

32.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

32.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

32.12.10 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

32.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

32.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

32.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

32.12.14 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.12.15 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

32.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to

ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

32.12.17 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

32.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.12.19 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.12.20 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

32.12.21 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

32.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.12.23 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on termination and redundancy through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

32.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

32.12.25 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. As an illustration, a request relating to termination and redundancy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

32.12.26 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were

received.

32.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on termination and redundancy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

32.12.28 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

32.12.29 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

32.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on termination and redundancy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to termination and redundancy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

32.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. †

32.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on termination and redundancy through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect.

32.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

Chapter 33

Exit and Offboarding

33.1 Purpose and Scope

33.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on exit and offboarding. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

33.1.2 The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

33.1.3 The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

33.1.4 The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company recognises that exit and offboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

33.1.5 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to exit and offboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

33.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to exit and offboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on exit and offboarding.

33.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

33.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.1.11 The Company recognises that exit and offboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on exit and offboarding. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

33.1.13 The Company recognises that exit and offboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

33.1.14 The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.1.15 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to exit and offboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.1.16 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.1.17 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.1.18 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on exit and offboarding. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee

shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

33.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

33.1.20 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The Company recognises that exit and offboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

33.1.21 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to exit and offboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.1.23 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.1.24 The Company recognises that exit and offboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

33.1.25 The Company recognises that exit and offboarding has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to exit and offboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.1.27 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.1.28 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

33.1.29 The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.1.30 The objective of these provisions on exit and offboarding is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to exit and offboarding and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.1.33 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

33.2 Definitions and Interpretation

33.2.1 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

33.2.2 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.2.3 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.2.4 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to exit and offboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

33.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to exit and offboarding. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to exit and offboarding. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

33.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

33.2.9 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to exit and offboarding.

33.2.10 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

33.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to exit and offboarding.

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33.2.13 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to exit and offboarding. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term

of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

33.2.14 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "exit and offboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

33.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

33.2.17 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

33.2.18 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "exit and offboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

33.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

33.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision

shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.2.22 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

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33.2.25 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.2.26 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "exit and offboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

33.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "exit and offboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to exit and offboarding.

33.2.29 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "exit and offboarding" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

33.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.2.31 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

33.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

33.3 Eligibility and Applicability

33.3.1 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on exit and offboarding. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for exit and offboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.3.3 Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.3.4 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on exit and offboarding. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

33.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

33.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for exit and offboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

33.3.7 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another

department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on exit and offboarding. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

33.3.9 Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.3.10 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

33.3.11 Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.3.13 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for exit and offboarding restricted until the matter is concluded.

33.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. †

33.3.16 Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed

strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

33.3.17 Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.3.18 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

33.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for exit and offboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.3.22 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on exit and offboarding. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

33.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for exit and offboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.3.26 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

33.3.27 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.3.28 Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for exit and offboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

33.3.30 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

33.3.31 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

33.3.32 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for exit and offboarding restricted until the matter is concluded. Eligibility for exit and offboarding shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

33.4 Responsibilities of Employees

33.4.1 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

33.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

33.4.3 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly

to the HR Operations team or to HR.

33.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of exit and offboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to exit and offboarding and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with exit and offboarding. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

33.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with exit and offboarding. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to exit and offboarding and shall not withhold material facts. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times.

33.4.10 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to exit and offboarding and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

33.4.12 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual

circumstances of each case.

33.4.13 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with exit and offboarding. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.4.15 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to exit and offboarding and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of exit and offboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

33.4.18 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to exit and offboarding and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.4.19 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.4.20 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.4.21 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted

in that spirit.

33.4.22 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.4.23 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.4.25 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

33.4.26 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times.

33.4.27 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of exit and offboarding as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

33.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

33.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.4.31 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on exit and offboarding and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance,

where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with exit and offboarding.

33.4.33 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

33.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.5.2 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on exit and offboarding and applies them consistently. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.5.3 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on exit and offboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on exit and offboarding. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on exit and offboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

33.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to exit and offboarding within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.5.7 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to exit and offboarding within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

33.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on exit and offboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise.

33.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

33.5.10 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on exit and offboarding. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

33.5.11 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on exit and offboarding and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to exit and offboarding to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to exit and offboarding to the HR Director without undue delay.

33.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on exit and offboarding. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on exit and offboarding and applies them consistently.

33.5.15 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on exit and offboarding. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.5.16 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to exit and offboarding within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

33.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to exit and offboarding to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.5.18 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on exit and offboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise.

33.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

33.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to exit and offboarding within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

33.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on exit and offboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to exit and offboarding to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

33.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on exit and offboarding. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on exit and offboarding. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.5.25 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on exit and offboarding and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.5.26 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.5.27 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to exit and offboarding within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.5.28 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on exit and offboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on exit and offboarding and applies them consistently.

33.5.29 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to exit and offboarding to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

33.5.30 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on exit and offboarding and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on exit and offboarding and applies them consistently.

33.5.32 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to exit and offboarding within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

33.5.33 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

33.5.34 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. **[New in v2.0]**

33.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

33.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 7 working days of receipt.

33.6.2 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

33.6.3 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

33.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to exit and offboarding. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

33.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

33.6.7 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to exit and offboarding and on the applicable legal requirements.

33.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

33.6.9 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. †

33.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.6.13 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees.

33.6.15 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to exit and offboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 2 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 14 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

33.6.18 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.6.20 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to exit and offboarding.

33.6.21 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to exit and offboarding. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

33.6.22 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to exit and offboarding. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

33.6.24 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to exit and offboarding and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 7 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.6.27 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to exit and offboarding. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.6.28 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

33.6.29 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 10 working days of receipt.

33.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 30 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.6.31 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to exit and offboarding and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request

after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

33.6.32 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

33.6.33 HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 30 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for exit and offboarding and shall make them available to all employees.

33.6.34 HR shall respond to every written query on exit and offboarding within 30 working days of receipt. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with exit and offboarding in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. **[New in v2.0]**

33.7 Procedure and Process Steps

33.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

33.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

33.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.7.5 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

33.7.6 The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall

prevail.

33.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

33.7.8 The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

33.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.7.10 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department.

33.7.11 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager.

33.7.12 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 15 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

33.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

33.7.17 The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

33.7.18 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

33.7.19 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

33.7.22 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it.

33.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories

unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.7.25 The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

33.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

33.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

33.7.28 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to exit and offboarding by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager.

33.7.31 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.7.32 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

33.7.33 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

33.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

33.8.1 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Records relating to exit and offboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

33.8.3 Records relating to exit and offboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

33.8.4 All documents relating to exit and offboarding shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.8.5 Records relating to exit and offboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to exit and offboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to exit and offboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

33.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.8.9 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.8.10 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if

they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.8.11 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to exit and offboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

33.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.8.14 Records relating to exit and offboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.8.15 All documents relating to exit and offboarding shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

33.8.16 All documents relating to exit and offboarding shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.8.17 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Records relating to exit and offboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

33.8.18 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

33.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to exit and offboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

33.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.8.21 All documents relating to exit and offboarding shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

33.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.8.23 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

33.8.24 All documents relating to exit and offboarding shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.8.26 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

33.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

33.8.28 All documents relating to exit and offboarding shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.8.29 Records relating to exit and offboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a

term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

33.8.30 Records relating to exit and offboarding shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.8.31 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to exit and offboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.8.32 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.8.33 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to exit and offboarding that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

33.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

33.9.1 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on exit and offboarding may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

33.9.3 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

33.9.4 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

33.9.5 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.9.8 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

33.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.9.10 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

33.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

33.9.12 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on exit and offboarding may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.9.14 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

33.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on exit and offboarding may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless

the Company decides otherwise.

33.9.16 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.9.17 Exceptions to the provisions on exit and offboarding may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

33.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Exceptions to the provisions on exit and offboarding may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

33.9.19 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

33.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on exit and offboarding may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

33.9.21 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

33.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.9.25 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

33.9.26 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. †

33.9.27 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.9.28 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

33.9.29 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

33.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

33.9.31 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

33.9.32 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

33.9.34 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. **[New in v2.0]**

33.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

33.10.1 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

33.10.2 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

33.10.3 An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

33.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to exit and offboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.10.5 Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.10.6 An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

33.10.7 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

33.10.8 Compliance with the provisions on exit and offboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance data relating to exit and offboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

33.10.9 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to exit and offboarding. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.10.11 An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Compliance data relating to exit and offboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

33.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on exit and offboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.10.13 An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

33.10.14 Compliance with the provisions on exit and offboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.10.15 An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

33.10.16 An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.10.17 Compliance with the provisions on exit and offboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.10.18 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and

inspections that relate to exit and offboarding. †

33.10.19 An internal audit of exit and offboarding shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

33.10.20 Compliance data relating to exit and offboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to exit and offboarding. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

33.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

33.10.26 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.10.27 Compliance data relating to exit and offboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

33.10.28 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having

been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

33.10.29 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

33.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on exit and offboarding shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.10.31 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where an external regulator requests information concerning exit and offboarding, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

33.10.32 Compliance data relating to exit and offboarding shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to exit and offboarding.

33.10.33 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to exit and offboarding. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

33.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

33.11.2 A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

33.11.3 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to exit and offboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct.

33.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to exit and offboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.11.7 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

33.11.8 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

33.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

33.11.10 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to exit and offboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct.

33.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

33.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.11.14 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.11.15 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to exit and offboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.11.16 A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

33.11.17 A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.11.18 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

33.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.11.20 A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.11.21 A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

33.11.22 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

33.11.23 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

33.11.24 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to exit and offboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.11.25 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.11.26 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. A failure to comply with the provisions on exit and offboarding may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

33.11.28 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

33.11.30 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.11.31 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to exit and offboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

33.11.32 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to exit and offboarding shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

33.12 Review and Amendment

33.12.1 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on exit and offboarding through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. As an illustration, a request relating to exit and offboarding made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

33.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to exit and offboarding, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. †

33.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

33.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

33.12.5 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on exit and offboarding through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.12.7 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

33.12.9 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

33.12.10 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

33.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

33.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

33.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

33.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

33.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

33.12.17 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

33.12.18 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

33.12.19 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

33.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

33.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.12.23 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

33.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

33.12.25 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

33.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

33.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

33.12.28 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

33.12.29 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

33.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the

matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on exit and offboarding through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

33.12.31 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

33.12.32 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

33.12.33 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

Chapter 34

Retirement and Post-Employment Obligations

34.1 Purpose and Scope

34.1.1 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.1.2 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to retirement and post-employment obligations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

34.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to retirement and post-employment obligations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.1.4 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to retirement and post-employment obligations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

34.1.5 The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.1.6 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to retirement and post-employment obligations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

34.1.7 The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and

post-employment obligations.

34.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to retirement and post-employment obligations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

34.1.10 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

34.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.1.12 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

34.1.13 The Company recognises that retirement and post-employment obligations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.1.14 The Company recognises that retirement and post-employment obligations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.1.15 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to retirement and post-employment obligations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

34.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.1.18 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.1.19 The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.1.20 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.1.21 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.1.22 The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

34.1.23 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.1.24 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to retirement and post-employment obligations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company recognises that retirement and post-employment obligations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

34.1.25 The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.1.26 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.1.27 The Company recognises that retirement and post-employment obligations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.1.28 The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.1.29 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.1.30 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.1.31 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on retirement and post-employment obligations. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

34.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

34.1.33 The objective of these provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

34.2 Definitions and Interpretation

34.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

34.2.2 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.2.3 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under

this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

34.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.2.5 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.2.6 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.2.7 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

34.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.2.13 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "retirement and post-employment obligations" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

34.2.14 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to retirement and post-employment obligations. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

34.2.15 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.2.16 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "retirement and post-employment obligations" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.2.17 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.2.18 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.2.20 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.2.21 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to retirement and post-employment obligations. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.2.22 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "retirement and post-employment obligations" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.2.23 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.2.24 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

34.2.25 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.2.27 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

34.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.2.30 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. †

34.2.31 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

34.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.3 Eligibility and Applicability

34.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

34.3.2 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.3.3 Eligibility for retirement and post-employment obligations shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for retirement and post-employment obligations restricted until the matter is concluded.

34.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for retirement and post-employment obligations restricted until the matter is concluded.

34.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.3.8 Eligibility for retirement and post-employment obligations shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

34.3.9 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for retirement and post-employment obligations restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

34.3.10 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

34.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

34.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.3.13 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

34.3.14 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

34.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where eligibility is disputed,

the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

34.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

34.3.20 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for retirement and post-employment obligations restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.3.21 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for retirement and post-employment obligations restricted until the matter is concluded.

34.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.3.23 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

34.3.25 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

34.3.26 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.3.27 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.3.28 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of

the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

34.3.29 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.3.30 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.3.32 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.4 Responsibilities of Employees

34.4.1 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.4.4 The employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

34.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall

be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.4.7 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.4.8 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of retirement and post-employment obligations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts.

34.4.9 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall comply with them at all times.

34.4.10 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts.

34.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of retirement and post-employment obligations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

34.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.4.13 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts.

34.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.4.15 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.4.16 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall comply with them at all times.

34.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.4.19 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.4.20 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of retirement and post-employment obligations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

34.4.21 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the

requests were received.

34.4.22 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

34.4.23 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

34.4.24 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of retirement and post-employment obligations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

34.4.27 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.4.28 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

34.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of retirement and post-employment obligations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual

circumstances of each case.

34.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.4.31 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.4.32 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

34.4.33 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

34.5.1 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

34.5.2 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.5.3 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

34.5.4 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to retirement and post-employment obligations to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.5.5 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to retirement and post-employment obligations to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and applies them consistently.

34.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to retirement and post-employment obligations to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

34.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to retirement and post-employment obligations to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Line Managers are

accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to retirement and post-employment obligations to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

34.5.15 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

34.5.17 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to retirement and post-employment obligations to the HR Director without undue delay.

34.5.18 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

34.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.5.20 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.5.21 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.5.22 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a decision of a Line Manager

may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

34.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on retirement and post-employment obligations. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.5.26 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.5.27 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

34.5.28 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

34.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

34.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on retirement and post-employment obligations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.5.32 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

34.5.33 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement

applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

34.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees.

34.6.2 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees.

34.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

34.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

34.6.6 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements. HR shall respond to every written query on retirement and post-employment obligations within 10 working days of receipt.

34.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on retirement and post-employment obligations within 10 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

34.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

34.6.12 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.6.13 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.6.15 HR shall respond to every written query on retirement and post-employment obligations within 30 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

34.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on retirement and post-employment obligations within 10 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and

post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. †

34.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

34.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.6.20 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.6.21 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.6.22 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements.

34.6.23 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

34.6.24 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.6.25 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to retirement and post-employment obligations. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail

address on record.

34.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.6.27 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.6.28 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements.

34.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.6.30 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to retirement and post-employment obligations and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

34.6.31 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for retirement and post-employment obligations and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with retirement and post-employment obligations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

34.7 Procedure and Process Steps

34.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The employee shall initiate the process relating to retirement and post-employment obligations by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner.

34.7.8 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 3 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.7.9 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.7.10 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The employee shall initiate the process relating to retirement and post-employment obligations by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner.

34.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

34.7.13 The employee shall initiate the process relating to retirement and post-employment obligations by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to retirement and post-employment obligations by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The employee shall initiate the process relating to retirement and post-employment obligations by submitting a written request to the Line Manager.

34.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.7.19 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

34.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An

example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

34.7.21 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

34.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.7.23 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

34.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to retirement and post-employment obligations by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

34.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.7.27 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to retirement and post-employment obligations by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

34.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

34.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

34.7.31 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.7.32 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

34.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

34.7.34 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. **[New in v2.0]**

34.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

34.8.1 Records relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

34.8.2 Records relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.8.3 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Records

shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. †

34.8.4 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

34.8.5 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. All documents relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. †

34.8.6 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.8.8 Records relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.8.9 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

34.8.10 All documents relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.8.11 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

34.8.12 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall

continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

34.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

34.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

34.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.8.17 Records relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

34.8.18 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.8.19 Records relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

34.8.20 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

34.8.21 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.8.22 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line

Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.8.23 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. All documents relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

34.8.25 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

34.8.26 All documents relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

34.8.27 Records relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.8.28 All documents relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. †

34.8.30 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.8.31 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

34.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to retirement and post-employment obligations that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

34.8.34 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. **[New in v2.0]**

34.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

34.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

34.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

34.9.3 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

34.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

34.9.6 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.9.8 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

34.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.9.11 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.9.12 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.9.13 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

34.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.9.15 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the

concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

34.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.9.18 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

34.9.19 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

34.9.20 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

34.9.22 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.9.23 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.9.25 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Exceptions to the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

34.9.26 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.9.27 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have

regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.9.31 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

34.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

34.10.1 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.10.3 Compliance data relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

34.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning retirement and post-employment obligations, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

34.10.5 An internal audit of retirement and post-employment obligations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.10.6 Compliance data relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

34.10.7 Compliance data relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.10.10 An internal audit of retirement and post-employment obligations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

34.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.10.12 An internal audit of retirement and post-employment obligations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.10.13 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

34.10.14 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.10.15 Compliance with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all

concerned. Where an external regulator requests information concerning retirement and post-employment obligations, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

34.10.16 Where an external regulator requests information concerning retirement and post-employment obligations, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.10.18 An internal audit of retirement and post-employment obligations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

34.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.10.20 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.10.21 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where an external regulator requests information concerning retirement and post-employment obligations, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

34.10.22 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. †

34.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. This provision shall be applied

consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning retirement and post-employment obligations, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations.

34.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning retirement and post-employment obligations, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.10.27 Compliance with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

34.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. Where an external regulator requests information concerning retirement and post-employment obligations, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

34.10.29 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.10.31 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to retirement and post-employment obligations. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An internal audit of retirement and post-employment obligations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

34.10.33 Compliance data relating to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

34.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.11.2 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.11.4 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

34.11.5 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

34.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

34.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

34.11.9 A failure to comply with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.11.11 A failure to comply with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.11.12 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.11.13 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. As an illustration, a request relating to retirement and post-employment obligations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

34.11.14 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

34.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

34.11.16 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

34.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct.

34.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

34.11.19 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

34.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

34.11.21 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.11.23 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

34.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

34.11.25 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.11.26 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

34.11.27 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct. To illustrate, where

the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

34.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

34.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. †

34.11.30 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

34.11.31 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.11.32 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct.

34.11.33 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

34.11.34 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to retirement and post-employment obligations shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. **[New in v2.0]**

34.12 Review and Amendment

34.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.12.2 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

34.12.4 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

34.12.5 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

34.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.12.7 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

34.12.8 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.12.9 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.12.10 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

34.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.12.12 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

34.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

34.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

34.12.15 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

34.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

34.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

34.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

34.12.19 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

34.12.20 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

34.12.21 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

34.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

34.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

34.12.24 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.12.25 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

34.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

34.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

34.12.28 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

34.12.29 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

34.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

34.12.31 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

34.12.32 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to retirement and post-employment obligations, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

34.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on retirement and post-employment obligations through the HR portal

not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

Chapter 35

Contractors and Temporary Staff

35.1 Purpose and Scope

35.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to contractors and temporary staff and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

35.1.2 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to contractors and temporary staff and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.1.4 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

35.1.5 The objective of these provisions on contractors and temporary staff is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. †

35.1.6 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

35.1.7 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

35.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

35.1.11 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

35.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on contractors and temporary staff. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on contractors and temporary staff. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

35.1.14 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

35.1.15 The objective of these provisions on contractors and temporary staff is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.1.16 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on contractors and temporary staff. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.1.17 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.1.18 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.1.19 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on contractors and temporary staff. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.1.20 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to contractors and temporary staff and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.1.21 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.1.23 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.1.24 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

35.1.25 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to contractors and temporary staff and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.1.26 The objective of these provisions on contractors and temporary staff is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.1.27 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.1.28 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person

responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.1.29 The objective of these provisions on contractors and temporary staff is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

35.1.30 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to contractors and temporary staff and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

35.1.31 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

35.1.32 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to contractors and temporary staff and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on contractors and temporary staff.

35.1.33 The Company recognises that contractors and temporary staff has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on contractors and temporary staff.

35.1.34 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. **[New in v2.0]**

35.2 Definitions and Interpretation

35.2.1 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.2.2 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff.

35.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.2.4 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff.

35.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

35.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

35.2.7 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

35.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.2.10 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "contractors and temporary staff" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.2.11 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

35.2.13 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

35.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

35.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

35.2.16 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "contractors and temporary staff" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

35.2.17 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. †

35.2.18 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

35.2.20 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

35.2.21 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.2.22 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "contractors and temporary staff" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.2.23 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.2.24 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to contractors and temporary staff. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.2.25 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

35.2.26 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.2.27 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.2.28 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "contractors and temporary staff" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be

dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

35.2.34 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. **[New in v2.0]**

35.3 Eligibility and Applicability

35.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.3.3 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

35.3.4 Eligibility for contractors and temporary staff shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.3.5 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.3.6 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.3.7 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for contractors and temporary staff restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.3.8 Eligibility for contractors and temporary staff shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff.

35.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. †

35.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

35.3.13 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for contractors and temporary staff restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

35.3.15 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance

from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.3.17 Eligibility for contractors and temporary staff shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for contractors and temporary staff restricted until the matter is concluded.

35.3.18 Eligibility for contractors and temporary staff shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff.

35.3.20 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

35.3.21 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff.

35.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.3.24 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

35.3.25 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

35.3.26 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for contractors and temporary staff restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent

seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.3.27 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff.

35.3.28 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Eligibility for contractors and temporary staff shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

35.3.29 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.3.30 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility for contractors and temporary staff shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

35.3.31 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on contractors and temporary staff. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

35.3.33 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.3.34 Eligibility for contractors and temporary staff shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may

be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. **[New in v2.0]**

35.4 Responsibilities of Employees

35.4.1 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to contractors and temporary staff and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

35.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.4.4 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to contractors and temporary staff and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

35.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

35.4.6 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff and shall comply with them at all times.

35.4.7 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of contractors and temporary staff as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.4.8 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. †

35.4.10 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to contractors and temporary staff and shall not withhold material facts.

35.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

35.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.4.13 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to contractors and temporary staff and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.4.14 The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.4.15 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to contractors and temporary staff and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.4.16 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

35.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of contractors and temporary staff as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all

concerned.

35.4.20 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.4.21 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with contractors and temporary staff. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff and shall comply with them at all times. †

35.4.22 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

35.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to contractors and temporary staff and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.4.24 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

35.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.4.26 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of contractors and temporary staff as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

35.4.27 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with contractors and temporary staff. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.4.29 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the

discretion of the Line Manager.

35.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to contractors and temporary staff and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff and shall comply with them at all times.

35.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.4.32 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

35.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

35.4.34 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. **[New in v2.0]**

35.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

35.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.5.2 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on contractors and temporary staff and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on contractors and temporary staff and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

35.5.3 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

35.5.4 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on contractors and temporary staff and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the HR Director without undue delay.

35.5.6 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on contractors and temporary staff. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.5.7 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the HR Director without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

35.5.8 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the HR Director without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

35.5.9 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

35.5.10 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on contractors and temporary staff and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.5.12 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on contractors and temporary staff and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

35.5.13 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on contractors and temporary staff.

35.5.15 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

35.5.16 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on contractors and temporary staff and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

35.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

35.5.22 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on contractors and temporary staff. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to contractors and temporary staff to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

35.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on contractors and temporary staff. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.5.25 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.5.26 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on contractors and temporary staff. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

35.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on contractors and temporary staff. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on contractors and temporary staff. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

35.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

35.5.30 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to contractors and temporary staff within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.5.31 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on contractors and temporary staff and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.5.33 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on contractors and temporary staff and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

35.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

35.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

35.6.2 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

35.6.3 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with contractors and temporary staff in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.6.4 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

35.6.5 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

35.6.6 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

35.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to contractors and temporary staff and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.6.9 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to contractors and temporary staff and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

35.6.10 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

35.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for contractors and temporary staff and shall make them available to all employees. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff.

35.6.12 HR shall respond to every written query on contractors and temporary staff within 7 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall respond to every written query on contractors and temporary staff within 7 working days of receipt.

35.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on contractors and temporary staff within 21 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

35.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on contractors and temporary staff within 2 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

35.6.17 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to contractors and temporary staff and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.6.18 HR shall respond to every written query on contractors and temporary staff within 21 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt

resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

35.6.20 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

35.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to contractors and temporary staff and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for contractors and temporary staff and shall make them available to all employees.

35.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

35.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff.

35.6.25 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.6.26 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with contractors and temporary staff in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

35.6.27 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to contractors and temporary staff and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this

provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

35.6.28 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

35.6.29 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

35.6.30 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to contractors and temporary staff and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.6.31 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

35.6.32 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to contractors and temporary staff. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

35.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

35.7 Procedure and Process Steps

35.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.7.3 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.7.4 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The employee shall initiate the process relating to contractors and temporary staff by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team.

35.7.5 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

35.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.7.9 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

35.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

35.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

35.7.12 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.7.13 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.7.14 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

35.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to contractors and temporary staff by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.7.17 The employee shall initiate the process relating to contractors and temporary staff by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 21 working days of receiving it.

35.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

35.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.7.20 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

35.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The employee shall initiate the process relating to contractors and temporary staff by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team.

35.7.22 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to contractors and temporary staff by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.7.24 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 15 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the

matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

35.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.7.26 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

35.7.27 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

35.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.7.30 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

35.7.31 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be

dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

35.8.1 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

35.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to contractors and temporary staff that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

35.8.3 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.8.4 All documents relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.8.6 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

35.8.7 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

35.8.8 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

35.8.9 All documents relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.8.10 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. All documents relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

35.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to contractors and temporary staff that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.8.12 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

35.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

35.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

35.8.15 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. All documents relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

35.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

35.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

35.8.19 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.8.20 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to contractors and temporary staff that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

35.8.21 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

35.8.22 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

35.8.23 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

35.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

35.8.26 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to contractors and temporary staff that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a

Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.8.27 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.8.28 All documents relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

35.8.29 Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

35.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years.

35.8.31 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.8.32 All documents relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

35.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

35.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

35.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

35.9.2 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be

reported to the senior leadership team for information.

35.9.3 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

35.9.4 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

35.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

35.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

35.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

35.9.8 Exceptions to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

35.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.9.10 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

35.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

35.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

35.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

35.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

35.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.9.16 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. †

35.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

35.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment

contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

35.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.9.23 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

35.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.9.26 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.9.27 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.9.28 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

35.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and

shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.9.32 Exceptions to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

35.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

35.10.1 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to contractors and temporary staff. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.10.2 Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

35.10.3 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An internal audit of contractors and temporary staff shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

35.10.4 Where an external regulator requests information concerning contractors and temporary staff, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.10.5 An internal audit of contractors and temporary staff shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

35.10.6 Where an external regulator requests information concerning contractors and temporary staff, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due;

the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.10.7 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

35.10.8 Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

35.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to contractors and temporary staff. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.10.10 Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to contractors and temporary staff. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.10.14 Where an external regulator requests information concerning contractors and temporary staff, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.10.15 Compliance with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

35.10.16 Where an external regulator requests information concerning contractors and temporary staff, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt

resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

35.10.18 An internal audit of contractors and temporary staff shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where an external regulator requests information concerning contractors and temporary staff, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

35.10.19 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to contractors and temporary staff. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

35.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.10.23 An internal audit of contractors and temporary staff shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.10.24 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to contractors and temporary staff. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. †

35.10.25 Compliance with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

35.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning contractors and temporary staff, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal

e-mail address on record.

35.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to contractors and temporary staff. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.10.28 Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.10.29 Compliance with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.10.30 Where an external regulator requests information concerning contractors and temporary staff, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

35.10.31 Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An internal audit of contractors and temporary staff shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

35.10.32 Compliance data relating to contractors and temporary staff shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

35.10.33 Compliance with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

35.11.1 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.11.3 A failure to comply with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

35.11.4 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to contractors and temporary staff shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

35.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to contractors and temporary staff shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

35.11.6 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.11.7 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

35.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

35.11.11 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to contractors and temporary staff shall be treated as serious misconduct.

35.11.12 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

35.11.13 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

35.11.14 A failure to comply with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.11.16 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to contractors and temporary staff shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.11.18 A failure to comply with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.11.19 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to contractors and temporary staff shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.11.20 A failure to comply with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.11.21 A failure to comply with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.11.22 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

35.11.23 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

35.11.24 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

35.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to contractors and temporary staff shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.11.26 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to contractors and temporary staff shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

35.11.27 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

35.11.28 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

35.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.11.30 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.11.31 A failure to comply with the provisions on contractors and temporary staff may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

35.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

35.11.34 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. **[New in v2.0]**

35.12 Review and Amendment

35.12.1 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to contractors and temporary staff made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

35.12.2 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

35.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.12.4 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

35.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

35.12.6 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

35.12.7 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

35.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.12.9 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

35.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.12.11 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

35.12.12 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

35.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

35.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

35.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive

rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

35.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

35.12.18 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

35.12.19 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

35.12.20 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

35.12.21 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

35.12.23 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.12.24 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

35.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

35.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on contractors and temporary staff through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

35.12.28 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

35.12.29 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to contractors and temporary staff, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

35.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

35.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

35.12.32 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

35.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

Chapter 36

Employee Recognition and Rewards

36.1 Purpose and Scope

36.1.1 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

36.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.1.3 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

36.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

36.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards.

36.1.7 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.1.8 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee recognition and rewards and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards.

36.1.9 The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.1.10 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

36.1.11 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.1.12 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.1.13 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.1.16 The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.1.17 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards.

36.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee recognition and rewards and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.1.20 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

36.1.21 The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.1.22 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.1.23 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

36.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

36.1.25 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

36.1.26 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.1.27 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

36.1.28 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

36.1.29 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company

will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards.

36.1.30 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee recognition and rewards. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.1.32 The objective of these provisions on employee recognition and rewards is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.1.33 The Company recognises that employee recognition and rewards has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

36.2 Definitions and Interpretation

36.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee recognition and rewards. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

36.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee recognition and rewards. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.2.3 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

36.2.5 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

36.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

36.2.7 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee recognition and rewards. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.2.8 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

36.2.9 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.2.10 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee recognition and rewards. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.2.12 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee recognition and rewards" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

36.2.13 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

36.2.15 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee recognition and rewards.

36.2.16 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. †

36.2.18 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee recognition and rewards.

36.2.20 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

36.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.2.22 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

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36.2.27 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee recognition and rewards.

36.2.29 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.2.30 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee recognition and rewards" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.2.32 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

36.2.33 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

36.3 Eligibility and Applicability

36.3.1 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

36.3.2 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

36.3.3 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

36.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

36.3.5 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

36.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

36.3.9 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.3.10 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

36.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.3.12 Eligibility for employee recognition and rewards shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

36.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

36.3.14 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

36.3.15 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.3.16 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee recognition and rewards restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

36.3.17 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility for employee recognition and rewards shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

36.3.18 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee recognition and rewards restricted until the matter is concluded. Where

eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

36.3.19 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.3.20 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee recognition and rewards restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

36.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee recognition and rewards restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

36.3.22 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee recognition and rewards restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

36.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee recognition and rewards restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

36.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.3.26 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

36.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may

be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

36.3.28 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.3.30 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Eligibility for employee recognition and rewards shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

36.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.3.33 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee recognition and rewards. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.4 Responsibilities of Employees

36.4.1 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee recognition and rewards and shall not withhold material facts.

36.4.2 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.4.3 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

36.4.4 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee recognition and rewards. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee recognition and rewards.

36.4.6 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.4.7 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.4.8 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee recognition and rewards as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee recognition and rewards.

36.4.9 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee recognition and rewards as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

36.4.12 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

36.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee recognition and rewards.

36.4.16 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

36.4.18 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.4.19 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

36.4.20 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.4.21 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee recognition and rewards. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.4.22 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

36.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

36.4.24 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

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36.4.27 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and shall comply with them at all times. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

36.4.28 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee recognition and rewards as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will

apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and shall comply with them at all times.

36.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee recognition and rewards and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.4.31 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

36.4.32 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

36.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

36.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee recognition and rewards to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.5.2 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.5.3 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.5.4 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

36.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee recognition and rewards and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

36.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.5.7 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.5.8 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee recognition and rewards to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

36.5.9 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

36.5.10 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

36.5.11 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee recognition and rewards and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee recognition and rewards.

36.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee recognition and rewards to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.5.13 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

36.5.15 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee recognition and rewards. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee recognition and rewards within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

36.5.16 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee recognition and rewards. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.5.17 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

36.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

36.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee recognition and rewards. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.5.20 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. †

36.5.21 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently.

36.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee recognition and rewards to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.5.23 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

36.5.24 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee recognition and rewards within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

36.5.25 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee recognition and rewards and applies them consistently.

36.5.26 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee recognition and rewards. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.5.27 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee recognition and rewards and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

36.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee recognition and rewards to the HR Director without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

36.5.30 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee recognition and rewards within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee recognition and rewards and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.5.32 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee recognition and rewards. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee recognition and rewards. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

36.6.1 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee recognition and rewards. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

36.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on employee recognition and rewards within 21 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.6.3 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.6.4 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.6.5 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.6.6 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee recognition and rewards and on the applicable legal requirements. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

36.6.7 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee recognition and rewards in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

36.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

36.6.9 HR shall respond to every written query on employee recognition and rewards within 21 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

36.6.10 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee recognition and rewards and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee recognition and rewards.

36.6.11 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

36.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall respond to every written query on employee recognition and rewards within 10 working days of receipt.

36.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee recognition and rewards and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on employee recognition and rewards within 21 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.6.15 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.6.16 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee recognition and rewards and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.6.18 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee recognition and rewards in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards

made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee recognition and rewards. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.6.21 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee recognition and rewards and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

36.6.22 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee recognition and rewards and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall respond to every written query on employee recognition and rewards within 10 working days of receipt.

36.6.24 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee recognition and rewards and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.6.25 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee recognition and rewards in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

36.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on employee recognition and rewards within 5 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.6.27 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

36.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee recognition and rewards. The Company will

apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee recognition and rewards in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

36.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on employee recognition and rewards within 5 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.6.32 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee recognition and rewards and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. †

36.6.33 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee recognition and rewards. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee recognition and rewards in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

36.7 Procedure and Process Steps

36.7.1 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.7.2 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee recognition and rewards by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.7.3 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee recognition and rewards by submitting a written request to the HR Business Partner.

36.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee recognition and rewards by submitting the prescribed form

to the HR Operations team.

36.7.6 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.7.8 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 7 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

36.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.7.10 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.7.12 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.7.13 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.7.14 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

36.7.15 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

36.7.16 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.7.17 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee recognition and rewards by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.7.18 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 2 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee recognition and rewards by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager.

36.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee recognition and rewards by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

36.7.20 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 2 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

36.7.21 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

36.7.22 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.7.23 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

36.7.24 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.7.25 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.7.26 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.7.27 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.7.28 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

36.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

36.7.30 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.7.31 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

36.7.32 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

36.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

36.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the

concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

36.8.3 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.8.4 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

36.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.8.6 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

36.8.7 Records relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.8.8 All documents relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.8.10 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.8.12 All documents relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

36.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

36.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. All documents relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

36.8.15 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. All documents relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

36.8.16 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

36.8.19 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Records relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years.

36.8.20 Records relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line

Manager. All documents relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

36.8.21 Records relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.8.22 Records relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

36.8.23 All documents relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

36.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.8.25 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.8.26 All documents relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.8.28 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

36.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

36.8.30 Records relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.8.31 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

36.8.33 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee recognition and rewards that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

36.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

36.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. †

36.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

36.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision

shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

36.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

36.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

36.9.7 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

36.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

36.9.9 Exceptions to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.9.12 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if

they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

36.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

36.9.15 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.9.16 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

36.9.17 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.9.18 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.9.19 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

36.9.20 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

36.9.21 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Exceptions to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

36.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.9.24 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

36.9.25 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.9.26 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

36.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.9.28 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.9.29 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.9.30 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.9.31 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

36.9.33 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

36.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

36.10.1 Compliance data relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee recognition and rewards. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

36.10.3 Compliance with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

36.10.4 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.10.6 An internal audit of employee recognition and rewards shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.10.7 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee recognition and rewards.

36.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.10.9 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

36.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.10.11 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

36.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

36.10.13 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.10.14 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

36.10.15 An internal audit of employee recognition and rewards shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.10.16 An internal audit of employee recognition and rewards shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee recognition and rewards. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.10.18 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

36.10.19 An internal audit of employee recognition and rewards shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Compliance data relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

36.10.20 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee recognition and rewards. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Compliance with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

36.10.21 An internal audit of employee recognition and rewards shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee recognition and rewards.

36.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

36.10.24 Compliance data relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.10.25 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

36.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

36.10.28 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.10.29 Compliance data relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An internal audit of employee recognition and rewards shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

36.10.30 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

36.10.32 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee recognition and rewards, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

36.10.33 Compliance data relating to employee recognition and rewards shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

36.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

36.11.1 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

36.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

36.11.5 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

36.11.6 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.11.7 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

36.11.8 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.11.9 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

36.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

36.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

36.11.12 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated

less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

36.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

36.11.17 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.11.18 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

36.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A failure to comply with the provisions on employee recognition and rewards may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

36.11.20 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

36.11.21 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

36.11.22 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

36.11.23 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may

escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

36.11.24 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.11.25 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

36.11.26 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.11.27 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

36.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.11.30 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.11.31 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee recognition and rewards shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.12 Review and Amendment

36.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

36.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

36.12.3 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.12.4 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. †

36.12.5 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

36.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall

be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

36.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.12.10 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

36.12.11 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

36.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.12.14 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

36.12.15 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

36.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

36.12.17 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.12.18 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.12.20 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

36.12.21 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

36.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

36.12.23 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

36.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

36.12.25 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

36.12.26 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

36.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee recognition and rewards through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

36.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.12.29 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

36.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee recognition and rewards made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

36.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

36.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

36.12.33 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

36.12.34 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee recognition and rewards, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. **[New in v2.0]**

Chapter 37

Employee Wellbeing

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Wellbeing days	no dedicated wellbeing days	**2 wellbeing days per year**

37.1 Purpose and Scope

37.1.1 The objective of these provisions on employee wellbeing is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee wellbeing. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

37.1.3 The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

37.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

37.1.5 The objective of these provisions on employee wellbeing is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

37.1.7 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.1.8 The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which

the requests were received.

37.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee wellbeing.

37.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

37.1.12 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

37.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.1.15 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee wellbeing and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

37.1.16 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.1.17 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee wellbeing.

37.1.20 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee wellbeing. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

37.1.21 The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

37.1.22 The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

37.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee wellbeing. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

37.1.25 The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee wellbeing.

37.1.26 The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

37.1.27 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.1.29 The Company recognises that employee wellbeing has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

37.1.30 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. †

37.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.1.32 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee wellbeing and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.1.33 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee wellbeing and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

37.2 Definitions and Interpretation

37.2.1 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.2.2 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

37.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.2.5 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.2.6 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee wellbeing" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

37.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee wellbeing.

37.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee wellbeing. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee wellbeing" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

37.2.10 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee wellbeing. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.2.11 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.2.12 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee wellbeing" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

37.2.13 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

37.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost

implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.2.16 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.2.17 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.2.18 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee wellbeing. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

37.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.2.20 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

37.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.2.23 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.2.24 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.2.25 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose

of calculating time limits. †

37.2.26 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee wellbeing. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

37.2.27 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee wellbeing. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

37.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.2.29 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

37.2.30 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

37.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

37.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

37.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.3 Eligibility and Applicability

37.3.1 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.3.2 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

37.3.3 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.3.4 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

37.3.5 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.3.6 Eligibility for employee wellbeing shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.3.7 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.3.9 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee wellbeing. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

37.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee wellbeing. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated

by reference to their contracted hours.

37.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.3.13 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.3.14 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.3.15 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

37.3.16 Eligibility for employee wellbeing shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

37.3.17 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

37.3.18 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.3.19 Eligibility for employee wellbeing shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee wellbeing.

37.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

37.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee wellbeing.

37.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee wellbeing. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.3.24 Eligibility for employee wellbeing shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee wellbeing. †

37.3.26 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee wellbeing restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Eligibility for employee wellbeing shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

37.3.28 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

37.3.29 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.3.30 Eligibility for employee wellbeing shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

37.3.31 Eligibility for employee wellbeing shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.3.32 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee wellbeing restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.3.34 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. **[New in v2.0]**

37.4 Responsibilities of Employees

37.4.1 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.4.2 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee wellbeing and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

37.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.4.4 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee wellbeing and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

37.4.5 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.4.6 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee wellbeing. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee wellbeing and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee wellbeing as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

37.4.8 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee wellbeing as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee wellbeing and shall comply with them at all times. †

37.4.9 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

37.4.10 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.4.11 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee wellbeing. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee wellbeing as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

37.4.12 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.4.13 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee wellbeing.

37.4.14 The staff member shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

37.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee wellbeing. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

37.4.16 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee wellbeing. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

37.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.4.18 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee wellbeing and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee wellbeing and shall not withhold material facts.

37.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

37.4.20 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee wellbeing and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee wellbeing as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

37.4.21 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee wellbeing and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.4.22 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

37.4.23 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee wellbeing and shall not withhold material facts.

37.4.24 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee wellbeing and shall comply with them at all times.

37.4.25 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

37.4.26 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee wellbeing as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

37.4.27 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. †

37.4.28 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee wellbeing. †

37.4.29 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee wellbeing and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.4.31 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee wellbeing and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.4.32 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee wellbeing as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.4.33 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

37.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

37.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

37.5.2 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee wellbeing. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

37.5.3 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee wellbeing within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.5.4 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee wellbeing and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee wellbeing within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.5.7 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee wellbeing. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.5.9 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee wellbeing. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.5.10 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall

be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.5.11 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee wellbeing.

37.5.12 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.5.17 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee wellbeing and applies them consistently. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.5.18 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee wellbeing within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

37.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications,

where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.5.20 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee wellbeing and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.5.21 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

37.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee wellbeing to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.5.23 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee wellbeing. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee wellbeing to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

37.5.25 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee wellbeing and applies them consistently.

37.5.26 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee wellbeing and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

37.5.27 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee wellbeing within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.5.28 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

37.5.29 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee wellbeing and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.5.30 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee wellbeing and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

37.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee wellbeing within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

37.5.32 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee wellbeing. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.5.33 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee wellbeing and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

37.6.1 HR shall respond to every written query on employee wellbeing within 2 working days of receipt. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.6.3 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee wellbeing and on the applicable legal requirements.

37.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.6.5 HR shall respond to every written query on employee wellbeing within 5 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

37.6.7 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees.

37.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee wellbeing and on the applicable legal requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

37.6.9 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. †

37.6.10 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.6.11 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

37.6.12 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee wellbeing and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.6.13 HR shall respond to every written query on employee wellbeing within 7 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.6.15 HR shall respond to every written query on employee wellbeing within 3 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee wellbeing and on the applicable legal requirements.

37.6.16 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee wellbeing in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

37.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on employee wellbeing within 10 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee wellbeing and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

37.6.19 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall respond to every written query on employee wellbeing within 30 working days of receipt.

37.6.20 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee wellbeing and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

37.6.21 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

37.6.22 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee wellbeing.

37.6.23 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee wellbeing and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

37.6.26 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee wellbeing in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

37.6.27 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.6.28 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee wellbeing in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee wellbeing. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee wellbeing in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

37.6.31 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.6.32 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee wellbeing and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

37.7 Procedure and Process Steps

37.7.1 **Wellbeing days.** The Company provides 2 wellbeing days per year for all confirmed employees. **[Revised in v2.0; previously no dedicated wellbeing days]**

37.7.2 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.7.3 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee wellbeing by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee wellbeing by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

37.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.7.7 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee wellbeing by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

37.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.7.9 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee

who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.7.10 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.7.11 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

37.7.12 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

37.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.7.14 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

37.7.15 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.7.16 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.7.18 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee wellbeing by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee wellbeing by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

37.7.20 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 15 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

37.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. †

37.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.7.25 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

37.7.27 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.7.28 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee wellbeing by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. †

37.7.29 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed

period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

37.7.30 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 3 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.7.34 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee wellbeing by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

37.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Records relating to employee wellbeing shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years.

37.8.2 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.8.3 Records relating to employee wellbeing shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the

order in which the requests were received. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

37.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.8.6 Records relating to employee wellbeing shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.8.7 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

37.8.8 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee wellbeing that is held about them, subject to applicable law. †

37.8.10 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee wellbeing that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

37.8.11 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

37.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.8.13 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

37.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee wellbeing that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.8.15 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.8.16 All documents relating to employee wellbeing shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.8.17 Records relating to employee wellbeing shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee wellbeing that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

37.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

37.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee wellbeing that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

37.8.21 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

37.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

37.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.8.25 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.8.26 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee wellbeing that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

37.8.27 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

37.8.28 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

37.8.29 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.8.30 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

37.8.31 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.8.32 Records relating to employee wellbeing shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

37.8.33 Records relating to employee wellbeing shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

37.8.34 All documents relating to employee wellbeing shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. **[New in v2.0]**

37.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

37.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

37.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.9.3 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

37.9.4 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.9.6 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

37.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.9.10 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

37.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on employee wellbeing may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

37.9.12 Exceptions to the provisions on employee wellbeing may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.9.13 Exceptions to the provisions on employee wellbeing may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

37.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.9.15 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.9.21 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

37.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

37.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.9.24 Exceptions to the provisions on employee wellbeing may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

37.9.25 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

37.9.26 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

37.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.9.28 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

37.9.29 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received

on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on employee wellbeing may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

37.9.31 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

37.9.33 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

37.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

37.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on employee wellbeing shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

37.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

37.10.3 Compliance data relating to employee wellbeing shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.10.4 An internal audit of employee wellbeing shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Compliance data relating to employee wellbeing shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

37.10.5 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee wellbeing. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration,

where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

37.10.6 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee wellbeing. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.10.8 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee wellbeing. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

37.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

37.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on employee wellbeing shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.10.12 Compliance data relating to employee wellbeing shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.10.13 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

37.10.14 An internal audit of employee wellbeing shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

37.10.15 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.10.16 Compliance with the provisions on employee wellbeing shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.10.17 An internal audit of employee wellbeing shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Compliance data relating to employee wellbeing shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

37.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.10.19 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee wellbeing. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

37.10.20 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

37.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.10.22 An internal audit of employee wellbeing shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.10.23 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Compliance data relating to employee wellbeing shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

37.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee wellbeing.

37.10.26 Compliance data relating to employee wellbeing shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An internal audit of employee wellbeing shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

37.10.27 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

37.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on employee wellbeing shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.10.29 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.10.30 An internal audit of employee wellbeing shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.10.31 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.10.32 An internal audit of employee wellbeing shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.10.33 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee wellbeing, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

37.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

37.11.1 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee wellbeing shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee wellbeing shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee wellbeing shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A failure to comply with the provisions on employee wellbeing may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

37.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.11.5 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.11.6 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee wellbeing may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.11.7 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. A failure to comply with the provisions on employee wellbeing may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

37.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.11.9 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee wellbeing may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee wellbeing may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies

equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

37.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.11.12 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.11.13 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

37.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

37.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

37.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

37.11.17 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

37.11.18 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee wellbeing shall be treated as serious misconduct. †

37.11.19 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.11.20 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

37.11.22 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee wellbeing may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

37.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

37.11.24 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.11.25 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee wellbeing made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

37.11.27 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.11.28 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

37.11.29 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line

Manager.

37.11.31 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

37.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

37.12 Review and Amendment

37.12.1 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.12.2 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.12.3 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.12.5 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.12.6 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.12.7 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

37.12.8 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. †

37.12.9 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

37.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy

committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

37.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

37.12.12 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

37.12.13 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

37.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

37.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

37.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

37.12.18 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee wellbeing through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

37.12.19 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

37.12.20 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

37.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall

prevail.

37.12.22 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee wellbeing through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

37.12.23 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

37.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

37.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

37.12.26 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee wellbeing through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.12.27 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

37.12.28 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

37.12.29 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

37.12.30 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

37.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

37.12.32 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

37.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt

resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee wellbeing, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

37.12.34 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee wellbeing through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. **[New in v2.0]**

Chapter 38

Conduct at Company Events

38.1 Purpose and Scope

38.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

38.1.2 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

38.1.3 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

38.1.4 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.1.5 The Company recognises that conduct at company events has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. †

38.1.6 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

38.1.7 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conduct at company events. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

38.1.8 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

38.1.9 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

38.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

38.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company recognises that conduct at company events has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

38.1.12 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

38.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.1.14 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

38.1.15 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

38.1.16 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

38.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.1.18 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The Company recognises that conduct at company events has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

38.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.1.20 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conduct at company events.

38.1.21 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conduct at company events. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

38.1.22 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.1.23 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

38.1.24 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conduct at company events. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.1.26 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.1.27 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

38.1.28 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

38.1.29 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.1.30 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on conduct at company events. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.1.31 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.1.32 The objective of these provisions on conduct at company events is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.1.33 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to conduct at company events and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

38.2 Definitions and Interpretation

38.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

38.2.2 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

38.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person

responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.2.5 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.2.6 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

38.2.7 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

38.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

38.2.9 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

38.2.10 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conduct at company events" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

38.2.11 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

38.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.2.13 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

38.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.2.15 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conduct at company events" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

38.2.17 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.2.18 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

38.2.19 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

38.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conduct at company events" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

38.2.21 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the

request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conduct at company events" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

38.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conduct at company events. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.2.23 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

38.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "conduct at company events" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

38.2.25 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

38.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.2.27 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conduct at company events. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

38.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

38.2.29 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.2.30 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to conduct at company events. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

38.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

38.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.3 Eligibility and Applicability

38.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.3.2 Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.3.3 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. †

38.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

38.3.5 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

38.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.3.7 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.3.8 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

38.3.9 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.3.10 Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.3.11 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

38.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

38.3.13 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.3.14 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.3.15 Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.3.16 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

38.3.17 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

38.3.18 Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conduct at company events. †

38.3.19 Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

38.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.3.21 Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.3.22 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conduct at company events.

38.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conduct at company events. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded.

38.3.24 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.3.25 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conduct at company events. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

38.3.26 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.3.27 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.3.28 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

38.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on conduct at company events.

38.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

38.3.31 Eligibility for conduct at company events shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for conduct at company events restricted until the matter is concluded.

38.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees

make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.4 Responsibilities of Employees

38.4.1 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

38.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conduct at company events and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.4.4 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conduct at company events and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

38.4.6 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conduct at company events and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.4.7 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.4.10 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conduct at company events. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The staff member shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

38.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.4.12 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.4.13 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conduct at company events. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conduct at company events and shall not withhold material facts.

38.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

38.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.4.16 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conduct at company events. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

38.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

38.4.18 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.4.20 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conduct at company events.

38.4.21 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conduct at company events and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.4.22 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conduct at company events and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conduct at company events and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conduct at company events.

38.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

38.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conduct at company events and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.4.26 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.4.27 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.4.28 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conduct at company events and shall not withhold material facts. Employees

should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conduct at company events.

38.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conduct at company events and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.4.31 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with conduct at company events.

38.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to conduct at company events and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.4.33 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on conduct at company events and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of conduct at company events as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

38.4.34 The employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. **[New in v2.0]**

38.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

38.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.5.3 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conduct at company events within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

38.5.5 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

38.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conduct at company events within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

38.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.5.8 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conduct at company events and applies them consistently. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.5.9 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conduct at company events and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conduct at company events to the HR Director without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conduct at company events within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

38.5.11 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conduct at company events and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

38.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conduct at company events. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

38.5.15 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conduct at company events. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conduct at company events and applies them consistently.

38.5.17 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conduct at company events and applies them consistently.

38.5.19 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

38.5.20 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conduct at company events. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company

decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

38.5.21 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.5.22 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on conduct at company events and applies them consistently.

38.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to conduct at company events within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

38.5.24 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

38.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conduct at company events. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.5.27 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conduct at company events to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. †

38.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on conduct at company events. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are

sent by e-mail.

38.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on conduct at company events and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

38.5.30 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.5.31 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

38.5.33 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to conduct at company events to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

38.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

38.6.1 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for conduct at company events and shall make them available to all employees. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

38.6.2 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

38.6.3 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conduct at company events. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

38.6.4 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 2 working days of receipt. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.6.5 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conduct at company events.

38.6.6 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

38.6.7 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.6.8 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

38.6.9 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 14 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.6.10 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 7 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

38.6.12 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 7 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conduct at company events and on the applicable legal requirements.

38.6.14 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 5 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.6.15 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 5 working days of receipt. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to conduct at company events.

38.6.16 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

38.6.17 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conduct at company events and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.6.19 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 10 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.6.20 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for conduct at company events and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.6.21 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 10 working days of receipt. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

38.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive

rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.6.24 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 3 working days of receipt.

38.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to conduct at company events and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

38.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

38.6.27 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.6.28 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 3 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

38.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 5 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

38.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on conduct at company events within 10 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.6.32 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.6.33 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for conduct at company events and shall make them available to all employees. HR shall treat all

personal information received in connection with conduct at company events in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

38.7 Procedure and Process Steps

38.7.1 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

38.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

38.7.3 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

38.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.7.5 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.7.6 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

38.7.8 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

38.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be

an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

38.7.10 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.7.11 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it.

38.7.12 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.7.14 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager.

38.7.15 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.7.16 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 14 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

38.7.17 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

38.7.18 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.7.20 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

38.7.21 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

38.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 14 working days of receiving it.

38.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

38.7.24 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

38.7.27 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

38.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

38.7.29 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

38.7.32 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.7.33 The employee shall initiate the process relating to conduct at company events by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

38.7.34 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 14 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. **[New in v2.0]**

38.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

38.8.1 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

38.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.8.4 Records relating to conduct at company events shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

38.8.5 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.8.6 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

38.8.7 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conduct at company events that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

38.8.8 All documents relating to conduct at company events shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

38.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.8.10 Records relating to conduct at company events shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and

a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.8.11 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

38.8.12 All documents relating to conduct at company events shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.8.13 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

38.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conduct at company events that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conduct at company events that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Records relating to conduct at company events shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years.

38.8.17 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.8.18 Records relating to conduct at company events shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.8.19 Records relating to conduct at company events shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

38.8.20 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.8.21 Records relating to conduct at company events shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

38.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.8.23 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

38.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

38.8.25 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conduct at company events that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

38.8.26 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to conduct at company events that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

38.8.27 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.8.28 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.8.29 Records relating to conduct at company events shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. The time limits in this Chapter are

intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.8.30 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.8.31 All documents relating to conduct at company events shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

38.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.8.33 All documents relating to conduct at company events shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

38.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on conduct at company events may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

38.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

38.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on conduct at company events may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.9.5 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Every exception shall be recorded in the

departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

38.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.9.8 Exceptions to the provisions on conduct at company events may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.9.9 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

38.9.10 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.9.11 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

38.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.9.13 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.9.14 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

38.9.15 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

38.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

38.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

38.9.19 Exceptions to the provisions on conduct at company events may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

38.9.20 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

38.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

38.9.22 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.9.23 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

38.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.9.25 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

38.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

38.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

38.9.29 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

38.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.9.31 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.9.32 Exceptions to the provisions on conduct at company events may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

38.9.33 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

38.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on conduct at company events shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

38.10.2 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and

shall not identify individual employees.

38.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance with the provisions on conduct at company events shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

38.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

38.10.5 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conduct at company events, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.10.6 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

38.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conduct at company events. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.10.8 Compliance with the provisions on conduct at company events shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

38.10.9 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.10.10 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.10.11 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conduct at company events. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be

dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on conduct at company events shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

38.10.13 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.10.14 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An internal audit of conduct at company events shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

38.10.16 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.10.17 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

38.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conduct at company events. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.10.20 An internal audit of conduct at company events shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

38.10.21 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.10.22 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to conduct at company events. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

38.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conduct at company events, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

38.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conduct at company events, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.10.26 An internal audit of conduct at company events shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conduct at company events, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. †

38.10.28 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

38.10.29 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Compliance with the provisions on conduct at company events shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

38.10.30 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

38.10.31 Compliance data relating to conduct at company events shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.10.32 Compliance with the provisions on conduct at company events shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

38.10.33 Where an external regulator requests information concerning conduct at company events, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

38.11.1 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. †

38.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

38.11.3 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

38.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

38.11.5 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

38.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conduct at company events shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a breach has caused

financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

38.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conduct at company events shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

38.11.8 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conduct at company events shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

38.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on conduct at company events may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

38.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on conduct at company events may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

38.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conduct at company events shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

38.11.14 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conduct at company events shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.11.15 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

38.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on

the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

38.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.11.19 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A failure to comply with the provisions on conduct at company events may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. †

38.11.20 A failure to comply with the provisions on conduct at company events may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

38.11.21 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to conduct at company events shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.11.24 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

38.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the

requests were received. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

38.11.26 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

38.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.11.28 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.11.29 A failure to comply with the provisions on conduct at company events may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

38.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.11.31 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on conduct at company events may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

38.12 Review and Amendment

38.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conduct at company events through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. †

38.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

38.12.3 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.12.4 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

38.12.5 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conduct at company events through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

38.12.6 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.12.7 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.12.8 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

38.12.9 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

38.12.10 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

38.12.11 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conduct at company events through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

38.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conduct at company events through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.12.13 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.12.14 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

38.12.15 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conduct at company events through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to conduct at company events, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

38.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conduct at company events through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

38.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

38.12.18 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on conduct at company events through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

38.12.19 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

38.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

38.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

38.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

38.12.23 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

38.12.24 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

38.12.25 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

38.12.26 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

38.12.27 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

38.12.28 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

38.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

38.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

38.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

38.12.32 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to conduct at company events made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

38.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

Chapter 39

Remote and Hybrid Work [Retitled / revised]

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Remote work allowance	up to 2 days per month, with prior written approval	**up to 3 days per week under the hybrid model**

39.1 Purpose and Scope

39.1.1 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

39.1.2 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.1.3 The objective of these provisions on remote and hybrid work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

39.1.4 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

39.1.5 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on remote and hybrid work.

39.1.6 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.1.7 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the

standards that apply to every employee in every location.

39.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on remote and hybrid work. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

39.1.9 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.1.10 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.1.12 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

39.1.14 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.1.15 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the

Reporting Manager.

39.1.16 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

39.1.17 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

39.1.18 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

39.1.19 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on remote and hybrid work. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The objective of these provisions on remote and hybrid work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

39.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

39.1.21 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For

instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.1.24 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

39.1.26 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. †

39.1.27 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to remote and hybrid work and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

39.1.28 The objective of these provisions on remote and hybrid work is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

39.1.29 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. †

39.1.30 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

39.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

39.1.32 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.1.34 The Company recognises that remote and hybrid work has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. **[New in v2.0]**

39.2 Definitions and Interpretation

39.2.1 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.2.2 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.2.3 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.2.4 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. †

39.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to remote and hybrid work. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to remote and hybrid work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

39.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

39.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.2.10 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

39.2.11 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

39.2.12 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to remote and hybrid work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.2.13 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.2.14 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.2.15 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.2.16 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

39.2.17 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.2.18 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

39.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.2.20 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied

consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.2.22 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.2.23 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "remote and hybrid work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "remote and hybrid work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

39.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "remote and hybrid work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.2.26 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.2.27 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

39.2.29 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. †

39.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For

instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.2.32 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "remote and hybrid work" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

39.3 Eligibility and Applicability

39.3.1 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

39.3.2 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on remote and hybrid work.

39.3.3 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded.

39.3.4 Eligibility for remote and hybrid work shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

39.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

39.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.3.7 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

39.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on remote and hybrid work. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

39.3.9 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.3.10 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

39.3.11 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

39.3.12 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.3.13 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.3.14 Eligibility for remote and hybrid work shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

39.3.15 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Head of Department shall

decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on remote and hybrid work.

39.3.17 Eligibility for remote and hybrid work shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

39.3.18 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

39.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.3.20 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded.

39.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

39.3.22 Eligibility for remote and hybrid work shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded.

39.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on remote and hybrid work.

39.3.24 Eligibility for remote and hybrid work shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.3.25 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.3.26 Eligibility for remote and hybrid work shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.3.27 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.3.28 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on remote and hybrid work. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for remote and hybrid work restricted until the matter is concluded.

39.3.30 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.3.32 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

39.3.33 Eligibility for remote and hybrid work shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.4 Responsibilities of Employees

39.4.1 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.4.2 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended

to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times.

39.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

39.4.4 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

39.4.6 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

39.4.8 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with remote and hybrid work. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

39.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of remote and hybrid work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Line Manager at

least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

39.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

39.4.12 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.4.13 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times.

39.4.14 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of remote and hybrid work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.4.15 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to remote and hybrid work and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.4.16 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.4.18 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Operations team at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

39.4.19 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to remote and hybrid work and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.4.21 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to remote and hybrid work and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with remote and hybrid work.

39.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to remote and hybrid work and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.4.23 The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

39.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with remote and hybrid work.

39.4.26 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.4.27 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.4.28 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of remote and hybrid work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed

period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

39.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of remote and hybrid work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. †

39.4.30 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with remote and hybrid work. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with remote and hybrid work. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on remote and hybrid work and shall comply with them at all times.

39.4.32 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of remote and hybrid work as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

39.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

39.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

39.5.3 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to remote and hybrid work to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

39.5.4 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

39.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

39.5.8 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.5.9 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to remote and hybrid work within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to remote and hybrid work to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

39.5.11 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

39.5.12 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on remote and hybrid work and applies them consistently.

39.5.13 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that

training at least once every two years.

39.5.15 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on remote and hybrid work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to remote and hybrid work within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

39.5.16 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to remote and hybrid work to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.5.18 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on remote and hybrid work and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.5.19 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on remote and hybrid work. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to remote and hybrid work within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.5.21 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

39.5.22 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to remote and hybrid work within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

39.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on remote and hybrid work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.5.25 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on remote and hybrid work and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

39.5.26 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.5.27 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on remote and hybrid work and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.5.28 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

39.5.29 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to remote and hybrid work to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

39.5.30 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to remote and hybrid work within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.5.31 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to remote and hybrid work to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.5.32 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on remote and hybrid work. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

39.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to remote and hybrid work within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.5.34 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on remote and hybrid work. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. **[New in v2.0]**

39.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

39.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with remote and hybrid work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

39.6.2 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with remote and hybrid work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

39.6.4 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.6.5 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.6.6 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.6.7 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for remote and hybrid work and shall make them available to all employees.

39.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work.

39.6.9 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.6.10 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to remote and hybrid work and on the applicable legal requirements.

39.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to remote and hybrid work and on the applicable legal requirements.

39.6.13 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.6.14 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with remote and hybrid work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

39.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with remote and hybrid work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

39.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.6.19 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for remote and hybrid work and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.6.21 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with remote and hybrid work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

39.6.22 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

39.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to remote and hybrid work and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

39.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.6.25 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to remote and hybrid work and on the applicable legal requirements.

39.6.26 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to remote and hybrid work and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work.

39.6.27 HR shall respond to every written query on remote and hybrid work within 5 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment

categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for remote and hybrid work and shall make them available to all employees.

39.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to remote and hybrid work and on the applicable legal requirements. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with remote and hybrid work in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

39.6.31 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

39.6.32 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

39.6.33 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to remote and hybrid work. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.7 Procedure and Process Steps

39.7.1 **Remote work allowance.** Eligible employees may work remotely for up to 3 days per week under the hybrid model. **[Revised in v2.0; previously up to 2 days per month, with prior written approval]**

39.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

39.7.3 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of

illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

39.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

39.7.5 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.7.7 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

39.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

39.7.9 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

39.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

39.7.11 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.7.12 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

39.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.7.14 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

39.7.15 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

39.7.17 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 14 working days of receiving it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

39.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.7.19 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. †

39.7.20 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.7.21 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. †

39.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it.

39.7.26 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.7.27 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.7.28 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

39.7.29 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager.

39.7.30 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

39.7.33 The employee shall initiate the process relating to remote and hybrid work by submitting a written request to the Head of Department. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.7.34 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

39.8.1 Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.8.2 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.8.3 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

39.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.8.5 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.8.6 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

39.8.7 Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

39.8.8 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.8.10 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

39.8.11 Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.8.12 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to remote and hybrid work that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

39.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to remote and hybrid work that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

39.8.15 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

39.8.16 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

39.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the

following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

39.8.18 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

39.8.19 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.8.20 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

39.8.21 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to remote and hybrid work that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.8.22 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.8.23 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

39.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.8.25 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.8.26 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

39.8.27 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

39.8.28 Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.8.29 Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to remote and hybrid work that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

39.8.30 Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to remote and hybrid work that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

39.8.31 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Records relating to remote and hybrid work shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

39.8.32 All documents relating to remote and hybrid work shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.8.33 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

39.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. †

39.9.2 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall

continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.9.3 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

39.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

39.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

39.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

39.9.7 Exceptions to the provisions on remote and hybrid work may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.9.8 Exceptions to the provisions on remote and hybrid work may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

39.9.9 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on remote and hybrid work may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on remote and hybrid work may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice.

39.9.12 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

39.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.9.14 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Exceptions to the provisions on remote and hybrid work may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

39.9.17 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

39.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

39.9.19 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

39.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Exceptions to the provisions on remote and hybrid work may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

39.9.21 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.9.22 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this

provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

39.9.23 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. †

39.9.24 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

39.9.25 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.9.26 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.9.27 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

39.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.9.30 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

39.9.31 Exceptions to the provisions on remote and hybrid work may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.9.32 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

39.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

39.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on remote and hybrid work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An internal audit of remote and hybrid work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

39.10.2 Compliance with the provisions on remote and hybrid work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.10.3 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

39.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to remote and hybrid work.

39.10.5 Compliance data relating to remote and hybrid work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

39.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to remote and hybrid work. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.10.7 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.10.8 An internal audit of remote and hybrid work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.10.9 Where an external regulator requests information concerning remote and hybrid work, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.10.11 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to remote and hybrid work. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

39.10.12 Compliance data relating to remote and hybrid work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.10.13 Compliance data relating to remote and hybrid work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.10.14 Compliance with the provisions on remote and hybrid work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

39.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.10.16 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to remote and hybrid work. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

39.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to remote and hybrid work. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

39.10.18 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.10.19 An internal audit of remote and hybrid work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.10.20 Compliance data relating to remote and hybrid work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.10.21 Compliance with the provisions on remote and hybrid work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning remote and hybrid work, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

39.10.24 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.10.25 Where an external regulator requests information concerning remote and hybrid work, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.10.27 An internal audit of remote and hybrid work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Compliance with the provisions on remote and hybrid work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

39.10.28 An internal audit of remote and hybrid work shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Compliance with the provisions on remote and hybrid work shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

39.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

39.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to remote and hybrid work. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.10.33 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Compliance data relating to remote and hybrid work shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

39.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

39.11.1 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

39.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

39.11.4 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on remote and hybrid work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

39.11.6 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

39.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

39.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.11.9 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.11.10 A failure to comply with the provisions on remote and hybrid work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct.

39.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

39.11.12 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

39.11.13 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

39.11.14 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be

treated as serious misconduct.

39.11.15 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct.

39.11.16 A failure to comply with the provisions on remote and hybrid work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

39.11.19 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.11.20 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.11.21 A failure to comply with the provisions on remote and hybrid work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

39.11.22 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.11.23 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

39.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

39.11.25 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.11.26 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

39.11.27 A failure to comply with the provisions on remote and hybrid work may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

39.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

39.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.11.32 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to remote and hybrid work shall be treated as serious misconduct. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

39.11.33 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.12 Review and Amendment

39.12.1 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on remote and hybrid work through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

39.12.2 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

39.12.3 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

39.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

39.12.5 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on remote and hybrid work through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

39.12.6 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

39.12.7 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

39.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.12.9 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on remote and hybrid work through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

39.12.10 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.12.12 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.12.14 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on remote and hybrid work through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.12.15 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

39.12.16 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

39.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.12.18 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

39.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

39.12.20 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

39.12.21 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on remote and hybrid work through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the

reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

39.12.22 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

39.12.23 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on remote and hybrid work through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

39.12.24 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

39.12.25 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

39.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

39.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

39.12.28 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

39.12.29 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

39.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment

contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to remote and hybrid work, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

39.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. As an illustration, a request relating to remote and hybrid work made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

39.12.33 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

Chapter 40

Use of Artificial Intelligence and Generative Tools [New in v2.0]

40.1 Purpose and Scope

40.1.1 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.1.3 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.1.4 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

40.1.5 The objective of these provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.1.6 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools.

40.1.7 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

40.1.8 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The

Company recognises that use of artificial intelligence and generative tools has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

40.1.10 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

40.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

40.1.12 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.1.13 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.1.15 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.1.16 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.1.17 The Company recognises that use of artificial intelligence and generative tools has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.1.18 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

40.1.19 The objective of these provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.1.20 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.1.21 The Company recognises that use of artificial intelligence and generative tools has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

40.1.22 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.1.23 The Company recognises that use of artificial intelligence and generative tools has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

40.1.24 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.1.25 The Company recognises that use of artificial intelligence and generative tools has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

40.1.26 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.1.27 The objective of these provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

40.1.28 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.1.29 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as

received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company recognises that use of artificial intelligence and generative tools has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

40.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company recognises that use of artificial intelligence and generative tools has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

40.1.31 The objective of these provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.1.32 The objective of these provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.1.33 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.2 Definitions and Interpretation

40.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

40.2.3 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

40.2.4 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "use of artificial intelligence and generative tools" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.2.5 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

40.2.6 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "use of artificial intelligence and generative tools" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools.

40.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

40.2.8 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "use of artificial intelligence and generative tools" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

40.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

40.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

40.2.12 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.2.13 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

40.2.15 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.2.16 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "use of artificial intelligence and generative tools" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

40.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.2.18 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.2.19 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "use of artificial intelligence and generative tools" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.2.20 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

40.2.21 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.2.22 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.2.23 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

40.2.24 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

40.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "use of artificial intelligence and generative tools" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.2.26 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.2.27 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.2.28 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

40.2.29 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.2.31 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.2.32 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.2.33 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.3 Eligibility and Applicability

40.3.1 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

40.3.2 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.3.3 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

40.3.5 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.3.6 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.3.7 Eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

40.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools restricted until the matter is concluded.

40.3.9 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.3.10 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.3.13 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.3.14 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.3.15 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.3.16 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

40.3.17 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.3.19 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.3.20 Eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools restricted until the matter is concluded.

40.3.21 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.3.22 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools.

40.3.23 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools.

40.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

40.3.25 Eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.3.26 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools restricted until the matter is concluded.

40.3.28 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.3.29 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools restricted until the matter is concluded. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.3.31 Eligibility for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.3.33 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as

late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

40.4 Responsibilities of Employees

40.4.1 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.4.2 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of use of artificial intelligence and generative tools as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

40.4.3 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

40.4.4 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of use of artificial intelligence and generative tools as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

40.4.6 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.4.7 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.4.8 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.4.9 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

40.4.10 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request

relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

40.4.11 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.4.12 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall not withhold material facts. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.4.13 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall not withhold material facts.

40.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

40.4.16 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.4.17 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.4.18 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.4.19 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.4.20 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

40.4.21 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

40.4.22 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of use of artificial intelligence and generative tools as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

40.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The staff member shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

40.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall not withhold material facts.

40.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Employees should

seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

40.4.27 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

40.4.29 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

40.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.4.32 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

40.5.1 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

40.5.2 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

40.5.3 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

40.5.5 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

40.5.6 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.5.7 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools.

40.5.8 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

40.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

40.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

40.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.5.14 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.5.15 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

40.5.16 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

40.5.18 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools to the HR Director without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.5.20 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall

prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools to the HR Director without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

40.5.22 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.5.24 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.5.25 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.5.26 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.5.27 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.5.28 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of

this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.5.29 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

40.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.5.33 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

40.6.1 HR shall respond to every written query on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 10 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.6.2 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

40.6.3 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall respond to every written query on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 5 working days of receipt.

40.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall respond to

every written query on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 2 working days of receipt.

40.6.5 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall respond to every written query on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 7 working days of receipt.

40.6.6 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and on the applicable legal requirements.

40.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.6.8 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.6.9 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

40.6.10 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.6.11 HR shall respond to every written query on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 7 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

40.6.12 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act

within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

40.6.13 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

40.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and on the applicable legal requirements.

40.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.6.19 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with use of artificial intelligence and generative tools in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.6.20 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and on the applicable legal requirements.

40.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for use of artificial intelligence and generative

tools and shall make them available to all employees.

40.6.22 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.6.23 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall respond to every written query on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools within 2 working days of receipt.

40.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools.

40.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.6.27 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.6.28 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

40.6.30 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated

less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.6.32 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools and on the applicable legal requirements.

40.7 Procedure and Process Steps

40.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.7.3 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

40.7.4 The employee shall initiate the process relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

40.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 21 working days of receiving it.

40.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or

treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.7.8 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.7.9 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The employee shall initiate the process relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager.

40.7.10 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 15 working days of receiving it.

40.7.11 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

40.7.12 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

40.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it.

40.7.14 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.7.15 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.7.16 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

40.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The employee shall initiate the process relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools by submitting the prescribed form to the Head of Department.

40.7.18 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

40.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

40.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The employee shall initiate the process relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department.

40.7.22 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.7.23 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The employee shall initiate the process relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team.

40.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.7.25 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.7.26 The employee shall initiate the process relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools by submitting a written request to the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 2 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.7.28 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.7.29 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.7.30 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.7.31 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.7.33 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

40.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

40.8.1 All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

40.8.2 All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

40.8.3 Records relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.8.4 All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

40.8.5 All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

40.8.6 Records relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.8.7 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.8.8 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

40.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

40.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.8.13 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.8.14 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.8.15 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.8.16 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

40.8.18 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.8.20 All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the

concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

40.8.21 Records relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

40.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

40.8.24 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

40.8.26 Records relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.8.27 All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.8.28 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

40.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.8.30 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

40.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.8.32 Records relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

40.8.33 All documents relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

40.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

40.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

40.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

40.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the

Policy Committee.

40.9.5 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.9.6 Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.9.8 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

40.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.9.10 Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

40.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies

to their situation.

40.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.9.16 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.9.17 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

40.9.18 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

40.9.19 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

40.9.20 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.9.21 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

40.9.22 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.9.23 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.9.24 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.9.25 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

40.9.26 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

40.9.27 Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

40.9.28 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

40.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

40.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.9.31 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice.

40.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

40.9.33 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

40.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

40.10.2 Where an external regulator requests information concerning use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably

for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

40.10.4 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

40.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.10.6 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where an external regulator requests information concerning use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

40.10.7 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

40.10.8 Compliance data relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

40.10.9 Compliance data relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.10.12 Where an external regulator requests information concerning use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

40.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably

for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.10.14 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

40.10.16 An internal audit of use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

40.10.17 Compliance data relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.10.18 An internal audit of use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

40.10.20 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

40.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

40.10.22 Compliance with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

40.10.23 An internal audit of use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

40.10.24 Compliance data relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Compliance with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

40.10.25 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.10.26 Compliance data relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.10.27 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.10.28 Compliance with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

40.10.29 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An internal audit of use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

40.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Compliance with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

40.10.31 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

40.10.33 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

40.11.1 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

40.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.11.3 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be treated as serious misconduct.

40.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

40.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.11.7 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

40.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

40.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

40.11.11 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

40.11.14 A failure to comply with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.11.15 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

40.11.16 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.11.18 A failure to comply with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures

Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

40.11.19 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

40.11.21 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.11.22 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

40.11.23 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

40.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

40.11.27 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

40.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

40.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.11.30 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.11.31 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.11.32 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.11.33 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.12 Review and Amendment

40.12.1 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

40.12.2 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.12.3 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.12.4 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

40.12.5 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department

concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.12.6 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

40.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

40.12.9 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect.

40.12.10 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.12.11 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

40.12.12 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

40.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.12.14 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to use of artificial intelligence and generative tools made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

40.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.12.17 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

40.12.18 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

40.12.19 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.12.20 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

40.12.21 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

40.12.22 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

40.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.12.24 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

40.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

40.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

40.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

40.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

40.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

40.12.30 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

40.12.31 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on use of artificial intelligence and generative tools through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

40.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

40.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

Chapter 41

Flexible Working Arrangements [New in v2.0]

41.1 Purpose and Scope

41.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

41.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on flexible working arrangements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to flexible working arrangements and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

41.1.3 The Company recognises that flexible working arrangements has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

41.1.4 The Company recognises that flexible working arrangements has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.1.5 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on flexible working arrangements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.1.7 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on flexible working arrangements.

41.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on flexible working arrangements.

41.1.9 The Company recognises that flexible working arrangements has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in

this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.1.10 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

41.1.11 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on flexible working arrangements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.1.12 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

41.1.13 The objective of these provisions on flexible working arrangements is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

41.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

41.1.15 The objective of these provisions on flexible working arrangements is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

41.1.16 The objective of these provisions on flexible working arrangements is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.1.17 The Company recognises that flexible working arrangements has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

41.1.18 The Company recognises that flexible working arrangements has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to flexible working arrangements and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.1.20 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

41.1.21 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to flexible working arrangements and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

41.1.22 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

41.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

41.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

41.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to flexible working arrangements and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

41.1.27 The objective of these provisions on flexible working arrangements is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to flexible working arrangements and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

41.1.28 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.1.29 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to flexible working arrangements and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.1.30 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on flexible working arrangements.

41.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.1.32 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on flexible working arrangements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.2 Definitions and Interpretation

41.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

41.2.3 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "flexible working arrangements" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.2.5 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements.

41.2.7 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements.

41.2.9 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

41.2.10 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

41.2.11 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this

provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.2.13 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

41.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.2.15 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

41.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.2.17 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.2.18 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "flexible working arrangements" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.2.20 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "flexible working arrangements" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

41.2.21 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "flexible working arrangements" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

41.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements.

41.2.24 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.2.25 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

41.2.26 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

41.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "flexible working arrangements" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

41.2.29 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that

spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

41.2.30 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to flexible working arrangements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

41.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

41.3 Eligibility and Applicability

41.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for flexible working arrangements restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.3.4 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department

during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.3.5 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

41.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

41.3.8 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.3.9 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

41.3.10 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

41.3.12 Eligibility for flexible working arrangements shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

41.3.13 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.3.15 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements.

41.3.16 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

41.3.17 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

41.3.18 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

41.3.21 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for flexible working arrangements restricted until the matter is concluded.

41.3.22 Eligibility for flexible working arrangements shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.3.23 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for flexible working arrangements restricted until the matter is concluded. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Eligibility for flexible working arrangements shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

41.3.25 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.3.26 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.3.27 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Eligibility for flexible working arrangements shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

41.3.28 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for flexible working arrangements restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.3.30 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.3.31 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for flexible working arrangements restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.3.33 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on flexible working arrangements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

41.4 Responsibilities of Employees

41.4.1 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.4.2 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.4.4 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts.

41.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on flexible working arrangements and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.4.6 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on flexible working arrangements and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

41.4.8 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a

term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.4.10 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

41.4.11 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

41.4.13 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.4.14 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

41.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.4.16 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements.

41.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.4.18 The employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

41.4.19 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements.

41.4.20 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.4.21 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.4.22 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.4.23 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.4.25 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.4.26 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.4.27 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of flexible working arrangements as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

41.4.28 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.4.29 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on flexible working arrangements and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the

employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on flexible working arrangements and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

41.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.4.32 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.4.33 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to flexible working arrangements and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with flexible working arrangements.

41.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

41.5.1 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on flexible working arrangements and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

41.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.5.3 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

41.5.4 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently. Notices

under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.5.5 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to flexible working arrangements to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

41.5.7 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

41.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on flexible working arrangements and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.5.10 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on flexible working arrangements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.5.11 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to flexible working arrangements to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.5.12 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on flexible working arrangements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.5.13 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

41.5.14 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to flexible working arrangements within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.5.15 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

41.5.16 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to flexible working arrangements to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.5.17 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.5.18 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

41.5.19 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

41.5.20 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on flexible working arrangements and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

41.5.21 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more

favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently.

41.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on flexible working arrangements and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently.

41.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on flexible working arrangements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to flexible working arrangements within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

41.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on flexible working arrangements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

41.5.26 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.5.27 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to flexible working arrangements to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on flexible working arrangements.

41.5.29 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the

employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on flexible working arrangements.

41.5.30 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on flexible working arrangements and applies them consistently.

41.5.31 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.5.32 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on flexible working arrangements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to flexible working arrangements to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

41.5.33 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

41.6.1 HR shall respond to every written query on flexible working arrangements within 3 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

41.6.4 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to flexible working arrangements.

41.6.5 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall respond to every written

query on flexible working arrangements within 10 working days of receipt.

41.6.6 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for flexible working arrangements and shall make them available to all employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

41.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for flexible working arrangements and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.6.10 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

41.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to flexible working arrangements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.6.12 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to flexible working arrangements and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.6.13 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.6.14 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for flexible working arrangements and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek

guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.6.16 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for flexible working arrangements and shall make them available to all employees.

41.6.17 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.6.18 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall respond to every written query on flexible working arrangements within 5 working days of receipt.

41.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.6.20 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to flexible working arrangements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

41.6.21 HR shall respond to every written query on flexible working arrangements within 2 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

41.6.22 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to flexible working arrangements and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.6.24 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to flexible working arrangements and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

41.6.26 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to flexible working arrangements and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

41.6.27 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to flexible working arrangements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.6.28 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.6.29 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.6.30 HR shall respond to every written query on flexible working arrangements within 14 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to flexible working arrangements and on the applicable legal requirements.

41.6.31 HR shall respond to every written query on flexible working arrangements within 10 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.6.32 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for flexible working arrangements and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.6.33 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with flexible working arrangements in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests

were received.

41.7 Procedure and Process Steps

41.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.7.2 The employee shall initiate the process relating to flexible working arrangements by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The employee shall initiate the process relating to flexible working arrangements by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team.

41.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

41.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.7.7 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

41.7.8 The employee shall initiate the process relating to flexible working arrangements by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.7.9 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.7.10 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. By way of illustration, where the

concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

41.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.7.12 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.7.14 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

41.7.15 The employee shall initiate the process relating to flexible working arrangements by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.7.16 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

41.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.7.18 The employee shall initiate the process relating to flexible working arrangements by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager.

41.7.19 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.7.20 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 15 working days of receiving it.

41.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.7.23 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it.

41.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.7.25 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

41.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.7.27 The employee shall initiate the process relating to flexible working arrangements by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.7.29 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

41.7.30 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.7.31 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 3 working days of receiving it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

41.7.32 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

41.7.33 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

41.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

41.8.1 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

41.8.2 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to flexible working arrangements that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

41.8.3 All documents relating to flexible working arrangements shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.8.4 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.8.5 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to flexible working arrangements that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.8.6 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

41.8.7 All documents relating to flexible working arrangements shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under

this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

41.8.8 All documents relating to flexible working arrangements shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

41.8.10 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

41.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to flexible working arrangements that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

41.8.12 All documents relating to flexible working arrangements shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.8.13 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.8.15 Records relating to flexible working arrangements shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.8.16 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

41.8.17 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

41.8.18 Records relating to flexible working arrangements shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to flexible working arrangements that is held about them, subject to applicable law. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.8.20 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.8.21 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.8.22 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.8.23 All documents relating to flexible working arrangements shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.8.24 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.8.25 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to flexible working arrangements that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.8.26 Records relating to flexible working arrangements shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where records

are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

41.8.27 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.8.28 All documents relating to flexible working arrangements shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.8.30 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Records relating to flexible working arrangements shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

41.8.31 Records relating to flexible working arrangements shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.8.32 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to flexible working arrangements that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.8.33 Records relating to flexible working arrangements shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

41.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

41.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice.

41.9.2 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories

unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

41.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.9.4 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.9.5 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

41.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.9.8 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

41.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.9.10 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the

matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on flexible working arrangements may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.9.12 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on flexible working arrangements may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

41.9.13 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

41.9.14 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

41.9.15 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

41.9.16 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.9.17 Exceptions to the provisions on flexible working arrangements may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

41.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

41.9.19 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

41.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A request for an exception

shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

41.9.21 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on flexible working arrangements may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice.

41.9.24 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

41.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

41.9.26 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

41.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

41.9.28 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.9.29 Exceptions to the provisions on flexible working arrangements may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

41.9.30 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

41.9.31 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.9.32 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.9.33 Exceptions to the provisions on flexible working arrangements may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

41.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on flexible working arrangements shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

41.10.3 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

41.10.4 Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.10.5 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.10.7 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Where an external regulator requests information concerning flexible working arrangements, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

41.10.8 Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.10.9 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

41.10.10 Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.10.11 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.10.12 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

41.10.13 Compliance with the provisions on flexible working arrangements shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.10.14 Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.10.15 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements.

41.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

41.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning flexible working arrangements, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.10.20 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

41.10.21 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.10.22 Where an external regulator requests information concerning flexible working arrangements, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning flexible working arrangements, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements.

41.10.24 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

41.10.25 Compliance with the provisions on flexible working arrangements shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

41.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.10.27 Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning flexible working arrangements, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.10.29 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.10.30 Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

41.10.31 An internal audit of flexible working arrangements shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to flexible working arrangements. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

41.10.33 Compliance data relating to flexible working arrangements shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

41.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

41.11.1 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

41.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to flexible working arrangements shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to flexible working arrangements shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

41.11.4 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.11.5 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to flexible working arrangements shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.11.7 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.11.8 A failure to comply with the provisions on flexible working arrangements may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

41.11.9 A failure to comply with the provisions on flexible working arrangements may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.11.11 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.11.12 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to flexible working arrangements shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.11.14 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A failure to comply with the provisions on flexible working arrangements may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

41.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

41.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

41.11.17 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

41.11.18 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.11.19 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

41.11.20 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

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41.11.25 A failure to comply with the provisions on flexible working arrangements may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.11.27 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

41.11.28 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to flexible working arrangements shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

41.11.29 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

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41.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on flexible working arrangements may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to flexible working arrangements shall be treated as serious misconduct.

41.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades,

locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

41.12 Review and Amendment

41.12.1 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.12.2 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

41.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

41.12.4 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.12.5 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

41.12.6 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

41.12.7 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.12.8 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

41.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

41.12.11 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

41.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

41.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

41.12.14 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

41.12.15 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

41.12.16 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

41.12.17 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.12.18 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

41.12.19 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. Cost

implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

41.12.20 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.12.21 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

41.12.22 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

41.12.23 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to flexible working arrangements made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

41.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

41.12.25 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

41.12.26 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

41.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

41.12.28 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Head of Department

shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

41.12.29 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

41.12.30 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

41.12.31 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

41.12.32 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on flexible working arrangements through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect.

41.12.33 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to flexible working arrangements, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

Chapter 42

Mental Health Support Programme [New in v2.0]

42.1 Purpose and Scope

42.1.1 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.1.2 The Company recognises that mental health support programme has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.1.3 The objective of these provisions on mental health support programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.1.4 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on mental health support programme. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.1.5 The Company recognises that mental health support programme has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

42.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.1.7 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

42.1.9 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.1.10 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

42.1.12 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

42.1.13 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on mental health support programme. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The objective of these provisions on mental health support programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

42.1.14 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

42.1.15 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

42.1.16 The objective of these provisions on mental health support programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

42.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

42.1.19 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.1.20 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on mental health support programme. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

42.1.21 The Company recognises that mental health support programme has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.1.22 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

42.1.23 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

42.1.24 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

42.1.25 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on mental health support programme. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

42.1.26 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to mental health support programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.1.27 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The objective of these provisions on mental health support programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

42.1.28 The objective of these provisions on mental health support programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.1.29 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on mental health support programme. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.1.30 The Company recognises that mental health support programme has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

42.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

42.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The objective of these provisions on mental health support programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

42.2 Definitions and Interpretation

42.2.1 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to mental health support programme. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "mental health support programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

42.2.3 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.2.4 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to mental health support programme.

42.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to mental health support programme.

42.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

42.2.8 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.2.9 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

42.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to mental health support programme.

42.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and

a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

42.2.15 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.2.16 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.2.17 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.2.18 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "mental health support programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

42.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

42.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "mental health support programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

42.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.2.22 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.2.23 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be

supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.2.24 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.2.25 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to mental health support programme. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

42.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.2.27 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.2.28 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.2.29 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

42.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

42.2.31 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

42.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

42.3 Eligibility and Applicability

42.3.1 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on mental health support programme.

42.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for mental health support programme restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for mental health support programme restricted until the matter is concluded.

42.3.4 Eligibility for mental health support programme shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.3.5 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

42.3.6 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on mental health support programme.

42.3.7 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.3.8 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for mental health support programme restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

42.3.10 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for mental health support programme restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.3.11 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

42.3.12 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on mental health support programme. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.3.14 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for mental health support programme restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility for mental health support programme shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

42.3.15 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for mental health support programme restricted until the matter is concluded. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.3.16 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on mental health support programme.

42.3.17 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.3.18 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision

reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

42.3.21 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.3.22 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for mental health support programme restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

42.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

42.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.3.26 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.3.27 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to

ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

42.3.28 Eligibility for mental health support programme shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.3.29 Eligibility for mental health support programme shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

42.3.30 Eligibility for mental health support programme shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on mental health support programme.

42.3.31 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on mental health support programme. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.3.32 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

42.3.33 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on mental health support programme. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

42.4 Responsibilities of Employees

42.4.1 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

42.4.3 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.4.4 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts.

42.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.4.6 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

42.4.7 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.4.8 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on mental health support programme and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts.

42.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.4.12 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.4.15 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.4.16 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on mental health support programme and shall comply with them at all times.

42.4.17 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

42.4.18 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with mental health support programme. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.4.19 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.4.20 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be

delivered without delay.

42.4.21 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

42.4.24 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to mental health support programme and shall not withhold material facts.

42.4.25 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

42.4.26 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

42.4.27 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on mental health support programme and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.4.28 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with mental health support programme.

42.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

42.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

42.4.32 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of mental health support programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR.

42.4.33 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

42.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

42.5.1 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on mental health support programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

42.5.2 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

42.5.3 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on mental health support programme.

42.5.4 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to mental health support programme within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on mental health support programme.

42.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to mental health support programme to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.5.7 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on mental health support programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.5.9 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on mental health support programme.

42.5.10 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to mental health support programme within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.5.11 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to mental health support programme to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.5.12 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to mental health support programme within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to mental health support programme to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on mental health support programme.

42.5.15 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

42.5.16 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.5.17 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to mental health support programme within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

42.5.18 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to mental health support programme to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

42.5.20 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to mental health support programme to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on mental health support programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

42.5.21 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on mental health support programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently.

42.5.22 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to mental health support programme within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to mental health support programme to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

42.5.23 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.5.24 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.5.25 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.5.26 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.5.27 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.5.28 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

42.5.29 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on mental health support programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on mental health support programme and applies them consistently.

42.5.30 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on mental health support programme. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

42.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to mental health support programme to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.5.33 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on mental health support programme. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

42.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.6.2 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with mental health support programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

42.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with mental health support programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

42.6.6 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to mental health support programme. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with mental health support programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

42.6.7 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for mental health support programme and shall make them available to all employees. HR shall respond to every written query on mental health support programme within 5 working days of receipt.

42.6.8 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for mental health support programme and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

42.6.9 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements.

42.6.10 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements.

42.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

42.6.14 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with mental health support programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

42.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

42.6.17 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with mental health support programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for mental health support programme and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to mental health support programme. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.6.20 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with mental health support programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.6.21 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to mental health support programme. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the

decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on mental health support programme within 30 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

42.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to mental health support programme. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for mental health support programme and shall make them available to all employees.

42.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

42.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on mental health support programme within 10 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

42.6.27 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for mental health support programme and shall make them available to all employees.

42.6.28 HR shall respond to every written query on mental health support programme within 15 working days of receipt.

42.6.29 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to mental health support programme. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements.

42.6.30 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for mental health support programme and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff

member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

42.6.31 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to mental health support programme and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.6.32 HR shall respond to every written query on mental health support programme within 10 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

42.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

42.7 Procedure and Process Steps

42.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 30 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

42.7.2 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it.

42.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.7.5 The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

42.7.6 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it.

42.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.7.8 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.7.9 The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.7.10 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.7.11 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager.

42.7.12 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.7.13 The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.7.14 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.7.15 The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

42.7.17 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting a written request to

the HR Business Partner.

42.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.7.19 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.7.20 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.7.21 The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting the approved template to the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

42.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager.

42.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

42.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.7.25 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager.

42.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

42.7.28 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

42.7.29 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.7.30 The employee shall initiate the process relating to mental health support programme by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

42.7.31 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

42.7.32 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

42.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

42.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

42.8.1 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

42.8.2 Records relating to mental health support programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.8.3 All documents relating to mental health support programme shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

42.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

42.8.5 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.8.6 Records relating to mental health support programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.8.7 All documents relating to mental health support programme shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

42.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.8.9 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.8.10 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

42.8.12 All documents relating to mental health support programme shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.8.13 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

42.8.14 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

42.8.15 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

42.8.16 Records relating to mental health support programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.8.17 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.8.18 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where

relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

42.8.21 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

42.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

42.8.24 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

42.8.25 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.8.26 Records relating to mental health support programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.8.27 All documents relating to mental health support programme shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.8.28 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.8.29 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to mental health support programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following

Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.8.30 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.8.31 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.8.32 Records relating to mental health support programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years.

42.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Records relating to mental health support programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

42.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

42.9.1 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.9.2 Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

42.9.3 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

42.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this

Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

42.9.8 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.9.10 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

42.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.9.12 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

42.9.13 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

42.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.9.16 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

42.9.17 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

42.9.18 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

42.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.9.21 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

42.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

42.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.9.27 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

42.9.28 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

42.9.29 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

42.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.9.31 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

42.9.33 Exceptions to the provisions on mental health support programme may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

42.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

42.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on mental health support programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.10.2 An internal audit of mental health support programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where the

person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Compliance with the provisions on mental health support programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

42.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to mental health support programme. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.10.4 An internal audit of mental health support programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.10.5 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to mental health support programme. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Compliance data relating to mental health support programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

42.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.10.7 An internal audit of mental health support programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to mental health support programme.

42.10.8 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.10.9 Compliance data relating to mental health support programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.10.10 Compliance with the provisions on mental health support programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

42.10.11 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Compliance with the provisions on mental health support programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

42.10.12 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.10.14 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to mental health support programme. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

42.10.16 An internal audit of mental health support programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.10.17 An internal audit of mental health support programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.10.18 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.10.19 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.10.20 Compliance data relating to mental health support programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.10.21 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to mental health support programme. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

42.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.10.23 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

42.10.24 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.10.27 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance with the provisions on mental health support programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

42.10.28 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An internal audit of mental health support programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

42.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

42.10.30 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.10.31 Where an external regulator requests information concerning mental health support programme, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.10.32 An internal audit of mental health support programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.10.33 Compliance data relating to mental health support programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

42.11.1 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to mental health support programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.11.2 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

42.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to mental health support programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.11.4 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.11.5 A failure to comply with the provisions on mental health support programme may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.11.6 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.11.7 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.11.8 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.11.9 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.11.10 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

42.11.11 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to mental health support programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to mental health support programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

42.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to mental health support programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

42.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.11.16 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.11.17 A failure to comply with the provisions on mental health support programme may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed

strictly by all concerned.

42.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.11.19 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.11.21 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

42.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

42.11.23 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

42.11.25 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

42.11.26 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Employees should seek guidance

from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

42.11.27 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

42.11.28 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

42.11.30 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

42.11.31 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to mental health support programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.11.32 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

42.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.12 Review and Amendment

42.12.1 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

42.12.2 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to mental health support programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

42.12.3 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.12.4 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

42.12.5 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect.

42.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

42.12.7 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

42.12.8 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

42.12.9 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

42.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.12.11 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

42.12.12 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

42.12.13 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.12.14 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

42.12.15 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.12.16 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.12.17 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

42.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

42.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

42.12.20 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

42.12.21 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.12.22 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.12.23 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.12.24 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

42.12.25 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

42.12.26 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

42.12.27 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

42.12.29 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

42.12.30 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

42.12.31 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

42.12.32 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

42.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation

shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to mental health support programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on mental health support programme through the HR portal not less than 14 days before it takes effect.

Chapter 43

Employee Referral Programme

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Referral reward	a bonus of 5,000 payable after 6 months of service	**a bonus of 10,000 payable after 3 months of service**

43.1 Purpose and Scope

43.1.1 The Company recognises that employee referral programme has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

43.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. †

43.1.3 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.1.4 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

43.1.5 The objective of these provisions on employee referral programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.1.7 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee referral programme. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company recognises that employee referral programme has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

43.1.8 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee referral programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

43.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee referral programme.

43.1.10 The Company recognises that employee referral programme has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

43.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee referral programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

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43.1.15 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee referral programme. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

43.1.16 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

43.1.17 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.1.18 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee referral programme and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

43.1.19 The objective of these provisions on employee referral programme is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

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instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

43.1.27 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

43.1.28 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee referral programme. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

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43.2 Definitions and Interpretation

43.2.1 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

43.2.2 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

43.2.3 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.2.4 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.2.5 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

43.2.6 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

43.2.7 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

43.2.8 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.2.9 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.2.10 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.2.11 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

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43.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

43.2.17 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee referral programme. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

43.2.18 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

43.2.19 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

43.2.20 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.2.22 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.2.23 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

43.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

43.2.26 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

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43.2.28 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

43.2.29 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.2.30 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

43.2.31 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

43.2.32 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee referral programme" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

43.2.33 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.3 Eligibility and Applicability

43.3.1 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.3.2 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

43.3.3 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

43.3.4 Eligibility for employee referral programme shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter

directly to the Policy Committee.

43.3.5 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee referral programme. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

43.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee referral programme. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

43.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee referral programme. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

43.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.3.10 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.3.11 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee referral programme restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

43.3.12 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

43.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee referral programme. †

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43.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee referral programme.

43.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.3.20 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

43.3.21 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

43.3.22 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.3.23 Eligibility for employee referral programme shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

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43.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.3.26 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee referral programme restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.3.27 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee referral programme. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

43.3.28 Eligibility for employee referral programme shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

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43.3.32 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee referral programme restricted until the matter is concluded. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.4 Responsibilities of Employees

43.4.1 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.4.2 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

43.4.3 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.4.4 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.4.5 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee referral programme and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.4.6 An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.4.7 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee referral programme. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee referral programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee referral programme. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.4.13 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.4.14 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

43.4.15 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee referral programme. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

43.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee referral programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee referral programme and shall comply with them at all times.

43.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.4.19 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee referral programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.4.20 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.4.21 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

43.4.22 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee referral programme.

43.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee referral programme and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

43.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee referral programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.4.25 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee referral programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.4.26 The staff member shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.4.27 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee referral programme as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee referral programme and shall comply with them at all times. †

43.4.28 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

43.4.29 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.4.30 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee referral programme and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.4.32 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee referral programme. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

43.4.34 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee referral programme and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. **[New in v2.0]**

43.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

43.5.1 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

43.5.2 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

43.5.3 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the HR Director without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.5.4 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee referral programme. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.5.5 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee referral programme and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

43.5.6 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

43.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee referral programme and applies them consistently.

43.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.5.9 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.5.10 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.5.11 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.5.12 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

43.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.5.14 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the HR Director without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.5.18 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the Policy Committee without undue delay. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee referral programme within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. †

43.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.5.21 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee referral programme. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.5.22 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.5.23 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee referral programme within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

43.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.5.25 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee referral programme. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee referral programme within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file.

43.5.26 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee referral programme within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.5.27 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee referral programme and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

43.5.28 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the

decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.5.30 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee referral programme within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.5.31 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

43.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

43.5.33 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee referral programme to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

43.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee referral programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

43.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 14 working days of receipt. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.6.3 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 7 working days of receipt. †

43.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee referral programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.6.5 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 30 working days of receipt.

43.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee referral programme and shall make them available to all employees.

43.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee referral programme.

43.6.8 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.6.9 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee referral programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

43.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee referral programme. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

43.6.12 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 2 working days of receipt.

43.6.13 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 3 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.6.14 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.6.15 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee referral programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

43.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 7 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

43.6.17 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.6.18 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee referral programme and on the applicable legal requirements.

43.6.19 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 10 working days of receipt. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

43.6.20 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 2 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

43.6.21 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee referral programme and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 10 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.6.23 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee referral programme and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.6.24 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee referral programme and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.6.25 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee referral programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on employee referral programme within 21 working days of receipt. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee referral programme.

43.6.27 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee referral programme in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

43.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

43.6.29 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee referral programme and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.6.30 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee referral programme and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.6.31 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee referral programme. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.6.32 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

43.6.33 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee referral programme and on the applicable legal requirements.

43.7 Procedure and Process Steps

43.7.1 **Referral reward.** An employee who successfully refers a candidate shall receive a bonus of 10,000 payable after 3 months of service. **[Revised in v2.0; previously a bonus of 5,000 payable after 6 months of service]**

43.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.7.4 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.7.5 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.7.6 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 30 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.7.7 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.7.8 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

43.7.10 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.7.11 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.7.12 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 14 working days of receiving it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

43.7.14 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be

applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.7.15 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.7.17 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.7.19 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.7.20 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

43.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee referral programme by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

43.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less

favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.7.26 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

43.7.27 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

43.7.29 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

43.7.30 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.7.31 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

43.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.7.33 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.7.34 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

43.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee referral programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.8.2 Records relating to employee referral programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. †

43.8.3 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee referral programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.8.4 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

43.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.8.6 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

43.8.7 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

43.8.8 Records relating to employee referral programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

43.8.9 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.8.10 Records relating to employee referral programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee referral programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

43.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.8.13 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.8.14 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.8.16 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.8.17 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee referral programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.8.18 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

43.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee referral programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.8.20 Records relating to employee referral programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. †

43.8.21 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.8.24 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Records relating to employee referral programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

43.8.25 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

43.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

43.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee referral programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

43.8.28 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.8.29 Records relating to employee referral programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

43.8.30 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee referral programme that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.8.31 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.8.32 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.8.33 Records relating to employee referral programme shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years.

43.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

43.9.1 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 14 working days' written notice.

43.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

43.9.3 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

43.9.4 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.9.8 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions to the provisions on employee referral programme may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

43.9.9 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.9.10 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice.

43.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on employee referral programme may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and

employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice.

43.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.9.13 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

43.9.14 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.9.15 Exceptions to the provisions on employee referral programme may be granted only in writing by the Policy Committee and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

43.9.16 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

43.9.17 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

43.9.18 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.9.19 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.9.20 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on

employee referral programme may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

43.9.21 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

43.9.22 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice.

43.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

43.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on employee referral programme may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

43.9.26 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

43.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

43.9.28 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice.

43.9.29 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

43.9.30 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

43.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

43.9.32 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

43.9.33 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

43.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

43.10.1 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.10.2 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

43.10.3 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee referral programme. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.10.4 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.10.5 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee referral programme. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee referral programme. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.10.7 Compliance data relating to employee referral programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.10.8 Compliance data relating to employee referral programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.10.9 Compliance with the provisions on employee referral programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.10.10 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee referral programme, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

43.10.11 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee referral programme. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.10.12 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

43.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.10.14 Compliance data relating to employee referral programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

43.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee referral programme. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee referral programme, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

43.10.16 Compliance with the provisions on employee referral programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.10.18 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

43.10.19 Compliance data relating to employee referral programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee referral programme, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

43.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on employee referral programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

43.10.22 Compliance data relating to employee referral programme shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An internal audit of employee referral programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

43.10.23 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

43.10.24 An internal audit of employee referral programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.10.25 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

43.10.26 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee referral programme. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.10.27 Compliance with the provisions on employee referral programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

43.10.28 An internal audit of employee referral programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

43.10.29 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.10.30 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.10.31 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee referral programme. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

43.10.32 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An internal audit of employee referral programme shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

43.10.33 Compliance with the provisions on employee referral programme shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

43.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

43.11.3 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

43.11.4 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

43.11.5 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period,

the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

43.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee referral programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

43.11.7 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee referral programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

43.11.8 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

43.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

43.11.11 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

43.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

43.11.13 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

43.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee referral programme shall be treated as serious misconduct.

43.11.15 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

43.11.16 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee referral programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.11.17 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee referral programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

43.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.11.21 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee referral programme shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

43.11.22 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

43.11.23 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

43.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

43.11.25 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.11.26 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee referral programme may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

43.11.27 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

43.11.28 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

43.11.29 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

43.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.11.31 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee referral programme may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.12 Review and Amendment

43.12.1 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.12.3 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee referral programme through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

43.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

43.12.5 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.12.6 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

43.12.7 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

43.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee referral programme through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.12.9 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

43.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to employee referral programme made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

43.12.11 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.12.12 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

43.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

43.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

43.12.15 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee referral programme through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

43.12.16 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

43.12.17 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee referral programme through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.12.18 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. †

43.12.20 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

43.12.21 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line

Manager.

43.12.22 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

43.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

43.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee referral programme, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee referral programme through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

43.12.25 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

43.12.26 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

43.12.27 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

43.12.28 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.12.29 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

43.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee referral programme through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

43.12.31 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. †

43.12.32 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

43.12.33 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee referral programme through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect.

Chapter 44

Employee Representation and Consultation

44.1 Purpose and Scope

44.1.1 The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.1.2 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.1.3 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.1.4 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.1.5 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.1.6 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.1.7 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

44.1.8 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation.

44.1.9 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

44.1.10 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee representation and consultation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.1.11 The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

44.1.12 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.1.13 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee representation and consultation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

44.1.14 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

44.1.16 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.1.17 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

44.1.18 The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act

within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.1.19 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.1.20 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.1.21 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.1.22 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

44.1.23 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

44.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on employee representation and consultation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.1.25 The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.1.26 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee representation and consultation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

44.1.27 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to employee representation and consultation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

44.1.28 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.1.29 The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.1.30 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

44.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

44.1.32 The objective of these provisions on employee representation and consultation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.1.33 The Company recognises that employee representation and consultation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.2 Definitions and Interpretation

44.2.1 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.2.2 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations

team.

44.2.3 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

44.2.4 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

44.2.5 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.2.6 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

44.2.7 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

44.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

44.2.10 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee representation and consultation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.2.11 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

44.2.13 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

44.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.2.15 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

44.2.16 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee representation and consultation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.2.18 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

44.2.19 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.2.20 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee representation and consultation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

44.2.21 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.2.22 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee representation and consultation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

44.2.23 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

44.2.24 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

44.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.2.28 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.2.29 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.2.30 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to employee representation and consultation. †

44.2.31 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.2.32 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

44.2.33 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "employee representation and consultation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.3 Eligibility and Applicability

44.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

44.3.2 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.3.4 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final.

44.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee representation and consultation restricted until the matter is concluded.

44.3.6 Eligibility for employee representation and consultation shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.3.7 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee representation and consultation.

44.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.3.10 Eligibility for employee representation and consultation shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

44.3.11 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

44.3.12 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

44.3.13 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee representation and consultation restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.3.14 Eligibility for employee representation and consultation shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and

length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.3.15 Eligibility for employee representation and consultation shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.3.16 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.3.17 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

44.3.18 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.3.19 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.3.21 Eligibility for employee representation and consultation shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.3.22 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.3.23 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee representation and consultation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.3.24 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee representation and consultation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.3.25 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee representation and consultation.

44.3.26 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee representation and consultation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

44.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee representation and consultation.

44.3.28 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Eligibility for employee representation and consultation shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

44.3.29 Eligibility for employee representation and consultation shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.3.30 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

44.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for employee representation and consultation restricted until the matter is concluded.

44.3.32 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on employee representation and consultation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.3.33 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.4 Responsibilities of Employees

44.4.1 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times.

44.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of employee representation and consultation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

44.4.3 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.4.4 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.4.5 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.4.6 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.4.7 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee representation and consultation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.4.8 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the

discretion of the HR Operations team. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee representation and consultation.

44.4.9 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.4.10 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

44.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.4.12 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee representation and consultation.

44.4.13 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.4.14 An eligible employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee representation and consultation.

44.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times.

44.4.17 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material

facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

44.4.18 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times.

44.4.19 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee representation and consultation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

44.4.20 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

44.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.4.22 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.4.23 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.4.24 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances

of each case.

44.4.25 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.4.26 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.4.27 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.4.28 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to employee representation and consultation and shall not withhold material facts. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with employee representation and consultation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.4.30 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times.

44.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

44.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on employee representation and consultation and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

44.4.33 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the

decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

44.5.1 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee representation and consultation and applies them consistently. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

44.5.3 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee representation and consultation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

44.5.4 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

44.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee representation and consultation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.5.6 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee representation and consultation within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

44.5.7 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the Policy Committee without undue delay. †

44.5.8 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee representation and consultation and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the HR Director without undue delay.

44.5.9 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee representation and consultation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to

another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.5.10 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee representation and consultation within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.5.11 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee representation and consultation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.5.12 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee representation and consultation and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee representation and consultation.

44.5.13 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

44.5.14 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee representation and consultation within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee representation and consultation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.5.16 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee representation and consultation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.5.17 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee representation and consultation and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.5.18 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.5.19 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee representation and consultation within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information

system. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.5.20 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

44.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.5.22 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee representation and consultation and applies them consistently.

44.5.23 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee representation and consultation.

44.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

44.5.25 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

44.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to employee representation and consultation to the HR Director without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

44.5.27 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee representation and consultation within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.5.28 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on employee representation and consultation and applies them consistently. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.5.29 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to employee representation and consultation within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

44.5.30 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee representation and consultation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

44.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on employee representation and consultation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

44.5.32 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on employee representation and consultation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

44.5.33 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

44.6.1 HR shall respond to every written query on employee representation and consultation within 30 working days of receipt. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.6.3 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.6.4 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed

strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

44.6.5 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.6.6 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements.

44.6.7 HR shall respond to every written query on employee representation and consultation within 10 working days of receipt. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

44.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements.

44.6.9 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

44.6.10 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.6.11 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be

delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.6.14 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

44.6.15 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements.

44.6.16 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee representation and consultation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.6.17 HR shall respond to every written query on employee representation and consultation within 30 working days of receipt. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

44.6.18 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.6.19 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.6.20 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.6.21 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements.

44.6.22 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee representation and consultation and shall make them available to all employees.

44.6.23 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.6.24 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to employee representation and consultation and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.6.25 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee representation and consultation.

44.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on employee representation and consultation within 7 working days of receipt.

44.6.27 HR shall respond to every written query on employee representation and consultation within 10 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

44.6.28 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.6.30 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.6.31 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for employee representation and consultation and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

44.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with employee representation and consultation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

44.6.33 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to employee representation and consultation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall respond to every written query on employee representation and

consultation within 15 working days of receipt.

44.7 Procedure and Process Steps

44.7.1 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee representation and consultation by submitting a written request to the Reporting Manager. †

44.7.2 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee representation and consultation by submitting the approved template to the Head of Department. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

44.7.4 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.7.5 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 2 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.7.6 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

44.7.7 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee representation and consultation by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.7.8 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.7.10 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

44.7.11 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee representation and consultation by submitting a written request to the Line Manager. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.7.12 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.7.13 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

44.7.14 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.7.15 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

44.7.16 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.7.17 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.7.18 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee representation and consultation by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests

were received.

44.7.20 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

44.7.22 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 14 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

44.7.23 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee representation and consultation by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager.

44.7.24 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

44.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 7 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

44.7.27 On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.7.28 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the

employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.7.29 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.7.30 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

44.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to employee representation and consultation by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.7.32 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.7.33 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

44.8.1 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

44.8.2 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.8.3 All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.8.4 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period,

the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

44.8.5 All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.8.6 Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee representation and consultation that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

44.8.8 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years.

44.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

44.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.8.12 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

44.8.13 Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years.

44.8.14 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.8.15 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. †

44.8.16 All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.8.17 All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.8.18 All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

44.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee representation and consultation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.8.20 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee representation and consultation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years.

44.8.21 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

44.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.8.23 Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

44.8.24 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

44.8.25 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.8.26 Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

44.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.8.28 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

44.8.29 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.8.30 All documents relating to employee representation and consultation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.8.31 Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to employee representation and consultation that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

44.8.32 Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.8.33 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

44.8.34 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Records relating to employee representation and consultation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. **[New in v2.0]**

44.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

44.9.1 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. †

44.9.2 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

44.9.3 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

44.9.4 Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. †

44.9.7 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

44.9.8 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Business Partner shall

decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

44.9.10 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

44.9.11 Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.9.12 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice.

44.9.13 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

44.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 2 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.9.16 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.9.17 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

44.9.18 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.9.19 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall

be recorded together with the reason for it. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. †

44.9.20 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

44.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.9.23 Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.9.24 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

44.9.25 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

44.9.26 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

44.9.27 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

44.9.28 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

44.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on employee representation and consultation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

44.9.30 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.9.31 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

44.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.9.33 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

44.10.1 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

44.10.2 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

44.10.3 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee representation and consultation, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee representation and consultation.

44.10.4 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each

case. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee representation and consultation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources.

44.10.5 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

44.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

44.10.7 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.10.8 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

44.10.9 Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

44.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee representation and consultation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.10.11 Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.10.12 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

44.10.13 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee representation and consultation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

44.10.14 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee representation and consultation, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the

Company decides otherwise.

44.10.15 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee representation and consultation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

44.10.17 Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee representation and consultation.

44.10.18 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

44.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee representation and consultation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.10.20 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee representation and consultation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

44.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee representation and consultation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

44.10.22 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

44.10.23 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Where an external regulator requests information concerning employee representation and consultation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

44.10.24 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee representation and consultation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.10.25 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

44.10.26 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

44.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to employee representation and consultation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

44.10.28 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.10.29 An internal audit of employee representation and consultation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

44.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on employee representation and consultation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.10.31 Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.10.32 Compliance data relating to employee representation and consultation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An internal audit of employee representation and consultation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

44.10.33 An internal audit of employee representation and consultation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

44.11.1 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

44.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

44.11.3 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

44.11.4 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

44.11.5 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.11.6 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

44.11.7 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate

the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

44.11.8 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.11.9 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.11.10 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

44.11.11 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee representation and consultation shall be treated as serious misconduct. †

44.11.12 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

44.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

44.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee representation and consultation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee representation and consultation shall be treated as serious misconduct.

44.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

44.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by

the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

44.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

44.11.20 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee representation and consultation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

44.11.21 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.11.23 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.11.24 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

44.11.25 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee representation and consultation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

44.11.26 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee representation and consultation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

44.11.27 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

44.11.28 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

44.11.29 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee representation and consultation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

44.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

44.11.31 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to employee representation and consultation shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

44.11.32 A failure to comply with the provisions on employee representation and consultation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

44.11.33 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. †

44.12 Review and Amendment

44.12.1 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

44.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

44.12.3 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall

then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.12.5 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

44.12.6 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

44.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

44.12.8 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.12.9 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.12.10 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

44.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

44.12.12 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

44.12.13 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

44.12.14 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.12.15 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee representation and consultation through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.12.16 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

44.12.17 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.12.18 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

44.12.19 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on employee representation and consultation through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

44.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

44.12.21 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.12.22 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

44.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

44.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.12.25 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

44.12.26 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

44.12.27 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to employee representation and consultation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

44.12.28 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

44.12.29 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to employee representation and consultation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

44.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

44.12.31 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

44.12.32 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

44.12.33 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

Chapter 45

Workplace Investigations

Chapter at a glance

Key provision	Position in v1.0	Position in v2.0
Investigation timeline	60 days	**45 days**

45.1 Purpose and Scope

45.1.1 The Company recognises that workplace investigations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.1.3 The Company recognises that workplace investigations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

45.1.4 The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.1.5 The Company recognises that workplace investigations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.1.6 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

45.1.7 The Company recognises that workplace investigations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at

the discretion of the HR Operations team. The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

45.1.8 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

45.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

45.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.1.11 The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on workplace investigations. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

45.1.13 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

45.1.14 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

45.1.15 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.1.16 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

45.1.17 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

45.1.18 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.1.19 The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

45.1.20 The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.1.21 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.1.22 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.1.23 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

45.1.24 The Company recognises that workplace investigations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

45.1.25 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.1.26 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.1.27 The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.1.28 The objective of these provisions on workplace investigations is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on workplace investigations.

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45.1.30 The Company recognises that workplace investigations has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.1.31 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to workplace investigations and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.1.32 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

45.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on workplace investigations. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. †

45.2 Definitions and Interpretation

45.2.1 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

45.2.2 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.2.3 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

45.2.4 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

45.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.2.7 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

45.2.8 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "workplace investigations" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. †

45.2.9 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to workplace investigations.

45.2.10 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

45.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The

Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.2.12 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

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45.2.18 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

45.2.20 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "workplace investigations" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.2.21 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

45.2.22 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

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45.2.24 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to workplace investigations.

45.2.25 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

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45.2.31 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an

employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "workplace investigations" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

45.2.32 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

45.2.33 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "workplace investigations" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

45.3 Eligibility and Applicability

45.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded.

45.3.2 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on workplace investigations. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.3.3 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on workplace investigations.

45.3.4 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

45.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

45.3.6 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.3.7 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

45.3.8 Eligibility for workplace investigations shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on workplace investigations.

45.3.9 Eligibility for workplace investigations shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on workplace investigations.

45.3.10 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Eligibility for workplace investigations shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

45.3.11 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

45.3.12 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

45.3.13 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.3.14 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.3.15 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall

decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.3.16 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.3.17 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on workplace investigations. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.3.19 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

45.3.20 Eligibility for workplace investigations shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

45.3.21 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Eligibility for workplace investigations shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

45.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.3.23 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

45.3.24 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.3.25 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.3.26 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.3.27 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

45.3.28 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.3.29 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

45.3.30 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for workplace investigations restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.3.31 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

45.3.32 Eligibility for workplace investigations shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on workplace investigations.

45.3.33 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

45.3.34 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. **[New in v2.0]**

45.4 Responsibilities of Employees

45.4.1 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

45.4.2 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on workplace investigations and shall comply with them at all times. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR.

45.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on workplace investigations and shall comply with them at all times. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.4.4 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

45.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to workplace investigations and shall not withhold material facts.

45.4.6 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with workplace investigations. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

45.4.7 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to workplace investigations and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.4.8 The staff member shall submit the prescribed form to the Head of Department at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to workplace investigations and shall not withhold material facts.

45.4.9 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.4.10 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with workplace investigations. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be

borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.4.11 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the HR Business Partner at least 2 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

45.4.12 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with workplace investigations. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

45.4.13 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with workplace investigations. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

45.4.14 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.4.16 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

45.4.17 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

45.4.18 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.4.19 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

45.4.22 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to workplace investigations and shall not withhold material facts. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on workplace investigations and shall comply with them at all times. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.4.24 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

45.4.25 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

45.4.26 The employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

45.4.27 The staff member shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.4.28 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on workplace investigations and shall comply with them at all times. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.4.29 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with workplace investigations. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

45.4.30 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 3 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

45.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of workplace investigations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.4.32 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of workplace investigations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.4.33 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of workplace investigations as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

45.5.1 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.5.3 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on workplace investigations. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

45.5.4 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on workplace investigations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

45.5.5 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.5.6 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on workplace investigations and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.5.7 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on workplace investigations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

45.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on workplace investigations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the HR Director without undue delay.

45.5.9 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on workplace investigations and applies them consistently. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

45.5.11 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on workplace investigations and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on workplace investigations.

45.5.12 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on workplace investigations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on workplace investigations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

45.5.16 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to workplace investigations within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.5.17 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on workplace investigations.

45.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to workplace investigations within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

45.5.19 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on workplace investigations and applies them consistently. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.5.20 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on workplace investigations and applies them consistently. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.5.21 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on workplace investigations. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

45.5.23 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on workplace investigations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

45.5.24 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Policy Committee without undue delay. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

45.5.25 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

45.5.26 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.5.27 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. †

45.5.28 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on workplace investigations and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

45.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on workplace investigations and applies them consistently.

45.5.30 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.5.31 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to workplace investigations within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register.

45.5.32 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to workplace investigations to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

45.5.33 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to workplace investigations within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

45.6.1 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

45.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with workplace investigations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

45.6.3 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.6.4 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for workplace investigations and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements.

45.6.5 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to workplace investigations. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.6.6 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for workplace investigations and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.6.7 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. †

45.6.8 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with workplace investigations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

45.6.9 HR shall respond to every written query on workplace investigations within 10 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.6.11 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

45.6.12 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for workplace investigations and shall make them available to all employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each

case.

45.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.6.15 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to workplace investigations. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

45.6.16 HR shall respond to every written query on workplace investigations within 14 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to workplace investigations.

45.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for workplace investigations and shall make them available to all employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

45.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to workplace investigations. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for workplace investigations and shall make them available to all employees.

45.6.19 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with workplace investigations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

45.6.20 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to workplace investigations. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.6.21 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be

victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

45.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on workplace investigations within 7 working days of receipt. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.6.23 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall respond to every written query on workplace investigations within 2 working days of receipt.

45.6.24 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with workplace investigations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.6.26 HR shall respond to every written query on workplace investigations within 5 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. HR shall respond to every written query on workplace investigations within 21 working days of receipt.

45.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for workplace investigations and shall make them available to all employees.

45.6.29 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with workplace investigations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the

prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

45.6.31 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with workplace investigations in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

45.6.32 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to workplace investigations and on the applicable legal requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.6.33 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for workplace investigations and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.7 Procedure and Process Steps

45.7.1 **Investigation timeline.** Every workplace investigation shall ordinarily be completed within 45 days of its commencement. **[Revised in v2.0; previously 60 days]**

45.7.2 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

45.7.3 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.7.4 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.7.5 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it.

45.7.6 The employee shall initiate the process relating to workplace investigations by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 21 working days of receiving it.

45.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

45.7.8 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.7.9 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.7.10 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.7.11 The employee shall initiate the process relating to workplace investigations by submitting the prescribed form to the HR Operations team. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

45.7.12 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 21 working days of receiving it. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

45.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 3 working days of receiving it.

45.7.15 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

45.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. On receipt of the request, the Head of Department shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

45.7.19 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

45.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

45.7.21 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.7.22 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

45.7.23 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

45.7.24 The employee shall initiate the process relating to workplace investigations by submitting the approved template to the Line Manager. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the

order in which the requests were received. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

45.7.25 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 3 working days of receiving it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.7.26 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

45.7.27 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.7.28 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.7.29 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

45.7.30 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 14 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.7.31 The employee shall initiate the process relating to workplace investigations by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

45.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.7.33 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

45.7.34 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 15 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter

directly to the HR Director. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

45.7.35 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. **[New in v2.0]**

45.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

45.8.1 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.8.2 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

45.8.3 All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

45.8.4 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. †

45.8.5 All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.8.6 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.8.7 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to workplace investigations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Records relating to workplace investigations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years.

45.8.8 Records relating to workplace investigations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.8.9 Records relating to workplace investigations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.8.10 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to workplace investigations that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.8.11 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to workplace investigations that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

45.8.13 All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

45.8.14 All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.8.15 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.8.16 Records relating to workplace investigations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. †

45.8.17 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.8.18 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the

employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

45.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

45.8.20 Records relating to workplace investigations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.8.21 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

45.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.8.23 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.8.24 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

45.8.25 All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

45.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.8.27 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.8.28 All documents relating to workplace investigations shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be

applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.8.29 Records relating to workplace investigations shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

45.8.30 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

45.8.31 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

45.8.32 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.8.33 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. †

45.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

45.9.1 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

45.9.3 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

45.9.4 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

45.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

45.9.6 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.9.7 Exceptions to the provisions on workplace investigations may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

45.9.8 Exceptions to the provisions on workplace investigations may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

45.9.9 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.9.11 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.9.12 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

45.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. †

45.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.9.16 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

45.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

45.9.18 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

45.9.19 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

45.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Exceptions to the provisions on workplace investigations may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

45.9.21 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt

with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.9.23 Exceptions that affect more than 14 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

45.9.24 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

45.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on workplace investigations may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

45.9.26 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.9.27 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

45.9.28 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.9.29 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

45.9.30 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.9.31 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the

concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Exceptions to the provisions on workplace investigations may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

45.9.32 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Exceptions to the provisions on workplace investigations may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. †

45.9.33 Exceptions to the provisions on workplace investigations may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 3 working days' written notice. †

45.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

45.10.1 Compliance data relating to workplace investigations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.10.2 Where an external regulator requests information concerning workplace investigations, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.10.4 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to workplace investigations. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.10.5 An internal audit of workplace investigations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.10.6 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to workplace investigations. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.10.7 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.10.8 Compliance data relating to workplace investigations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

45.10.9 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.10.10 An internal audit of workplace investigations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.10.11 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

45.10.12 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

45.10.13 Compliance data relating to workplace investigations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.10.14 Compliance data relating to workplace investigations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. Where an external regulator requests information concerning workplace investigations, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. †

45.10.15 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect

any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.10.17 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to workplace investigations. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

45.10.18 Compliance data relating to workplace investigations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Compliance with the provisions on workplace investigations shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

45.10.19 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to workplace investigations. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

45.10.20 Where an external regulator requests information concerning workplace investigations, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

45.10.21 An internal audit of workplace investigations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.10.22 Where an external regulator requests information concerning workplace investigations, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to workplace investigations. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An internal audit of workplace investigations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

45.10.24 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

45.10.25 Compliance data relating to workplace investigations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the

employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

45.10.26 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

45.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to workplace investigations. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.10.28 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.10.29 Where an external regulator requests information concerning workplace investigations, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on workplace investigations shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.10.31 An internal audit of workplace investigations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.10.32 An internal audit of workplace investigations shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

45.10.33 Compliance data relating to workplace investigations shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

45.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

45.11.1 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. †

45.11.2 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to workplace investigations shall be treated as serious misconduct.

45.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to workplace investigations shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

45.11.4 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.11.5 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

45.11.6 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

45.11.7 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

45.11.8 A failure to comply with the provisions on workplace investigations may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.11.9 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the

following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

45.11.11 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to workplace investigations shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

45.11.12 A failure to comply with the provisions on workplace investigations may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

45.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to workplace investigations shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.11.14 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.11.15 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

45.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. As an illustration, a request relating to workplace investigations made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

45.11.17 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.11.18 A failure to comply with the provisions on workplace investigations may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

45.11.19 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

45.11.20 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

45.11.21 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.11.22 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.11.23 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

45.11.24 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.11.25 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

45.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

45.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

45.11.30 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.11.31 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.11.32 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

45.12 Review and Amendment

45.12.1 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

45.12.2 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect.

45.12.3 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on workplace investigations through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

45.12.4 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. †

45.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the

department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

45.12.6 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.12.7 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

45.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

45.12.10 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

45.12.11 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

45.12.12 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

45.12.13 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

45.12.14 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail

address on record.

45.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

45.12.16 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

45.12.17 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

45.12.18 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on workplace investigations through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to workplace investigations, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

45.12.19 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

45.12.20 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

45.12.21 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on workplace investigations through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. †

45.12.22 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

45.12.23 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on workplace investigations through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

45.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. The

Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

45.12.25 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

45.12.26 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.12.27 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

45.12.28 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on workplace investigations through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.12.29 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on workplace investigations through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

45.12.30 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

45.12.31 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

45.12.32 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

45.12.33 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on workplace investigations through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

45.12.34 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. **[New in v2.0]**

Chapter 46

Business Continuity and Emergency Response

46.1 Purpose and Scope

46.1.1 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

46.1.2 The objective of these provisions on business continuity and emergency response is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response.

46.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to business continuity and emergency response and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.1.4 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

46.1.5 The objective of these provisions on business continuity and emergency response is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to business continuity and emergency response and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

46.1.6 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.1.7 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.1.8 The objective of these provisions on business continuity and emergency response is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.1.9 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.1.10 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response.

46.1.11 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

46.1.12 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

46.1.13 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. The objective of these provisions on business continuity and emergency response is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

46.1.14 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.1.15 The objective of these provisions on business continuity and emergency response is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

46.1.16 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.1.17 The objective of these provisions on business continuity and emergency response is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

46.1.18 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

46.1.19 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to business continuity and emergency response and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.1.20 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

46.1.21 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.1.22 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.1.23 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.1.24 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.1.25 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to business continuity and emergency response and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.1.26 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Cost

implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

46.1.27 The Company recognises that business continuity and emergency response has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.1.28 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.1.29 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.1.30 The objective of these provisions on business continuity and emergency response is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.1.31 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

46.1.32 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on business continuity and emergency response. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.1.33 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. †

46.2 Definitions and Interpretation

46.2.1 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

46.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

46.2.3 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.2.5 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response. †

46.2.6 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

46.2.7 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.2.8 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

46.2.9 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team.

46.2.10 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "business continuity and emergency response" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

46.2.11 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "business continuity and emergency response" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this

provision applies to their situation. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response.

46.2.12 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

46.2.13 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.2.14 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response.

46.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.2.16 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "business continuity and emergency response" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

46.2.18 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "business continuity and emergency response" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.2.20 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the

prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

46.2.21 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.2.22 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "business continuity and emergency response" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response.

46.2.23 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

46.2.24 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "business continuity and emergency response" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.2.25 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.2.26 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

46.2.27 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.2.28 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response.

46.2.29 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations

team.

46.2.30 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to business continuity and emergency response. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.2.31 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.2.32 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.2.33 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.3 Eligibility and Applicability

46.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

46.3.2 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

46.3.3 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. †

46.3.4 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual

circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. †

46.3.5 Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

46.3.7 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.3.8 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.3.9 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.3.10 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on business continuity and emergency response. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.3.13 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on business continuity and emergency response. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded.

46.3.14 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded.

This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

46.3.15 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.3.16 Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the Line Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.3.17 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on business continuity and emergency response. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.3.18 Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on business continuity and emergency response. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

46.3.20 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.3.21 Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on business continuity and emergency response.

46.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.3.23 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive

rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

46.3.24 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on business continuity and emergency response.

46.3.25 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

46.3.26 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded.

46.3.27 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Policy Committee, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

46.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.3.29 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.3.30 Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

46.3.31 Eligibility for business continuity and emergency response shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.3.32 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.3.33 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for business continuity and emergency response restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on business continuity and emergency response.

46.4 Responsibilities of Employees

46.4.1 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with business continuity and emergency response. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

46.4.2 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.4.3 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with business continuity and emergency response. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An eligible employee shall submit the approved template to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

46.4.4 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and shall comply with them at all times. An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Line Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. †

46.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of business continuity and emergency response as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

46.4.6 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.4.7 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following

Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.4.8 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.4.9 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with business continuity and emergency response. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

46.4.10 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to business continuity and emergency response and shall not withhold material facts. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

46.4.11 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to business continuity and emergency response and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.4.12 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of business continuity and emergency response as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with business continuity and emergency response.

46.4.14 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.4.16 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Business Partner at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

46.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of business continuity and emergency response as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent

seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

46.4.18 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with business continuity and emergency response. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

46.4.19 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and shall comply with them at all times. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

46.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.4.21 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

46.4.22 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and shall comply with them at all times. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.4.23 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.4.24 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to business continuity and emergency response and shall not withhold material facts. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.4.25 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to business continuity and emergency response and shall not withhold material facts. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.4.26 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with business continuity and emergency response. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.4.27 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to business continuity and emergency response and shall not withhold material facts. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.4.28 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

46.4.29 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR.

46.4.30 The employee shall submit the approved template to the HR Business Partner at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

46.4.31 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of business continuity and emergency response as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.4.32 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

46.4.33 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with business continuity and emergency response. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

46.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

46.5.1 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.5.2 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on business continuity and emergency response. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.5.3 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to business continuity and emergency response to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

46.5.4 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

46.5.5 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on business continuity and emergency response and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.5.6 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.5.7 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.5.8 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on business continuity and emergency response and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.5.9 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the

discretion of the Reporting Manager. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on business continuity and emergency response.

46.5.10 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.5.11 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

46.5.12 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and applies them consistently.

46.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on business continuity and emergency response and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.5.14 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.5.15 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on business continuity and emergency response and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on business continuity and emergency response.

46.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

46.5.17 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

46.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 30 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.5.19 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the departmental register. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to business continuity and emergency response to the Policy Committee without undue delay. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.5.22 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to business continuity and emergency response to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

46.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.5.24 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

46.5.25 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on business continuity and emergency response.

46.5.26 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on business continuity and emergency response and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.5.27 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on business continuity and emergency response and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. An

example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.5.28 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 2 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on business continuity and emergency response. †

46.5.30 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 14 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to business continuity and emergency response to the Policy Committee without undue delay.

46.5.31 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

46.5.32 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and applies them consistently. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to business continuity and emergency response within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository.

46.5.33 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on business continuity and emergency response and applies them consistently. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

46.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with business continuity and emergency response in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis.

46.6.2 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to business continuity and emergency response and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.6.3 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.6.4 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to business continuity and emergency response. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with business continuity and emergency response in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.6.6 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.6.7 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall respond to every written query on business continuity and emergency response within 21 working days of receipt. †

46.6.8 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.6.9 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.6.10 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with business continuity and emergency response in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.6.11 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.6.12 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.6.13 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to business continuity and emergency response and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to business continuity and emergency

response.

46.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.6.15 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for business continuity and emergency response and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall respond to every written query on business continuity and emergency response within 5 working days of receipt.

46.6.16 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to business continuity and emergency response and on the applicable legal requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.6.17 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for business continuity and emergency response and shall make them available to all employees. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

46.6.18 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to business continuity and emergency response. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

46.6.19 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to business continuity and emergency response and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.6.20 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for business continuity and emergency response and shall make them available to all employees.

46.6.21 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall

continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to business continuity and emergency response and on the applicable legal requirements.

46.6.22 HR shall respond to every written query on business continuity and emergency response within 30 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with business continuity and emergency response in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

46.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to business continuity and emergency response. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.6.24 HR shall respond to every written query on business continuity and emergency response within 14 working days of receipt. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

46.6.25 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for business continuity and emergency response and shall make them available to all employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.6.26 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

46.6.27 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis.

46.6.28 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to business continuity and emergency response and on the applicable legal requirements. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.6.29 HR shall respond to every written query on business continuity and emergency response within 5 working days of receipt. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.6.30 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.6.31 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for business continuity and emergency response and shall make them available to all employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR

may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

46.6.32 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to business continuity and emergency response. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.6.33 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.7 Procedure and Process Steps

46.7.1 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 30 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.7.2 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.7.3 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

46.7.4 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

46.7.5 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of

equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.7.8 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.7.9 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.7.10 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

46.7.11 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 5 working days of receiving it.

46.7.12 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

46.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 10 working days of receiving it. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.7.15 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

46.7.16 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

46.7.17 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.7.18 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 10 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

46.7.19 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 10 working days of receiving it.

46.7.20 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The employee shall initiate the process relating to business continuity and emergency response by submitting the approved template to the HR Business Partner.

46.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.7.22 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 15 working days of receiving it.

46.7.23 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The employee shall initiate the process relating to business continuity and emergency response by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager.

46.7.24 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

46.7.25 The employee shall initiate the process relating to business continuity and emergency response by submitting the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.7.26 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.7.27 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

46.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

46.7.29 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 5 working days of receiving it. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.7.30 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

46.7.31 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.7.32 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 2 working days of receiving it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.7.33 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

46.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

46.8.1 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to business continuity and emergency response that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.8.2 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to business continuity and emergency response that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

46.8.4 All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

46.8.5 All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

46.8.6 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.8.7 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.8.8 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

46.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.8.10 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.8.11 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.8.12 All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

46.8.13 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. †

46.8.14 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

46.8.15 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.8.16 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.8.17 All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

46.8.18 All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

46.8.19 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

46.8.20 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

46.8.21 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.8.22 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.8.23 All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

46.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to business continuity and emergency response that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

46.8.25 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

46.8.26 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

46.8.27 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to business continuity and emergency response that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.8.28 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored.

46.8.29 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. By way of illustration, where an eligible

employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

46.8.30 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

46.8.31 Records relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 10 years. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.8.32 All documents relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.8.33 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

46.9.1 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

46.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.9.3 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.9.4 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate,

where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

46.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

46.9.6 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

46.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 10 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

46.9.8 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.9.9 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Exceptions to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

46.9.11 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

46.9.12 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

46.9.13 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.9.14 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.9.15 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

46.9.16 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.9.17 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.9.18 Exceptions to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.9.19 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.9.21 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

46.9.23 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as

received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

46.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 21 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

46.9.26 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

46.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Exceptions to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

46.9.28 Exceptions to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

46.9.29 Exceptions to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.9.30 Exceptions that affect more than 15 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

46.9.31 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 2 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.9.32 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.9.33 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

46.10.1 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.10.2 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

46.10.3 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.10.4 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.10.5 An internal audit of business continuity and emergency response shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.10.6 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

46.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.10.8 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.10.9 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

46.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

46.10.12 Compliance data relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

46.10.13 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.10.14 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response.

46.10.15 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.10.16 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

46.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response.

46.10.19 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.10.20 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Compliance data relating to business continuity and emergency response shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

46.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning business continuity and emergency response, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human

Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.10.22 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

46.10.24 An internal audit of business continuity and emergency response shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee.

46.10.25 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.10.26 Where an external regulator requests information concerning business continuity and emergency response, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer.

46.10.27 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response.

46.10.30 An internal audit of business continuity and emergency response shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

46.10.31 Where an external regulator requests information concerning business continuity and emergency response, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is

more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

46.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.10.33 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to business continuity and emergency response. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.10.34 Compliance with the provisions on business continuity and emergency response shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An internal audit of business continuity and emergency response shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. **[New in v2.0]**

46.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

46.11.1 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.11.2 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to business continuity and emergency response shall be treated as serious misconduct. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

46.11.3 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. †

46.11.4 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.11.5 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

46.11.6 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.11.7 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.11.8 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

46.11.9 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

46.11.10 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

46.11.11 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

46.11.12 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

46.11.13 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

46.11.14 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to business continuity and emergency response shall be treated as serious misconduct. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.11.15 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

46.11.16 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

46.11.17 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

46.11.18 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

46.11.20 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

46.11.21 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

46.11.22 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

46.11.23 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

46.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

46.11.25 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.11.26 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

46.11.27 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

46.11.28 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to business continuity and emergency response shall be treated as serious misconduct.

46.11.30 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.11.31 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.11.32 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

46.11.33 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to business continuity and emergency response shall be treated as serious misconduct. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

46.12 Review and Amendment

46.12.1 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect.

46.12.2 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

46.12.3 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

46.12.4 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

46.12.5 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.12.6 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

46.12.7 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.12.8 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

46.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

46.12.10 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

46.12.11 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.12.12 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

46.12.13 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

46.12.14 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

46.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.12.16 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

46.12.17 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

46.12.19 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

46.12.20 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect.

46.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

46.12.22 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. †

46.12.23 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

46.12.24 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

46.12.25 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to business continuity and emergency response, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

46.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

46.12.27 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

46.12.28 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect.

46.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

46.12.30 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a

right under this Chapter in good faith.

46.12.31 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on business continuity and emergency response through the HR portal not less than 30 days before it takes effect.

46.12.32 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

46.12.33 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to business continuity and emergency response made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

46.12.34 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. **[New in v2.0]**

Chapter 47

Drug and Alcohol Policy

47.1 Purpose and Scope

47.1.1 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

47.1.2 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to drug and alcohol policy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

47.1.4 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to drug and alcohol policy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.1.5 The objective of these provisions on drug and alcohol policy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.1.6 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.1.7 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.1.8 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on drug and alcohol policy. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

47.1.9 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to drug and alcohol policy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.1.10 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.1.11 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.1.12 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.1.13 The objective of these provisions on drug and alcohol policy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.1.14 The objective of these provisions on drug and alcohol policy is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

47.1.15 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.1.16 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

47.1.17 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on drug and alcohol policy.

47.1.18 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority

nominated by HR.

47.1.19 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

47.1.20 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

47.1.21 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.1.22 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

47.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on drug and alcohol policy.

47.1.24 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.1.25 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.1.26 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.1.27 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on drug and alcohol policy.

47.1.28 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

47.1.29 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

47.1.30 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

47.1.31 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

47.1.32 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to drug and alcohol policy and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

47.1.33 The Company recognises that drug and alcohol policy has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.2 Definitions and Interpretation

47.2.1 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

47.2.2 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

47.2.3 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to drug and alcohol policy. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

47.2.5 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

47.2.6 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to drug and alcohol policy.

47.2.7 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

47.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to drug and alcohol policy. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

47.2.10 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.2.11 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The

time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

47.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

47.2.13 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

47.2.14 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays.

47.2.15 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to drug and alcohol policy.

47.2.16 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.2.17 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.2.18 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

47.2.19 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.2.21 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

47.2.22 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

47.2.23 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

47.2.24 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

47.2.25 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.2.26 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.2.27 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

47.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

47.2.29 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

47.2.30 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

47.2.31 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to drug and alcohol policy.

47.2.32 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "drug and alcohol policy" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

47.2.33 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages.

47.3 Eligibility and Applicability

47.3.1 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for drug and alcohol policy restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

47.3.2 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.3.3 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.3.4 Eligibility for drug and alcohol policy shall be determined by the Head of Department on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

47.3.6 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for drug and alcohol policy restricted until the matter is concluded. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

47.3.7 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.3.8 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.3.9 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.3.10 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.3.11 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.3.12 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy.

47.3.13 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

47.3.14 Eligibility for drug and alcohol policy shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.3.15 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

47.3.16 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for drug and alcohol policy restricted until the matter is concluded. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

47.3.17 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for drug and alcohol policy restricted until the matter is concluded. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.3.19 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

47.3.20 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

47.3.21 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.3.22 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.3.23 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

47.3.24 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.3.25 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.3.26 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

47.3.27 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.3.28 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for drug and alcohol policy restricted until the matter is concluded. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements.

47.3.29 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.3.30 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Chief People Officer, whose decision shall be final.

47.3.31 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.3.32 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

47.3.33 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on drug and alcohol policy.

47.4 Responsibilities of Employees

47.4.1 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with drug and alcohol policy.

47.4.2 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with drug and alcohol policy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.4.3 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of drug and alcohol policy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

47.4.4 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of drug and alcohol policy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

47.4.5 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

47.4.6 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

47.4.7 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

47.4.8 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to drug and alcohol policy and shall not withhold material facts. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

47.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Employees are responsible for

keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

47.4.10 The concerned employee shall submit a written request to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.4.11 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.4.12 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to drug and alcohol policy and shall not withhold material facts. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.4.13 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of drug and alcohol policy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. †

47.4.14 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and shall comply with them at all times. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR.

47.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

47.4.16 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of drug and alcohol policy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

47.4.17 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of drug and alcohol policy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

47.4.18 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to drug and alcohol policy and shall not withhold material facts. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

47.4.19 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and shall comply with them at all times. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides

otherwise.

47.4.20 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.4.21 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Line Manager or to HR. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and shall comply with them at all times.

47.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with drug and alcohol policy.

47.4.23 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with drug and alcohol policy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to drug and alcohol policy and shall not withhold material facts.

47.4.24 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of drug and alcohol policy as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

47.4.25 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and shall comply with them at all times. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

47.4.26 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to drug and alcohol policy and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

47.4.27 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with drug and alcohol policy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.4.28 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with drug and alcohol policy. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.4.29 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To

illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

47.4.30 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

47.4.31 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.4.32 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Business Partner or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

47.4.33 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.4.34 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to drug and alcohol policy and shall not withhold material facts. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Business Partner at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. **[New in v2.0]**

47.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

47.5.1 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to drug and alcohol policy to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

47.5.2 The Reporting Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and applies them consistently. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

47.5.3 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the

new Line Manager. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to drug and alcohol policy to the HR Director without undue delay.

47.5.4 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on drug and alcohol policy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

47.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on drug and alcohol policy. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

47.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to drug and alcohol policy to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

47.5.7 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

47.5.8 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to drug and alcohol policy within 21 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.5.9 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.5.10 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.5.11 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on drug and alcohol policy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

47.5.12 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on drug and alcohol policy.

47.5.13 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to drug and alcohol policy to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on drug and alcohol policy.

47.5.14 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on drug and alcohol policy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.5.15 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to drug and alcohol policy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to drug and alcohol policy to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay.

47.5.16 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.5.17 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on drug and alcohol policy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

47.5.18 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to drug and alcohol policy within 5 working days and shall record the outcome in the employee's personnel file. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

47.5.19 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and applies them consistently. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.5.20 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to drug and alcohol policy within 10 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system.

47.5.21 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to drug and alcohol policy to the Policy Committee without undue delay. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.5.22 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on drug and alcohol policy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.5.23 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on drug and

alcohol policy and applies them consistently.

47.5.24 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

47.5.25 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on drug and alcohol policy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

47.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.5.27 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to drug and alcohol policy to the HR Director without undue delay. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on drug and alcohol policy. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. †

47.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.5.30 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and applies them consistently. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on drug and alcohol policy and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.5.33 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on drug and alcohol policy and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are

sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

47.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

47.6.1 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.6.2 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall respond to every written query on drug and alcohol policy within 7 working days of receipt.

47.6.3 HR shall respond to every written query on drug and alcohol policy within 14 working days of receipt. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.6.4 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees.

47.6.5 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. HR shall respond to every written query on drug and alcohol policy within 3 working days of receipt.

47.6.6 HR shall respond to every written query on drug and alcohol policy within 5 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

47.6.7 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to drug and alcohol policy. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

47.6.8 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to drug and alcohol policy and on the applicable legal requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

47.6.9 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.6.10 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.6.11 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.6.12 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to drug and alcohol policy and on the applicable legal requirements.

47.6.13 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it.

47.6.14 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.6.15 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.6.16 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.6.17 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

47.6.19 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

47.6.20 HR shall respond to every written query on drug and alcohol policy within 21 working days of receipt. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.6.21 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees.

47.6.22 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to drug and alcohol policy. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

47.6.23 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

47.6.24 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to drug and alcohol policy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.6.25 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.6.26 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to drug and alcohol policy and on the applicable legal requirements.

47.6.27 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.6.28 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for drug and alcohol policy and shall make them available to all employees. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.6.29 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following

Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Head of Human Resources on a quarterly basis.

47.6.30 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

47.6.31 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.6.32 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.6.33 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with drug and alcohol policy in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

47.7 Procedure and Process Steps

47.7.1 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.7.2 Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.7.3 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 7 working days of receiving it.

47.7.4 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 30 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.7.5 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each

case. The employee shall initiate the process relating to drug and alcohol policy by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team.

47.7.6 The employee shall initiate the process relating to drug and alcohol policy by submitting an HR portal request to the Reporting Manager. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

47.7.7 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

47.7.8 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.7.9 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The employee shall initiate the process relating to drug and alcohol policy by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department.

47.7.10 Where additional information is needed, the HR Business Partner shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

47.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

47.7.12 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

47.7.13 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.7.14 On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible

is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.7.15 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

47.7.16 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.7.17 The employee shall initiate the process relating to drug and alcohol policy by submitting an HR portal request to the HR Operations team. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.7.18 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

47.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to drug and alcohol policy by submitting the prescribed form to the Line Manager. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

47.7.20 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

47.7.21 The decision shall be communicated to the staff member in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

47.7.22 Where additional information is needed, the Head of Department shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. The employee shall initiate the process relating to drug and alcohol policy by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department.

47.7.23 The employee shall initiate the process relating to drug and alcohol policy by submitting the approved template to the Reporting Manager.

47.7.24 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

47.7.25 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the staff member and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.7.26 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

47.7.27 Where additional information is needed, the Reporting Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Chief People Officer within 21 working days of receiving it.

47.7.28 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.7.29 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

47.7.30 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.7.31 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 5 working days of receiving it.

47.7.32 On receipt of the request, the HR Business Partner shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the

Chief People Officer within 7 working days of receiving it.

47.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

47.8.1 All documents relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

47.8.2 Records relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

47.8.3 All documents relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

47.8.4 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

47.8.5 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

47.8.6 Records relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

47.8.7 All documents relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.8.8 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be

dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. All documents relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

47.8.9 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

47.8.10 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

47.8.11 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

47.8.12 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

47.8.13 Records relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 5 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

47.8.14 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. All documents relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

47.8.15 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.8.16 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.8.17 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are

unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

47.8.18 Records relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.8.19 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

47.8.20 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.8.21 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

47.8.22 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures.

47.8.23 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

47.8.24 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Records relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 21 years.

47.8.25 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

47.8.26 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.8.27 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

47.8.28 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to drug and alcohol policy that is held about them, subject to applicable law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

47.8.29 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. †

47.8.30 Records relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 14 years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

47.8.31 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.8.32 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

47.8.33 Records relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 15 years. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

47.9.1 Exceptions to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

47.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department

concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.9.4 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.9.5 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 30 working days' written notice. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.9.6 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.9.7 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

47.9.8 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.9.9 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.9.10 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

47.9.11 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Exceptions to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

47.9.12 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the

matter directly to the HR Director.

47.9.13 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

47.9.14 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.9.15 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.9.16 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.9.17 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

47.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies.

47.9.19 Exceptions to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. †

47.9.20 Exceptions that affect more than 30 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. †

47.9.21 A request for an exception shall be made in the prescribed form and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall

continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.9.22 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.9.23 Every exception shall be recorded in the departmental register together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

47.9.24 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.9.25 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.9.26 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.9.27 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.9.28 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice.

47.9.29 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

47.9.30 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

47.9.31 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be

dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.9.32 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Exceptions to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

47.9.33 Exceptions to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 7 working days' written notice.

47.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

47.10.1 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.10.2 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.10.4 An internal audit of drug and alcohol policy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.10.5 Compliance data relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.10.6 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Compliance with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

47.10.7 Where an external regulator requests information concerning drug and alcohol policy, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

47.10.8 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

47.10.9 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.10.10 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

47.10.11 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy.

47.10.12 Where an external regulator requests information concerning drug and alcohol policy, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Compliance data relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

47.10.13 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

47.10.14 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

47.10.15 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

47.10.16 Compliance with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

47.10.17 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

47.10.18 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.10.19 Where an external regulator requests information concerning drug and alcohol policy, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

47.10.20 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager. An internal audit of drug and alcohol policy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director.

47.10.21 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Compliance data relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

47.10.22 Compliance data relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. Where an external regulator requests information concerning drug and alcohol policy, the request shall be routed through the HR Director.

47.10.23 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.10.24 Compliance with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.10.25 An internal audit of drug and alcohol policy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Policy Committee. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.10.26 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.10.27 Compliance data relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

47.10.28 An internal audit of drug and alcohol policy shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

47.10.29 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.10.30 Compliance with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.10.31 Compliance with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

47.10.32 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to drug and alcohol policy. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.10.33 Compliance data relating to drug and alcohol policy shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

47.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

47.11.1 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. †

47.11.2 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

47.11.3 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

47.11.4 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

47.11.5 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.11.6 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.11.7 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. A failure to comply with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

47.11.8 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

47.11.9 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to drug and alcohol policy shall be treated as serious misconduct. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.11.10 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.11.11 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to drug and alcohol policy shall be treated as serious misconduct.

47.11.12 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.11.13 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to drug and alcohol policy shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

47.11.14 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the

employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

47.11.15 A failure to comply with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.11.16 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to drug and alcohol policy shall be treated as serious misconduct. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law.

47.11.17 A failure to comply with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

47.11.18 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

47.11.19 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.11.20 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

47.11.22 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to drug and alcohol policy shall be treated as serious misconduct. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

47.11.23 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.11.24 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

47.11.25 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.11.26 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.11.27 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion.

47.11.28 A failure to comply with the provisions on drug and alcohol policy may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to drug and alcohol policy shall be treated as serious misconduct.

47.11.29 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.11.30 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

47.11.31 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

47.11.33 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.12 Review and Amendment

47.12.1 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.12.2 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

47.12.3 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

47.12.4 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

47.12.5 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

47.12.6 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

47.12.7 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 21 days before it takes effect. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

47.12.8 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.12.9 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

47.12.10 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This requirement

applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

47.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

47.12.12 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

47.12.13 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

47.12.14 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 7 days before it takes effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

47.12.15 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

47.12.16 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

47.12.17 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

47.12.18 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect.

47.12.19 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail.

47.12.20 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. The Company's decision under this provision shall

not affect any statutory right of the employee. Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date.

47.12.21 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to drug and alcohol policy made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect.

47.12.22 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

47.12.23 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect.

47.12.24 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

47.12.25 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. †

47.12.26 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 10 days before it takes effect. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

47.12.27 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 5 days before it takes effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

47.12.28 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on drug and alcohol policy through the HR portal not less than 15 days before it takes effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

47.12.29 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

47.12.30 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. †

47.12.31 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. †

47.12.32 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to drug and alcohol policy, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

47.12.33 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

Chapter 48

Dress Code and Personal Presentation

48.1 Purpose and Scope

48.1.1 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

48.1.2 The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual.

48.1.3 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to dress code and personal presentation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

48.1.4 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to dress code and personal presentation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

48.1.5 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The objective of these provisions on dress code and personal presentation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made.

48.1.6 The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on dress code and personal presentation.

48.1.7 The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.1.8 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The time limits in this Chapter are

intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.1.9 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.1.10 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

48.1.11 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to dress code and personal presentation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.1.12 The objective of these provisions on dress code and personal presentation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.1.13 The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.1.14 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.1.15 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter.

48.1.16 The objective of these provisions on dress code and personal presentation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith.

48.1.17 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on dress code and personal presentation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict.

48.1.18 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.1.19 The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. †

48.1.20 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to dress code and personal presentation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.1.21 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on dress code and personal presentation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

48.1.22 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.1.23 Where this Chapter refers to the Company, it includes all subsidiaries and business units that have adopted this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to dress code and personal presentation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location.

48.1.24 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on dress code and personal presentation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.1.25 Nothing in this Chapter limits the rights available to employees under applicable law, which shall prevail in the event of any conflict. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.1.26 The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.1.27 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.1.28 The objective of these provisions on dress code and personal presentation is to ensure consistency, fairness and transparency in the way decisions are made. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

48.1.29 The Company recognises that dress code and personal presentation has a direct effect on employee experience and shall administer this Chapter in good faith. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

48.1.30 This Chapter sets out the Company's approach to dress code and personal presentation and the standards that apply to every employee in every location. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.1.31 These provisions apply to all permanent, fixed-term and probationary employees unless a specific category is excluded in this Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.1.32 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on dress code and personal presentation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.1.33 This Chapter should be read together with the Code of Conduct and the other Chapters of this Manual that bear on dress code and personal presentation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

48.2 Definitions and Interpretation

48.2.1 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

48.2.2 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.2.3 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.2.4 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.2.5 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

48.2.6 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "dress code and personal presentation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the staff member reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role.

48.2.7 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.2.8 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

48.2.9 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "dress code and personal presentation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.2.10 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.2.11 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.2.12 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.2.13 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.2.14 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.2.15 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.2.16 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.2.17 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.2.18 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom an eligible employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat

messages.

48.2.19 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.2.20 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

48.2.21 The term "Line Manager" means the person to whom the concerned employee reports for day-to-day work, and includes any person formally designated to act in that role. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.2.22 The term "HR" means the Human Resources function, including HR Business Partners and the HR Operations team. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "dress code and personal presentation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

48.2.23 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.2.24 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.2.25 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "dress code and personal presentation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

48.2.26 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.2.27 For the purposes of this Chapter, the expression "dress code and personal presentation" has the meaning that is ordinarily attributed to it in Company practice and in this Manual.

No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.2.28 Where a period is expressed in days, the day on which the relevant event occurs is excluded and the last day of the period is included.

48.2.29 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

48.2.30 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.2.31 A reference to "written" or "in writing" includes communication by e-mail or through the HR portal, but excludes informal chat messages. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

48.2.32 Headings are used for convenience only and shall not affect the interpretation of any provision relating to dress code and personal presentation.

48.2.33 A reference to a "working day" is a reference to any day on which the relevant office is open for business, excluding weekly offs and public holidays. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.3 Eligibility and Applicability

48.3.1 Where eligibility is disputed, the concerned employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

48.3.2 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. †

48.3.3 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their

contracted hours.

48.3.4 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.3.5 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

48.3.6 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.3.7 Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.3.8 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for dress code and personal presentation restricted until the matter is concluded.

48.3.9 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.3.10 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for dress code and personal presentation restricted until the matter is concluded. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.3.11 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.3.12 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day

after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.3.13 Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for dress code and personal presentation restricted until the matter is concluded. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. Eligibility for dress code and personal presentation shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

48.3.14 Eligibility for dress code and personal presentation shall be determined by the Reporting Manager on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.3.15 Eligibility for dress code and personal presentation shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

48.3.16 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.3.17 Eligibility for dress code and personal presentation shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

48.3.18 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.3.19 Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

48.3.20 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the

staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.3.21 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.3.22 Eligibility for dress code and personal presentation shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.3.23 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. Employees who are on notice, suspended or under investigation may have their eligibility for dress code and personal presentation restricted until the matter is concluded.

48.3.24 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. Where eligibility is disputed, an eligible employee may refer the question to the Head of Human Resources, whose decision shall be final.

48.3.25 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.3.26 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees on probation shall be eligible only to the extent expressly stated in this Chapter or confirmed in the employment contract.

48.3.27 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.3.28 Every employee who has completed the qualifying period specified in this Manual is eligible to benefit from the provisions on dress code and personal presentation. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours.

48.3.29 Eligibility for dress code and personal presentation shall be determined by the HR Business Partner on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with

by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.3.30 Where eligibility is disputed, the employee may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final.

48.3.31 Where eligibility is disputed, the staff member may refer the question to the HR Director, whose decision shall be final. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.3.32 Part-time employees shall be eligible on a pro-rata basis, calculated by reference to their contracted hours. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Eligibility for dress code and personal presentation shall be determined by the HR Operations team on the basis of the employee's grade, employment category and length of service.

48.3.33 Eligibility under this Chapter does not create an entitlement to any particular outcome and is subject to business requirements. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.4 Responsibilities of Employees

48.4.1 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times.

48.4.2 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. The concerned employee shall submit the approved template to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

48.4.3 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.4.4 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.4.5 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal

e-mail address on record. The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Reporting Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

48.4.6 An eligible employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

48.4.7 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 7 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.4.8 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to dress code and personal presentation and shall not withhold material facts. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.4.9 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 15 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

48.4.10 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

48.4.11 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. †

48.4.12 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.4.13 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.4.14 The employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 30 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to

date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

48.4.15 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Reporting Manager or to HR. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times.

48.4.16 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.4.17 The concerned employee shall submit the prescribed form to the Line Manager at least 14 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.4.18 The staff member shall submit an HR portal request to the Head of Department at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect.

48.4.19 The employee shall submit the prescribed form to the HR Operations team at least 10 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the HR Operations team or to HR.

48.4.20 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.4.21 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to dress code and personal presentation and shall not withhold material facts.

48.4.22 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with dress code and personal presentation. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

48.4.23 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times. Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority.

48.4.24 An employee who becomes aware of any breach of these provisions shall report it promptly to the Head of Department or to HR. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.4.25 Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to dress code and personal presentation and shall not withhold material facts. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

48.4.26 Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

48.4.27 An eligible employee shall submit a written request to the Reporting Manager at least 21 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.4.28 The concerned employee shall submit an HR portal request to the HR Operations team at least 5 working days before the date on which the relevant action is to take effect. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.4.29 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Employees shall provide complete and accurate information when dealing with matters relating to dress code and personal presentation and shall not withhold material facts.

48.4.30 Employees shall treat all information obtained in the course of dress code and personal presentation as confidential and shall not disclose it without authority. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.4.31 Employees shall cooperate fully with any review, verification or inquiry carried out by HR in connection with dress code and personal presentation.

48.4.32 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.4.33 Each employee shall familiarise themselves with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and shall comply with them at all times. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable

to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Employees are responsible for keeping their personal details in the HR portal up to date so that notices can be delivered without delay.

48.5 Responsibilities of Line Managers

48.5.1 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and applies them consistently. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. †

48.5.2 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. †

48.5.3 The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and applies them consistently.

48.5.4 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and applies them consistently. A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter.

48.5.5 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on dress code and personal presentation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

48.5.6 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the Policy Committee without undue delay. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

48.5.7 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The Line Manager shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and applies them consistently.

48.5.8 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the HR Director without undue delay. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.5.9 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to dress code and personal presentation within 15 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

48.5.10 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the HR Director without undue delay. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.5.11 The Head of Department shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department.

48.5.12 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on dress code and personal presentation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.5.13 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on dress code and personal presentation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated.

48.5.14 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on dress code and personal presentation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. †

48.5.15 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.5.16 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company

decides otherwise.

48.5.17 Line Managers shall act on each request relating to dress code and personal presentation within 3 working days and shall record the outcome in the central HR repository. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.5.18 The HR Business Partner shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and applies them consistently. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the HR Director without undue delay.

48.5.19 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the Head of Human Resources without undue delay. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.5.20 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on dress code and personal presentation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.5.21 The HR Operations team shall ensure that every member of the team understands the provisions on dress code and personal presentation and applies them consistently.

48.5.22 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Line Managers shall act on each request relating to dress code and personal presentation within 7 working days and shall record the outcome in the HR information system. †

48.5.23 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.5.24 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on dress code and personal presentation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay.

48.5.25 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

48.5.26 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.5.27 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the HR Director without undue delay.

48.5.28 Line Managers shall treat all team members fairly and shall not allow personal preferences to influence decisions on dress code and personal presentation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on dress code and personal presentation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years.

48.5.29 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.5.30 A Line Manager shall not make any commitment on behalf of the Company that is inconsistent with this Chapter. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. †

48.5.31 Line Managers shall attend the training offered by HR on dress code and personal presentation and shall refresh that training at least once every two years. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.5.32 Where a decision of a Line Manager may have a significant effect on an employee, the manager shall consult HR before the decision is communicated. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.5.33 Line Managers are accountable for escalating any unresolved matter relating to dress code and personal presentation to the Chief People Officer without undue delay. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.6 Responsibilities of Human Resources

48.6.1 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.6.2 HR shall respond to every written query on dress code and personal presentation within 5 working days of receipt. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.6.3 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

48.6.4 HR shall respond to every written query on dress code and personal presentation within 10 working days of receipt. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with dress code and personal presentation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

48.6.5 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for dress code and personal presentation and shall make them available to all employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.6.6 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. HR shall respond to every written query on dress code and personal presentation within 30 working days of receipt.

48.6.7 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with dress code and personal presentation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.6.8 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.6.9 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for dress code and personal presentation and shall make them available to all employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their

situation.

48.6.10 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.6.11 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.6.12 HR shall respond to every written query on dress code and personal presentation within 30 working days of receipt. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

48.6.13 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with dress code and personal presentation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.6.14 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.6.15 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to dress code and personal presentation and on the applicable legal requirements.

48.6.16 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.6.17 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.6.18 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for dress code and personal presentation and shall make them available to all employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

48.6.19 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Chief People Officer on a quarterly basis.

48.6.20 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the HR Director on a quarterly basis. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

48.6.21 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. †

48.6.22 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.6.23 HR shall interpret and administer this Chapter and shall provide advice to employees and managers on matters relating to dress code and personal presentation. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

48.6.24 HR shall treat all personal information received in connection with dress code and personal presentation in accordance with the Data Protection Chapter.

48.6.25 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to dress code and personal presentation and on the applicable legal requirements. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

48.6.26 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner. HR shall respond to every written query on dress code and personal presentation within 30 working days of receipt.

48.6.27 HR shall maintain the forms, templates and portal workflows required for dress code and personal presentation and shall make them available to all employees. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.6.28 HR shall monitor compliance with this Chapter and shall report significant trends to the Policy Committee on a quarterly basis. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.6.29 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to dress code and personal presentation and on the applicable legal requirements. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation,

the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.6.30 HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.6.31 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to dress code and personal presentation and on the applicable legal requirements.

48.6.32 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to dress code and personal presentation and on the applicable legal requirements. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. HR may issue guidance notes from time to time to clarify the application of this Chapter, and such notes shall be read as part of it. †

48.6.33 HR shall ensure that its own staff are trained on the provisions relating to dress code and personal presentation and on the applicable legal requirements. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. HR shall respond to every written query on dress code and personal presentation within 7 working days of receipt.

48.7 Procedure and Process Steps

48.7.1 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

48.7.2 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 14 working days of receiving it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.7.3 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

48.7.4 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. On receipt of the request, the Reporting Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter.

48.7.5 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.7.6 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.7.7 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from an eligible employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.7.8 On receipt of the request, the Line Manager shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the HR information system and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

48.7.9 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

48.7.10 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

48.7.11 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

48.7.12 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.7.13 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 10 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.7.14 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

48.7.15 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. No employee shall be

victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer. Where additional information is needed, the HR Operations team shall request it from the concerned employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided.

48.7.16 The employee shall initiate the process relating to dress code and personal presentation by submitting an HR portal request to the Head of Department. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.7.17 The decision shall be communicated to the employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

48.7.18 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the employee's personnel file and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Head of Human Resources within 7 working days of receiving it.

48.7.19 The employee shall initiate the process relating to dress code and personal presentation by submitting an HR portal request to the Line Manager. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

48.7.20 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.7.21 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.7.22 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if an eligible employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified.

48.7.23 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.7.24 The decision shall be communicated to the concerned employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.7.25 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.7.26 On receipt of the request, the HR Operations team shall acknowledge it in writing and shall review it against the criteria set out in this Chapter. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the HR Director within 30 working days of receiving it.

48.7.27 An employee who is dissatisfied with the decision may appeal to the Policy Committee within 5 working days of receiving it. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.7.28 Where additional information is needed, the Line Manager shall request it from the employee and the period for decision shall be suspended until it is provided. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.7.29 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the central HR repository and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.7.30 The decision shall be communicated to an eligible employee in writing, stating the reasons where the request has been declined or modified. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. To illustrate, where the Head of Department fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

48.7.31 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

48.7.32 Once the decision is communicated, HR shall update the departmental register and shall initiate any consequential action, such as payroll adjustments.

48.7.33 The appeal shall be decided by a person who was not involved in the original decision, and the outcome shall be final.

48.8 Documentation and Record Keeping

48.8.1 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.8.2 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. †

48.8.3 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.8.4 All documents relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

48.8.5 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to dress code and personal presentation that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

48.8.6 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

48.8.7 Records relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to dress code and personal presentation that is held about them, subject to applicable law. †

48.8.8 Records relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.8.9 All documents relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

48.8.10 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. An employee may request a copy of any record relating to dress code and personal presentation that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

48.8.11 All documents relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.8.12 Records relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 3 years. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.8.13 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.8.14 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.8.15 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.8.16 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.8.17 Records relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.8.18 All documents relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be stored in the departmental register and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.8.19 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed

period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

48.8.20 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.8.21 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.8.22 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion.

48.8.23 An employee may request a copy of any record relating to dress code and personal presentation that is held about them, subject to applicable law.

48.8.24 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed.

48.8.25 Records relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 2 years. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.8.26 Records shall be accurate, complete and legible, and corrections shall be made by a dated annotation rather than by deletion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. All documents relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be stored in the employee's personnel file and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel.

48.8.27 All documents relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be stored in the HR information system and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.8.28 Where records are held electronically, regular back-ups shall be taken and tested to ensure that they can be restored. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Records relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 7 years.

48.8.29 Every form submitted under this Chapter shall be dated, signed or electronically authenticated, and filed on the day it is processed. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

48.8.30 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.8.31 All documents relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be stored in the central HR repository and shall be accessible only to authorised personnel. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.8.32 Records relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be retained for the period required by law and in any event for not less than 30 years. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

48.8.33 At the end of the retention period, records shall be destroyed securely in accordance with the Company's records management procedures. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.9 Exceptions and Special Approvals

48.9.1 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

48.9.2 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. †

48.9.3 Exceptions to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.9.4 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.9.5 A request for an exception shall be made in the approved template and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

48.9.6 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of

equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.9.7 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 5 working days' written notice. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.9.8 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 21 working days' written notice. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.9.9 Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Reporting Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.9.10 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.9.11 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.9.12 The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. †

48.9.13 Exceptions that affect more than 10 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.9.14 A request for an exception shall be made in an HR portal request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees.

48.9.15 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.9.16 Exceptions that affect more than 5 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. Exceptions to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

48.9.17 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.9.18 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. By way of illustration, where the employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. Exceptions to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

48.9.19 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Exceptions that affect more than 7 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information.

48.9.20 Exceptions to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may be granted only in writing by the HR Director and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.9.21 Exceptions to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.9.22 Every exception shall be recorded in the central HR repository together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.9.23 An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.9.24 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Business Partner shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.9.25 Exceptions to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may be granted only in writing by the Chief People Officer and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.9.26 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Where a provision of this Chapter and a

term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.9.27 Exceptions that affect more than 3 employees shall be reported to the senior leadership team for information. An exception granted in one case shall not be treated as a precedent for any other case.

48.9.28 No exception shall be granted that would contravene applicable law or that would result in unfair treatment of other employees. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.9.29 Every exception shall be recorded in the HR information system together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise. The Company may withdraw an exception at any time by giving the employee 15 working days' written notice.

48.9.30 Exceptions to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may be granted only in writing by the Head of Human Resources and only where there are compelling business or personal reasons.

48.9.31 A request for an exception shall be made in a written request and shall explain why the standard provision cannot reasonably be applied.

48.9.32 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Line Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

48.9.33 Every exception shall be recorded in the employee's personnel file together with the reasons for it and the period for which it applies. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.10 Compliance, Monitoring and Audit

48.10.1 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.10.2 Compliance data relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.10.3 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. †

48.10.4 Compliance data relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.10.5 Compliance with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Chief People Officer.

48.10.6 An internal audit of dress code and personal presentation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

48.10.7 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to dress code and personal presentation. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. †

48.10.8 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to dress code and personal presentation. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.10.9 Where an external regulator requests information concerning dress code and personal presentation, the request shall be routed through the HR Director. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

48.10.10 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.10.11 Compliance with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.10.12 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. †

48.10.13 Compliance data relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

48.10.14 An internal audit of dress code and personal presentation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

48.10.15 An internal audit of dress code and personal presentation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Head of Department shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.10.16 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. An internal audit of dress code and personal presentation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Chief People Officer.

48.10.17 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources.

48.10.18 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.10.19 An internal audit of dress code and personal presentation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the HR Director. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned.

48.10.20 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. By way of illustration, where the employee submits an HR portal request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

48.10.21 Where an external regulator requests information concerning dress code and personal presentation, the request shall be routed through the Policy Committee.

48.10.22 Where an external regulator requests information concerning dress code and personal presentation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. Compliance data relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

48.10.23 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date.

48.10.24 Compliance data relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are

sent by e-mail. Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require.

48.10.25 Any deficiency identified shall be addressed through a corrective action plan with an owner and a completion date. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

48.10.26 Employees and managers shall give auditors access to the records and information they reasonably require. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager.

48.10.27 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to dress code and personal presentation. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee.

48.10.28 The Company shall comply with all statutory returns and inspections that relate to dress code and personal presentation. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An internal audit of dress code and personal presentation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources.

48.10.29 Where an external regulator requests information concerning dress code and personal presentation, the request shall be routed through the Chief People Officer. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.10.30 Compliance data relating to dress code and personal presentation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, an eligible employee may escalate the matter directly to the Policy Committee. Compliance with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

48.10.31 An internal audit of dress code and personal presentation shall be carried out at least once every two years and the findings shall be presented to the Head of Human Resources. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team. †

48.10.32 Where an external regulator requests information concerning dress code and personal presentation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. Compliance data relating to dress code

and personal presentation shall be reported to the Board in aggregate and shall not identify individual employees.

48.10.33 Where an external regulator requests information concerning dress code and personal presentation, the request shall be routed through the Head of Human Resources. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. Compliance with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation shall be monitored by HR through periodic reviews and spot checks.

48.11 Non-Compliance and Corrective Action

48.11.1 A failure to comply with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.11.2 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to dress code and personal presentation shall be treated as serious misconduct.

48.11.3 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to dress code and personal presentation shall be treated as serious misconduct. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith.

48.11.4 A failure to comply with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

48.11.5 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record.

48.11.6 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to dress code and personal presentation shall be treated as serious misconduct. By way of illustration, where an eligible employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Reporting Manager.

48.11.7 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.11.8 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of

the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail.

48.11.9 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. †

48.11.10 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.11.11 A failure to comply with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.11.12 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to dress code and personal presentation shall be treated as serious misconduct. †

48.11.13 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to dress code and personal presentation shall be treated as serious misconduct.

48.11.14 Where a breach has caused financial loss to the Company, the Company may recover the amount to the extent permitted by law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.11.15 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.11.16 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the staff member is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. A failure to comply with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter.

48.11.17 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation.

48.11.18 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.11.19 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. Notices under this Chapter shall be

treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.11.20 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.11.21 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the approved template after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

48.11.22 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. Cost implications, where relevant, shall be borne by the department concerned unless the Company decides otherwise.

48.11.23 A failure to comply with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.11.24 A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. †

48.11.25 Deliberate falsification of any information given in relation to dress code and personal presentation shall be treated as serious misconduct. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.11.26 A failure to comply with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

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48.11.28 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made.

48.11.29 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee. For instance, where two

employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.11.30 A failure to comply with the provisions on dress code and personal presentation may result in disciplinary action in accordance with the Disciplinary Procedures Chapter. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.11.31 An employee against whom action is proposed shall be given a fair opportunity to respond before any decision is made. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.11.32 Minor or inadvertent breaches shall ordinarily be dealt with by informal counselling and a written record of the discussion. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Head of Department. A manager who knowingly permits a breach of these provisions shall be regarded as having committed a breach himself or herself.

48.11.33 The seriousness of the action taken shall depend on the nature of the breach, its consequences and the employee's previous record. This provision is intended to be supportive rather than punitive and shall be interpreted in that spirit.

48.12 Review and Amendment

48.12.1 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it.

48.12.2 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. To illustrate, where the HR Business Partner fails to act within the prescribed period, the staff member may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail.

48.12.3 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual.

48.12.4 Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation through the HR portal not less than 2 days before it takes effect. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.12.5 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The time limits in this Chapter are intended to

ensure prompt resolution and shall be observed strictly by all concerned. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits.

48.12.6 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

48.12.7 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Chief People Officer before they take effect. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.12.8 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.12.9 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the employee submits a written request after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Operations team.

48.12.10 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.12.11 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise.

48.12.12 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.

48.12.13 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the Reporting Manager fails to act within the prescribed period, the concerned employee may escalate the matter directly to the Head of Human Resources. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

48.12.14 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.12.15 This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received. Employees shall be notified of every amendment to the provisions on dress code and personal presentation through the HR portal not less than 3 days before it takes effect.

48.12.16 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. For example, if the concerned employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager. This Chapter shall be reviewed by HR at least once every twelve months, or earlier if there is a change in law.

48.12.17 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Where a provision of this Chapter and a term of the employment contract differ, the term that is more favourable to the employee shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests relating to dress code and personal presentation, the HR Operations team shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.12.18 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the HR Director shall prevail. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. To illustrate, where the HR Operations team fails to act within the prescribed period, the employee may escalate the matter directly to the HR Director.

48.12.19 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Head of Human Resources before they take effect. This requirement applies equally to all grades, locations and employment categories unless this Chapter expressly provides otherwise. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

48.12.20 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the Policy Committee before they take effect. The Company's decision under this provision shall not affect any statutory right of the employee.

48.12.21 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. For example, if the employee is transferred to another department during the process, the matter shall continue to be dealt with under this Chapter by the new Line Manager.

48.12.22 Proposed amendments shall be circulated to the policy committee and approved by the HR Director before they take effect. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.12.23 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail. This provision shall be applied consistently, and any deviation shall be recorded together with the reason for it. By way of illustration, where the staff member submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the HR Business Partner.

48.12.24 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.12.25 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. Where the person responsible is absent, the matter shall be dealt with by a person of equivalent seniority nominated by HR.

48.12.26 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. No employee shall be victimised or treated less favourably for exercising a right under this Chapter in good faith. By way of illustration, where the concerned employee submits the prescribed form after the prescribed period, the request shall be treated as late and may be declined at the discretion of the Line Manager. The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law.

48.12.27 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. The Company will apply this provision reasonably and shall have regard to the individual circumstances of each case.

48.12.28 Unless the amendment states otherwise, it shall apply only to events occurring on or after its effective date. As an illustration, a request relating to dress code and personal presentation made on a Friday shall be treated as received on the following Monday for the purpose of calculating time limits. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail.

48.12.29 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Chief People Officer shall prevail. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record.

48.12.30 A record of amendments shall be maintained in the Document Control section of this Manual. Employees should seek guidance from HR if they are unsure how this provision applies to their situation. An example would be an employee who is absent on the day a decision is due; the decision shall then be delivered to the personal e-mail address on record. In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Policy Committee shall prevail.

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48.12.32 In the event of an ambiguity, the interpretation adopted by the Head of Human Resources shall prevail. For instance, where two employees make competing requests

relating to dress code and personal presentation, the Line Manager shall decide on the basis of business need and the order in which the requests were received.

48.12.33 The Company reserves the right to modify, suspend or withdraw any provision of this Chapter at any time, subject to law. Notices under this Chapter shall be treated as having been received on the next working day after they are sent by e-mail.